System User Guide

> **Who this guide is for:** Everyone who uses this system day-to-day — cashiers, sales staff, managers, HR, drivers, and business owners. Each section is written for a specific role. Jump straight to your section.

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1. Getting Started — All Users

Signing In

1. Open the system in your web browser.
2. Enter your email address and password.
3. Click **Sign In**.
4. If you belong to more than one business, you will be taken to your main dashboard. Use the **business switcher** (top of the screen) to switch between businesses.

The Screen Layout



- **Top bar (left):** Click the business name to switch to a different business.
- **Top bar (centre):** Main navigation links for your role.
- 🔔 **Bell icon:** Shows pending tasks waiting for your attention. A red number means action is needed.
- 👤 **Your name:** Open your profile menu. From here you can access:
    - **Profile Settings** — change your name, photo, password
    - **Printer Setup** — configure your local QZ Tray receipt printer (available to all users)
    - **Sign Out**

Collapsible Sections & Action Menus (System-Wide)

Two interface conventions now apply consistently across almost every list screen in the app — inventory, POS toolbars, employee and user management, reports, and more:

- **Collapsed-by-default sections.** Secondary controls that aren't needed on every visit — extra filters, a row of action buttons, a financial summary panel — are tucked behind a **▼ Show / ▲ Hide** toggle instead of always taking up screen space. The primary thing you actually came for (the search box, the item list, the Sale/Return/Exchange switch) always stays visible; everything else is one tap away. This is especially useful on mobile, where these panels used to push the actual content below the fold.
- **The ⋮ actions menu.** Where a table row used to show a cluttered strip of individual buttons ("View | Edit | Delete | Print…"), it's now a single ⋮ button — tap it to open a small menu listing every action available for that row. On some tables the same ⋮ menu also appears at the front of the row (near the name/photo), not just at the end, so it's reachable without scrolling all the way across a wide table on a small screen. Tapping anywhere else on the row (where noted) opens that item directly, the same as clicking "View" used to.

Both are just a different way to reach the exact same actions as before — nothing has been removed, only tidied up.

The Dashboard

When you sign in, you land on the **Dashboard**. It shows:

- **Today's activity** — sales, deposits, and transactions for the day.
- **Pending tasks** — things waiting for you to approve or complete.
- **Recent activity** — a log of what has been happening across the business.
- **Alerts** — warnings about low balances, overdue laybys, or stock levels.

Business Summary Cards

At the top of the dashboard, each business type (e.g. Clothing, Grocery, Restaurant) has its own summary card. These are only visible to users with financial data access.

Each card shows:

Row	What it means
Account balance (large number)	The running business account balance — total revenue minus expenses
Sales	Total revenue from all completed and pending orders
💵 **/** 📱 **split**	Cash vs EcoCash breakdown of sales (shown only when EcoCash sales exist)
🗳️ **Cash Box (Free)**	Physical cash and EcoCash currently held in the till and not earmarked for anything
🔒 **Earmarked**	Cash still in the till but already reserved for an allocation or payroll funding — unbounded, not limited to a recent-days window. Only shown when greater than zero — see Cash Box, Earmarked, and Expense Account on the Dashboard.

Row	What it means
🏦 **Expense Account**	The business's own expense account balance. Only shown when greater than zero.
📦 **Inventory**	Total value of stock on hand — calculated as quantity × cost price (or selling price if no cost price is set). Only shown when inventory value is greater than zero.
🏠 **Rent**	How much of this month's rent target has been contributed, with a progress bar

The **All** card at the far left shows the combined totals across every business type.

Click any card to open a detailed breakdown showing each individual business within that type, including its own 🔒 Earmarked and 🏦 Expense Account figures.

Today's Performance

Below the summary cards, the **Today's Performance** section shows a card for each active POS business (restaurant, grocery, clothing, hardware). These update automatically every 60 seconds.

Each card shows:

Row	What it means
Today orders	Number of orders placed today. Also shows how many individual items were sold (with a ▲/▼ badge comparing to yesterday's item count).
Today sales	Total dollar sales today, with a ▲/▼ badge showing the percentage change versus yesterday.
Yesterday	Yesterday's item count (▲/▼ vs the day before) and dollar sales (▲/▼ vs the day before), shown together on one line.
2 days ago	Raw item count and dollar sales from two days ago — no comparison badge since there is no third day to compare against.
Pending	Orders that have been placed but not yet completed or paid (shown only when pending orders exist).

Reading the delta badges:

- A **green** ▲ badge means that figure is higher than the previous period.
- A **red** ▼ badge means it is lower.
- The percentage shown is how much higher or lower, e.g. ▼17% means 17% less than the comparison period.
- On the **Yesterday** row, the first badge (items) compares yesterday's items to two days ago, and the second badge ($) compares yesterday's sales to two days ago.

> **Example:** "Yesterday: ▼11% 74 items ▼17% $87" means yesterday had 74 items sold (11% fewer than the day before) and $87 in sales (17% less than the day before).

Cash Position — Today

If you have access to the Cash Bucket, the dashboard also shows a **Cash Position** card row for today (Opening Balance, Cash In, Set Aside, Expenses, Available Balance, Closing Balance). This is the exact same calculation shown on the Cash Bucket page and the Cash Position Report — see **Understanding Your Cash Position** in section 3 for what each figure means.

Switching Between Businesses

If your account covers more than one business:

1. Click the business name in the top-left corner.
2. A dropdown will show all your businesses.
3. Click the one you want to work in.
4. The screen will reload, taking you to that business's **Default Landing Page** — usually its Home page, but an admin can set it to something else (e.g. POS System) per business under **Edit Business Settings → Branding** (see section 49).

> **Note:** "All" in the business switcher means the umbrella view — it shows combined data for all businesses together.

> **Tip:** If a business name is too long to fit in the switcher, hover over it to see the full name and business type in a tooltip.

Your Notifications

Click the 🔔 **bell** to open your notifications panel.

- Unread notifications appear in **bold**.
- Click a notification to go directly to the item it relates to.
- Click **Mark all as read** to clear the list.
- Click the **×** that appears on a notification row to **dismiss** it — unlike marking it read, dismissing removes it from the list immediately rather than leaving it sitting there (read) for up to 30 days. Dismissing is per-notification and only affects your own list.

Grouped by Category

Notifications are grouped into labelled sections — e.g. **Vehicle & Licensing**, **Payments**, **Petty Cash**, **Combo Requests**, **Receipts**, **Jobs**, **Inventory**, **Chat**, **Other** — so a busy day doesn't turn into one long unsorted list. Each section:

- Starts **collapsed**, showing just its icon, name, an unread count, and a total count in parentheses.
- Expands when you click its header, revealing the individual notifications underneath.
- Searching (see below) automatically expands every matching section so results aren't hidden behind a collapsed header.

Some notification types are also pre-grouped at the source — for example, vehicle/driver licence alerts collapse into a single summary notification (*"3 Licenses Overdue, 2 Expiring Soon"*) that refreshes in place as the underlying list changes, instead of adding a new row per vehicle every time the check runs. See Vehicle & Driver License Compliance Alerts.

Searching Notifications

Both the bell preview dropdown and the blue notification side-panel include a **search bar** (appears automatically when there are more than 4 items).

- Type any part of a name, amount, date, or note to filter the list instantly.
- Click the × button inside the search box to clear the filter.
- The search works across all sections of the panel simultaneously.

Jumping Directly to a Payment Request

When a **Personal Payment Request** appears in the bell preview, clicking it takes you straight to that specific request on the Pending Actions page — it scrolls into view automatically and is highlighted with a blue ring so you can spot it instantly. You do not need to scroll through the list manually.

Trusting the Site Certificate on a New Device

If your browser shows a **NET::ERR_CERT_AUTHORITY_INVALID** warning when you open the system, it means that device doesn't yet trust the server's root certificate. The fix depends on the device type. You only need to do this once per device.

> **Where to find `rootCA.pem`:** It is in the `certs\` folder on the server machine. Copy it to the device before following the steps below.

Windows PC

1. Copy these two files to the PC (via USB drive or network share):
   - `rootCA.pem`
   - `setup-ssl.bat`

   Both files must be in the **same folder**.
2. Double-click **setup-ssl.bat** to run it.
3. When it says **Done!**, close and reopen Chrome — the warning will be gone.

If the script fails (no admin rights): install manually —

- Open Chrome → go to `chrome://settings/security` → **Manage certificates** → **Trusted Root Certification Authorities** → **Import** → select `rootCA.pem`.

Android Phone or Tablet

1. Transfer `rootCA.pem` to the device (via Google Drive, WhatsApp, USB cable, etc.).
2. Open the file from the device's file manager — Android will prompt you to install it.
3. Give it a name (e.g. *Multi-Business App CA*) and set **Used for: CA certificate** (or **VPN and apps** on older Android versions). Tap **OK**.
4. Open Chrome and navigate to the app — the warning will be gone.

> On Android 11 and newer you may need to go to **Settings** → **Security** → **Encryption & credentials** → **Install a certificate** → **CA certificate** and select the file from there if tapping it directly doesn't work.

iPhone or iPad

1. Transfer `rootCA.pem` to the device (via AirDrop, email, iCloud Drive, etc.) and tap/open it — iOS will show **"Profile Downloaded"**.
2. Go to **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap the downloaded profile → tap **Install** (top right) → enter your passcode → tap **Install** again to confirm.
3. Go to **Settings** → **General** → **About** → **Certificate Trust Settings** → toggle **on** the certificate listed under *Enable Full Trust for Root Certificates*.
4. Open Safari or Chrome and navigate to the app.

> Step 3 is required — without it iOS installs the certificate but does not trust it for HTTPS, so the warning will persist.

Quick Reference

Device	Script available?	Notes
Windows PC	Yes — `setup-ssl.bat`	Or use Chrome → Manage certificates
Android	No	Install via file manager or Settings → Security
iPhone / iPad	No	Install profile, then enable trust in Settings → About

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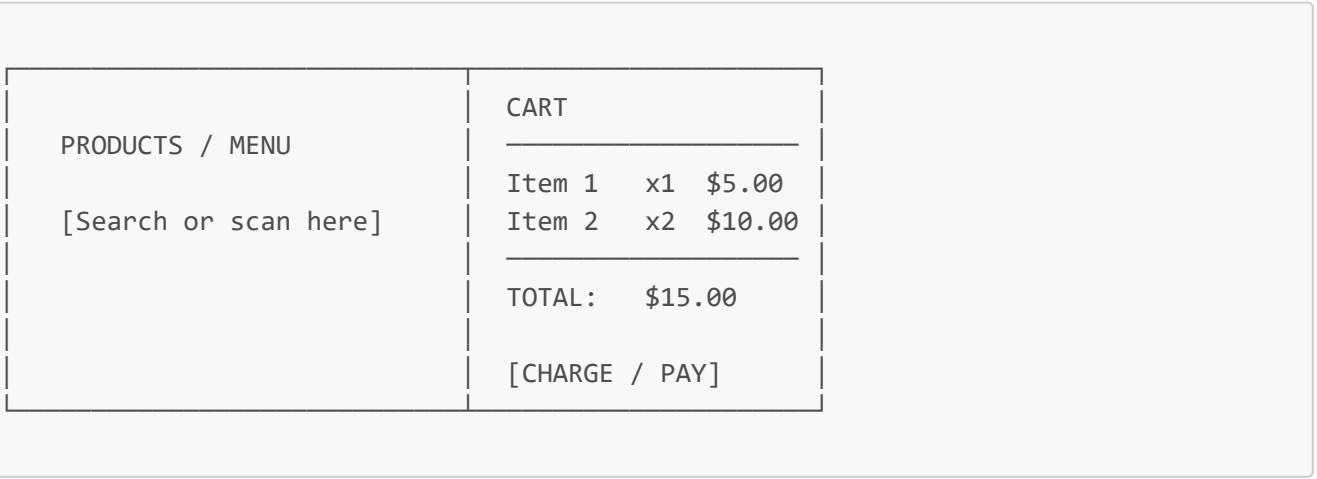
2. POS Cashier — Making Sales

> **Who reads this:** Anyone serving customers at the till — cashiers, sales assistants, restaurant servers.

Opening the POS

From the top menu, go to your business section and click **POS**, or use **Universal POS** if your location uses the shared till.

The POS screen has three areas:



Step 1 — Finding a Product

Option A — Search by name: Type the product name in the search box. Results appear as you type. Click the item to add it to the cart.

Option B — Scan a barcode: Point your barcode scanner at the product. It will be added to the cart automatically.

Option C — Browse by category: Click a category button (e.g., "Beverages", "Groceries", "Clothing") to see only items in that group.

Option D — Manual entry: If an item is not in the system, click **Manual Entry**, type a description and a price, and add it.

Step 2 — The Cart

Once items are in the cart:

- **Change quantity:** Click the **+** or **−** buttons next to an item, or type a number directly.
- **Remove an item:** Click the 🗑 **bin icon** next to the item.
- **Apply a discount to one item:** Click the item price and choose a percentage or fixed-amount discount.
- **Apply a coupon code:** Click **Add Coupon** and type the code. The discount will be deducted from the total.

Step 3 — Selecting a Customer (Optional but Recommended)

Linking a customer to an order enables purchase history tracking, loyalty reward qualification, layby accounts, and targeted campaigns. It takes only a few seconds at checkout.

Searching for an Existing Customer

1. Click **Select Customer** (above the cart).
2. A search box appears. Type at least 2 characters — the system searches by:
    - Customer name
    - Phone number
    - Customer number (e.g., `RES-CUST-000012`)
    - Email address
3. Matching results appear as a dropdown. Click the customer's name to select them.

Their name appears at the top of the cart. The order will be recorded against their account.

Scanning the Customer's Loyalty Card

The fastest method — no typing required:

1. Point the barcode scanner at the customer's loyalty card.
2. The system recognises the customer number barcode (format `RES-CUST-000012`) and **instantly pre-selects the customer** in the POS.
3. If the cashier is on a different business's POS than where the customer was registered, a prompt appears asking whether to switch to the correct POS.

> Scanning a loyalty card works at any time — even if someone else is using the screen. A customer scan never interrupts an in-progress sale.

Creating a New Customer at the POS (Inline)

If the customer is not yet in the system, you can register them without leaving the POS:

1. Click **Select Customer** → type their name → click **+ Add New Customer**.
2. Fill in:
    - **Full name** *(required)*
    - **Phone number** *(required — minimum 9 digits)*
    - Email, address, and other details are optional and can be added later
3. Click **Save**.
4. The system generates a customer number and immediately selects them for the current order.
5. A **Print Loyalty Card** button appears — print the card and hand it to the customer before they leave.

Why Associate a Customer with an Order?

Benefit	How it works
Purchase history	Every sale is recorded — manager can see what they bought and when
Loyalty rewards	Spending tracked against campaigns; eligible customers earn rewards automatically
Layby accounts	Customer can pay off items over time (requires a customer account)
Targeted campaigns	Customers who reach a spend threshold earn discount credits, free items, or WiFi passes
Customer activity report	Manager can identify top spenders, at-risk customers, and lapsed customers

Continuing Without a Customer (Walk-In)

If the customer does not want to share their details or you are too busy:

- Simply leave the customer field blank and proceed.
- The sale is recorded as a **Walk-In** order — it is complete and correct, but no purchase history is attached to an individual.

Step 4 — Processing Payment

Click **Charge** or **Pay Now** to open the payment screen.

Choose a payment method:

Method	When to use
Cash	Customer pays with notes/coins. Enter the amount received — the system calculates change.
Card	Customer pays by debit or credit card. Select Card and confirm.
Check	Customer pays by cheque. Enter cheque number.

Method	When to use
Split Payment	Customer pays part cash and part card. Click each method and enter the amount for each.

After selecting the method and entering amounts, click **Complete Sale**.

Cash Rounding

Cash rounding avoids impractical change by adjusting the payment total to the nearest step boundary (default $0.50). The system supports two directions: **round up** (customer pays a small amount more) and **round down** (customer receives a small discount). Both are fully logged. The right place to apply rounding depends on whether the order contains an AYLI combo.

AYLI Combo Orders — Round or Confirm in the Modal (recommended)

When filling an AYLI combo, the rounding decision is made **inside the AYLI modal, before the item enters the cart**. Once all ingredients are captured, the modal footer shows up to four options:

Button	Colour	What it does
↑ **$X.XX (+$Y.YY)**	Green	**Round up.** Distributes the extra amount proportionally across the ingredient prices for this sale only. The combo enters the cart at the rounded-up total. Calibration prices in the database are never touched.
↓ **$X.XX (−$Y.YY)**	Orange	**Round down.** Keeps every ingredient price exactly as weighed. A separate **Promotional Discount (CR) −$Y.YY** line is injected into the cart below the combo — the customer sees it as a good-gesture discount. Only shown when the discount does not exceed the configured **Max Round-Down Discount** (default $0.10).
Keep $X.XX	Grey	Add the combo at its exact calculated price. No rounding applied.
Cancel	—	Cancel the entire combo and return to the POS.

Round up — how the adjustment is spread: The extra cents are distributed across ingredients using a largest-remainder algorithm so the line prices always sum precisely to the rounded total. Heavier or more expensive lines absorb slightly more. Only this one sale is affected.

Round down — what the customer sees on the receipt: The AYLI combo line prints at its exact weighed price. Directly below it, a separate line reads:

```
Promotional Discount (CR)           -$0.41
```

This signals to the customer that they received a courtesy discount, not that the food was mis-weighed. The " (CR)" suffix is internal shorthand for cash rounding — the customer simply sees a promotional discount on their receipt.

Strategy tip — aim for a round number during filling: The scale readout in Step 3 shows a pending cost line and a live rounding gap:

```
+0.133 kg → Beef dishes  (+$0.83)
New total: $1.89  ·  +$0.11 to reach $2.00
```

Add or remove a tiny amount of food to land within a few cents of a boundary before tapping Capture — this makes the rounding adjustment negligible and the choice between round up/down easier.

Non-AYLI Orders — Amber Rounding Panel in Payment

> **AYLI orders:** Rounding is handled entirely inside the AYLI modal before the combo enters the cart. The payment screen does **not** show a rounding panel when the cart contains an AYLI combo.

For orders containing only regular menu items (no AYLI combo), an amber rounding panel appears automatically in the payment screen when the cart total does not land on a step boundary.

Element	What it shows
Sub-total	The exact cart total before rounding
Round up (+$X.XX)	The gap to the next step boundary
Rounded Total	What the customer will pay after rounding

Button	What it does
Apply $X.XX Rounding	Sets the rounded-up amount as the final total and logs the event.
Round down to $X.XX (−$Y.YY)	Sets the rounded-down amount as the final total (customer pays less). Only shown when the discount does not exceed the configured **Max Round-Down Discount** (default $0.10).
Keep $X.XX	Dismisses the panel and charges the exact total.

When the rounding gap is ≤ the configured auto-apply threshold (default $0.05), rounding is applied automatically without any button press.

Every rounding event — whether from the AYLI modal or the payment panel — is logged to the **Cash Rounding Report** (Reports → Cash Rounding). The log records the original amount, rounded amount, adjustment, direction (UP/DOWN), and the cashier's name.

> **Configuration:** Cash rounding is enabled by default with a $0.50 step. Managers can adjust the step, auto-apply threshold, and maximum round-down discount in **Business Settings → Cash Rounding Configuration**. See Section 49 — Edit Business Settings.

Step 5 — The Receipt

After payment is processed:

1. On business types that share the universal POS screen (vehicle service, hardware, services, construction, consulting, retail, and any other type without its own dedicated POS page — restaurant, grocery, and clothing each have their own), an **Order Complete** confirmation appears first — order number, items, and (for a WiFi sale) the token/credentials or a clear error if generation failed — with **Print Receipt** and **Close** buttons. Clicking **Print Receipt** opens the receipt preview described below; **Close** skips printing without affecting the sale, which is already recorded either way.
2. A **receipt preview modal** appears showing the full receipt.
3. Choose your print method from the dropdown:
    - **QZ Tray Printer** — sends directly to your saved local printer (fastest, no dialog). Requires QZ Tray to be running and a printer saved via **Profile** → **Printer Setup**.
    - **Browser Print** — opens the browser's print dialog. Works on any machine but may need margin adjustments.
4. Click **Print Receipt**.
5. If the sale includes a WiFi token, the token details (username and password) are printed on the receipt automatically.

> 📋 **Copy** — the receipt preview also has a Copy button (next to Preview/Print) that copies the full receipt as plain text to your clipboard, e.g. to paste into an email or chat instead of printing. It briefly shows ✅ **Copied** as confirmation. This is available everywhere this same receipt preview is used, including WiFi/R710 token sales.

> **Tip:** If the customer does not need a printed receipt, click **Skip**.

> **First time printing?** Go to 👤 **Profile** → **Printer Setup** to connect QZ Tray and save your printer. See Section 26 — Printer Setup & QZ Tray for full instructions.

Handling a $0 Sale (Free Items or Fully Discounted Orders)

If a discount brings the total to $0.00:

- The system will allow you to complete the sale without choosing a payment method.
- Click **Complete Sale** and a receipt can still be printed.

Voiding / Cancelling a Sale

If you need to cancel before payment is complete:

- Click **Clear Cart** to remove all items and start over.
- If you need to cancel a completed sale, contact your manager — completed sales need to be voided by a manager.

Re-ordering from Recent Orders

Every POS user (admin and non-admin alike) can quickly repeat a previous order using the **Recent Orders** panel in the POS sidebar.

How it works:

1. In the left-hand sidebar, find the 📋 **Recent Orders** collapsible section. It shows today's last 5 orders.

2. Click on any order row to expand it. You will see the full list of items and the order total.
3. Click **+ Re-order** to add all items from that order to the current cart.
4. Items are merged into the cart — if an item is already in the cart, its quantity is increased rather than creating a duplicate line.

> **Tip:** The most recent order is labelled **latest** and is always at the top of the list.

This works in both the **Restaurant POS** and **Grocery POS**. Admins and managers see the same panel in their financial summary section; salespeople see it as a standalone collapsible card at the top of the product area.

Customer Display Screen

If your till has a second screen facing the customer, it shows:

- Items currently in the cart, at their exact priced amounts — these never change.
- The running total. Once a cash payment is started and rounding is confirmed (see **Cash Rounding**, section 49), this figure updates to the **rounded** total the customer actually pays and the change is calculated against — only the total is ever rounded, individual line items are not.
- Promotions and advertisements when the till is idle.
- The **salesperson's name and photo** — if a salesperson has been selected using the Salesperson Selector at the top of the POS, the display shows that person's name, not the logged-in user's name. This lets you correctly identify which staff member is serving the customer even if multiple people share the same login session.

> **Note:** The customer display updates automatically when a salesperson is selected or changed. The display always reflects the salesperson currently active on the POS, not the account used to sign in.

How the second screen actually opens depends on how you're running the POS:

- **Desktop app (Electron) with a second monitor connected** — opens automatically, full screen, the moment the app starts. Nothing to click.

> **Note on the desktop app window itself:** the main app window always runs maximized and cannot be resized or minimized — this is intentional on a till, so the app can't accidentally get hidden behind other windows or shrunk to an unusable size. The ✕ **close** button still works normally; if you need to fully exit the app, close it and relaunch when needed.

- **Desktop, plain browser** — never opens on its own. Click the 🖥️ **Display** button at the top of the POS to open it (a one-time browser permission prompt appears the first time). Use this to test the customer display on a regular browser without installing the desktop app.
- **Phone or tablet** — the 🖥️ **Display** button doesn't appear at all. A mobile device has only one screen, so there's nothing for a second display to open on.

> **Applies to every business type**, including vehicle_service, services, vehicles, construction, and consulting — these share the Universal POS page, which didn't broadcast cart/order updates to the customer display at all until this was fixed; restaurant/grocery/clothing/hardware (each with their own dedicated POS page) always had it. If a second screen on one of these business types still shows nothing, confirm the workstation is on a build that includes this fix rather than assuming it's unsupported for that business type.

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3. Cash Office — Cash Handling & End of Day

> **Who reads this:** Cashiers responsible for counting cash, funding the cash box, and closing the day's books.

The Cash Bucket (Physical Cash Tracking)

The **Cash Bucket** is the system's record of physical cash at each business location. Every time cash comes in from sales or goes out for expenses, it should be recorded here.

Viewing Cash Box Status

Go to **Cash Bucket** in the menu. You will see:

- A **Cash Position** summary (see below) for today, plus the per-business breakdown.
- The current cash balance for each business location, with a small colour dot next to each business name so you can tell them apart at a glance when several are shown together (see **Display Colour**, section 49).
- Recent transactions (INFLOW = cash in, OUTFLOW = cash out).

Understanding Your Cash Position

The **Cash Position** card row appears on the Dashboard, the Cash Bucket page, and the Cash Position Report — it always shows the same six figures, calculated the same way, for whatever business and date range you're looking at:

Figure	What it means
Opening Balance	The cash on hand at the very start of the selected period.
Cash In	Cash that came in during the period — EOD sales receipts, direct deposits, petty cash returned, and EcoCash-to-cash conversions.
Set Aside	Cash moved out of "free" cash during the period for a specific purpose (rent, payroll funding, or another earmarked allocation) — it's still in the cash box, just reserved.
Expenses	Cash that actually left the business during the period — approved payments and petty cash issued out.
Available Balance	Closing Balance minus everything still currently earmarked (see **Set Aside by Purpose** below) — the cash you can actually spend right now.
Closing Balance	The cash on hand at the end of the period: Opening + Cash In − Set Aside − Expenses (± any manual adjustments).

> If you ever see a small note like "Includes $X in manual adjustments this period," it means an admin made a manual correction to the cash box during that period — the Closing Balance always reconciles exactly even when that happens.

Set Aside by Purpose. Rather than one lump "earmarked" number, the Cash Bucket page and Cash Position Report break Set Aside down by what it's actually for — Rent, Payroll, or another named allocation — showing

four columns: **This Period**, **Lifetime Contributed**, **Lifetime Disbursed**, and **Still Available**. This gives you both the immediate picture (what happened this period) and the running picture (how much of that purpose's funding is still sitting unspent) in one table.

Drilling in. On the Cash Position Report, clicking most of the cards takes you further:

- **Cash In** or **Expenses** — jumps to the ledger below, filtered to just the transactions that make up that figure.
- **Set Aside** — jumps to the Set Aside by Purpose table.
- **Available Balance** or **Closing Balance** — opens a small breakdown showing exactly how the system got to that number, step by step (Opening → Cash In → Set Aside → Expenses → Closing, or Closing → each earmarked purpose → Available). Each step in that breakdown is itself clickable and takes you to the matching transactions.

Cash Comes In Automatically

Sales processed through the POS are recorded as cash inflows automatically when the cashier processes a cash payment. You do not need to enter these manually.

Recording a Cash Withdrawal

When cash is taken out of the cash box (for an expense, a payment run, or a transfer):

1. Go to **Cash Bucket**.
2. Click **New Entry** or **Record Withdrawal**.
3. Enter the amount, the reason, and your name.
4. Click **Save**.

Keep the printed voucher as a physical record.

Payment Batch Workflow (Paying Approved Expenses from the Cash Box)

When approved expenses need to be paid out:

1. A manager will have approved a **Payment Batch** in the Expense Accounts module.
2. You will receive a **Withdrawal Voucher** (printed or emailed) listing how much to pull from each cash box.
3. Pull the specified cash amount from each cash box listed on the voucher.
4. Give the cash to the person being paid and ask them to sign the voucher.
5. Record the withdrawal in the Cash Bucket (if not already recorded by the system).

End-of-Day Close — Full Walkthrough

The EOD process finalises the day's trading, transfers money into savings accounts, reconciles cash, and locks the records so they cannot be changed.

Step 1 — Open the EOD Report Page

Go to **[Your Business]** → **Reports** → **End of Day** (e.g. Restaurant → Reports → End of Day).

The page loads today's trading summary:

- Total sales and order count
- Breakdown by payment method (Cash, Card, etc.)
- Sales per employee
- Sales by category

Review these figures before proceeding. If numbers look wrong, investigate before closing.

Step 2 — Rent Transfer (if configured)

If your business has a **Rent Account** configured with "Auto-transfer on EOD" turned on, a rent transfer section appears.

What it does: Records the configured daily rent amount (e.g. $16.00) against the Rent Expense Account balance. This builds up the rent balance so that when rent is due the full amount is confirmed as set aside.

- Click **Include Rent Transfer** (or it may run automatically).
- The system checks whether a transfer was already done today (it will not double-transfer).
- The rent account balance increases by the daily amount.
- A transaction record is created with type `EOD_RENT_TRANSFER`.

Important — where the money physically lives: The daily rent amount is tracked as part of the cash bucket (all physical cash is kept in the cash bucket). The rent account is a **bookkeeping record** that shows how much of the cash bucket is earmarked for rent. When rent is eventually paid out, the full rent amount is drawn from the cash bucket.

What the transfer is checked against: real available cash — the cash bucket's running balance plus whatever cash you count in at Step 4 — not the business's sales-revenue balance. A day with heavy card/EcoCash sales and little actual cash on hand will correctly skip the transfer rather than moving money that isn't physically there.

> **If rent transfer is skipped (not enough real cash on hand):** the EOD does not stop — it's silently skipped for that day, no money moves, and the Cash Allocation report (Step 6) shows a red **"🏠 ⚠ Rent Transfer SKIPPED — insufficient cash available"** row instead of the usual rent deduction. The missed day is tracked automatically and can be manually caught up later once cash is available — see Allocation Backlog & Manual Catch-Up.

Step 3 — Auto-Deposits (if configured)

If auto-deposit rules are set up (e.g. "move $10/day into the Staff Welfare account"), a preview table appears listing every active auto-deposit:

Account	Daily Amount	Status
Staff Welfare Fund	$10.00	✅ Will process
Building Maintenance	$5.00	⏭ Skipped (cap reached)

What each status means:

- **Will process** — the deposit will run and money moves from the business account to that expense account.
- **Cap reached** — the account has already accumulated its configured maximum; no deposit today.
- **Insufficient funds** — there isn't enough **real available cash** (cash bucket balance + today's counted cash) to cover this deposit — checked in priority order (`displayOrder`), so once one config runs out of cash, every lower-priority config after it is skipped too for that day.
- **Frozen / Inactive** — the expense account is not accepting deposits right now.
- **Before start / After end date** — the auto-deposit schedule is outside its active window.

Click **Process Auto-Deposits** to execute. The system processes each eligible deposit and shows a results summary.

> Auto-deposits are idempotent — running EOD twice for the same date will not deposit twice.

> **Every "Insufficient funds" skip is tracked automatically** — nothing just silently vanishes. Once real cash becomes available (today's sales, or a quieter config further down the priority list freeing up room), you can manually catch up on any missed day for that account — see Allocation Backlog & Manual Catch-Up.

Step 3b — Payroll Account Auto-Contribution (Automatic)

Below the expense account auto-deposit rows, the EOD preview table shows a **Payroll Account** row. This is separate from the expense account auto-deposits — it runs automatically whenever the conditions below are met and requires no manual setup or toggle.

What it does: Calculates a daily cash contribution from this business's sales into the shared Payroll Account, so that the account is gradually funded throughout the month ready for salary payments.

How the amount is calculated:

1. Adds up the base salary + living allowance of every employee with an active contract across all businesses (total monthly payroll).
2. Works out how much is still needed to reach that target (remaining = target − current payroll balance).
3. Calculates this business's share based on how many of its employees have active contracts (e.g. 3 of 8 total = 37.5% share).
4. Divides the share by the remaining days in the month to get today's daily target.
5. Caps the contribution at 80% of net daily sales (sales minus prorated daily rent, if a rent config is active).
6. Floors the result to a whole dollar — contributions below $1.00 are skipped.

What you see on the EOD screen:

Condition	What the row shows
Contribution calculated	💼 Payroll Account — `3/8 staff · 38% share` — **$42**
Already done today	💼 Payroll Account — `Already contributed today` — **$42**
Payroll fully funded	⚠ Skipped — `Payroll account already fully funded`

Condition	What the row shows
No contracts for business	⚠ Skipped — `No contracts for this business`
Contribution rounds to $0	⚠ Skipped — `Contribution rounds to $0 (target $3, net sales $2.40)`
Insufficient cash available	⚠ Skipped — `Insufficient cash available (target $42, available $18.50)`
No global payroll account	⚠ Skipped — `No global payroll account`

The row is informational only — you cannot override or skip it. It either runs automatically when EOD is processed or is silently skipped.

Why a business might show "Skipped":

Skipped reason	What to do
`No contracts for this business`	The most common cause. The business has no active employee contracts assigned to it. Go to **Employees** → **[Employee]** → **New Contract** and ensure the contract's **Primary Business** is set to this business and the contract status is **active**.
`No global payroll account`	A one-time admin task. Ask your administrator to create the global payroll account under **Payroll** → **Payroll Account**.
`Payroll account already fully funded`	Good — the target is already met for the month. No action needed.
`Contribution rounds to $0`	Today's net sales were too low relative to the contribution target. Will retry tomorrow. No action needed.
`Insufficient cash available`	There isn't enough **real cash** (cash bucket balance + today's counted cash) to cover the contribution — this checks physical cash on hand, not the business's sales-revenue balance. The skipped day is tracked automatically and can be caught up manually once cash is available — see Allocation Backlog & Manual Catch-Up.

> **No toggle or setting is needed to enable this.** As long as the business has active contracts and a sufficient business account balance, the payroll contribution will happen automatically on every EOD.

Step 4 — Enter Manager Name and Cash Count

Two fields appear at the bottom of the EOD page:

1. **Manager Name** — type the name of the manager authorising the close. This is your electronic signature on the day's records.

2. **Cash Counted** (optional) — count the physical notes and coins in the till and enter the total here.

What the system does with the cash count:

- Calculates **Expected Cash** = total cash sales from the POS for the day.
- Calculates **Variance** = Cash Counted − Expected Cash.
- A positive variance means more cash than expected (overage).
- A negative variance means less cash than expected (shortage).

The variance is saved in the report. Managers review it — small variances are normal (rounding, change errors); large variances need investigation.

Step 5 — Save and Lock the EOD Report

Click **Save EOD Report** (or **Close Day**). A two-step confirmation modal appears:

Step 1 — Manager confirmation:

- Enter the **Manager Name** (your electronic signature on the record).
- Enter the **Cash Counted** (optional) — the physical till count. The system calculates the variance automatically.

Step 2 — EcoCash Transaction Verification: All EcoCash orders for the day are listed with checkboxes:

Field	Meaning
Time	When the EcoCash payment was processed
Amount	Gross amount charged to the customer (including fee)
Reference code	The EcoCash transaction code entered at the POS

Check off each transaction you have confirmed against your EcoCash merchant statement. The **Confirmed EcoCash total** updates as you tick. You can also **Deselect All** and re-check individually.

> **Note:** EcoCash reference codes are captured at the point of sale. If a transaction shows "—" instead of a code, it was processed before this feature was fully enabled — go forward all new sales will capture the code automatically.

Click **Save & Lock** to finalise.

What happens:

- The report is saved as a **locked snapshot** — the figures cannot be changed after this point.
- Status changes to **Locked**.
- The cash allocation report (for the cashier's physical handover) is generated automatically.
- A notification is sent to the approver.

> Once locked, an EOD report can only be reviewed, not edited. Contact your system administrator if a correction is genuinely needed.

Step 6 — Cash Allocation Review (Cashier Follow-up)

After the EOD is saved, a **Cash Allocation Report** is created automatically. This is the cashier's checklist for handing over the day's cash to the designated accounts.

Go to **[Business]** → **Reports** → **Cash Allocation** to open it.

Cash Distribution summary at the top shows, in order:

- 💵 **Cash Received** — what the manager counted at EOD.
- 🪣 **+ Cash Bucket Carried Over** — the running cash-bucket balance left over from previous days (only shown when there is one). Deductions aren't limited to just today's own count — they can legitimately draw on this carried-over float, which is why a lean day can still fully cover rent/loan/payroll without it being a shortfall.
- **= Total Available to Allocate Today** — the two added together.
- 🏠 **Less: Rent Transfer**, 💼 **Less: Payroll Contribution**, 🏦 **Less: [account]** — one row per deduction that actually happened.
- ✅ **Remaining Cash Bucket Balance** — what's left after all of the above, shown in red as ⚠ **Cash Bucket Shortfall** only if it's genuinely negative.

The itemized table below lists every money movement from the EOD:

- Rent transfer (with amount) — or, on a day it was skipped for lack of cash, a red **"⚠ Rent Transfer SKIPPED — insufficient cash available"** row with the configured amount struck through and $0.00 actually deducted.
- Each auto-deposit (with account name and amount).

Only deposits that **actually happened** appear here — a config that was skipped for insufficient cash simply has no row (see Allocation Backlog & Manual Catch-Up to see and recover any skipped amounts).

For each line item the cashier must:

1. Count the physical cash matching that line item.
2. Check the checkbox ✅ and confirm the amount.

Once all items are checked and amounts match:

- Click **Lock Allocation**.
- The system records a **Cash Bucket OUTFLOW** for each line item (cash leaving the till), plus one **Cash Bucket INFLOW** for the day's counted cash.
- The report status changes to **LOCKED** — the day's cash reconciliation is complete.

> **Nothing here can allocate more than real cash actually covers.** Every rent transfer, auto-deposit, and payroll contribution is checked against real available cash (cash bucket balance + today's count) *before* it's ever created — not after. If cash genuinely isn't there, the item is skipped rather than force-created, and the skip is tracked so it can be caught up later — see the next section.

Catching Up Missed Days (Grouped EOD)

If EOD was not run for one or more past days, use **Grouped EOD Catch-Up**:

1. Go to **[Business]** → **Reports** → **EOD Catch-Up** (or the manager will open it from Cash Allocation).
2. **Step 1 — Select days**: A list of unclosed dates appears (up to 60 days back). Tick the ones to close.
3. **Step 2 — Preview**: See the sales totals and order counts for each selected day before committing.
4. **Step 3 — Manager sign-off**: Enter the manager name and a single **total cash received** figure covering all selected days combined.
5. **Step 4 — Run**: The system closes each day in order (oldest first), running rent transfers and auto-deposits for each. A single grouped cash allocation report is created covering all selected dates.

The catch-up run is also idempotent — if it fails partway through and you run it again, already-processed days are skipped.

Funding Payroll from the Cash Box

When the manager runs payroll, they may ask you to pull cash for salary payments:

1. The manager will generate a **Payroll Cash Box Withdrawal Voucher** (a PDF document).
2. The voucher lists each business location and how much to pull from each cash box.
3. Count out the amounts listed on the voucher.
4. Hand the cash to the payroll officer.
5. Both you and the payroll officer sign the voucher.
6. The system automatically records the withdrawal — you do not need to enter it manually.

Eco-Cash to Cash Conversions

A **Cash Bucket** cashier can convert eco-cash (mobile money) into physical cash for customers or staff. The system tracks the transaction through a multi-step approval workflow so that both the eco-cash wallet balance and the physical cash balance stay accurate.

Who Is Involved

Role	What they do
Requester	Submits a request for a specific dollar amount to be converted from eco-cash to cash
Cashier / Approver	Reviews the request, verifies the eco-cash balance is sufficient, and confirms the tendered amount
Cashier / Completer	Physically sends the eco-cash transfer, receives the cash, and records the final amounts

Approver and Completer can be the same person.

Step 1 — Submitting a Conversion Request (Requester)

1. Go to **Cash Bucket** in the menu.
2. Click **New Eco-Cash Conversion** (or the equivalent button on the page).
3. Select the **business** whose eco-cash wallet will be used.

4. Enter the **amount** you want converted (in USD).
5. Add any **notes** — e.g. the reason or the recipient's name.
6. Click **Submit Request**.

The request is created with status **PENDING** and a notification is sent to cashiers with approval access.

Step 2 — Approving the Request (Cashier)

1. Open the 🔔 **bell** menu or go to **Pending Actions**. Pending eco-cash conversions appear under *Eco-Cash Conversions*.
2. Click **Review** to open the **Cash Bucket** page.
3. Find the PENDING conversion in the list.
4. Click **Approve**.
5. In the dialog, confirm the **Tendered Amount** — this is the exact eco-cash amount that will be sent to the requester. It may differ slightly from the requested amount (e.g. the requested amount is $66.00 but eco-cash fees round it to $66.35).
6. Click **Approve**.

The system checks that the eco-cash wallet has sufficient balance before approving. If the balance is too low, the approval is blocked.

The status changes to **APPROVED**.

Step 3 — Completing the Conversion (Cashier)

After approval:

1. Open the eco-cash app or use the USSD interface to send the approved amount to the requester's eco-cash number. The requester **must have the cash ready** to hand over.
2. Note the **transaction code** from the eco-cash confirmation SMS or app (e.g. `66567DE`).
3. Back in the system, find the APPROVED conversion and click **Complete**.
4. Fill in the three fields:

Field	What to enter	Required?
Eco-Cash Transaction Code	The reference code from the eco-cash confirmation message	Optional but strongly recommended
Eco-Cash Total Sent	The exact decimal amount debited from the eco-cash wallet (e.g. `66.35`) — may include fees	Required
Cash Tendered	The whole dollar amount of physical cash you received from the requester (e.g. `67`)	Required

5. Click **Confirm & Complete**.

The system:

- Records an **OUTFLOW** from the eco-cash wallet for the exact eco-cash amount sent.

- Records an **INFLOW** into the cash bucket for the cash received.
- Marks the conversion as **COMPLETED** and stores the transaction code.

Step 4 — Rejecting a Request (if needed)

If a request cannot be processed (insufficient balance, incorrect amount, or suspicious request):

1. Find the PENDING conversion and click **Reject**.
2. Enter a **rejection reason** — this is saved and visible to the requester.
3. Click **Reject**.

The status changes to **REJECTED** and the requester can see the reason.

Status Overview

Status	Meaning
PENDING	Request submitted, awaiting cashier approval
APPROVED	Cashier confirmed the tendered amount; ready to complete
COMPLETED	Eco-cash sent, cash received, ledger entries created
REJECTED	Request declined; no ledger entries created

Important Tips

- Always record the **transaction code**. If the eco-cash payment is disputed later, the code is your proof.
- The **Eco-Cash Total Sent** (decimal) and **Cash Tendered** (integer) may differ — fees, rounding, or change. Enter both exactly as they occurred. The system uses each figure for the correct ledger side.
- The eco-cash balance check happens at **Approve** time. If another transaction reduces the balance between approval and completion, the system will still allow completion — always verify the balance yourself before sending.
- Completed conversions appear in the list with a summary: *EcoCash: $66.35 → Cash: $67* and the transaction code for quick reference.

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4. Manager — Approvals, Payroll & Reports

> **Who reads this:** Business managers and business owners responsible for approving staff requests, running payroll, and reviewing financial performance.

Your Pending Actions Queue

The 🔔 **bell icon** at the top of the screen shows you how many things are waiting for your attention.

Click the bell or go to **Pending Actions** to see everything in one place. Items include:

- Expense payment requests from staff

- Salary increase requests
- Petty cash requests
- Payroll periods ready for approval
- Eco-Cash to Cash conversion requests (cashiers only)
- **Return Confirmations Needed** — a requester has reported returning unused funds (an expense payment or CASH petty cash) and a cashier needs to confirm receipt before the account is credited — see Returning Unused Funds below

Click any item to review and approve or decline it.

Grouped by category: the bell preview organises items into collapsed sections (Payment Batches, Return Confirmations Needed, Petty Cash, Cash Allocations, Supplier Payments, and so on), each showing just a count until you click its header to expand it — so a large queue stays manageable instead of one long scroll. Searching automatically expands any section with a match.

Searching the bell dropdown: When there are more than 4 pending items, a search box appears at the top of the bell preview. Type to filter by name, amount, account, or note — type a dollar amount like **"$20"** to match $20.00 through $20.99 regardless of the exact cents. Click **×** to clear.

Searching the full Pending Actions page: A search bar at the top of the page filters all sections at once — including by amount, same "$20" matches $20.xx behaviour — useful when you have many items across different categories.

Going straight to a request: Clicking a Personal Payment Request in the bell preview opens the Pending Actions page and scrolls directly to that card, which is highlighted with a blue ring for 2–3 seconds.

Setting Up EOD Payroll Auto-Contribution for a Business

> **Use this section if a business (e.g. Mvimvi) is running EOD but the Payroll Account row is showing "Skipped — No contracts for this business" or is not contributing anything.**

The payroll auto-contribution is completely automatic — there is no on/off switch. It runs during every EOD as long as four conditions are met. Work through the checklist below in order.

Checklist: Why Is [Business Name] Not Contributing to Payroll?

Step 1 — Confirm the global payroll account exists (one-time, admin only)

Go to **Payroll** → **Payroll Account** in the top navigation. If you see a payroll account with a balance and transaction history, this is already done — skip to Step 2.

If there is no payroll account, ask your administrator to create one:

- Navigate to **Admin** → **Payroll Account** → **Create**
- Leave the "Business" field blank (it must be a global account, not linked to one business)
- Set status to **Active**

This only needs to be done once for the entire system.

Step 2 — Ensure the business has employees with active contracts (most common fix)

This is the most frequent reason a business is skipped. The system counts how many employees have an **active contract** with **this business set as their Primary Business**.

1. Go to **Employees** and filter by the business (e.g. Mvimvi).
2. For each employee who works at this business, click their name → **Contracts**.
3. Check that at least one contract shows status **Active**.
4. Check that the contract's **Primary Business** field is set to this business (e.g. Mvimvi) — not to another business or left blank.

If an employee has no active contract:

- Go to **Employees** → **[Employee Name]** → **New Contract**
- Fill in Job Title, Compensation Type, Base Salary, Start Date
- Set **Primary Business** = Mvimvi (or the correct business)
- Submit — the contract starts as a draft and must be activated

If an employee's contract shows the wrong Primary Business:

- Create a new contract renewal with the correct Primary Business set
- The old contract will be superseded

> The system calculates this business's payroll share as: `(number of this business's active contracts) ÷ (all active contracts across all businesses)`. Even one active contract is enough for the contribution to start.

Step 3 — Ensure the business account has a balance

Go to **[Business]** → **Business Account** (or **Finance** → **Business Account**). The current balance must be greater than $0 and greater than the daily contribution amount.

If the balance is $0:

- Record today's sales income into the business account, or
- Make a manual deposit into the business account before running EOD

The system will not debit a business account that cannot cover the contribution.

Step 4 — Check the rent configuration (optional, affects the calculation)

If a rent config is active for this business, the daily rent equivalent is subtracted from sales before calculating the contribution (net sales = sales − daily rent). This reduces the contribution amount but does not block it unless net sales are $0.

To check: go to **Admin** → **Business Settings** → **Rent Config** for the business. If no config exists, the full daily sales figure is used — this is fine.

Step 5 — Run EOD and confirm the Payroll row

After completing the steps above, run the EOD for today:

1. Go to **[Business] → Reports → End of Day**
2. Look at the auto-deposit preview table
3. The **Payroll Account** row should now show a dollar amount and the share percentage (e.g. `2/10 staff · 20% share — $28`)
4. Process the EOD — the contribution will execute automatically

If the row still shows "Skipped", hover over the reason text or check the exact skip reason against the table in **Step 3b** above.

Quick reference — what each skip reason means for setup:

Skip reason	Fix
`No contracts for this business`	Create or reassign active contracts with this business as Primary Business (Step 2)
`No global payroll account`	Admin creates the global payroll account (Step 1)
`Insufficient business account funds`	Deposit funds into the business account (Step 3)
`Contribution rounds to $0`	Sales were very low today — no fix needed, retries tomorrow
`Payroll account already fully funded`	No fix needed — payroll is ready for the month

Payroll Account — Transaction History & Breakdown

Go to **Payroll → Payroll Account** to see the account balance and the **Recent Transactions** list. This list combines all deposits (green, marked +) and payments (amber, marked −) in reverse chronological order.

Transaction Types

Type	What it represents
Funded from [Business] cash box	EOD auto-contribution or manual funding deposit
Salary — [Employee Name]	Net pay + approved per diem paid to that employee on payroll approval
ZIMRA PAYE	Aggregate PAYE tax for all employees in that payroll period
NSSA Contribution	Aggregate NSSA employee contributions for the period
AIDS Levy	Aggregate AIDS Levy for the period

Clicking a Transaction for Full Breakdown

Salary, ZIMRA PAYE, NSSA, and AIDS Levy rows are **clickable**. Click any of these rows to open a detail modal.

Salary row → Payslip Breakdown

Shows the full payslip detail for that employee:

Section	Fields shown
Earnings	Basic Salary, Commission, Living Allowance, Vehicle Allowance, Travel Allowance, Overtime Pay, Benefits (zero-value lines are hidden)
Gross Pay	Total of all earnings
Deductions	PAYE Tax, AIDS Levy, NSSA (Employee), Loan Repayments, Advance Recovery, Misc Deductions (zero-value lines are hidden)
Net Pay	Gross Pay minus Total Deductions

> **Why does the transaction list amount differ from the payslip Net Pay?** The payroll account payment includes **per diem** on top of the payslip net pay. Per diem is a non-taxable allowance paid from the payroll account alongside salary but does not appear on the formal payslip. Example: Payslip Net Pay $111.00 + Per Diem $7.47 = Payment $118.47.

ZIMRA PAYE / NSSA / AIDS Levy row → Per-Employee Breakdown

Shows a table of every employee's individual contribution for that payroll period, with a running total at the bottom. This is useful for verifying figures before filing with ZIMRA or making NSSA payments.

Adjusting the Payroll Account Balance (Admin Only)

Like expense accounts, the payroll account's balance can occasionally drift from what it should be (for example, after restoring from a backup, or if historical transactions were missing). Unlike expense accounts, the payroll account has no automatic self-check — if you notice the balance looks wrong, or the account card shows **"⚠️ Needs reconciliation"** instead of **"✓ Accurate"**, a system administrator can correct it manually.

Who can do this: System administrators only.

1. Go to **Payroll** → **Payroll Account**.
2. Next to the balance figure, click the ✏️ (pencil) icon. If you don't see it, you don't have permission to adjust balances.
3. In the **Adjust Payroll Account Balance** window:
   - **Correct Balance** — enter what the balance should actually be (e.g., from a bank reconciliation).
   - **Reason** — required. Explain why the correction is needed.
4. Click **Adjust Balance**, then confirm.

What happens: The system doesn't just overwrite the number — it posts a proper correction entry into the account's transaction history (visible in Recent Transactions as **"Manual Balance Correction"**), tagged with your name, the date, the old and new balance, and your reason. This keeps the balance fully auditable.

Adjusting a Business's Payroll Contribution (Admin Only)

The payroll account is one shared account, but the dashboard's **Cash Box Balances** widget shows each business's own cumulative contribution to it as a separate **Payroll** card (e.g. under "HXI Eats", "HXI Fashions"). If one of these needs correcting — clearing out demo/test data for a clean start, or fixing a figure that's drifted — an admin can adjust it the same way as the account-level balance above, without deleting the underlying EOD contribution history.

Who can do this: System administrators only.

1. From the **Dashboard**, click a business's **Payroll** card under Cash Box Balances to open its history.
2. Next to the modal's title, click the ✏️ (pencil) icon. If you don't see it, you don't have permission to adjust balances.
3. In the **Adjust Payroll Contribution** window:
    - **Correct Balance** — enter what this business's contribution should actually be (often `0` for a clean start).
    - **Reason** — required.
4. Click **Adjust Balance**, then confirm.

What happens: Same as above — a signed correction entry is posted (visible in the card's own history as **"Manual Adjustment"**, alongside the regular EOD contribution entries), and both the business's card and the shared payroll account's overall balance update immediately. Nothing is deleted.

Payroll — Complete Workflow

Payroll involves several roles and a defined sequence of steps. No step can be skipped — the system enforces the order.

Who Does What

Role	Responsibilities
Manager	Creates the period, edits entries, syncs data, submits for approval, funds the account
Business Owner	The only person who can **approve** payroll — no export is possible without owner approval
Cashier	Pulls physical cash from the cash box when the manager prints a withdrawal voucher; distributes salary to employees and collects signatures

---

Payroll Period Statuses

A payroll period moves through these stages in order:

```
draft → in_progress → review → approved → exported → closed
```

Status	Meaning
Draft	Period created, entries being built
In Progress	Manager is actively editing entries
Review	Manager has submitted — waiting for owner approval
Approved	Owner has approved — ready to export
Exported	Excel file generated and downloaded — period is locked
Closed	All payments disbursed and reconciled

Step 1 — Manager Creates the Period

1. Go to **Payroll** in the top menu.
2. Click **New Payroll Period**.
3. Choose the business (or "All" for all businesses).
4. Set the month and year (e.g. March 2026).
5. Click **Create Period**.

The system automatically pulls in all active employees with their current salary, benefits, and allowances from their contracts. Status → **Draft**.

Step 2 — Manager Syncs Attendance and Absences

Before reviewing figures, run the sync buttons to pull in live data:

🔄 **Sync All** (blue button)

1. On the payroll period page, click 🔄 **Sync All**.
2. The system processes every employee simultaneously:
    - **Absence sync** — counts recorded absence days from the HR module and applies them as deductions.
    - **Clock-in sync** — reviews all clock-in/clock-out records for the period and calculates:
        - **Tardiness deductions** — if an employee clocked in late or left early, the shortfall is converted to a deduction at their hourly rate.
        - **Overtime credits** — if they worked up to 30 minutes extra, a small credit is added.
        - **Overtime pay** — if they worked more than 30 minutes beyond the shift, a 1.5× rate overtime amount is created as a pending adjustment.
3. A summary appears: "Synced 12 entries — absences: 4, clock-in adjustments: 7".

> Run Sync All at least once before reviewing entries. You can run it multiple times — it recalculates without duplicating.

📋 **Sync Stock Shortfall** (orange button)

If your business runs stock takes, click this button to pull in any stock shortfall deductions for the period:

1. Click 📋 **Sync Stock Shortfall**.
2. The system finds all fully signed-off stock take reports where the final sign-off date falls within this payroll period.
3. For each responsible employee on those reports, it calculates their share of the shortfall (total shortfall value ÷ number of responsible employees) and adds it as a deduction.
4. The deduction appears as **"Stock Shortfall Deductions (N report/s)"** in each affected employee's entry.

> If no signed-off stock take reports fall in this period, clicking the button has no effect and no deduction is applied.

Per Diem column

The payroll table includes a **Per Diem** column showing the total per diem for each employee in the period. Both **Approved** and **Pending** entries are counted and displayed — pending entries show with a ⚠ **Pending** badge. Rejected entries are excluded. This figure is fetched live from the Per Diem module and is read-only in the payroll table — to approve or correct per diem entries, go to **Employees** → **Per Diem**.

Step 3 — Manager Reviews and Edits Individual Entries

Click any employee row to open their **Entry Detail**. Here the manager can:

Edit basic figures:

- Work days for the month
- Sick days and leave days taken
- Commission amount (if applicable)

Review and approve adjustments:

- Pending overtime credits appear with an **Approve** button — the manager sets the exact amount and approves each one.
- Pending tardiness deductions appear — the manager can override the calculated amount if circumstances warrant.

Edit deductions:

- Salary advance deductions for this period
- Loan repayments (auto-calculated from active loans but can be overridden)
- Miscellaneous deductions

Add a one-off deduction (penalty, damage recovery, etc.):

Use the dedicated **Deductions** section at the bottom right of the Entry Detail — do **not** use "Add Benefit" for this purpose.

A deduction is money taken from an employee's net pay after ZIMRA calculations — it does **not** affect gross pay or the tax base. Examples: an employee broke company property, a penalty was agreed, or a recovery for a company expense.

1. Click **+ Add Deduction**.
2. Enter a **Deduction Name** — e.g. "Furniture Damage". If you have saved names from before, the browser will show them as suggestions.
3. Enter a **Reason** (mandatory — this text appears on the employee's payslip so they can see exactly why the deduction was made). Keep it concise, max 80 characters.
    - Click **Copy from name** to pre-fill the Reason with the Deduction Name if the name already says enough.
4. Enter the **Amount**.
5. Tick **Save deduction name for future use** if you want this deduction name to appear as a suggestion for all payroll managers next time.
6. Click **Add Deduction**.

The deduction appears under the **Deductions** section, with its reason shown in italics beneath the name. The Compensation Breakdown (gross pay) is unchanged — only the post-tax net pay is reduced.

> **Important:** Deductions are distinct from Benefits. Adding a penalty or recovery as a Benefit would incorrectly inflate the employee's gross pay and ZIMRA tax base. Always use the Deductions section for money being taken from the employee.

Review benefits:

- All active benefits (housing allowance, medical aid, transport) are listed.
- Toggle benefits on or off for this period if needed.
- **Annual-only benefits (e.g. Annual Bonus):** Benefits that are only paid in a specific month (such as December) appear greyed out with the label **"Annual benefit — not paid this month"** in every other month — no action needed. In the correct payment month they revert to the normal active state automatically and are included in gross pay.

Per diem:

- The total per diem entered separately (via Employees → Per Diem) is shown here as a read-only figure. It cannot be edited from this modal — edit it in the Per Diem module.

ZIMRA Tax Override:

- At the bottom of the Entry Detail (below the Net Gross card) is a collapsible **ZIMRA Tax Override** section.
- Use this when the ZIMRA online calculator produces different figures from the system's calculated PAYE, NSSA, or AIDS Levy — enter the exact ZIMRA values here.
- When saved, an amber **"ZIMRA values active"** badge appears on the section header and a small **Z** badge appears on the PAYE column in the main payroll table.
- These override values flow through to the exported spreadsheet, payslip records, and the payslip capture modal automatically.
- Click **Clear overrides** to remove all three values and revert to system calculations.

Field	What to enter
PAYE Payable	The PAYE amount from the ZIMRA calculator

Field	What to enter
NSSA Contributions	The employee NSSA contribution from ZIMRA
AIDS Levy	Auto-suggested as 3% of PAYE when you type PAYE; edit if ZIMRA shows a different figure

> **When to use:** If the system's calculated PAYE does not match what ZIMRA's website calculator shows for the same gross, enter the ZIMRA values here before exporting. This ensures the spreadsheet and payslips carry the correct statutory amounts.

The entry shows a running breakdown:

```
Basic Salary:                  $500.00
Commission:                    $  0.00
Overtime:                      $ 12.50
Benefits:                      $ 30.00   ← housing allowance, medical aid, etc.
──────────────────────────────────────
Gross Pay (excl. Per Diem):    $542.50
Per Diem:                      $ 45.00   ← approved + pending entries
──────────────────────────────────────
Gross Pay (incl. Per Diem):    $587.50
Advances/Loans:              - $ 50.00
Stock Shortfall Deductions:  - $  8.25
Furniture Damage:            - $ 25.00   ← one-off deduction (post-ZIMRA)
──────────────────────────────────────
Net Pay:                       $504.25
```

What affects Gross Pay vs Net Pay:

Item	Affects Gross	Affects Net
Base salary, commission, overtime	✓	✓
Benefits (housing, medical, transport)	✓	✓
Per diem allowance (approved or pending)	✓	✓
ZIMRA (PAYE, NSSA, AIDS Levy)	—	✓
Salary advances, loans, misc	—	✓
One-off deductions (damage, penalty)	**—**	✓

> **Per diem is included in gross and net pay and is non-taxable** — PAYE and NSSA are calculated on the gross amount after per diem is excluded. Both **Approved** and **Pending** per diem entries are counted. Rejected entries are excluded. Approve entries before exporting so that payslips show the confirmed figure.

> **Stock Shortfall Deductions** appear only if the employee was listed as a responsible party on one or more signed-off stock take reports in this period. The amount is calculated automatically when the

> manager clicks **Sync Stock Shortfall**.

Step 4 — Manager Checks the Payroll Total and Funds the Account

At the top of the period page the **total net pay** for all employees is shown. Compare this against the **Payroll Account Balance**.

If the account is short:

> **⚠ Payroll requires $4,250.00 — account balance is $3,100.00 (short by $1,150.00). Please fund the account before approving.**

To fund:

1. Click 💵 **Fund Payroll**.
2. The system calculates how much to pull from each business's cash box.
3. Print the **Withdrawal Voucher** and hand it to the cashier.
4. The cashier counts the cash, signs the voucher, and confirms.
5. The payroll account balance updates automatically.

Repeat until the balance covers the total net pay.

> **Cash box earmarks:** When you fund payroll, the amount is recorded against this payroll period in each business's cash box as a **Payroll Funding** earmark. These earmarks remain visible in the cash bucket view until the payroll period is **Approved** — at which point they are automatically cleared. This keeps the cash bucket display accurate during the funding window.

Step 5 — Manager Submits for Owner Approval

Once all entries look correct and the account is funded:

1. Click **Submit for Review**.
2. Status → **Review**.
3. The business owner receives a notification that payroll is ready to approve.

> **Only the business owner can approve.** Managers cannot approve their own payroll submission.

Step 5b — Sending Back to In Progress (if corrections are needed)

If the owner or manager notices an issue after the period has been submitted for review, any user with payroll access can send it back:

1. Open the payroll period (status: **Review**).
2. Click ↩ **Back to In Progress**.
3. Status → **In Progress**.
4. Make the necessary corrections and repeat Steps 3–5.

Step 6 — Owner Reviews and Approves

The owner opens the payroll period (from the notification or from **Payroll** in the menu):

1. Review the period summary — total employees, gross pay, deductions, net pay.
2. Confirm the payroll account balance is sufficient (shown on screen).
3. Click **Approve Payroll**.
4. Status → **Approved**.

What happens automatically on approval:

- Approval timestamp and owner name are recorded.
- Any **Payroll Funding** earmarks in each business's cash box are automatically cleared — the cash is now fully transferred and the earmark display resolves.
- Any loan deductions in the payroll entries are automatically reconciled — the loan balances decrease and repayment records are created.
- The **Payroll Account balance is debited** and a full set of payment records is created automatically:
  - One **SALARY** debit per employee (their net pay + approved per diem for the period)
  - One **ZIMRA PAYE** aggregate debit for the period (sum of all employees' PAYE)
  - One **NSSA** aggregate debit for the period (sum of all employees' NSSA employee contributions)
  - One **AIDS LEVY** aggregate debit for the period (sum of all employees' AIDS Levy)
- All four record types are visible as individual line items in **Payroll → Payroll Account → Recent Transactions**.

Step 7 — Export the Payroll Spreadsheet

With the period approved, the manager exports the payroll spreadsheet:

1. Click **Export to Excel** (for the current month) or **Export YTD** (all months January to current).
2. The system generates a `.xlsx` file.
3. Status → **Exported**. The period is now **locked** — no further changes can be made.

Columns in the exported spreadsheet:

Column	Source
ID Number	Employee national ID
Date of Birth	Employee profile
First Name	Employee profile
Last Name	Employee profile
Work Days	Entry (from sync or manual)
Basic Salary	Employment contract
Earned Salary	Basic Salary minus any absence deduction — the actual amount earned (used for ZIMRA entry)
Commission	Contract / manual override

Column	Source
Living Allowance	Contract allowances
Vehicle Reimbursement	Contract allowances
Travel Allowance	Contract allowances
Overtime	Approved overtime adjustments
Per Diem	Per diem entries for the month — approved and pending entries included; rejected excluded
Benefits	Dynamic columns — one column per active benefit type (housing allowance, medical aid, etc.) shown in normal text
Deductions	Dynamic columns — one per manual deduction added via **Add Deduction** (e.g. penalty, damage recovery), shown in **red** in the on-screen table. These reduce Net Pay but do not affect Gross Pay or the ZIMRA tax base
Advances	Salary advances deducted
Loans	Loan repayments deducted
Gross Pay	Sum of all earnings (base + benefits + per diem + overtime + adjustments − absences)
Net Pay	Gross Pay − ZIMRA − Deductions − Advances − Loans

> **Deduction columns (red):** Any manual deduction added via the **Add Deduction** form appears as its own column in the payroll table, shown in red to distinguish it from benefit columns (which are shown in normal text). These amounts reduce the employee's **Net Pay** — they do not change the gross pay or ZIMRA calculations. The net pay figure on the payslip reflects these deductions.

> **Per Diem in the export:** Approved and pending per diem entries are both included in the exported spreadsheet. Rejected entries are excluded. Per diem is included in both the **single-month export** and the **Year-to-Date multi-tab export**. Use the **Regenerate Export** button to re-download an already-exported period — per diem values are included in regenerated files too.

The exported spreadsheet contains all gross pay, OT, per diem, and benefit figures. It can be handed to an external payroll bureau or accountant if required, or used to verify figures before filing.

Step 8 — Post-Export: Payslips, ZIMRA, and Statutory Returns

Payslips are auto-populated on export. When you export (or regenerate) the payroll spreadsheet, the system automatically calculates PAYE, AIDS Levy, and NSSA Employee contributions for every employee and creates a payslip record for each one with status `CAPTURED`. You do not need to enter these figures manually.

One-off deductions on payslips: Any deductions added via the **Add Deduction** form in Step 3 appear on the printed payslip as individually named line items in the **Other Deductions** section — each shows the deduction name and the manager-entered reason beneath it in italics. This lets the employee see exactly what

was deducted and why. These deductions are post-ZIMRA and do not affect the gross pay or tax figures on the payslip.

If an employee's entry has a **ZIMRA override** set (see Step 3 — ZIMRA Tax Override), those override values are used instead of the system calculation in both the exported spreadsheet and the payslip record.

Reviewing and adjusting captured payslips:

1. Return to the exported period in **Payroll**.
2. Click 📋 **Capture Payslips**.
3. The table shows all employees with their auto-populated values:
    - **Total Earnings**, **PAYE Tax**, **AIDS Levy**, **NSSA Emp**, and **Nett Pay** are read-only — populated from the system calculation or the ZIMRA override (whichever applies).
    - A small amber **Z** badge next to a tax value means it came from a ZIMRA override, not the system calculation.
    - **NEC Emp**, **Net Round**, **WCIF**, **NEC Co.**, **Loan Recovery**, **Advance**, **Other Ded.**, **Leave Days**, and **Pay Point** are editable — fill these in as needed.
4. Click **Save All** to save any edits.
5. Click **Mark Distributed** once physical payslips have been handed to employees (status → `DISTRIBUTED`).

> Statutory deductions displayed in the capture modal use the Zimbabwe tax brackets, NSSA rate, and AIDS Levy rate configured in **Settings** → **Tax Constants** — unless a ZIMRA override has been entered for that employee, in which case the override takes precedence. Verify tax constants are up to date before each payroll run.

ZIMRA Employee Earnings Export (for online upload):

- Click 📊 **Export ZIMRA File** on the period page to download an `.xlsx` file in ZIMRA's Employee Earnings upload format.
- The file contains one row per employee (only employees in the payroll for that month) with all required fields: TIN, National ID, earned salary, overtime, commission, benefits categorised into ZIMRA columns, NSSA, NEC, per diem (as non-taxable earnings), and more.
- **TIN is required** — if any employee is missing their TIN the export is blocked and a message shows which employees need to be updated. Go to **Employees** → **[Name]** → **Edit** to add the TIN, then retry.
- This button is only available after the payroll has been exported to Excel (i.e. status is **Exported** or **Closed**).

ZIMRA P2 Remittance Voucher:

- Click **Print ZIMRA Voucher** on the period page to generate a two-page PDF:
    - **Page 1 — NSSA Voucher:** lists total NSSA employee and employer contributions.
    - **Page 2 — PAYE Voucher:** lists total gross PAYE and AIDS Levy due.
- The voucher shows your company name, address, registration number, and the pay period.
- Use the blank fields at the bottom of each page to record the **Payment Reference**, **Bank / Branch**, and payment date when you make the transfer.

ZIMRA Year-to-Date (P14 / ITC):

- Use the **Export YTD** button to download all months January to December in a single multi-tab file.

- This is used by your accountant or tax agent to prepare annual employee tax certificates (ITF16 / P14).

> **Tax calculations:** PAYE is computed using the configured monthly tax brackets on the employee's taxable gross (excluding non-taxable per diem). AIDS Levy is a percentage of PAYE. NSSA Employee is a percentage of the employee's contractual basic salary (capped at the NSSA ceiling). All rates are set in **Settings → Tax Constants**. If a **ZIMRA override** has been entered for an employee in their Entry Detail, those values replace the system calculation for that employee only — all others continue to use the system calculation.

Step 9 — Disbursing Payments to Employees

After export, the manager can use the **Payroll Account Payments** page to record individual payments directly from the payroll account balance:

Opening the payments page:

- Go to **Payroll → Payroll Account → Make Payments**, or
- Click 💸 **Process Payments** on the period page.

How it works:

1. The page shows the current **Payroll Account Balance** at the top.
2. Under **Batch Settings**, choose:
    - **Default Amount** — a base amount to apply to multiple employees at once (starts at $0 — enter the correct amount or use per-employee amounts)
    - **Payment Type** — Regular Salary, Bonus, or Commission
    - **Payment Schedule** — Weekly, Bi-weekly, or Monthly
3. Under **Select Employees**, tick each employee to pay:
    - Enter the exact payment amount in their row (or use a quick-amount button: $500, $1000, $1500, $2000)
    - Click 📝 **Note** to add an optional note for that payment (e.g. reason for a different amount)
4. Use **Select All** to tick every employee, then **Apply Default Amount to Selected** to fill in a uniform amount.
5. The green summary bar at the bottom shows the **Total Payment Amount** and the **Balance After Payment**.
6. Click **Process X Payments** to submit.

> **Process Payments is disabled if the total exceeds the payroll account balance.** Top up the account first if needed.

For employees paid by bank transfer, initiate the transfer externally and use this page to record the transaction against their name.

Step 10 — Closing the Period

After all payments are disbursed and payslips are captured:

1. Return to the payroll period.

2. Click **Close Period**.
3. Status → **Closed**.

The period is archived. It remains visible under **Payroll** → **History** and is included in all historical reports.

Setting Daily Sales Performance Targets

The POS displays a live **performance bar** while cashiers are selling. It shows how close today's sales are to your target, using three colour bands. Managers set these thresholds per business.

Where to configure: Go to **[Business]** → **Settings** → **POS Settings** → **Sales Performance Targets** (or **Universal** → **POS** → **Settings** → **Performance**).

The three thresholds:

Field	What it means	Example
Fair minimum ($)	Sales below this amount show 🔴 Low — the day is off to a slow start	$100
Good minimum ($)	Sales at or above this amount show 🟢 Good — on track	$150
Full bar amount ($)	The progress bar fills to 100% at this amount — the target to hit	$200

Rules:

- Fair minimum must be at least $1.
- Good minimum must be higher than Fair minimum.
- Full bar amount must be at least as high as Good minimum.

How to set them:

1. Enter your three dollar amounts.
2. The live preview below the form shows sample badges — e.g. "$80 = 🔴 Low", "$130 = 🟡 Fair", "$180 = 🟢 Good".
3. Click **Save**. Changes take effect the next time the POS page loads.

> **Tip:** Set the Full bar amount to your realistic daily target, not a stretch goal. Cashiers should be able to reach 🟢 Good on a normal trading day. Reserve the Full bar as a "great day" milestone.

When sales exceed the Full bar amount, the badge shows ⭐ stars — one extra star for every 10% above the target, up to five stars.

Payment Request Workflow — From Submission to Payment

This describes the full lifecycle of an expense payment request, including the notification bells at each stage.

Stage 1 — Employee Submits a Request

An employee goes to **Expense Accounts** → **[Account Name]** → **New Payment Request** and fills in:

- Amount

- What it is for (description)
- Reference number or receipt number (if available)

They click **Submit for Approval**.

What happens:

- A payment request record is created with status **SUBMITTED**.
- A 🔔 notification is sent to the manager(s) authorised to approve payments from that account.
- The bell icon on the manager's screen shows an increased count.

Stage 2 — Manager Reviews and Approves

The manager sees the bell 🔔 and clicks it (or goes to **Pending Actions**). The request appears with the submitter's name, amount, account, and description.

Manager actions:

Action	What happens
Approve	Request status → **APPROVED**. Employee receives a 🔔 notification that their request was approved. Request is queued for the next payment batch.
Decline	Manager enters a reason. Request status → **DECLINED**. Employee receives a 🔔 notification with the reason.

> Approved requests are not paid immediately — they wait for a payment batch to be processed.

Stage 3 — Payment Batch (Grouping Approved Requests)

When enough approved requests have accumulated, the manager creates a batch:

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** → **Payment Batches** → **New Batch**.
2. The system groups all **APPROVED** requests into a single batch.
3. Review the batch — you see each payee, their amount, and the source account.
4. On the review screen, **Approve** or **Reject** each individual payment:
    - Approved items are paid out; rejected items are moved to **REJECTED** status and the requester is notified with the reason.
    - You may approve some payments and leave others undecided — undecided items are deferred to the next EOD batch automatically.
    - You may reject all items if needed — the batch can still be processed.
5. If any payments are being rejected, enter a **rejection reason** (required):
    - Choose a predefined reason from the dropdown (e.g. "Insufficient funds", "Incorrect payee or amount").
    - Or type a custom reason in the text box.
    - The global reason applies to all rejected items. You can override it per-item using the inline text box that appears below each rejected payment's row.
6. Click **Process X of Y** (or **Process & Print Report** when all are decided) once you are ready.

7. Print the **Batch Payment Voucher** as a physical record.

What happens:

- Approved requests move to status **APPROVED** and cash is disbursed from the cash bucket.
- Rejected requests move to status **REJECTED** with the reason recorded. The requester receives a 🔔 notification linking them to their **Rejected** tab where they can act on it.
- Undecided items (neither approved nor rejected) are automatically deferred to the next EOD batch — they remain in the queue with no notification.
- The cashier receives a 🔔 notification that a payment batch needs physical cash disbursement.
- The batch appears in the Cash Office payment queue.

Stage 4 — Cash Disbursement (Cashier)

The cashier opens the batch from their queue:

1. Go to **Cash Office** → **Payment Batches** (or the notification link).
2. The batch lists each payee and amount.
3. For each payee: count out the cash, hand it to them, and mark the line item **Paid** (or the payee signs a slip).
4. Once all items are disbursed, click **Mark Batch Complete**.

What happens:

- Each request moves to status **PAID**.
- A Cash Bucket **OUTFLOW** entry is recorded for the total batch amount.
- Each submitter receives a 🔔 notification: "Your payment request of $XX has been paid."

Notification Bell Summary

Event	Who gets notified
Employee submits a request	Manager (🔔 +1 on bell)
Manager approves	Employee (🔔 "Your request was approved")
Manager declines	Employee (🔔 "Your request was declined: [reason]")
Batch review — payment **rejected**	Requester (🔔 notification links directly to the **Rejected** tab of My Payments — shows the rejection reason and action buttons)
Batch created / ready to pay	Cashier (🔔 "Payment batch ready for disbursement")
Batch marked complete / paid	Each payee in the batch (🔔 "Your payment has been processed")

Approving Expense Payment Requests

When an employee submits an expense request, you will receive a notification.

1. Go to **Pending Actions** or **Expense Accounts** → **Payment Batches**.
2. Find the request and click to open it.
3. Review the amount, the description, and any supporting notes.
4. Click **Approve** (or **Decline** with a reason).

Approved payments are added to the next **payment batch** for processing.

Processing a Payment Batch

When several approved payments have built up:

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** → **Payment Batches**.
2. Click **New Batch** to group the pending approved payments together.
3. Review the batch — you will see each payee, the amount, and the source expense account.
4. Click **Review Batch** to open the final review screen.
5. For each payment, click **Approve** or **Reject**:
    - **Approve** — the payment will be processed and cash disbursed.
    - **Reject** — the payment moves to **REJECTED** status. The requester is notified immediately with your rejection reason and can then edit and resubmit, resubmit as-is, or cancel their request.
    - **Leave undecided** — you do not have to decide every item. Undecided items are automatically deferred to the next EOD batch with no notification to the requester.
6. If any payments are being rejected, a **Rejection Reason** field appears:
    - Select from the predefined list (Insufficient funds, Incorrect payee or amount, Duplicate request, Not in budget, Needs manager approval, Other).
    - Or type a custom reason. This reason applies to all rejected items.
    - To give a different reason for a specific payment, use the per-item override input that appears below that payment's **Reject** button.
7. Click **Process X of Y** (partial) or **Process & Print Report** (all decided).
8. Print the **Batch Payment Voucher** as a record.

> **Rejecting a rent payment:** If the rent payment is not ready to go out (e.g., landlord gave an extension), reject it in the batch review — it will move to REJECTED and the requester can resubmit it in the next cycle.

> **Partial processing:** You do not need to decide every item before submitting. Click **Process X of Y** to process only the items you've actioned — the rest are quietly deferred to the next EOD batch without any notification.

Standalone Account Approvals — Per-Payment Voucher Panel

When you approve payments from a **standalone expense account** (personal or family accounts not linked to a business), a post-approval voucher panel opens automatically at the bottom of the screen.

Why individual vouchers? Each voucher captures the payee's signature as proof of receipt. Because signatories differ per payment, you cannot combine multiple payments into a single voucher — each one is created separately.

How the panel works:

After clicking **Submit Decisions**, a panel appears showing every payment you just approved:

```
✅ 3 Payments Approved — Create Vouchers
Each voucher captures the payee's signature as proof of receipt.

John Doe    $45.00  Fuel        CASH      [📄 Voucher]  [Skip]
Jane Smith  $20.00  Stationery  ECOCASH    ✅ Voucher created
Bob Moyo    $80.00  Repairs     CASH      [Skipped]
```

Button	What it does
📄 **Voucher**	Opens the Payment Voucher form for that specific payment
Skip	Marks the row as skipped — no voucher is created
✕ **(close)**	Dismisses the panel; any un-actioned payments can still have vouchers created from the payment detail page

After you complete and save the voucher form, the row updates to show "✅ Voucher created". After clicking Skip, the row dims to show "Skipped".

> **Missed a payment?** If you dismiss the panel before creating all the vouchers you need, open the individual payment detail page (Expense Account → Payments → [Payment]) and click the 📄 **Create Voucher** button that appears for APPROVED payments with no existing voucher.

Reading Reports

Go to **Reports** in the top menu to access all available reports.

Sales Reports

Report	What it shows
Sales Summary	Total revenue by day, week, or month
Top Products	Best-selling items by quantity and value
Sales by Employee	Which staff member processed what sales
Order History	Full list of all transactions with details
Sales Analytics Dashboard	Sales and expense trend chart with daily or monthly grouping

Sales Analytics Dashboard

Go to **Reports** → **Sales Analytics** to see your business performance over any date range.

The dashboard shows:

- **Summary cards** — total sales, expenses, average order value
- **Top performers** — best products by units and revenue, top categories, top sales reps
- **Sales trend chart** — a line graph of sales and expenses over the selected period, with a margin indicator in the tooltip

Daily vs Monthly grouping:

The chart has a **Daily / Monthly** toggle in the top-left of the chart panel. Switching to **Monthly** collapses the daily data points into one point per calendar month, making it easy to compare month-over-month performance across a long date range (e.g. "All Time" or a full year). The period totals (total sales, expenses, and margin) stay the same in both views — only the chart granularity changes. Switch back to **Daily** at any time to see day-by-day detail again.

> **Tip:** Use the Monthly view when your date range spans several months. Use the Daily view for shorter ranges (last 30 days) where individual day spikes are useful.

Drilling down into a day:

Click any dot on the **Daily** chart to open the **Daily Detail** report for that specific day. Drill-down is not available in Monthly view because each point represents an entire month.

The Daily Detail report includes:

- **Summary bar** — sales total, expenses total, net profit, and margin for the day
- **Day navigation** — use the ← **Prev** and **Next** → buttons beside the date heading to move to the previous or next day without going back to the chart; the Next button is greyed out when you reach today
- **Filter tabs** — switch between All, Sales, and Expenses views
- **Search** — type any keyword (payee name, product, category, amount, or who recorded it) to filter the list; a match count and filtered total appear automatically above the results; click **Reset** to clear the search
- **Sales orders** — each order shows time, payment method, server name, and order amount; click a row to expand and see the individual items sold with quantities and unit prices
- **Expense payments** — each payment shows time, category, payment channel, payee, description, and who recorded the payment; the recorder's name is colour-coded so you can quickly distinguish entries made by different staff members

> **Tip:** The Daily Detail expenses only include payments in **PAID** status, matching exactly what is counted in the Sales Analytics chart. If an expense shows as Pending Approval or Queued it will not appear here until it is marked as paid.

Cash Reports

Report	What it shows
Cash Position Report	Opening/Cash In/Set Aside/Expenses/Available/Closing for any date range and business, with drill-downs, period-over-period comparison arrows, and Excel export. See **Cash Position Report** in section 3.

Report	What it shows
Cash Rounding	Every rounding event (direction, original amount, rounded amount, cashier) for audit and EOD reconciliation.

Payroll Reports

Report	What it shows
By Employee	Total paid to each employee over a date range
By Payment Type	Salary, bonus, advance breakdown
Monthly Summary	Month-by-month payroll costs
ZIMRA Report	Tax submission format

Expense Reports

Report	What it shows
Account Overview	Balance and activity for each expense account
By Category	Where money is being spent
Lending Analysis	Loan repayment performance

Customer Reports

Report	What it shows
Customer Activity	Purchase history for individual customers
Top Customers	Customers ranked by spend
Loyalty Summary	Points earned and redeemed

Saving a Report: After setting your filters (date range, business, category), click **Save Report**. You can find it again under **Reports** → **Saved Reports**.

Exporting a Report: Click **Export CSV** or **Export PDF** to download the report for use in Excel or for printing.

Salary Increases and Contract Updates

Requesting a Salary Increase

When an employee is due a raise, the manager submits a salary increase request. The business owner must approve it before the new salary takes effect.

1. Go to **Employees** and open the employee's profile.
2. Click **Request Salary Increase**.
3. Fill in:

- **New salary amount** — the proposed new monthly or hourly rate.
- **Effective date** — the date the new rate should start (can be future-dated).
- **Reason** — e.g. "Annual review", "Promotion to Senior Cashier", "Cost of living adjustment".

4. Click **Submit**.

The business owner receives a 🔔 notification. They open the request, review the current vs proposed salary, and click **Approve** or **Decline with reason**.

Once approved:

- The employee's salary record updates to the new amount from the effective date.
- The next payroll period created after the effective date will use the new salary automatically.
- A salary history record is kept on the employee's profile showing the previous amount, the new amount, the date, and who approved it.

Creating a New Contract to Override the Current One

When an employee's role, salary, or terms change significantly — such as a promotion, a role change, or a new fixed-term — you create a **new contract** rather than editing the existing one. The old contract is retained as a historical record; the new one becomes active.

When to create a new contract (rather than just updating a salary):

- Employee is promoted to a different role or department
- Employment type changes (e.g. contract → permanent, or hourly → salaried)
- Notice period or working hours change
- A completely new set of duties applies
- A fixed-term contract is being renewed with new terms

Steps:

1. Open the employee's profile → **Contracts** tab.
2. The current active contract is shown. Do **not** edit it.
3. Click **New Contract**.
4. Fill in all the contract fields (see Employment Contracts section above for the full field list).
5. Set the **start date** — this is when the new contract takes effect. This date should be the day after the old contract ends, or the agreed commencement date.
6. If the previous contract was fixed-term and is being replaced, set its **end date** to the day before the new contract starts (if not already set).
7. Add the new duties for the new role.
8. Save as Draft → print → get signed → upload signed copy → Approve.

Once active, the **new contract's salary and benefits** are used in all subsequent payroll runs. The old contract remains on record under the Contracts tab but is marked as Inactive or Superseded.

Contract Renewal (Fixed-Term Contracts)

Fixed-term contracts have an end date. When the end date approaches, the system flags the contract as **Expiring Soon** on the HR dashboard.

To renew:

1. Open the employee's profile → **Contracts** tab.
2. Find the expiring contract.
3. Click **Renew** (or **New Contract** if the terms are changing).
    - **Renew** extends the same terms for a new period — update the end date and re-sign.
    - **New Contract** creates a fresh contract (use this if salary, duties, or type are changing).
4. Set the new start and end dates.
5. Print, sign, upload, and approve as normal.

> **If a contract expires without renewal:** The employee's record shows a warning on the HR dashboard. They remain active in the system but the contract is shown as Expired. Payroll continues to run using the last known salary — but address the renewal as soon as possible to keep records compliant.

Adding or Removing a Benefit Without Renewing the Contract

Small benefit changes — adding a gym allowance, discontinuing a perk company-wide — don't need a full contract renewal. Benefits can be added to or removed from an employee's **current, active contract** directly.

To add a benefit:

1. Open the employee's profile → **Contracts** tab.
2. On the active contract, find the **Benefits** list and click **+ Add Benefit**.
3. Search for the benefit type, enter the amount, and check the box if it's a percentage of salary rather than a flat amount.
4. Optionally add a note. Click **Add**.

To remove a benefit:

1. In the same Benefits list, click the ✕ next to the benefit.
2. You'll be prompted for an optional reason — this isn't required, but it's saved for the internal record if you provide one.

Both actions take effect immediately on the contract and are recorded in the audit log (who made the change, when, and what changed). They do **not** regenerate or alter the originally signed contract PDF — that document remains the historical record of what was signed at the time. The employee's current benefits, as shown throughout the system (payroll, contract view), always reflect the latest list.

> Every new contract now includes standard language stating the Company may add, modify, or remove any benefit at any time, for any reason — this is what makes the above possible without treating each change as a contract amendment. This clause only appears on contracts generated after this feature shipped; contracts signed earlier are unaffected.

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5. HR & Employee Management

> **Who reads this:** HR staff and managers who add employees, manage contracts, and track attendance.

Adding a New Employee

1. Go to **Employees** in the menu.
2. Click **Add Employee**.
3. Fill in the employee's details:
    - Full name
    - ID number
    - Contact details (phone, address)
    - Job title
    - Department
    - Employment type (full-time, part-time, contract)
4. Set their salary:
    - Choose salary type (Fixed Monthly, Hourly, Commission)
    - Enter the amount
5. Click **Save Employee**.

TIN (Tax Identification Number): This field is optional when first creating an employee — TIN may not be known at the time of onboarding. Once known, add it via **Employees → [Name] → Edit → TIN field**. The TIN is displayed on the employee profile and on their payslips. It is required before the ZIMRA Employee Earnings file can be exported for a payroll period.

The employee will receive a welcome email with login instructions if they need system access.

Employment Contracts — Full Workflow

An employment contract documents the terms of employment agreed between the business and the employee. The system stores contracts digitally and tracks their status from draft through to signed.

What Must Be Captured

A complete contract record should include:

Field	Notes
Employee name	Auto-filled from their profile
Job title	Their official title
Department	Which department they belong to
Employment type	Full-time, Part-time, or Contract
Start date	When employment begins
End date	Required for fixed-term contracts; leave blank for permanent
Probation period	Duration in months (if applicable)
Salary	Monthly or hourly rate, as agreed
Notice period	How many days/weeks notice is required by either party
Employee duties	The specific responsibilities for this role (see below)

Field	Notes
Contract document	Uploaded PDF of the signed contract

Adding Employee Duties

Duties are the specific tasks and responsibilities for the employee's role. They appear on the printed contract.

1. Open the employee's profile.
2. Go to the **Contracts** tab.
3. Under the contract being created or edited, find the **Duties** section.
4. Click **Add Duty**.
5. Type the duty description (e.g., "Operate the cash register and process all sales transactions accurately").
6. Add as many duties as needed — one per line.
7. Duties can be reordered by dragging.

> **Tip:** Keep duties specific and measurable. They become part of the performance review framework.

Creating and Printing a Contract

To create a new contract:

1. Open the employee's profile.
2. Go to the **Contracts** tab.
3. Click **New Contract**.
4. Fill in all the required fields (see table above).
5. Add duties.
6. Click **Save as Draft**.

To print the contract for signing:

1. With the contract open, click **Print Contract** (or **Preview & Print**).
2. The system generates a formatted contract document with all the details and a signature block at the bottom.
3. Print two copies — one for the employee, one for the file.
4. Both the employee and the manager sign both copies.

Uploading a Signed Contract

After both parties have signed the printed copy:

1. Scan or photograph the signed document.
2. Open the employee's profile → **Contracts** tab.
3. Click **Upload Signed Contract** (or click into the draft contract and choose **Upload**).
4. Select the scanned PDF or image file.
5. Click **Save** — contract status changes from **Draft** → **Active**.

Approving a Contract

If your business requires a senior manager or owner to approve contracts before they are active:

1. After saving the contract as a draft, click **Submit for Approval**.
2. The designated approver receives a 🔔 notification.
3. They open the contract, review the terms and duties, and click **Approve**.
4. Contract status → **Active**.

Converting an Employee to a System User

Employees who need to log into the system (e.g. a cashier who processes sales, or an HR officer who manages records) must be given a **user account** linked to their employee profile.

Step 1 — Check if a User Account Already Exists

1. Open the employee's profile.
2. Look for a **System Account** section.
3. If it shows "No Account", you have two options: create a brand-new one (Step 2 below), or — if this person already has a system user account that was set up separately (a common situation if their login was created before their employee record, or the two were entered by different people) — click 🔗 **Link Existing User** instead to search for and connect their existing account, rather than creating a second, disconnected one for the same person.

> The same check works the other way round too: on **Admin** → **Users**, a user with no linked employee shows both **Create Employee Record** and 🔗 **Link Existing Employee** in their ⋮ actions menu — use "Link Existing Employee" if you know an employee record for this same person already exists, instead of creating a duplicate.

Why an Employee and a User Account Can Get Disconnected

An **Employees** record (their HR/payroll profile — job title, salary, contracts) and a **Users** record (their actual login) are two separate things in the system, connected by a single link. Normally that link is created automatically the moment you create one from the other — but if the two were ever created independently (the login was set up first and an employee record added later, or vice versa, or by two different people), nothing connects them, even though they're the same real person. When that happens:

- The employee's **System Account** panel shows **"No Account"**, even though a working login for them exists elsewhere in the system.
- On **Admin** → **Users**, that same login shows **"Create Employee Record"** instead of recognizing the employee record that already exists.

Neither screen can see across to the other on its own — each only knows about its own side of that one link field. **Link Existing User** / **Link Existing Employee** exists specifically to fix this: it connects the two existing records instead of creating a duplicate.

Step 1a — Linking to an Existing Account

1. Click 🔗 **Link Existing User** (from the employee side) or 🔗 **Link Existing Employee** (from the Admin → Users side).
2. The search box is pre-filled with the person's first name, so a likely match usually shows up immediately with nothing typed — you can still edit the search if you need to narrow it down (e.g. by email) or the

name doesn't match exactly.
3. Select the correct match from the list and confirm. This only connects the two records — it does **not** create a new login, and does **not** change any business access the account already has. If the employee's own record lists a business they're not yet a member of, that access is added; anything they already have is left alone.

> **Name & photo:** once linked, the employee record's name and photo become the shared values for both — see §70 Linked Profile for how they stay in sync going forward.

> **Why some accounts don't appear in this list:** the search only shows real, active system users — people who are either a system admin or an active member of at least one business. Accounts that exist for an unrelated reason (for example, an outside contractor's own portal login, which has no business membership of its own) are deliberately left out, since linking one of those to an employee record wouldn't be correct.

Step 2 — Create the User Account

1. Still on the employee's profile, click **Grant System Access** (or **Create User Account**).
2. Confirm or set their **login email** (usually their work email address).
3. A temporary password is generated — the employee will be prompted to change it on first login.
4. Click **Create Account**.

The employee is now both an employee record and a system user. Their clock-in card still works; they can also log in to the full system.

Step 3 — Assign Permissions

After creating the user account, assign the correct permissions for their role:

1. Go to **Users** (or **Settings** → **Users** → **[Employee Name]**).
2. Click **Manage Permissions**.
3. Permissions are grouped by area. Tick what applies to their role:

Permission Group	Examples
POS	Process sales, apply discounts, void items
Inventory	Add products, adjust stock, print labels
Expense Accounts	Submit payment requests, view balances
Cash Office	Record cash entries, run EOD, lock allocations
Payroll	View payslips, submit per diem, manage payroll (manager)
Employees	View employees, add employees, manage contracts
Reports	View sales reports, export data
Cash Allocation	Approve and lock cash allocation reports
Barcode	Print labels, manage templates

4. Click **Save Permissions**.

> Permissions take effect the next time the employee logs in. If they are already logged in, ask them to log out and back in.

Typical Permission Sets by Role

Role	Suggested Permissions
Cashier	POS (process sales), view-only inventory
Stock Manager	Inventory (full), barcode (print labels)
Cash Office Clerk	Cash Office (EOD, bucket entries), expense accounts (view)
HR Officer	Employees (full), payroll (view)
Manager	All of the above + approvals, reports, payroll management
Owner	Full access to everything

Employee Benefits

To add benefits to an employee (e.g., housing allowance, medical aid, transport):

1. Open the employee's profile.
2. Go to the **Benefits** tab.
3. Click **Add Benefit**.
4. Choose the benefit type and enter the amount.
5. Set whether it is taxable or not.
6. Click **Save**.

Benefits are automatically included in the next payroll run.

> This is a separate list from a **contract's own benefits** (Living Allowance, Annual Bonus, etc. shown on the Contracts tab) — see Adding or Removing a Benefit Without Renewing the Contract above for changing those.

Tracking Absences

Absences affect payroll and attendance records. Managers can record absences directly, or employees can submit leave requests that managers then approve.

Absence Types

Type	Meaning	Payroll Impact
Sick Leave	Employee is unwell	Paid if sick leave balance allows; unpaid if exhausted
Annual Leave	Planned time off	Paid from leave balance

Type	Meaning	Payroll Impact
Unpaid Leave	Approved absence, no pay	Deducted from salary
Absent Without Leave (AWOL)	No notice, no approval	Deducted; may trigger disciplinary
Public Holiday	National holiday	Paid (no leave balance consumed)
Maternity / Paternity	Statutory leave	Follow statutory rules

Recording an Absence (Manager)

1. Go to **Employees** → **Absences**.
2. Click **Record Absence**.
3. Select the employee from the dropdown.
4. Choose the **absence type** from the list above.
5. Enter the **start date** and **end date** (for a single day, both dates are the same).
6. Optionally add a **note** (e.g. "Doctor's certificate submitted").
7. Click **Save**.

The absence is immediately reflected in:

- The employee's attendance record
- The payroll period for those dates (deduction calculated at next payroll sync)
- The manager's absence report

> **Tip:** If an employee was absent but forgot to tell you, you can back-date the entry. The system allows absence dates in the past.

Employee Self-Reporting (Leave Request)

Employees can submit their own leave requests before the absence happens:

1. Employee goes to **My Profile** → **Leave Requests**.
2. Clicks **Request Leave**.
3. Selects leave type, dates, and adds an optional reason.
4. Submits — manager receives a 🔔 **notification** in the bell.

Manager then:

1. Opens the notification or goes to **Employees** → **[Employee]** → **Time Off**.
2. Reviews the dates and the employee's remaining leave balance (shown on the same page).
3. Clicks **Approve** or **Decline**.
4. Employee is notified of the decision.

Viewing the Absence Report

Go to **Employees** → **Absence Report** (or **Reports** → **Absences**) to see:

- All absences across all employees for a selected period
- Filtered by employee, absence type, or date range
- Total days absent per employee
- Summary of paid vs unpaid days

Absence data is also visible inside each employee's individual profile under the **Attendance** tab.

How Absences Affect Payroll

When you run payroll:

- **Unpaid absence days** are automatically deducted from the gross salary (pro-rated by number of working days in the period).
- **Paid leave** is counted as a working day — no deduction.
- **AWOL days** are treated as unpaid.
- The payroll entry detail modal shows the breakdown — you can see the number of absent days that were deducted.

> If an absence is recorded *after* payroll has already been exported, you will need to manually adjust the next payroll period or handle it as a manual deduction.

Leave Balances

Each employee's leave balance is tracked under their profile:

- **Annual leave** accrues over time (configured per employment type).
- When leave is approved, the balance decreases automatically.
- Managers can manually adjust a balance (e.g. carry-over from previous year) in the **HR** → **Leave Balances** settings.

Managing Time Off Requests

Employees can submit leave requests through the system. When they do:

1. You will receive a notification.
2. Go to **Pending Actions** or **Employees** → **[Employee Name]** → **Time Off**.
3. Review the dates and type of leave.
4. Check their leave balance (shown on the same page).
5. Click **Approve** or **Decline**.

The employee will be notified of your decision.

Leave Management — HR Direct Actions

HR managers can place employees on leave and record their return directly from two places: the **Employees list** and the dedicated **Leave Management** page.

Leave Status Badges on the Employee List

When you open **Employees**, the system automatically checks who is currently on approved leave. Each employee on leave shows a coloured pill next to their name:

Pill colour	Meaning
Amber — "On Sick Leave since …"	Employee is on approved sick leave
Teal — "On Annual Leave since …"	Employee is on approved annual leave

No pill = not currently on leave.

Placing an Employee on Leave (HR Direct Action)

Unlike the self-service leave request flow (where employees submit and managers approve), this path is instant — no approval step.

From the Employee List:

1. Find the employee.
2. Click ✓ **Return to Work** if they are already on leave, or go to the **Leave Management** page for placement actions.

From the Leave Management page (`Employees → Leave Management`):

1. Use the search bar to find the employee by name or employee number.
2. Click **Sick Leave** or **Annual Leave** next to their name.
3. Fill in the modal:
   - **Start date** — first day of leave (defaults to today)
   - **Expected return date** — first day back at work
   - **Reason** (optional)
4. Click **Confirm**.

The system will:

- Create an approved leave request immediately (no pending step).
- Deduct the days from the employee's leave balance.
- Sync the open payroll entry for the period with the correct `sickDays` / `leaveDays` count.

> The employee's amber or teal badge will appear on the Employees list as soon as the action is saved.

Recording a Return to Work

When an employee returns — whether on the expected date or earlier — you must record their actual return so the system can correct the balance and payroll.

From the Employee List or Leave Management page:

1. Find the employee (they will be showing a leave badge).
2. Click ✓ **Return to Work**.
3. Pick the **return date** (first day back at work — defaults to today).
4. Click **Confirm**.

The system will:

- Record the actual return date on the leave request (the leave badge disappears).
- If the employee returned **early** — refund the unused days back to their leave balance.
- If sick leave days taken **exceeded the allocation** — automatically create absence records for the excess days (see below).
- Correct the payroll entry for the leave period.

Sick Day Overflow — When Sick Leave Runs Out

If an employee takes more sick days than their annual allocation allows, the excess days automatically become **unpaid absent days**:

- The system calculates: `excess = actual sick days taken - sick leave allocation`.
- The last N days of the sick leave period (where N = excess) are converted to individual absence records.
- These absence records feed into payroll as absent days — they are **not** paid.
- A toast notification appears when you record the return, showing how many days overflowed.

Example: Employee has 5 sick days allocated. They take 8 days. On return, 3 days become absent/unpaid and appear in the absence log.

> Overflow days do **not** consume annual leave — they are treated as unpaid absence.

Leave Management Page — Reports Tab

Go to **Employees** → **Leave Management** → **Reports** for three live report cards:

Report	What it shows
Currently on Leave	All employees on approved leave right now — name, type, start date, expected return
Sick Leave Usage	All employees for the current year: allocated days, used days, remaining. Rows in red if ≥ 80% of allocation has been used.
Sick Day Overflow Log	Employees who have exceeded their sick allocation this year and how many days became unpaid absent days

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Employee Scan Cards (ID / Clock-In Cards)

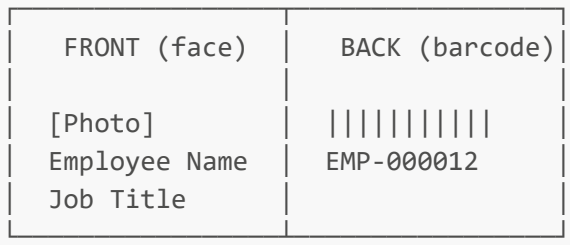
Every employee has a personal barcode card used to clock in and out quickly. The card contains the employee's name, photo, and a unique barcode.

Issuing or reprinting a card:

1. Open the employee's profile (**Employees** → **[Employee Name]**).
2. Go to the **ID Card** tab (or **Clock-In Card** tab).
3. Choose a print method (see below).

Option A — Print ID Card (A4 / Laser / Inkjet)

Click 🖨️ **Print ID Card**. A browser print window opens showing **two identical copies side by side** separated by a dashed fold line.



Print → fold along the dashed line (both faces outward) → trim to card size → laminate. A standard credit-card-sized laminating pouch works perfectly.

Option B — Print Card to Receipt Printer (Thermal)

Click **Print Card to Receipt Printer** to send the card directly to a thermal receipt printer. The printer outputs **two copies stacked vertically** with a fold/cut line between them — fold at the line and trim so you have a card with identical faces on each side.

This option requires either:

- A **network receipt printer** already configured for your business (set up under Settings → Printers), or
- **QZ Tray** — a free desktop app that lets the system print to any USB or locally-installed printer on the same PC.

Setting up QZ Tray (one-time per machine):

See **Section 26 — Printer Setup & QZ Tray** for the complete step-by-step guide. The short version:

1. Download and install QZ Tray from **https://qz.io/download/** — Java is bundled, no separate install needed.
2. Start QZ Tray — look for its icon in the system tray (bottom-right of the Windows taskbar).
3. Open 👤 **Profile** → **Printer Setup** in the app.
4. On first connection, a QZ Tray security dialog will appear — click **Allow** and select **Always allow from this site** so you are not asked again.
5. Select your printer from the dropdown, click **Save Printer**, then **Test Print** to confirm.

> The Printer Setup page is accessible to all users from the profile menu — no admin access needed.

Updating a card (e.g. name change or new photo):

1. Update the employee's details or profile photo on their profile.
2. Return to the **ID Card** tab and reprint — the card automatically reflects the latest information.

> Cards use the employee's unique number (e.g. `RES-EMP-000012`) as the barcode value. If a card is lost, simply reprint from the same screen — the barcode does not change.

Printer Troubleshooting — Clearing Stuck Jobs

If a printer is not responding or is printing garbage, open the **Test Print** panel (printer icon in the top bar) to manage print queues without leaving the app.

Button	What it does
Bring Online	Pings the printer to check its network connection and refresh its online status
Test	Sends a short test page to confirm the printer is reachable
🗑 Clear Print Queue	Cancels all stuck jobs for that printer and restarts the Windows print spooler
■ Stop QZ / Clear Pending Jobs	Disconnects QZ Tray and drops all pending QZ print jobs immediately

> Use **Clear Print Queue** first if the printer is online but stuck (e.g. printing the same job repeatedly). Use **Stop QZ** if a QZ Tray job is looping or printing garbage — then reconnect QZ Tray from the ID Card or receipt page.

> **No printers found after connecting QZ Tray?** Check the Windows taskbar for a QZ Tray security dialog and click **Allow**. Then click the refresh icon on the panel. If the list is still empty, enter your printer name manually (find it under Windows **Start** → **Settings** → **Printers & scanners**). See Section 26 for full troubleshooting.

How Barcode Scanning Works System-Wide — Full Priority Order

The system has a **global barcode scanner** that is always active on every screen. Every scan — no matter what page is open — is passed through a fixed priority chain. The chain stops at the first match. Understanding this order explains why the same physical scanner serves multiple purposes without conflict.

The Priority Chain (Highest to Lowest)

```
Barcode scanned
       │
       ▼  PRIORITY 1 ── Is this an employee card?
       │                Pattern: RES-EMP-000012 / GRO-EMP-000007 etc.
       │                YES → Clock-in / clock-out popup
       │                      Current user's screen is paused but preserved
       │                      Employee confirms in/out → popup closes
```

```
        │                    STOP — nothing else checked
        │                NO  ↓
        ▼  PRIORITY 2 ── Is this a customer loyalty card?
        │                Pattern: RES-CUST-000012 / GRO-CUST-000007 etc.
        │                YES → Customer pre-selected in POS
        │                      (or navigates to correct POS if not already there)
        │                      STOP — nothing else checked
        │                NO  ↓
        ▼  PRIORITY 3 ── Is this a product barcode / inventory item?
                         Runs the full multi-step inventory lookup:
                         3a. Check current business products
                         3b. Check clothing bales (by barcode or SKU)
                         3c. Check barcode templates
                         3d. Check other businesses (cross-business global lookup)
                         3e. Completely unknown → Quick Stock Add form
```

Priority 1 — Employee Clock-In Card (Highest Priority)

Recognised by: The barcode matches the format of an employee number (e.g., `RES-EMP-000012`).

What happens:

- A clock-in/clock-out popup immediately overlays whatever is on screen.
- The current user's work is **not lost** — it is paused underneath.
- The employee selects Clock In or Clock Out and the system captures their photo.
- The popup closes and the previous user's screen resumes exactly as it was.

Why this has the highest priority: An employee scan must always work — a cashier should never have to stop a sale, log out, let someone clock in, then log back in. The clock-in is a quick overlay that does not touch the active session.

> If an employee's card is scanned but they have no pending clock action (e.g. they already clocked in and it is not yet time to clock out), the system may show a brief confirmation rather than a full prompt.

Priority 2 — Customer Loyalty Card

Recognised by: The barcode matches the customer number pattern (e.g., `RES-CUST-000023`, `CLO-CUST-000007`).

What happens — three scenarios:

Scenario	Result
Cashier is on the **correct business's POS** (e.g. scanning a restaurant customer card while on the restaurant POS)	Customer is instantly pre-selected in the POS cart. No navigation, no typing.
Cashier is **not on any POS** (e.g. on a reports page)	System navigates to the correct POS for that customer's business with the customer pre-

Scenario	Result
	loaded.
Cashier is on a **different business's POS** (e.g. on grocery POS, customer is from clothing store)	Confirmation prompt: "Switch to [Clothing] POS for this customer?" — cashier can accept or cancel.

Why Priority 2 comes before inventory: A customer card scan is always intentional — the cashier or customer is deliberately presenting the card to start a transaction. It should never be treated as a product lookup. The customer number format is distinct enough that false matches against product barcodes are not possible.

Priority 3 — Product / Inventory Barcode (Lowest Priority, Most Common)

Recognised by: Anything that did not match employee or customer patterns.

This triggers the full inventory lookup sequence described in the Inventory section:

Sub-step	Checks	Result on match
3a	Current business's product list	Add to cart / show in inventory
3b	Clothing bales (barcode or SKU)	Add bale to cart at unit price
3c	Barcode templates	Show template card → create product
3d	All other businesses (global)	Show cross-business match → option to stock here
3e	No match anywhere	Quick Stock Add form opens

See the **Adding Inventory by Scanning a Barcode** section in Section 14 for the full detail on each sub-step.

Why This Order Makes Sense

Priority	Reason it comes first
Employee clock-in	Must work at all times on any screen without any friction. An employee scan should never accidentally add a product to a cart or select a customer.
Customer loyalty card	A card scan is always intentional and should immediately set up the POS for that customer. Checking inventory first could cause a customer card to be misidentified as a product barcode.
Product / inventory	The most common scan type but also the most flexible — it has its own multi-step lookup and fallback logic, so it is safe to run only after the more specific checks have cleared.

The 4-Character Minimum

The global scanner ignores input shorter than 4 characters. This prevents stray keystrokes (e.g. a fast typist in a text field) from accidentally triggering a scan. Scanners typically send 8–13 characters in under 80 milliseconds — the system detects this rapid input rate and treats it as a scan rather than keyboard typing.

When Two Cards Could Conflict

In practice, formats are designed to be distinct:

Card type	Format	Example
Employee card	`XXX-EMP-000000`	`RES-EMP-000012`
Customer card	`XXX-CUST-000000`	`RES-CUST-000023`
Product barcode	Any other format	`5000112637922`, `BALE-HXI-042`, custom codes

The `-EMP-` and `-CUST-` segments in the middle make employee and customer cards unambiguous regardless of what the business prefix or number is. A product barcode will never contain `-EMP-` or `-CUST-` unless someone deliberately assigned those strings, which the system will flag as a conflict at the time of barcode assignment.

Clock-In Reports

To see attendance records:

1. Go to **Employees** → **Clock-In** → **Reports**.
2. Choose the date range and (optionally) filter by employee.
3. The report shows each day with clock-in time, clock-out time, and total hours.
4. Click **Export** to download as CSV or PDF.

Manually Managing Clock-In Records

Managers can view, add, edit, and correct any clock-in record. This covers situations where an employee forgot to scan, clocked in but forgot to clock out, was clocked in by a colleague, or where the system missed a scan.

Viewing an Employee's Attendance History

1. Go to **Employees** → **[Employee Name]** → **Clock-In** (or **Employees** → **Clock-In** → **Records**).
2. Select the date range.
3. Each row shows: Date, Clock-In Time, Clock-Out Time, Total Hours, and whether a photo was captured.
4. Rows with missing data (e.g. no clock-out) are highlighted so they are easy to spot.

Adding a Missing Clock-In Entry

If an employee was present but has no record for a day:

1. Go to **Employees** → **Clock-In** → **Records**.
2. Click **Add Entry** (or **New Manual Entry**).

3. Select the employee.
4. Enter the date.
5. Enter the **clock-in time** (the time they arrived — use the actual time or your best estimate based on paper records or CCTV).
6. Enter the **clock-out time** (the time they left) — or leave blank if they are still clocked in.
7. Add a **note** explaining the manual entry (e.g., "Scanner offline — entry added from paper register").
8. Click **Save**.

The entry is saved with a flag indicating it was manually created by a manager.

Editing an Existing Record

To correct a wrong time or fill in a missing clock-out:

1. Find the record in the attendance list.
2. Click the row (or click **Edit** on the row).
3. Update the clock-in time, clock-out time, or both.
4. Add or update the note.
5. Click **Save**.

> The original scan time (if any) is preserved in the audit log. The edited values are what appear in reports and payroll calculations. The edit history shows who changed the record and when.

Correcting a Missing Clock-Out

The most common issue is an employee who clocked in but never clocked out (e.g. they left without scanning, or the shift ended past midnight).

1. Find the open record — it will show a clock-in time but no clock-out.
2. Click **Edit** → enter the correct clock-out time.
3. Save with a note (e.g., "Clock-out added — employee left at shift end per manager records").

If you do not know the exact time, enter the standard shift end time and note that it is an estimate.

What "Missing Data" Looks Like in Reports

Clock-in records that are incomplete or manually entered are flagged in the report view:

Indicator	Meaning
⚠ No clock-out	Employee clocked in but has no clock-out time — hours cannot be calculated
✏ Manual entry	Record was created or edited manually by a manager
📷 No photo	Clock-in happened without a camera capture (manual entry or scanner-only mode)

Hours for payroll are only calculated when both clock-in and clock-out are present. Records marked ⚠ must be resolved before the payroll period closes.

Printing Clock-In Sheets

If your business uses paper sign-in sheets as a backup:

1. Go to **Employees** → **Clock-In** → **Bulk Print**.
2. Select the employees and the period.
3. Click **Print Sheets**.

Employee Termination — Full Checklist

When an employee leaves the business (resignation, dismissal, end of contract, or redundancy), a series of steps must be completed in the system to close out their records correctly and prevent continued system access.

Step 1 — Run Final Payroll

Before terminating the employee record, ensure their final payroll is processed:

1. Check whether they have outstanding clock-in records that need correction (see Manually Managing Clock-In Records).
2. Ensure any remaining leave days owed are recorded — unpaid leave entitlements may need to be paid out as a terminal benefit.
3. Include them in the current payroll period (or create a supplementary entry if payroll has already been exported).
4. Note any final adjustments: notice pay owed, leave payout, or deductions for property not returned.
5. Process and export payroll as normal. Mark them as paid once disbursed.

Step 2 — Issue Final Payslip and P45 / Certificate of Service

After final payroll is exported:

1. Generate their final payslip from the payroll period.
2. Prepare a **Certificate of Service** (also called a reference letter or service letter) stating their employment dates, job title, and reason for leaving. This is a legal requirement in most jurisdictions and a common expectation.
3. Export the **ZIMRA YTD** file (Export YTD button) to get the employee's year-to-date tax figures for their ZIMRA P45 / ITC, which the employee needs to file with ZIMRA and provide to their next employer.

Step 3 — Revoke System Access (If the Employee Was a User)

If the employee had a system login:

1. Go to **Settings** → **Users** (or **Employees** → **[Employee Name]** → **System Access**).
2. Click **Deactivate Account** (or **Revoke Access**).
3. Confirm — the account is immediately disabled. Any active sessions are terminated.

> Do this **on the last working day** or immediately on dismissal. A departing employee should not retain access to sales, cash, inventory, or any other business data after they leave.

Also check:

- Remove them from any shared logins or admin roles.
- If they had a POS session open, ensure it is closed before deactivating.

Step 4 — Mark Employee as Terminated in the System

1. Open the employee's profile.
2. Click **Terminate Employee** (or **End Employment**).
3. Fill in:
    - **Termination date** — their last working day.
    - **Reason** — Resignation, End of Contract, Dismissal, Redundancy, or Other.
    - **Notice period served** — whether they worked out their notice or were paid in lieu.
    - **Notes** — any relevant details for the record.
4. Click **Confirm Termination**.

What happens:

- The employee's status changes to **Terminated / Inactive**.
- They are removed from all active payroll period pulls (future payroll runs will not include them automatically).
- Their clock-in card barcode is deactivated — scanning it will no longer trigger a clock-in prompt.
- They disappear from active employee lists but their full history (payroll, attendance, contracts, per diem) remains permanently in the system for audit and reporting purposes.

Step 5 — Close Out Their Expense and Petty Cash Items

Before finalising:

1. Check for any open petty cash requests in their name — settle or cancel them.
2. Check for any outstanding expense payment requests they submitted — ensure these are approved and paid out, or cancelled if no longer valid.
3. Check for any loans in their name — record any final repayment from their terminal pay, or write off the balance per company policy.

Step 6 — Collect Business Property

Ensure the following are returned and recorded:

- ☐ Employee scan card / clock-in card (deactivate immediately)
- ☐ Keys, access cards, uniforms
- ☐ Company phone or equipment
- ☐ Any cash float or petty cash they held

Note the return of each item in the employee's profile under **Notes** or **Offboarding Checklist** if available.

Contract Expiry vs Termination

Situation	What to do
Fixed-term contract ends, employee not continuing	Set contract end date if not already set → Terminate employee record → follow checklist above
Fixed-term contract ends, employee continuing	Create a new contract (see Contract Renewal above) — do NOT terminate the employee record
Permanent employee resigns	Record resignation date as termination date → follow checklist above
Dismissal	Terminate immediately → revoke system access first

> An expired contract without renewal does not automatically terminate the employee in the system. You must explicitly go through the termination process to deactivate their record and access.

---

6. Employees — Clock-In, Leave & Per Diem

> **Who reads this:** General employees who need to clock in, apply for leave, or request per diem.

Clocking In and Out

Using Your Scan Card (Recommended)

Your manager will give you a personal barcode card with your name and photo. To clock in or out:

1. **Scan your card** at any terminal using the barcode scanner — you can do this at any time, even if someone else is using the screen. A clock-in prompt will pop up over whatever is on screen.
2. The system will turn on the camera to **take your photo** automatically. Look at the camera briefly.
3. Confirm whether you are **clocking in** or **clocking out** on the popup.
4. The popup closes and the other user's screen continues uninterrupted.

> **You do not need to log in to use your scan card.** Just scan and go.

Without a Scan Card

1. Go to **Employees** → **Clock-In** (or ask your manager for the link).
2. Find your name in the list.
3. The camera will take your photo.
4. Click **Clock In** or **Clock Out**.

> **If you forgot to clock in or out:** Tell your manager as soon as possible. They can open your attendance record and manually add or correct the time. Provide them with your actual arrival or departure time so the record is accurate.

Applying for Leave

1. Go to **Employees** → **[Your Name]** → **Time Off**.

2. Click **Request Time Off**.
3. Choose the leave type (Annual Leave, Sick Leave, etc.).
4. Pick the start and end dates.
5. Add a note if needed (e.g., "Doctor's appointment").
6. Click **Submit Request**.

Your manager will receive a notification and approve or decline your request. You will be notified of the outcome.

Per Diem — Complete Process

Per diem is a daily allowance paid to an employee for travel or work away from their normal location. It covers expenses like accommodation, meals, and incidentals that the employee incurs on behalf of the business.

Step 1 — Employee Requests a Per Diem Form (Paper)

Before travel begins, the employee obtains a **Per Diem Request Form**. This is a printed document the employee fills in by hand to declare their travel details, which is then submitted to the manager or HR officer for authorisation.

To print a blank request form:

1. Go to **Employees** → **Per Diem** → **Request Form**.
2. Select the employee's name (optional — leave blank for a generic form).
3. Select the month and year the travel falls in.
4. Click **Print Form** or **Download PDF**.

The form contains:

- Employee name and employee number
- Job title and business
- Month / year
- A table with rows for each travel day: Date | Purpose | Amount | Notes
- Signature lines for the Employee, the person entering the data, and the Approver

The employee fills in the form by hand during or after the trip, noting each day they were away and what category the expense falls under.

Step 2 — Employee Submits the Completed Form

The employee hands the completed, signed form to their manager or HR officer. The manager reviews and signs the **Approver** line to authorise the amounts.

> The physical signed form is the authorisation record. Keep it on file. The system entry (Step 3) is based on what the manager has signed off.

Step 3 — Entering Per Diem into the System

Once the form is signed and approved, the HR officer or authorised cashier enters the data into the system.

1. Go to **Employees** → **Per Diem** → **New Entry**.
2. Select the **employee** from the dropdown (all active employees are listed).
3. Select the **month** and **year** the travel occurred in. This links the entries to the correct payroll period.
4. The entry table appears. For each day on the form, click **Add Row** and fill in:

Field	What to enter
Date	The exact date of that travel day (must fall within the selected month)
Amount	The approved allowance amount for that day (as signed on the form)
Purpose	Choose the category that best matches: **Lodging**, **Meals**, **Incidentals**, **Travel**, or **Other**
Notes	Optional — add a brief description (e.g., "Harare overnight", "Fuel reimbursement")

5. Add as many rows as needed — one row per travel day (or per expense category per day if they differ).
6. The **running total** at the bottom of the form updates as you add rows.
7. When all days are entered, click **Save X Entries**.

All rows are saved together in a single transaction. If any row has an error, none are saved — fix the error and try again.

Step 4 — Verify the Entry

After saving, the entries appear in the per diem list grouped by employee:

1. Go to **Employees** → **Per Diem**.
2. Select the same month and year.
3. Find the employee — their entries are listed with each date, purpose, and amount.
4. Confirm the total matches what was on the signed form.

To print the **Claim Form** (a filled-in summary for the file):

1. Find the employee in the list.
2. Click **Print Claim Form**.
3. The system generates a PDF showing all entries for that period, with the total, and signature lines.
4. Attach this to the original paper form and file it.

Step 5 — Manager or Admin Approves or Rejects Per Diem Entries

Per diem entries start in **Pending** status. A manager or admin should approve them before the payroll period is exported.

1. Go to **Employees** → **Per Diem**.
2. Select the month and year.
3. The list shows all entries grouped by employee, with a **Status** badge on each row: **Pending** (amber), **Approved** (green), or **Rejected** (red).

4. The summary bar at the top shows a **Pending Approval** count so you can see at a glance how many entries still need action.
5. For each pending entry, click:
    - **Approve** — marks the entry as approved; it is counted in the payroll Per Diem column with a ✓ Approved badge.
    - **Reject** — marks the entry as rejected; it is excluded from all payroll totals. A rejected entry can still be approved later if needed.

> **Who can approve:** Managers with `canAccessPayroll` or `canManageEmployees` permissions, and all system admins. Delete is restricted to admins only.

> **Payroll picks up pending and approved entries.** The payroll table Per Diem column shows both approved and pending entries — pending ones display with a ⚠ Pending badge. Approve before exporting so payslips show the confirmed, finalised figure.

Step 6 — Per Diem Flows into Payroll Automatically

Per diem entries do not need to be transferred or manually added to payroll. When the payroll export runs for the same month and year:

- The system aggregates all per diem entries for each employee.
- The total is added to a **"Per Diem"** column in the payroll spreadsheet.
- It is included in the employee's **gross pay** for that period.
- The payroll processor handles any applicable tax treatment on the per diem amount.

> Both **approved** and **pending** per diem entries are included in payroll totals — rejected entries are excluded. Approve all entries before exporting payroll so that payslips show the confirmed figures rather than provisional ones.

Correcting or Deleting an Entry

If a mistake was made in the entered amount or date:

- Entries can only be deleted (not edited in place). Delete the incorrect row and re-enter it correctly.
- **Delete requires admin access.** Contact your system administrator or a manager with admin rights to remove an incorrect entry.

Purposes Explained

Purpose	Use when
Lodging	Employee paid for overnight accommodation
Meals	Daily meal allowance while away
Incidentals	Miscellaneous small expenses (tips, internet, laundry)
Travel	Fuel, bus fare, taxi, flight — transport costs

Purpose	Use when
Other	Anything that does not fit the above categories

Multiple purposes can be claimed for the same day by adding separate rows — e.g., one row for Lodging and one for Meals on the same date.

---

7. Expense Accounts & Petty Cash

> **Who reads this:** Staff who manage or use expense accounts, and anyone who handles petty cash.

Types of Expense Accounts

The system has two distinct types of expense accounts. They look similar in the interface but serve different purposes.

Business Expense Accounts

A **business expense account** is a pot of money set aside for a specific operational purpose — for example, "Office Supplies", "Vehicle Maintenance", "Staff Welfare Fund", or "Building Maintenance". Money is deposited in from the business account (manually or automatically at EOD), and payments are made from it by submitting payment requests.

Key characteristics:

- Belongs to a specific business (or can span all businesses).
- Funded from the business's sales income — typically via EOD auto-deposits.
- All payments require manager approval before the cash is released.
- Payments go through a batch payment workflow (see Section 4 — Payment Request Workflow).
- Balance and transaction history are visible in reports.

Common business expense accounts:

Account	Purpose
Office Supplies	Stationery, printer ink, cleaning materials
Vehicle Maintenance	Fuel, servicing, tyres
Staff Welfare	Staff meals, medical emergencies, welfare events
Building Maintenance	Repairs, plumbing, electrical
Rent Account	Saves daily towards monthly rent (see Rent Account section)
Payroll Account	Funded specifically to pay employee salaries

Personal / Employee Expense Accounts

A **personal expense account** is linked to a specific employee rather than a business. It is used to advance money to an individual or track what they owe back.

Key characteristics:

- Linked to an employee's record.
- Funded by a deposit from the business (e.g., an advance or a loan to the employee).
- The employee submits repayments or the amount is deducted from payroll.
- Used for salary advances, staff loans, and individual reimbursement tracking.

When a personal account is used:

- An employee needs a salary advance before payday — money is deposited into their personal account and counted as a future payroll deduction.
- An employee takes a loan from the business — recorded as a deposit to their account and tracked separately in the Loans module.

Making an Expense Payment Request (Business Account)

1. Go to **Expense Accounts**.
2. Click the account you are spending from.
3. Click **New Payment Request**.
4. Enter:
    - The **amount**
    - **What it is for** (description — be specific, e.g. "Replacement printer cartridge HP 63XL")
    - **Payee / supplier** — who is being paid (select from the supplier list or type a name)
    - **Reference number** — invoice number, receipt number, or quote number if available
5. Click **Submit for Approval**.

Your manager will review it. You will receive a notification when it is approved or declined. Once approved, the payment is grouped into the next payment batch and the cashier disburses the cash.

Checking Your Account Balance

1. Go to **Expense Accounts**.
2. The balance for each account is shown on the main list.
3. Click into an account to see the full history of deposits and payments, including who requested each payment and when it was approved.

Adjusting an Account Balance (Admin Only)

An account's balance is calculated automatically from its deposit and payment history — you never normally need to set it directly. But occasionally a balance can drift from what it should be (for example, after restoring from a backup, or if historical transactions were missing). If you notice a balance that looks wrong, a system administrator can correct it.

Who can do this: System administrators only.

1. Open the expense account with the incorrect balance.
2. Next to the balance figure, click the ✏️ (pencil) icon. If you don't see it, you don't have permission to adjust balances.
3. In the **Adjust Account Balance** window:
    - **Correct Balance** — enter what the balance should actually be (e.g., from a bank/cash reconciliation).
    - **Reason** — required. Explain why the correction is needed (e.g., "Reconciled against landlord statement — a deposit from before the backup restore was missing").
4. Click **Adjust Balance**, then confirm.

What happens: The system doesn't just overwrite the number — it posts a proper correction entry (a deposit or a payment, whichever direction is needed) into the account's transaction history, tagged with your name, the date, the old and new balance, and your reason. This keeps the balance fully auditable and means it won't silently drift back to the old figure later. The account's own balance display, and the ⇄ **Switch** account dropdown, both update immediately to the corrected figure — no page reload needed.

> If the same account shows different balances in different places (e.g. on a dashboard summary vs. the account detail page), open the account detail page first — it recalculates the true balance from the full transaction history every time it loads, and this is always the number to trust.

Adjusting the Business Balance or Cash Box (Admin Only)

The same correction tool exists for two more balances, so every number in the books — expense accounts, the business's own revenue balance, and the physical cash box — can be kept in sync with reality:

Business Balance (a business's revenue balance across all payment methods) — the pencil appears in two places, both correcting the same balance:

- The **Dashboard**, next to "💰 [Business] Sales Balance", or
- **Business Accounts → [pick a business]** (`/business-accounts/[businessId]`), next to the large **Balance** figure at the top of the page — this is the dedicated account page with its own Transactions and Reports tabs, and is the more direct place to go when you're specifically reconciling that business's books.

1. Click the ✏️ pencil next to the balance figure (admin only).
2. Enter the **Correct Balance** and a required **Reason**, then confirm.

Cash Box — Cash and EcoCash (the **Cash Box** page, per-business breakdown):

1. Click the ✏️ pencil next to a business's name (admin only).
2. The **Adjust Cash Box Balance** window lets you correct **Cash** and **EcoCash** independently — enter a new value for either or both (leave a field as-is if that channel is already correct), plus one shared **Reason**.
3. Confirm. Correcting the cash figure automatically updates "💵 Physical cash to count" too, since that's the cash balance plus whatever is currently earmarked for rent/payroll/other allocations — you don't need to (and can't) adjust that combined figure directly, only the underlying cash balance.

What happens (same principle in both cases): Nothing is silently overwritten. Each correction posts a real, audited entry into the same transaction/ledger history everything else in that balance is built from — tagged

with who made it, when, the old and new values, and the reason — so the fix is permanent and traceable, and won't drift back to the old number the next time the balance is recalculated.

Drilling Into an Earmarked Amount (Cash Box)

On the **Cash Box** page's Per-Business Breakdown, each business's "💵 Physical cash to count" splits into "✅ Free / available" and "🔒 Earmarked" — and every individual line under Earmarked (e.g. "Loan: Tichaona Hwandaza", "General Expenses", a rent account) is clickable.

> **Earmarked is unbounded** — it is not limited to a rolling window of recent days. It shows everything currently set aside and not yet disbursed, for as long as it stays undisbursed, so the figure is always accurate no matter how long ago the money was earmarked. The same unbounded calculation is used everywhere earmarked/Set Aside totals appear — the Cash Box page, the Dashboard, the Cash Position card row, and the Cash Position Report's Set Aside by Purpose table.

Click a line to open a breakdown showing:

- **Lifetime Contributed**, **Lifetime Disbursed**, and **Still Available** for that purpose — the same three figures shown in the Cash Position Report's Set Aside by Purpose table (see section 3), since both are backed by the same calculation.
- The **real expense account** it belongs to, by name and account number (🏦) — including shared accounts used by more than one business (like "General Expenses" or a shared loan account), which don't otherwise show which real account they map to.

This is read-only — it's for tracing where an earmarked figure actually comes from, not for editing it. To correct the underlying cash balance, use the 🖍️ pencil described above instead.

Cash Box, Earmarked, and Expense Account on the Dashboard

The **Dashboard**'s business-type cards (and the summary "All" card) show three related but distinct figures in their footer, using consistent labels:

Label	Meaning
🗳️ **Cash Box (Free)**	Cash and EcoCash currently on hand and *not* reserved for anything — this is the same figure previously labeled just "Cash Box"; the "(Free)" suffix was added so it's not confused with the earmarked total next to it.
🔒 **Earmarked**	Cash still physically in the box but already reserved for an allocation or payroll funding — unbounded, not limited to a recent-days window (see above). Only shown when non-zero.
🏦 **Expense Account**	The balance of the business's own GENERAL expense account. Only shown when non-zero.

> Note: unlike the Cash Box page's "💵 Physical cash to count" (which is Free + Earmarked combined), the Dashboard's "🗳️ Cash Box (Free)" figure does **not** include Earmarked — that's why Earmarked is broken out as its own line here instead of being folded in.

Opening a business-type card's detail view (click the card) also lists each individual business with its own 🔒 Earmarked and 🏦 Expense Account figures, when either is non-zero — the same figures as the type-level

card, scoped to just that one business.

Linking an Expense Account to a Business (Admin Only)

A business's expense account is normally linked automatically when the business is created. If an account somehow ends up without a business link — most likely an older account created before this was in place — several features that look up "this business's expense account" (like contractor payouts and auto-deposits) won't be able to find it.

Who can do this: System administrators only.

1. Open the account. If it's a **GENERAL** account with no business link, a 🔗 **Link to Business** button appears next to the Active/Inactive status.
2. Click it, pick the correct business from the list, and confirm.

This can only be done once per account — an already-linked account can't be re-pointed to a different business from here, to avoid accidentally disconnecting a business from a live account by mistake.

Switching Between Expense Accounts

When you are inside an expense account detail page, a ⇄ **Switch** button appears in the breadcrumb bar next to "Accounts /". This lets you jump directly to another account without going back to the list.

How to use it:

1. Open any expense account.
2. Click ⇄ **Switch** in the top breadcrumb area.
3. A dropdown appears showing all expense accounts you have access to, along with each account's current balance (green = positive, red = zero/negative).
4. Type to search by account name or account number.
5. Click any account to navigate directly to it.

> The current account is highlighted in blue in the switcher list.

Transferring Funds Between Non-Business Accounts

The **Transfer** feature moves money from one expense account to another. Transfers are only available on accounts that are **not tied to a specific business** — these are shared or personal accounts accessible via direct grants.

> If an account belongs to a business (e.g. "Office Supplies – Restaurant"), the Transfer button will not appear on that account. Only accounts with no business link show the Transfer button.

Who can transfer:

- Users who have been granted **Full Access** to the source account.
- System administrators.

Transferring from the Account Detail Page

1. Open the expense account you want to transfer **from**.
2. Click ⇄ **Transfer** (top-right action buttons area).
3. In the Transfer Funds modal:
    - **From** — pre-filled with the current account and its balance (read-only).
    - **To** — select the destination account from the dropdown. Each option shows the account name, number, and current balance. Type to search.
    - **Amount** — enter the amount to transfer. A "Balance after transfer" preview updates as you type.
    - **Notes** — required. Describe the reason for the transfer (e.g. "Covering shortfall for supplier payment").
4. Click **Transfer**.

The transfer is atomic — the debit and credit happen together. If the source account has insufficient balance the transfer is rejected.

Transferring from the Accounts List Page

On the **Expense Accounts** list, accounts without a business link show a ⇄ **Transfer** button directly on the account card. Click it to open the same Transfer Funds modal without navigating into the account first.

Viewing Transfer History

Inside any non-business expense account, click the ⇄ **Transfers** tab to see all transfers involving that account — both inbound and outbound — with the date, amount, counterpart account, and notes.

Personal Expense Accounts — Private Expense Tracking

A personal expense account lets an individual user track their own spending privately. Unlike business expense accounts (which are visible to managers and used for company spending), a personal account is **private to the account holder** — only the account holder and system administrators can see its contents.

What a Personal Account Is Used For

- **Tracking personal business expenses** that you will later claim back — e.g. you paid for a business dinner out of your own pocket and want to record it before submitting a claim.
- **Monitoring a salary advance** — if the business advanced you money, your personal account shows the balance you owe back and what has been deducted from payroll so far.
- **Recording reimbursable costs** — fuel, accommodation, or supplies paid personally while travelling for work.

How It Works

1. **Viewing your personal account:** Go to **Expense Accounts** → **My Account** (or **Profile** → **My Expense Account**). Your personal account balance and transaction history are shown.

2. **Recording an expense you paid:**

    - Click **New Entry** or **Add Expense**.
    - Enter the amount, date, description, and category.
    - Attach a receipt photo if available.

- Save — the entry is logged against your account.

3. **Submitting a claim for reimbursement:**
    - When you are ready to claim back money you spent, click **Submit for Reimbursement**.
    - The request goes to your manager for approval (same workflow as a regular expense payment request, but drawn from your personal account).
    - Once approved and paid out, the entry is marked as **Reimbursed**.
4. **Tracking an advance or loan:**
    - If the business deposited an advance into your account, it shows as a positive balance (you have been given money).
    - As payroll runs, the advance amount is deducted — the balance reduces toward zero.
    - When the balance reaches zero the advance is fully repaid.

Privacy

- Your personal expense account balance and entries are **not visible to other employees or managers** through normal screens.
- Only the account holder and system administrators (owners/admins) can view the account contents.
- Payment requests you submit from your personal account do go to a manager for approval — but the manager only sees the amount and description you provide, not your full account history.

> Use your personal account as a running expense diary for any costs you incur on behalf of the business. Record expenses as they happen (not in a batch at month end) so you do not lose receipts and your records stay accurate.

Petty Cash — Full Workflow

Petty cash is for small, immediate purchases (e.g., stationery, a taxi fare, emergency supplies). Unlike a formal expense payment request (which goes through a batch payment), petty cash is for situations where you need cash in hand right now.

Stage 1 — Employee Submits a Request

1. Go to **Petty Cash** → **New Request**.
2. Fill in:
    - **Amount** — how much you need
    - **Reason** — what you are buying (e.g., "Printer cartridges", "Taxi to town")
    - **Category** — choose the most relevant category
3. Click **Submit**.

Status → **Pending Approval**. The manager receives a 🔔 notification.

Stage 2 — Manager Approves or Declines

The manager sees the request in **Pending Actions** or under **Petty Cash** → **Requests**.

- **Approve** — clicks Approve. Status → **Approved**. The employee receives a 🔔 notification: "Your petty cash request of $XX was approved."
- **Decline** — clicks Decline and enters a reason. Status → **Declined**. Employee is notified with the reason.

Stage 3 — Cash Is Released and Spending Is Recorded

Approval itself releases the money — there's no separate "collect from the cashier" step to mark in the system. The moment a cashier approves the request, the cash bucket is debited and the approved amount is deposited into the request's own petty cash tracking automatically.

As you spend, go to your approved request and click **+ Record Spend** (or **+ Record EcoCash Spend** for an EcoCash-channel request) each time you make a purchase — enter the amount, a description, a category, and optionally a payee. This builds up a running **Spent** total against the approved amount, visible on the request.

Stage 4 — Returning Unused Funds

Once you're done spending, any leftover balance (approved amount minus what you actually spent) needs to be returned. How this works depends on the payment channel:

CASH requests — returning physical cash needs a cashier to confirm they actually received it, so it's a two-step process:

1. Open your approved request and click 💰 **Return unused funds**. This submits a settlement request — it does **not** credit anything yet.
2. Status changes to **Awaiting Settlement**, and you'll see the request under **Return Confirmations Needed** in the cashier's Pending Actions.
3. A cashier reviews it and, once they've physically received the cash, clicks ✅ **Confirm Receipt & Settle**. Only at that point is the cash bucket credited and the request marked **Settled**.

EcoCash requests — since returning EcoCash is a software transfer with no physical handoff, either you or a cashier can settle in one step: click 🧮 **Settle Request**, confirm the amount being returned, and the request is immediately marked **Settled** — no separate confirmation step needed.

Petty Cash Status Summary

Status	Meaning
Pending	Submitted, waiting for manager approval
Approved	Approved — cash already released, spending in progress
Awaiting Settlement	CASH only — requester has reported a return; awaiting cashier confirmation
Settled	Unused funds returned and confirmed (or, for EcoCash, self-settled)
Cancelled	Request cancelled before approval

Rent Account — Setup and Operation

The Rent Account is a dedicated savings account within the system that accumulates money over the month so that rent can be paid in full when it is due. Instead of scrambling for a lump sum at the end of the month, a small amount is set aside every day the business trades.

How It Works

1. The manager sets a **monthly rent amount** and the number of **operating days** per month.
2. The system calculates a **daily transfer amount** = Monthly Rent ÷ Operating Days (rounded up).
3. Every day at EOD close, the daily amount is recorded as a deposit into the Rent Expense Account. The physical cash remains in the cash bucket — the rent account is a bookkeeping record showing how much of the bucket is earmarked for rent.
4. By rent due day, the full monthly amount (or close to it) has accumulated in the rent account balance.
5. On payment day, the manager requests the rent payment from the Rent Account. The cash is drawn from the cash bucket.

Example: Monthly rent = $400, operating days = 25 → daily transfer = $16. After 25 trading days the account balance shows $400 — all of which is physically held in the cash bucket.

Rent Account Accounting Principle

The rent account is **bookkeeping only**. All physical cash is stored in the cash bucket:

Source	Rent Account	Cash Bucket
Daily EOD transfer	+$16 balance	Cash already there (earmarked)
Direct deposit (e.g. loan top-up)	+$50 balance	+$50 INFLOW recorded, immediately earmarked
Rent payment to landlord	−$375 balance	−$375 OUTFLOW recorded

> The balance in the Rent Account is what determines whether rent can be paid — if the balance is less than the monthly rent, the payment will be blocked until more deposits accumulate.

Setting Up a Rent Account

A manager or owner sets this up once:

1. Go to **[Business]** → **Settings** → **Rent Account** (or **Expense Accounts** → **Rent Account** → **Configure**).
2. Click **Set Up Rent Account**.
3. Fill in:
    - **Monthly Rent Amount** — what you pay each month
    - **Operating Days per Month** — how many days a month the business trades (used to calculate daily transfer; typically 25–26 for Mon–Sat)
    - **Rent Due Day** — which day of the month rent is due (e.g., 1 = 1st of each month); must be between 1 and 28
    - **Landlord** — search for the landlord by name, or use **+ Add Landlord** to create a new one (name, phone, email are required for a new landlord)
    - **Auto-transfer on EOD** — toggle ON to have the daily amount move automatically at each EOD close

4. The system displays the calculated **Daily Transfer Amount** (read-only — it is computed from your inputs).
5. Click **Save**.

A dedicated rent expense account is created automatically with an account number in the format `RENT-XXXXX`.

The Rent Account Dashboard

Go to **Expense Accounts** and click the Rent Account (or via **Settings** → **Rent Account** → **Manage**) to see:

- **Current Balance** — how much has accumulated so far this month
- **Monthly Rent Target** — the full amount needed
- **Funding % bar** — visual indicator:
  - 🔴 Red (< 75%) — still building up, rent day may be tight
  - 🟠 Orange (75–99%) — good progress
  - 🟢 Green (100%+) — fully funded, ready to pay
- **Transactions tab** — full history of every daily deposit and any payments made

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When Rent is Due — Paying the Landlord

When rent is due, the money has been accumulating in the Rent Account. To request payment:

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** and open the Rent Account.
2. Click 🏠 **Request Rent** — the button shows the configured monthly rent amount (e.g. "🏠 Request Rent $375.00").
3. The system checks that the **Rent Account balance ≥ monthly rent amount**. If the balance is short, the request is blocked — you need to wait for more EOD transfers or add a direct deposit.
4. If the balance is sufficient, a payment request is created and queued for the next EOD payment batch.
5. A manager reviews and approves the batch. At that point the cash is drawn from the cash bucket and the rent account balance decreases.

> If you need to cancel a submitted rent payment request — for example if the landlord gave an extension — open the EOD Payment Batch review, **Reject** the rent line item, and click **Process & Print Report**. The payment is returned to the queue for the next EOD cycle.

Adding a Direct Deposit to the Rent Account

If the regular EOD transfers are not enough to cover rent on time (e.g. a missed day, or a one-off top-up from a loan or cash injection):

1. Go to the Rent Account.
2. Click **Add Deposit**.
3. Select the source type — e.g. **Manual**, **Loan**, or **Other** (not EOD).
4. Enter the amount and a note.
5. Click **Save**.

What happens:

- The rent account balance increases immediately.
- A **Cash INFLOW** entry is recorded in the cash bucket (the physical cash is now accounted for).
- An **earmark** (CASH_ALLOCATION) is recorded automatically so the deposited amount is not available for other expense requests.

Adjusting the Rent Configuration

If the rent amount changes or you need to update the landlord:

1. Go to **Settings** → **Rent Account** → **Manage**.
2. Update the Monthly Rent, Operating Days, Due Day, or Landlord as needed.
3. The new daily transfer amount is calculated immediately and applies from the next EOD onwards.

To deactivate the rent account (e.g., if you move premises):

- Go to **Manage** → **Deactivate Rent Account**.
- Existing balance is preserved. Auto-transfers stop.

Cash Allocation Report — Detailed Workflow

The Cash Allocation Report is the cashier's formal record of how the day's physical cash was distributed. It is generated automatically after the EOD report is saved and must be completed before the till shift is considered closed.

Why It Exists

When the EOD close runs auto-deposits and a rent transfer, money moves between accounts in the system — but physical cash still needs to be physically counted, separated, and placed in the right envelopes or handed to the right people. The Cash Allocation Report bridges the system records with the physical cash handling.

What It Contains

Each line item in the report represents one money movement from the EOD:

Line Item	Source	What the cashier must do
Rent Transfer	EOD_RENT_TRANSFER	Count out the daily rent amount, put in rent envelope
Staff Welfare Fund deposit	EOD_AUTO_DEPOSIT	Count out that amount, set aside for that account
Building Fund deposit	EOD_AUTO_DEPOSIT	Count out that amount, set aside for that account
… (one row per auto-deposit)		

Completing the Report

1. Go to **[Business]** → **Reports** → **Cash Allocation** (the report opens automatically after EOD save, or find it under Reports).
2. For each line item:
    - Count out the physical cash matching the **Reported Amount**.
    - Tick the checkbox ✅.
    - Confirm the amount (type it in if there is a discrepancy).
3. Once every line item is checked and amounts match, click **Lock Allocation**.

What Locking Does

- Status changes from **Draft** → **Locked** — the report cannot be changed.
- For each line item, a **Cash Bucket OUTFLOW** entry is recorded (the cash physically leaving the till).
- A single **Cash Bucket INFLOW** entry is recorded for the total cash counted in for the day.

> **Allocations can't exceed real cash.** Rent, auto-deposits, and payroll contributions are all checked against real available cash *before* they're created (see Step 2 and Step 3 of the EOD walkthrough) — so by the time you reach this report, every line item on it is already backed by real cash. A day that couldn't cover everything simply has fewer line items (or, for rent, a "SKIPPED" row) rather than an outflow with nothing behind it. See below for how to recover a skipped day once cash is available.

Grouped Cash Allocation (Catch-Up EOD)

When the Grouped EOD Catch-Up closes multiple missed days, a single combined Cash Allocation Report is created covering all selected dates. The workflow is the same — one report, one set of line items for all dates combined — making it easier to handle the physical cash for catch-up closes without generating many separate reports.

Allocation Backlog & Manual Catch-Up

Who sees this: Anyone who can run the Cash Allocation Report (`canRunCashAllocationReport`, or an admin) — the panel appears automatically at the top of **[Business]** → **Reports** → **Cash Allocation** whenever there's an outstanding backlog for that business, and stays hidden otherwise.

When rent, a loan/expense auto-deposit, or the payroll contribution is skipped because real cash isn't available that day (see Steps 2/3/3b above), the missed amount doesn't just disappear — it's recorded as **backlog** against that specific account, and can be manually caught up later once cash comes in.

The Backlog Panel

At the top of the Cash Allocation Report, a red **"⚠ Allocation Backlog"** panel lists every account with an outstanding amount:

Column	Meaning
Account	Which rent account, loan/expense account, or "Payroll Account" is owed money
Days missed	How many separate days contributed to this backlog, and the date range
Amount owed	Total still outstanding for that account (across all missed days)

Column	Meaning
Available now	Real cash currently available to catch up with, shown at the top of the panel

Catching Up

Click **Catch Up Now** next to an account to transfer as much of its backlog as real cash currently allows:

- If there's enough cash to cover the **entire** backlog, it's fully paid off in one click and the row disappears.
- If there's only enough for **part** of it, the amount actually transferred is applied to the **oldest missed day(s) first**, and the row updates to show what's still owed — you can click **Catch Up Now** again later as more cash becomes available.
- If there's currently no cash to spare, the button is disabled.

A loan account's catch-up is automatically capped at whatever is still actually owed on the loan — if the loan balance has changed since the missed day (e.g. partly repaid through other means), you can never accidentally overpay it.

Every catch-up transfer is a real, dated transaction — it updates the target account's balance, the business account, and the cash bucket exactly like a normal EOD deposit, and shows up in that account's transaction history as a manual catch-up.

> **Nothing here can ever transfer more than real cash actually covers** — the same real-cash check used everywhere else in Cash Allocation applies to catch-up transfers too.

Cash Position Report

Where: Cash Bucket → Report (or **Reports → Cash Position**).

This report shows the same Cash Position figures described above (see **Understanding Your Cash Position**), but for any date range and business you choose, with a full transaction ledger and export.

Choosing a range. Use the date filter at the top — presets (Today, Yesterday, Last 7/30/90 Days, etc.), a specific month/year, a custom range, or **All Time**. In All Time mode, Opening Balance has no meaning (there's no "before" to measure from), so the report falls back to three simple lifetime totals — Total Cash in Bucket, Total Inflows, Total Outflows — instead of the six-card breakdown.

Comparison arrows. For any real date range (not All Time), each figure shows a small ▲/▼ arrow underneath with how much it changed versus the equivalent prior period — yesterday vs. the day before, this week vs. last week, this month vs. last calendar month. For an arbitrary custom range, it compares against the same-length period immediately before it. The arrow just shows direction and amount — it doesn't judge whether a change is "good" or "bad" (a higher Expenses figure isn't flagged as bad, for instance).

Drilling in. Same as on the Cash Bucket page — click Cash In, Expenses, or Set Aside to jump to the filtered ledger or the Set Aside by Purpose table; click Available Balance or Closing Balance to see the step-by-step calculation.

Exporting. Click **Export** to download an Excel file with three sheets — Cash Position summary, Set Aside by Purpose, and the full Ledger (including deleted entries, marked in a Deleted column) — using whatever filters are currently applied on screen. Click the printer icon to print the report as shown.

8. Business Loans

> **Who reads this:** Managers and business owners tracking loans taken by the business or issued to employees.

The system has **two separate loan systems** that serve different purposes:

System	Direction	Example
Business Loan	External lender → Business	Bank loan, investor advance, supplier credit
Outgoing Employee Loan	Business → Employee/Person	Staff salary advance, personal loan

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Part A — Business Loans (The Business Borrows)

This tracks money the business has borrowed from an external source — a bank, investor, or supplier.

Business Loan Statuses

Status	Meaning
Recording	Loan details are being entered; figures can still change
Lock Requested	Manager has finished entering details and asked for it to be locked
Locked	Loan is confirmed and active; repayments are now tracked against it
Settled	Loan is fully paid off

> The status flow is strictly one-way: Recording → Lock Requested → Locked → Settled. You cannot go backwards.

Creating a Business Loan Record

1. Go to **Finance** → **Business Loans** (or **Loans** in the menu).
2. Click **New Loan**.
3. Fill in:
    - **Lender name** — who provided the money
    - **Loan number / reference** — the lender's reference (optional)
    - **Principal amount** — the total amount borrowed
    - **Interest rate** — percentage (enter 0 if none)
    - **Start date** and **due date**
    - **Notes** — purpose of the loan, collateral, conditions
4. Click **Save** — the loan is created in **Recording** status.

While in *Recording* status you can edit any field freely.

Requesting a Lock

When all details are confirmed and you want to start tracking repayments:

1. Open the loan.
2. Click **Request Lock**.
3. A manager or owner reviews and clicks **Confirm Lock**.
4. Status changes to **Locked** — the figures are now fixed.

Recording Loan Expenses (Pre-Lock)

While the loan is in *Recording* status, you can link **expenses** to it — for example, legal fees, bank charges, or disbursement costs that were paid before the loan was active:

1. Open the loan.
2. Click **Add Expense**.
3. Enter amount, date, and a description.
4. These are tracked separately from repayments.

Loan Repayments — Requesting Money Back

> **Who uses this:** Anyone who lent money to the business (a lender) and wants to request a repayment. Also used by loan managers who submit requests on behalf of a lender.

When the business is ready to return funds to the lender, the lender submits a **Withdrawal Request**. This is how money flows back out — it goes through admin approval and then cashier disbursement before funds are released.

Finding the Loan Repayments Screen

1. In the left sidebar, click **Loan Repayments**.
2. A list of loans you are associated with appears.
3. Click on a loan to open it.
4. Select the **Withdrawals** tab to see all requests and the **Request Withdrawal** button.

Withdrawal Request Statuses

Status	What it means
Pending	Submitted and waiting for admin review
Draft	You clicked "Edit Request" — the request is temporarily on hold while you make changes
Approved	Admin approved it; waiting for the cashier to disburse the funds
Paid	Funds have been disbursed to the lender
Denied	The request was declined — by the admin (wrong amount, wrong timing) or by the cashier (insufficient funds)
Rescinded	You cancelled the request before it was approved

> **One withdrawal request per month** per loan. The reference number format is `WR-{LoanNumber}-{YYYYMM}` (e.g. `WR-LN-20260317-001-202605`).

Submitting a Withdrawal Request

1. Open the loan (via **Loan Repayments** in the sidebar).
2. Go to the **Withdrawals** tab.
3. Click **Request Withdrawal**.
4. Enter:
    - **Amount** — how much you are requesting
    - **Notes** — reason or reference (optional)
5. Click **Submit**.

The admin and cashier are automatically notified. Your request appears with status **Pending**.

Editing a Pending Request

If you need to change the amount or notes **before the admin approves it**:

1. Find the request on the Withdrawals tab (status: **Pending**).
2. Click **Edit Request**.
    - The system immediately sets the status to **Draft** — this prevents the admin from approving stale figures while you are editing.
3. Update the amount or notes in the form that appears.
4. Click **Resubmit** to send the updated request back for admin review.
    - Status returns to **Pending** and the admin is notified again.

> If you open the edit form and change your mind, click **Cancel Edit** — the request goes back to Pending without any changes.

Rescinding a Request

To cancel a request you no longer need (while it is still **Pending** or **Draft**):

1. Find the request on the Withdrawals tab.
2. Click **Rescind** and confirm.

The request is permanently cancelled. You can submit a new one if needed.

What Happens After You Submit

The request moves through two stages before funds are released:

Stage 1 — Admin Review (Pending → Approved or Denied)

- The admin sees your request in the **Loans** admin page (amber banner) and in **Pending Actions**.

- Admin either **Approves** (moves to Approved, cashier is notified) or **Denies** with a reason (moves to Denied, you are notified).

Stage 2 — Cashier Disbursement (Approved → Paid or Denied)

- The cashier sees the approved request in **Pending Actions**.
- Cashier either **Marks as Paid** (funds disbursed, you are notified) or **Denies — Insufficient Funds** (moved to Denied, you are notified).

If Your Request Is Denied

You will receive a notification with the denial reason. Your request shows as **Denied** on the Withdrawals tab.

To resubmit:

1. Click **Edit & Resubmit** on the denied request.
2. Adjust the amount or notes if needed.
3. Click **Resubmit** — a fresh **Pending** request is created and the admin is notified again.

Recording Pre-Lock Repayments (Manager/Admin)

> **Note:** This is a manager-only action for recording repayments that happened **before** the loan was locked (e.g. an early part-payment during setup). It is separate from the lender's withdrawal request process described above.

Each repayment reduces the outstanding balance:

1. Open the loan (must be in **Locked** status).
2. Click **Record Repayment**.
3. Enter:
    - **Amount paid**
    - **Date of payment**
    - **Reference** (bank transaction ID, cheque number)
4. Click **Save**.

The outstanding balance updates automatically. When the balance reaches zero, click **Mark as Settled**.

Interest Handling

The system does **not** calculate interest automatically. Interest is recorded manually:

- Add an interest payment as a **Repayment** with a note indicating it is interest.
- Or record it as a separate **Expense** line on the loan.

Part B — Outgoing Employee Loans (The Business Lends)

This tracks money the business has advanced to an employee, contractor, or another person — salary advances, personal loans, emergency funds.

Employee Loan Statuses

Status	Meaning
Pending Approval	Loan application submitted, awaiting manager sign-off
Pending Contract	Approved; waiting for signed loan agreement
Active	Loan is disbursed and repayments are being tracked
Paid Off	All repayments completed; loan is closed
Written Off	Debt forgiven or uncollectable; closed with no further deductions

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Creating an Employee Loan

1. Go to **Finance** → **Employee Loans** (or **Loans** → **Outgoing**).
2. Click **New Loan**.
3. Fill in:
    - **Recipient** — select the employee or person
    - **Loan amount**
    - **Purpose** — reason for the advance
    - **Repayment type** — see table below
    - **Repayment amount** — monthly instalment
    - **Start date**
4. Click **Save** — loan enters **Pending Approval**.

Repayment Types

Type	How it works
Payroll Deduction	The repayment instalment is automatically deducted from the employee's salary each payroll period. No manual action needed — it appears as a line in the payroll entry.
Manual	The employee pays back cash or bank transfer. Manager records each repayment manually.

> **Payroll Deduction** is the preferred method for employee loans — it prevents missed payments and keeps everything in one place.

Approving and Activating a Loan

1. Manager opens the loan and reviews the details.
2. Clicks **Approve** — status moves to **Pending Contract**.
3. Print or prepare a loan agreement document.

4. Once the signed agreement is received, click **Activate Loan** — status moves to **Active**.
5. Disburse the funds (cash or bank transfer) and note the disbursement date.

Payroll Deduction (Automatic)

If repayment type is **Payroll Deduction**:

- Each payroll period, the system automatically includes the instalment as a deduction on the employee's payroll entry.
- It appears in the entry detail modal as a line: *Loan Repayment — [Loan Ref]*.
- The outstanding loan balance decreases after each payroll export.
- When the balance reaches zero, the loan is automatically marked **Paid Off**.

No manual recording is needed for payroll-deduction loans.

Manual Repayments

If type is **Manual**:

1. Employee brings the repayment (cash / transfer).
2. Go to the loan record.
3. Click **Record Repayment**.
4. Enter amount, date, and payment reference.
5. Click **Save**.

Repeat each month until fully paid. Click **Mark Paid Off** when balance is zero.

Writing Off a Loan

If the loan is uncollectable (employee left, debt forgiven):

1. Open the loan.
2. Click **Write Off**.
3. Enter the reason.
4. Confirm — status changes to **Written Off**. No further deductions occur.

Viewing All Loans

Go to **Finance** → **Loans** to see both business loans and employee loans in one list. Filter by:

- Loan type (Business / Outgoing)
- Status
- Employee name
- Date range

Each row shows: loan reference number, recipient/lender, principal, amount repaid, outstanding balance, and status.

9. Customers, Loyalty Cards & Campaigns

> **Who reads this:** POS cashiers, managers, and anyone who deals with customer accounts.

Customer Numbers

Every customer gets a unique number generated automatically when they are registered. The format is:

```
{BUSINESS_TYPE}-CUST-{SEQUENCE}

Examples:
  Restaurant:  RES-CUST-000001
  Grocery:     GRO-CUST-000023
  Clothing:    CLO-CUST-000007
  Hardware:    HAR-CUST-000015
```

This number is the barcode value on the customer's loyalty card. It is permanent — it does not change even if the customer's name or phone number is updated.

Adding a New Customer

From the Customers module:

1. Go to **Customers** in the menu.
2. Click **Add Customer**.
3. Fill in:
   - **Full name** *(required)*
   - **Phone number** *(required)*
   - Email, address, date of birth, national ID *(all optional)*
4. Click **Save**.

From the POS (inline, without leaving the till): See Step 3 in the POS section — type a name, click **+ Add New Customer**, enter name and phone.

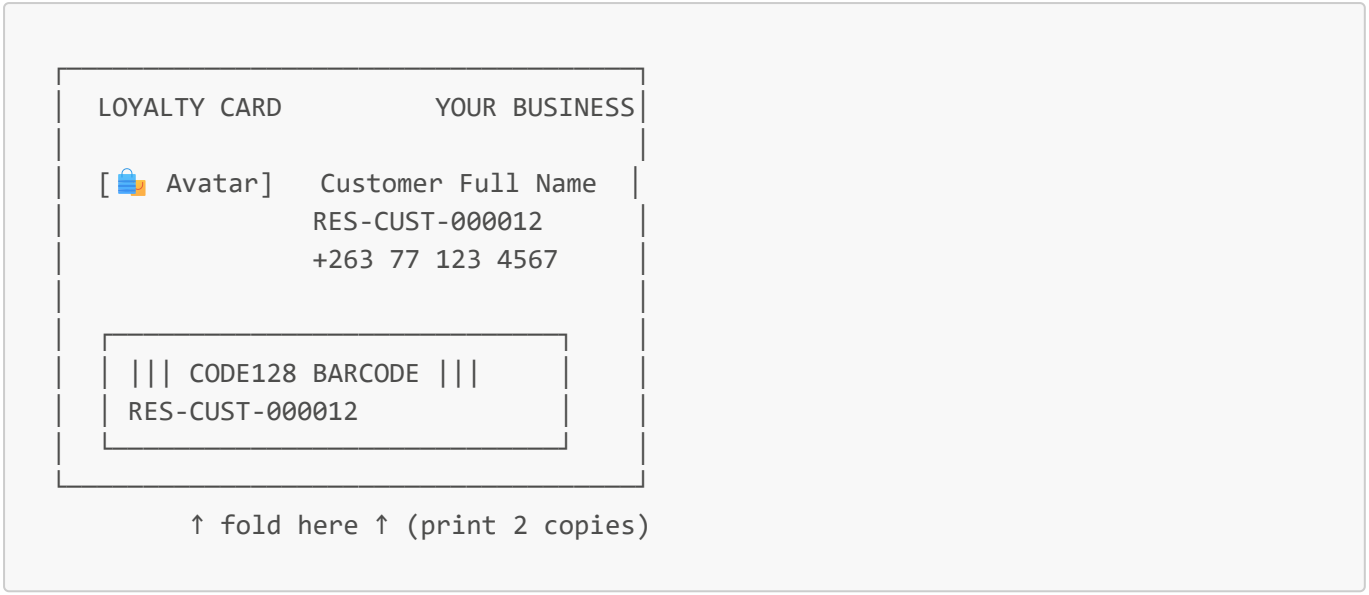
Printing a Customer Loyalty Card

Every customer should be given a loyalty card so that future visits can be scanned in seconds rather than searching by name.

How to print:

1. Open the customer's profile (or the card prints automatically after inline POS registration).
2. Click **Print Loyalty Card**.
3. The print window opens — the card is laid out **twice side by side on one sheet** for a fold-in-half design.

What is on the card:



4. Print on plain paper, fold in half, trim, and laminate (optional).
5. Hand the card to the customer.

When the customer scans their card at a future visit:

- The cashier scans it with the barcode scanner at any point.
- The customer is instantly pre-selected in the POS — no typing needed.
- Their name appears on the cart. All items added from that point forward are linked to their account.

Viewing a Customer's Purchase History

1. Open the customer's profile.
2. Click the **Purchases** or **History** tab.
3. Every completed sale is shown — date, order number, items, total, and payment method.

Customer Activity Report

For a manager-level view of all customers across the business:

1. Go to **Customers** → **Activity Report** (or **Reports** → **Customer Activity**).
2. Choose a time period: Last 30 days, 90 days, 12 months, or All time.
3. Sort by: Total Spend, Order Count, Most Recent Visit, or Average Order Value.

Each customer row shows:

- Total spend in the period
- Number of visits
- Average order value
- Last visit date
- Status indicator:
  - 🟢 **Active** — visited within the last 30 days
  - 🟡 **At Risk** — last visit 30–90 days ago
  - 🔴 **Lapsed** — no visit in over 90 days

Use the report to:

- Identify your top-spending customers for VIP treatment
- Find at-risk customers who may need a promotion to return
- Measure the impact of campaigns on repeat visit rates

Loyalty Campaigns — Setup and Workflow

Campaigns automatically reward customers who spend above a threshold within a month. No manual tracking is needed — the system calculates eligibility and generates reward codes.

Creating a Campaign

1. Go to **Universal** → **Promotions** (or **Campaigns & Promos**).
2. Click **New Campaign**.
3. Fill in:

Field	What to enter
Campaign name	e.g., "Monthly Loyal Customer Reward"
Description	Optional note about the campaign
Spend threshold	Minimum monthly spend to qualify (e.g., $100)
Reward type	Choose one or more: **Store Credit**, **Free Product**, **Free WiFi Token**
Credit amount	If credit: dollar value (e.g., $5 discount on next purchase)
Free product	If free item: select a product from the menu/inventory
WiFi config	If free WiFi: select which token package to award
Reward valid days	How many days the reward is valid after issuing (default: 30)

4. Click **Save**. The campaign is now active.

> Multiple reward types can be combined — e.g., a customer who spends $150+ gets both a $5 credit AND a free WiFi token.

Generating Rewards (Monthly)

Rewards are not issued automatically in real time. At the end of each month, a manager runs the reward generation:

1. Go to **Universal** → **Promotions** → **Campaigns** tab.
2. Click **Generate Rewards** (runs for the current month).
3. The system:
    - Looks at every customer's completed purchases for the month
    - Compares their total spend against each active campaign's threshold
    - Issues a **reward coupon code** (format: `RWD-xxxxxx`) to every qualifying customer
    - Each reward has an expiry date (current date + reward valid days)

4. A summary shows how many rewards were issued per campaign.

> Rewards are **idempotent** — running the generator twice for the same month will not issue duplicate rewards.

How Customers Redeem a Reward

At the next POS visit:

1. Customer provides their loyalty card (scan or name search) — they are selected in the POS.
2. An **Available Rewards** panel appears on the POS showing any active reward codes:
    - Reward type (credit / free item / WiFi)
    - Amount or item name
    - Expiry date
3. Cashier clicks **Redeem** next to the reward.
4. The discount or free item is applied to the current order automatically.
5. Reward status changes to **Redeemed** — it cannot be used again.

Reward Statuses

Status	Meaning
Issued	Generated, available for redemption
Redeemed	Used at checkout — linked to the order
Expired	Past expiry date without being used
Deactivated	Manually cancelled by a manager

Tracking Rewards

Go to **Universal** → **Promotions** → **Rewards** tab to see every reward ever issued:

- Filter by status (Issued, Redeemed, Expired)
- See which customers earned rewards and which have been used
- Monitor campaign effectiveness — how many rewards issued vs redeemed

---

Coupons (Manual Discount Codes)

Coupons are different from campaign rewards — they are **created manually** by the manager and given to specific customers or used in promotions (printed on flyers, handed out, etc.).

Creating a coupon:

1. Go to **[Business]** → **Coupons** → **New Coupon**.
2. Enter:
    - **Code** — a word or number (e.g., `SUMMER20`, `WELCOME5`)
    - **Discount amount** — fixed dollar amount off the order total
    - **Description** — internal note about what the coupon is for

- **Requires approval** — if ticked, the cashier cannot apply it without manager override

3. Save. The coupon is now active.

At the POS:

1. Click **Add Coupon** in the cart.
2. Type or scan the coupon code.
3. The discount is applied to the order total immediately.

> Coupons can also have a barcode printed on them — the cashier scans the coupon like a product barcode and the discount is applied without any typing.

Layby (Installment Purchases)

A layby allows a customer to reserve items and pay over time. The goods are held until fully paid.

Creating a Layby

1. Go to **Laybys** → **New Layby**.
2. Select the customer.
3. Add the items being laid by and the total price.
4. Set the deposit amount (minimum deposit may be required by policy).
5. Record the deposit payment.
6. Click **Save**.

Print the layby receipt and give the customer their copy.

Recording a Layby Payment

1. Go to **Laybys** and find the customer's layby.
2. Click **Record Payment**.
3. Enter the amount paid and the payment method.
4. Click **Save**.

The system calculates the remaining balance automatically.

Completing a Layby

When the balance reaches $0.00:

1. The layby status changes to **Ready for Collection**.
2. Confirm the customer collects their goods.
3. Click **Mark as Collected**.
4. Print a final receipt.

Refunding or Cancelling a Layby

If a customer wants to cancel:

1. Open the layby.
2. Click **Cancel Layby**.

3. The system will calculate the refund based on your business's refund policy.
4. Process the refund through the till.

---

10. Chicken Run Management

> **Who reads this:** Staff managing a poultry farming operation.

Dashboard Overview

Go to **Chicken Run** in the menu. The dashboard shows:

- **Active batches** — currently growing
- **Batches in culling** — ready to harvest
- **Completed batches** — archived
- **Total birds** — current live inventory count
- **Alerts** — high mortality or low inventory warnings

Starting a New Batch

1. Go to **Chicken Run** → **New Batch**.
2. Enter:
    - Batch number or name
    - Date the chicks arrived
    - Number of chicks placed
    - Breed (if applicable)
    - Supplier
3. Click **Start Batch**.

The batch is now in **GROWING** status.

Daily Logs

Every day (or as required), record:

Feed Log:

1. Go to the batch → **Feed Log** → **Add Entry**.
2. Enter the quantity of feed given and the type.
3. Save.

Mortality Log:

1. Go to the batch → **Mortality Log** → **Add Entry**.
2. Enter the number of birds that died today.
3. Select the probable cause.
4. Save.

> **Alert:** If mortality rises above 5% of the batch (or the threshold set in Settings), a warning will appear on the dashboard. Inform management immediately.

Weight Log:

1. Go to the batch → **Weight Log** → **Add Entry**.
2. Enter a sample size (number of birds weighed).
3. Enter the total weight of the sample.
4. The system calculates average weight per bird.
5. Save.

Vaccination Log:

1. Go to the batch → **Vaccination Log** → **Add Entry**.
2. Select the vaccine given.
3. Enter the date and number of birds vaccinated.
4. Save.

Moving to Culling

When the birds have reached target weight:

1. Open the batch.
2. Click **Move to Culling**.
3. Confirm the date.

The batch status changes to **CULLING**.

Recording a Harvest (Weigh-In / Processing)

When birds are being processed:

1. Go to **Chicken Run** → **Inventory** → **[Select Batch]**.
2. Click **Record Harvest**.
3. Enter:
    - Number of birds processed
    - Total weight
    - Breakdown (whole birds, cuts, etc.) if applicable
4. Save.

Stock levels in the inventory are updated automatically.

Completing a Batch

After all birds are processed:

1. Open the batch.
2. Click **Complete Batch**.
3. The system will show a final summary: starting count, mortality, total weight, feed used, and estimated profitability.
4. Review and confirm.

The batch is archived in **COMPLETED** status.

Reports

Go to **Chicken Run** → **Reports** for:

- **Batch Comparison** — side-by-side performance of different batches
- **Mortality Analysis** — death rates by cause and by time period
- **Profitability** — revenue vs. cost per batch
- **Kitchen Usage** — how much processed stock was used internally vs. sold

Vaccination Schedules

Maintain standard vaccination schedules:

1. Go to **Chicken Run** → **Vaccination Schedules**.
2. Click **New Schedule**.
3. Enter the vaccine name, recommended age (in days), and notes.
4. Save.

The system will remind you when upcoming vaccinations are due for active batches.

---

11. Construction & Projects

> **Who reads this:** Project managers, site supervisors, and contractors.

Viewing Your Projects

Go to **Construction** (or **Projects** if you use the cross-business module). You will see all active projects listed with:

- Project name
- Client
- Budget
- Spent to date
- Remaining budget
- Status

Creating a New Project

1. Click **New Project**.
2. Enter:
    - Project name
    - Client name
    - Start date and estimated end date
    - Total budget
3. Click **Create**.

Recording Project Expenses

1. Open the project.
2. Go to the **Expenses** tab.

3. Click **Add Expense**.
4. Enter:
    - Description (e.g., "Cement — 50 bags")
    - Supplier name
    - Amount
    - Date purchased
    - Category (Materials, Labour, Equipment, etc.)
5. Attach a receipt photo if available.
6. Click **Save**.

The project's **Spent to Date** updates and the remaining budget recalculates.

Managing Contractors

1. Open the project.
2. Go to the **Contractors** tab.
3. Click **Assign Contractor**.
4. Search for an existing contractor or add a new one.
5. Enter the agreed rate and scope of work.
6. Save.

To record a contractor payment:

1. Find the contractor in the project.
2. Click **Record Payment**.
3. Enter the amount and date.
4. Save.

Supplier Management

Go to **Construction** → **Suppliers** to maintain a list of your material suppliers with their contact details and payment terms.

Linking Expense Account Payments to a Project

Expense account payments (recorded through Quick Payment or Edit Payment) can be linked to a project. There are three ways to do this:

1 — At the time of payment (Quick Payment / Edit Payment)

When making or editing a payment, a **Link to Project** dropdown appears if the business has active projects. Select the project before submitting. The payment will appear in the project's Expense Payments tab immediately.

2 — From the payment list (assign after the fact)

Every payment row in the transaction history has a 📁 icon on the right side:

- If no project is linked: a faint 📁 icon appears — click it to open an inline dropdown and select a project.
- If a project is already linked: a coloured 📁 **ProjectName** badge is shown — click it to change or remove the project.

3 — From the project page (assign existing payments)

1. Open the project from the **Projects** list.
2. Go to the **Expense Payments** tab.
3. Click **+ Assign Payment**.
4. A search modal opens showing unlinked payments from the business's expense accounts.
5. Type to filter by payee name, notes, or category.
6. Click **Link** on any payment to associate it with this project.

The payment appears in the Expense Payments list immediately and the project's financial totals update.

Expense Payments Tab — Project Payment Report

The **Expense Payments** tab on a project detail page shows all expense account payments that have been linked to this project:

Column	What it shows
Payee	Name of the person, employee, supplier, or business paid
Category	Expense category with emoji
Notes	Payment notes or reference
Date · Account · Channel	When it was paid, from which account, and how (cash/EcoCash)
Amount	Payment amount
Status	PAID / SUBMITTED badge

The total of all linked payments is shown at the top of the tab and is also included in the project's **Financial Summary** tab under *Expense Payments*.

---

12. Driver & Vehicle Log

> **Who reads this:** Drivers responsible for logging their trips and vehicle maintenance.

Logging a Trip

1. Go to **Driver** → **Trips**.
2. Click **New Trip**.
3. Enter:
    - Date
    - Starting location
    - Destination

- Purpose of trip (e.g., "Delivery to client", "Pick up supplies")
- Starting odometer reading
- Ending odometer reading

4. Click **Save Trip**.

The mileage is calculated automatically from the odometer readings.

Logging Vehicle Maintenance

1. Go to **Driver** → **Maintenance**.
2. Click **New Maintenance Record**.
3. Enter:
   - Date of service
   - Type of service (Oil change, Tyre rotation, Repair, etc.)
   - Description of work done
   - Workshop/garage name
   - Cost
   - Next service due (if known)
4. Click **Save**.

Viewing Your Trip History

Go to **Driver** → **Trips** to see all logged trips. You can filter by date range or vehicle.

---

13. WiFi Token Sales — ESP32 and R710

> **Who reads this:** Staff selling WiFi access, managers configuring WiFi packages, and anyone setting up the integration.

Two WiFi Systems — Understanding the Difference

The system supports two separate WiFi hardware integrations. They work differently and are not interchangeable.

	ESP32 (Captive Portal)	**R710 (Ruckus Access Point)**
Hardware	ESP32 microcontroller with captive portal	Ruckus R710 or compatible access point
How it works	Customer connects to WiFi → browser redirects to captive portal → enters token code	Customer gets a username and password → enters credentials on the WiFi login page
Token format	Single **token code** (e.g., `AB12CD`) printed on receipt	**Username + Password** pair printed on receipt
Tokens generated	On-demand at sale time	Pre-generated as AVAILABLE → marked SOLD at checkout

	ESP32 (Captive Portal)	R710 (Ruckus Access Point)
Duration control	Token code controls time limit on the ESP32 device	Duration set by the token package (1hr, 24hr, weekly, etc.)
Best for	Simpler setups, guest WiFi with captive portal redirect	Business-grade Ruckus deployments
Portal	Configured via **ESP32 Integration settings**	Managed via **R710 Portal**

> Most businesses will use **only one** of these systems, not both. Check with your system administrator which type your hardware is.

R710 System — Full Guide

Which Businesses Can Sell R710 WiFi

R710 WiFi token sales are available to these business types: **restaurant, grocery, clothing, hardware, services,** and **vehicle service**. Every other business type does not show WiFi options at all — this is by design, not a bug or something to request a workaround for.

Making Packages Available for Sale — Menu Config

Owning a WiFi package (a "1 Hour", "Daily Pass", etc.) and having it actually appear for sale at a business are two separate steps:

1. **The package itself** — created directly, or **cloned** from another business's package list (System Admin → R710 Portal → Token Management → Clone). Cloning creates a fully independent copy owned by the target business — it does not stay linked to the original.
2. **Turning it on for sale** — go to **R710 Menu Config** in the sidebar (under the business's WiFi section). Every package the business owns is listed with an on/off toggle and an editable price. A package is only visible on the POS or the **R710 Portal** → **Sales** page once it's toggled **on** here.

> **This is the most common setup mistake:** cloning a package makes it exist for the new business, but it does **not** automatically make it sellable. If a freshly cloned package doesn't show up anywhere, check **R710 Menu Config** first — it's almost always just sitting there switched off.

How R710 Tokens Are Created

Tokens are **pre-generated** before any sale happens. A pool of AVAILABLE tokens is maintained per package. When a sale occurs at the POS, the next AVAILABLE token is marked as SOLD and printed on the receipt.

This means:

- There is no delay at checkout — the token is assigned instantly.
- The pool must be topped up before it runs out.
- The POS product card shows the current available count.

Selling an R710 Token at the POS

1. Open the POS.
2. Search for the WiFi package by name (e.g., "1 Hour WiFi", "Daily Pass", "Weekly Pass").
3. The product card shows **"X available"** — confirming tokens are in stock.
4. Add it to the cart.
5. Process payment as normal.
6. After payment, the **receipt automatically includes the WiFi credentials**:

```
──────────────────────────
      📶 WiFi Access
──────────────────────────
  Package:   Daily Pass
  Username:  guest_4829
  Password:  Kx7mP2qR
──────────────────────────
  Connect to: BusinessGuest
  Valid for:  24 hours
──────────────────────────
```

7. Hand the receipt to the customer. These are their login credentials — they connect to the WiFi network and enter the username and password when prompted.

> **Each token is single-use.** Once issued on a receipt, it cannot be reused or given to another customer.

Before you print — the **Order Complete** confirmation that appears immediately after checkout (Universal POS, Restaurant POS, and Grocery POS) shows the same WiFi/R710 credentials on screen, each section with its own 📋 **Copy** button. If the sale included more than one token, Copy grabs all of them at once, comma-separated — useful for pasting into a chat/SMS to the customer, or as a fallback if the printer is unavailable. A brief "✅ Copied" confirmation fades in next to the button that was clicked.

Copy Full Receipt — right below **Print Receipt** on that same confirmation, this copies the *entire* receipt as plain text: business header, every line item, totals, payment details, and any WiFi/R710 tokens — the same information that prints, just without the printer's raw formatting codes, so it pastes cleanly into an email. Useful for emailing a copy to the customer instead of (or in addition to) printing one. Shows the same " ✅ Copied — paste into an email" confirmation as the token Copy buttons.

Checking and Restocking Token Availability

On the POS product card, the available count is displayed. When availability drops below 5:

- A **"Request 5 More"** button appears on the product card. Click it — 5 new tokens are generated in seconds and the count updates.
- If availability actually reaches **zero**, the **Add to Cart** button itself becomes disabled and shows **"Sold Out"** instead — a package with nothing left can't be added to the cart at all, rather than failing later at checkout.

Automatic top-up: separately from the button above, the system checks every package's stock every 10 minutes and tops it up on its own — using each package's own configured threshold and refill quantity (set per package in **R710 Portal** → **Token Management**, defaulting to "top up 20 when below 5") — so in normal

operation a package shouldn't need the manual button at all. It exists for the rare case where a sudden rush of sales empties a package in between those automatic checks.

To generate tokens in larger batches manually:

1. Go to **R710 Portal → Token Management**.
2. Select the package.
3. Click **Generate Tokens** and enter the quantity.

WiFi as Part of a Combo (Bundle Deal)

WiFi tokens can be included as part of a combo order — for example, a "Meal + WiFi" bundle where buying a meal includes a 1-hour WiFi token automatically.

When the cashier adds the combo to the cart:

- The food items appear as normal cart lines.
- The WiFi token line is added automatically (marked with a 📶 icon).
- At payment, the receipt shows both the food items AND the WiFi credentials in the same receipt.

Example receipt with combo:

```
──────────────────────────
  Meal Deal + WiFi
  Chicken & Chips        $5.00
  Coke 500ml             $0.50
  1hr WiFi Token         $0.00  (included)
  ──────────────────────────
  TOTAL                  $5.50
──────────────────────────
       📶 WiFi Access
──────────────────────────
  Username:  guest_4831
  Password:  Lm9nQ4wS
  Valid for: 1 hour
──────────────────────────
```

WiFi as a Loyalty Campaign Reward

Customers who reach a spend threshold can earn a free WiFi token as their reward (see Campaigns section in Section 9). When the cashier redeems the reward at checkout:

- The WiFi token is added to the order at $0.00.
- The receipt includes the credentials exactly as a normal purchase would.
- The reward is marked as Redeemed.

Direct Token Sale — R710 Portal Sales Page

The **R710 Portal → Sales** page is a dedicated selling interface for R710 tokens, separate from the main POS. It supports selling **multiple packages in one transaction** using a cart.

How to make a direct sale:

1. Go to **R710 Portal** → **Sales**.
2. Browse the package cards (sorted shortest to longest duration).
3. Click **+ Add to Cart** on each package you want to sell. You can add the same package type multiple times using the **−** / **+** quantity controls that appear once it is in the cart.
4. In the **Cart panel** on the right, review line items:
   - Adjust the quantity of any line using the **−** and **+** buttons.
   - Edit the **price per unit** directly in the price field if a different rate applies.
   - The line total and grand total update in real time.
5. Select a **Payment Method** (Cash / Card / Mobile Money / EcoCash). For $0 total (free tokens), no payment method is required.
6. Click **Proceed to Payment**.
7. In the confirmation modal:
   - Review the line-item breakdown and total.
   - For **Cash** payments, enter the **amount received** — the change is calculated automatically.
   - For **EcoCash** payments, the fee and customer-pays total are shown. Enter the **EcoCash transaction code** (optional but recommended for records).
   - Click **Complete Sale**.
8. The system generates one token per unit sequentially, showing progress ("Generating token 2 of 5…").
9. When complete, all issued credentials appear in a result panel:

```
✅ 3 tokens sold!
──────────────────────────────────────────────
  Package       Username            Password
  2 Week Pass   DS-260516-F9B       GXHUM-AAAFW
  8 Hour Pass   DS-260516-619       TEILB-OQSTE
  2 Hour Pass   DS-260516-3CC       WADIO-DSNBK
──────────────────────────────────────────────
```

10. Click 📋 **Copy** to copy the credentials as plain text (shows ✅ **Copied** briefly), 👁️ **Preview** to review before printing, or 🖨️ **Print** to print all credentials on a single receipt.

> **Tip:** The cart is cleared after a successful sale. To sell another batch, simply add packages to the cart again — no page refresh needed.

R710 Wi-Fi Quick Sell — From Any Page

For businesses that sell R710 tokens often, a 📶 **R710 Wi-Fi** button sits in the sidebar right under **Current Business**, on every page — not just the Sales page. Clicking it opens the exact same sell → checkout → generated-tokens workflow described above, but as a **pop-up window over whatever page you're already on**, instead of navigating away.

- Whatever you were doing on the underlying page — a form half-filled-in, a report you had open — is untouched. Closing the window (✕ in its top-right corner) just removes it; you're back exactly where you were.

- This workflow keeps its own cart, completely separate from the business's main shopping cart — selling a WiFi token this way never adds to, clears, or otherwise affects whatever is in the main cart (or vice versa).
- Only shown to users who can sell R710 tokens (`canSellWifiTokens`), for a business with R710 selling already set up and at least one package enabled in its menu.
- The full-page **R710 Portal → Sales** screen (and its Sales History panel below the cart) still works exactly as before — this button is an additional shortcut, not a replacement.

Sales History & Reprinting

If a receipt is missed or the window is closed before printing, credentials are **never lost** — every token sale is saved to the database and retrievable from the **Sales History** panel at the bottom of the Sales page.

How to find and reprint a sale:

1. Scroll to the bottom of **R710 Portal → Sales** and click **▼ show** on the 🕐 **Sales History** panel.
2. Use the **date range pills** to narrow the window:

Pill	What it shows
All time	Every direct sale ever made
Today	Current calendar day (default)
Yesterday	Previous calendar day
Last 7 / 30 / 90 Days	Rolling window
Custom Range	Enter From / To dates manually
Specific Date	Pick a single date

3. Type in the **search box** to filter by package name, username, password, network name, or payment method.
4. Each row shows: package, date/time, payment method, amount, username, password, network, and who made the sale.
5. Click 🖨️ **Reprint** on the row — the receipt preview opens so you can select a printer and confirm.

> The panel auto-expands and refreshes immediately after each new checkout, so the most recently issued tokens always appear at the top of the list.

Viewing Sales History

Go to **R710 Portal → Sales History** to see:

- All tokens sold (date, package, username/password)
- Whether each token has been used or is still unused
- Which tokens were sold via POS vs direct sale

Admin-Issued Long-Term Tokens (Workstation Access)

Who reads this: System administrators and business owners.

Normal WiFi tokens are meant for customers and expire in hours or days. For **workstations that need to stay connected long-term** (a till, an office PC, a back-office printer), sharing the guest network's admin password with everyone who sets one up is a security risk. Instead, an admin can issue a **long-term, zero-fee token** as that workstation's own login, without ever exposing the AP password itself.

> **The real ceiling is 1 year, not longer.** The R710 device's guest-pass validity tops out at **365 days** — this is a hard limit of the router itself, not a setting this app can raise. There is no way to issue a token that genuinely lasts 5 years; the most a workstation credential can be valid for is 1 year, after which it needs to be reissued.

What actually controls the expiry — two settings, not one:

1. The **package's own Duration** (set when creating/editing the package).
2. The **WLAN's "Token Validity (Days)"** setting (**R710 Portal → WLANs → [that WLAN]**) — this is a per-WLAN ceiling that applies to *every* token issued on it, admin-issued or not. If this is set lower than the package's Duration (e.g. it's still at its default of a few days), **the WLAN setting wins** — the device silently clamps the token to whatever the WLAN allows, regardless of what the package says. Always check this setting is raised (up to 365) before issuing a long-term token, or the token will expire far sooner than expected.

Setting up a long-term package (one time, System Admin):

1. Go to **R710 Portal → Token Configurations → Create** (or edit an existing package).
2. Set the **Duration** to whatever length is needed, up to **52 weeks (1 year)**.
3. Set **Base Price** to **$0.00**.
4. Check **Admin-issued (long-term, zero-fee)**. This is the setting that makes everything below work — it hides the package from the regular POS and Direct Sale screens entirely, and restricts who can hand one out.
5. Save.
6. Separately, confirm the WLAN's **Token Validity (Days)** (see above) is set to **365** — otherwise the token will still expire early no matter what Duration was entered on the package.

> A package flagged this way can never be added to a cart or sold like a normal WiFi package, even at $0 — this isn't optional per-cashier behavior, it's enforced by the system regardless of who's logged in.

Finding an admin-issued package later: on **R710 Portal → Token Configurations**, packages flagged this way carry a 🔐 **Admin-Issued** badge in the top corner of their card, so they don't get lost among the regular packages in the list (they tend to sort toward the end, since they usually have the longest duration).

Issuing a token to a workstation:

1. Go to that business's **R710 Menu Config** page (same place packages are normally toggled on/off for sale).
2. If the business owns any admin-issued packages, a 🔐 **Issue Long-Term Access** panel appears at the top — but only if you're logged in as a System Admin or that business's owner. Anyone else won't see this panel at all, even though they can see the rest of the page.
3. Click **Issue "[package name]"** for the package you want.

4. The credentials (network name, username, password, expiry date) appear on screen once, with a 📋 **Copy** button. Enter these directly into the workstation's WiFi settings.

> **Need to change the package itself** (duration, price, description)? Click 🖍️ **Edit Package** right next to the Issue button in this same panel — it jumps straight to that package's settings in R710 Portal → Token Configurations. This link only appears for System Admins, since editing any package (admin-issued or not) has always been a System Admin-only action in this app. Editing the package only affects *future* tokens issued from it — an already-issued token's credentials and expiry are fixed on the device and can't be changed after the fact (see Revoking below).

> Credentials are shown only once at issuance time — there's no receipt printed and no customer-facing step, since this isn't a sale. If you need to see them again later, they're not retrievable in plaintext after this point (same as any other WiFi token) — you'd need to revoke and re-issue.

Revoking a workstation's access: use the normal **Invalidate** action on the token (from **R710 Portal → Tokens**, same as invalidating any WiFi token). For a long-term token this does more than just mark it unusable in this system:

- If the workstation is **currently connected**, the router itself blocks that device's MAC address immediately — the workstation is disconnected right away, not just left to expire on its own.
- If the token was **issued but never actually connected yet**, only the system-side record is invalidated. The credentials could theoretically still work directly against the router until first use — if that matters (e.g. a workstation was decommissioned before ever being set up), treat the physical device as compromised until confirmed otherwise, since a device-side block only kicks in once there's a connection to block.

Checking what's been issued: click 📊 **View Admin-Issued Tokens Report** on the same Issue Long-Term Access panel (or go to **[business]/r710-tokens/admin-issued** directly). Every admin-issued token for that business is listed with a status:

Status	Meaning
Not Yet Redeemed	Issued, but the workstation hasn't connected with it yet
Used	Has connected at least once (shows the current device's MAC if connected right now)
Expired	Past its validity period
Revoked	Manually invalidated

Summary counts for each status appear at the top of the report, so a quick glance shows whether, say, three "issued" workstations are all actually in use or one was never set up.

Device Registry — Admin Setup & Fixing a Mixed-Up IP Address

Who reads this: System administrators managing the physical R710 access points.

Each physical R710 router is registered once in a global **Device Registry**, then linked to one or more businesses. Getting a device's IP address wrong here is the most common cause of "tokens sell fine but customers can't connect" — the token gets created on the wrong physical router.

Registering a new device:

1. Go to **R710 Portal** → **Devices** → **Register Device**.
2. Enter the router's **IP address**, **admin username/password**, and an optional description (e.g. "Main building — Floor 2").
3. Click **Test Connection** — registration is blocked until the test succeeds, confirming the system can actually reach and log into that router.
4. Click **Register Device**.

> **"Failed to register device" / "ENCRYPTION_KEY environment variable is not set"**: this is not something wrong with the router or the form — it means the **application server itself** is missing a one-time setup step. The router's admin password is encrypted before being stored, and the server has no encryption key configured to do that with. This is a server-level fix, not a per-device one — a system administrator with access to the server needs to:
>
> 1. Generate a key: `node -e "console.log(require('crypto').randomBytes(32).toString('hex'))"`
> 2. Add it to the server's `.env` file as `ENCRYPTION_KEY=<the generated value>`.
> 3. Restart the application server so it picks up the new environment variable.
>
> Once set, this never needs to be done again for that server — it's a one-time step per server install, not per device or per business. See `ADMIN-INSTALLATION-GUIDE.md` in the project repository for the full server setup checklist (this key is one of several required environment variables).

Editing a device (e.g. the router's IP changed): open **R710 Portal** → **Devices**, click **Edit** on the device, update the fields, and save. If you change the IP or password, the system re-tests the connection before saving — this protects against typos, but it also means the save is blocked if the router is only temporarily unreachable (network issue, reboot, wrong subnet from the server). If a test-gated save fails and you're confident the value you entered is correct, a **"Save Anyway (Skip Test)"** option appears — use it only when you're sure, since it skips live verification. The device is marked "Disconnected" until the next successful test confirms it.

Fixing two devices whose IP addresses got swapped: If two routers' IP addresses were mixed up (e.g. during setup, one business's IP got assigned to another business's device by mistake), don't try to fix them one at a time — you'll hit an "IP already registered" error, since the wrong IP is already claimed by the other device. Instead:

1. Go to **R710 Portal** → **Devices**.
2. Click **Swap IP** on either of the two mixed-up devices.
3. Select the other device from the dropdown — a preview shows exactly what each device's IP will become after the swap.
4. Confirm. Both devices' IP addresses are exchanged in one step, and any cached connections to the old addresses are cleared automatically.
5. Click **Test** on both devices afterward to confirm each one now connects correctly.

> The devices list also shows which businesses each device is actually serving underneath the business count — worth a glance after any setup change, since a device serving the wrong business's WLAN is

> usually visible at a glance once you can see the names.

Remote Sites — R710 via Local Agent

Who reads this: System administrators setting up an R710 device at a branch or site that is not on the same local network as the application server (connected only via Tailscale or a similar VPN).

Normally the application server talks to an R710 device directly over the local network. A device at a remote site can't be reached that way — instead, a small **local agent** program runs on a workstation at that site (on the same network as the R710) and relays requests between the app and the device. This works the same way local receipt printers do: the agent runs quietly in the system tray, and once paired, everything else works exactly like a normal R710 device — selling tokens, generating stock, admin management — with no extra steps for staff.

Registering a remote device:

1. Go to **R710 Portal** → **Devices** → **Register Device**.
2. Under **Connection Mode**, choose **Remote Agent** instead of Direct.

   > Selecting Remote Agent skips the "Test Connection" requirement — the app server genuinely cannot reach a remote device directly, so there is nothing to test yet. Connectivity is verified later, from the Agent panel, once a workstation is paired.

3. Enter the device's **IP address** (as it appears on the remote site's own network) and **admin username/password**, plus an optional description.
4. Click **Register Device**. You're taken straight to the new device's **Agent** panel to pair a workstation.

> If you accidentally try to test-connect to a device that's actually remote, the failure message includes a **"switch to Remote Agent mode"** link that flips the form over for you — no need to start again.

Before you install, on a workstation that's never run the agent before: install the **Microsoft Visual C++ Redistributable (x64)** — https://aka.ms/vs/17/release/vc_redist.x64.exe. The agent needs it to talk to a scale; most Windows PCs already have it from other software, but a fresh/newly-imaged machine often doesn't, and a missing copy has been known to freeze the agent (occasionally the whole machine) the very first time it's run.

Installing the local agent (one time, on a workstation at the remote site):

1. From the device's **Agent** panel (**R710 Portal** → **Devices** → **Agent** button, or via the link shown right after registering), click **Download r710-agent.zip**.
2. Copy the zip to the workstation at the remote site — the one that's on the same local network as the R710 and stays logged in.
3. Unzip it and double-click **r710-agent.exe**. No installer, no Node.js, nothing else to set up beyond the Visual C++ Redistributable above — it's a single self-contained program. A tray icon appears showing it's running and waiting to be paired. Right-click it any time to see every server this workstation is currently paired to (each its own line, with its own status), plus **Preferences**, **Restart**, and **Quit**.
4. Set it to start automatically so it survives reboots: right-click the tray icon → **Preferences** → **Start with Windows**. This flips a per-user Windows setting (no administrator elevation needed to toggle it later)

— no shortcuts or Startup folder to manage by hand. The same toggle is also available from the **Manage Profiles** page (see below) and, once paired, from that device's Agent panel in the browser.

> **If the agent seems stuck** (e.g. it won't start, or the tray icon is missing but you suspect it's still running) — run `Stop R710 Agent.bat`, included in the same unzipped folder, then double-click `r710-agent.exe` again. This forcibly closes any running copy without needing Task Manager.
>
> **If it freezes the whole machine on that very first run** — this has been seen when the Visual C++ Redistributable above is missing, or from antivirus scanning the freshly downloaded, unsigned `.exe` heavily on a resource-constrained machine (wait it out, or add an antivirus exclusion for the extracted folder before running). Install the Redistributable and reboot, then try again.

Pairing the workstation to the device:

1. On that same workstation, open the app in a browser and log in as an administrator.
2. Go to the device's **Agent** panel. If you got here right after downloading and running the agent, no need to reload the page — it checks for the local agent automatically every couple of seconds.
3. Once it shows **"Local agent detected and waiting to be paired,"** enter a label for this workstation (e.g. "Front Desk PC — Bulawayo Branch") and click **Pair this machine**.
4. The tray icon switches to 🟢 **Connected**. The Agent panel now shows live status instead of the pairing instructions.

> **Pairing must be done from the workstation itself** — the "Pair this machine" button only works when the agent it's talking to is running on the same computer as the browser. If you open the Agent panel from a different machine (e.g. head office), no Pair button appears, only install instructions — that's expected, not a bug. An administrator can otherwise manage everything else about R710 — registering devices, editing settings, viewing sales — from anywhere they can log into the app.

Using the Agent panel day-to-day:

- **Status**: shows 🟢 Connected / 🔴 Offline, which workstation is paired, its agent version, and when it was last seen — refreshes automatically.
- **Test Connection**: sends a real round-trip request through the agent to the device and reports success or the specific failure.
- **Recent Activity**: a log of every request relayed through the agent — token generation, health checks — with who requested it (or "Background job" for automatic top-ups) and how long it took.
- **Start with Windows**: a toggle that reaches across to the workstation and flips the same auto-start setting as the tray's Preferences menu — since it's one setting for the whole agent, not per pairing, changing it here also updates it for any other server that workstation happens to be paired to, and vice versa.
- **Revoke Pairing**: disconnects the agent immediately for that pairing. The agent running on that workstation notices within a few seconds, automatically clears its old pairing, and goes back to waiting-to-be-paired on its own — there is no need to reinstall or restart anything on the workstation. Use this when a device needs to be re-paired (e.g. its IP address changed) or a workstation is being retired: just open the Agent panel again and click **Pair this machine** once the tray icon is showing "not paired." **Re-pairing never requires downloading the agent again** — the Agent panel detects the already-running agent on that workstation automatically and takes you straight to the label field and the Pair button; the download/install instructions only appear if it genuinely can't find a running agent on that machine.

- **Download r710-agent.zip**: always available next to Test Connection/Revoke Pairing, not just when an update banner is showing — use it to grab the installer again any time (e.g. to re-run the agent on the same workstation after it was closed, or to install it on a different one). Re-downloading doesn't disturb an existing pairing.

If the agent goes offline: everything that would normally happen automatically for this device — selling a token at POS, background stock top-ups — will fail with a clear **"Remote Wi-Fi device unavailable — the local agent is offline, contact IT"** message instead of a generic error, so staff and support can tell immediately that it's the agent (not the R710 itself, and not a wrong password) that needs attention. Check the tray icon on the paired workstation first — if it's not running, restart it; if it shows 🔴, the workstation likely lost its network connection to the app server.

If the agent connects but immediately drops, over and over ("websocket error" repeating in its console/log window): this almost always means the server is running HTTPS with a certificate the *browser* accepted but the *agent* can't validate — a browser lets a person manually click through an untrusted-certificate warning, but the agent (which isn't a browser) can't do that, so its connection just keeps failing silently with a generic error, even though pairing itself appeared to succeed.

There are two known specific causes, both fixed the same way (regenerate on the server, then re-pair) but diagnosed slightly differently. Both are covered in full technical detail, with exact commands, in the **Server-side certificates** section of `docs/TECHNICAL-DEPLOYMENT-GUIDE.md` — this is the quick summary:

- **The certificate covers the wrong address.** The server's certificate was generated for a different IP address/hostname than the one it's actually being reached at now (e.g. the server moved to a new IP, or got a second one added). Check the file names in that server's `certs/` folder against the address the workstation is actually connecting to (visible in `serverUrl` for that pairing, or simply the URL you typed in when pairing).
- **The certificate's "root" file doesn't actually match what the server is serving.** This one is subtler and has actually been hit in practice: regenerating a certificate with `mkcert` only creates a new certificate + key file in whatever folder you run it from — it does **not** automatically update the separate "root" trust file (`rootCA.pem`) that goes alongside it, especially if the certificate was regenerated from a different computer than the one used originally. If that happens, the server ends up handing out a root file that doesn't actually match its own certificate, and every local agent that pairs against it fails this exact way, no matter how many times it's re-paired — until an admin fixes the underlying files on the server itself.

To fix, on the **application server** (not the workstation), follow the exact `mkcert`/`openssl` verification and repair commands in the Technical Deployment Guide's certificate section, then:

1. Restart the server so it picks up the corrected certificate files.
2. **Revoke that pairing and re-pair it** — this is the step that's easy to miss. Just restarting the agent is not enough: the bad or missing certificate is already saved in the agent's own pairing file, and only a fresh pairing hands it a corrected one. Re-pairing does not require downloading the agent again (see the Revoke Pairing note above).

Updating the agent to a newer version: the Agent panel automatically compares the connected workstation's reported version against the latest one available and shows an ⚠️ **Update available** banner when they differ, with a direct download link. To update:

1. Click the **Download the latest r710-agent.zip** link in the banner (same link as the original install).
2. On the workstation, run `Stop R710 Agent.bat` from the old unzipped folder (or right-click the tray icon → **Quit**).
3. Unzip the new download and double-click the new `r710-agent.exe`.

The pairing survives an update automatically — there is no need to re-pair or re-register the device's IP address. The agent's pairing (which server, which device, its login token) is stored in a fixed location on the workstation itself, completely separate from the `.exe` file — replacing the program and starting the new one just picks the existing pairing back up. Skipping an update isn't dangerous, but any fix shipped in a newer version — including bug fixes for token generation — only takes effect once the new `.exe` is actually running in place of the old one.

> **Why this matters more than a typical "update available" nag (MBM-281):** an outdated agent doesn't usually show as broken — its basic connection still works, since new server-side additions are built to not break old agents outright. What silently doesn't work is anything *new* the old agent build was never taught — for example, an agent from before MBM-279 has no `/activate` endpoint at all, so a business switch that should reconfigure this workstation's active printer/scale just quietly does nothing on that machine, with no error shown anywhere, until a print or scale action fails later for reasons that look unrelated. Treat this banner (wherever it appears — see below) as something to act on promptly, not a routine nag.
>
> **The same banner now also appears on the Workstation Agents page** (Section 13's Scale/Printer pairing) — both share the exact same underlying agent build, so a stale one shows up wherever it's paired, R710 or Workstation. That page additionally shows a page-top summary if *any* of a business's paired workstations are outdated, not just a per-row note.
>
> **One caveat if a workstation is paired to more than one server (below) at different versions (MBM-284):** the comparison is per-server, against *that specific server's* currently-built agent version, not a global minimum-version check — so a workstation can show "up to date" against one paired server while showing a warning against another. Which warning it shows is direction-aware:
>
> - **"Agent update required"** (red) — this workstation's agent is *older* than that server expects. Download and run the new `.exe` there, same as above.
> - **"This server is behind the agent build these workstations are running"** (amber) — the opposite: this workstation's agent is *newer* than that particular server expects, which is normal after pairing to (or switching to) a different, less-recently-updated server. There is nothing to download or reinstall on the workstation for this one — a newer agent stays backward compatible with an older server for basic operation, but a feature added since that server's expected version may not work against it until **that server's own agent bundle is redeployed**. Never "fix" this by downgrading the workstation's agent to match.

One agent, many servers at once (MBM-276): the same `r710-agent.exe` can be paired to more than one application server from the same workstation — for example, a technician's laptop used to test devices against both a staging server and production, or a workstation that happens to sit on the network for two unrelated sites. Each server gets its own completely isolated **profile** on disk (its own credentials, its own connection, its own device registrations); pairing to a second server never touches or overwrites the first one's pairing, and both stay connected simultaneously — there is no "switch active server" step. Right-click the tray icon to see every paired profile listed by the label you gave it when pairing, each with its own live status.

> **Upgrading from an older agent:** if this workstation was already paired under a previous version of the agent, the very first launch of the new `r710-agent.exe` automatically converts that existing pairing into a profile — nothing needs to be re-paired, and no action is required.

The Manage Profiles page: open **http://127.0.0.1:47710** in a browser on the workstation itself (not from a remote machine) to see the same information as the tray, laid out as a page — every paired server with its live R710/Printer status (including device IP, business, configured printer(s), the QZ Tray printer on this machine if set, and configured scale port), the scale's current owner (see below) with a **Release** button, the **Start with Windows** toggle, a manual **Unpair** button per profile (removes that profile's saved credentials from this machine — re-pair from that server's Agent panel to reconnect), and a **Restart Agent** button.

The Same Agent Now Also Relays a Scale and a Printer (MBM-275)

Who reads this: System administrators and business owners setting up a workstation whose MG-S8200 scale or receipt printer is not physically attached to the machine running the application server.

The `r710-agent.exe` downloaded above is not R710-only — the exact same program, the exact same download, can independently carry **two separate pairings** at once:

- The **R710 pairing** described above (per-device, from a device's own Agent panel).
- A **Workstation pairing**, which relays that workstation's MG-S8200 scale and/or its locally-installed receipt printer back to the app, the same way the R710 pairing relays a WiFi device.

A workstation only needs one download and one running `r710-agent.exe` no matter how many of R710 / Scale / Printer it ends up covering — pair it for whichever it has attached. A workstation with only a scale never touches the R710 pairing at all, and vice versa.

Pairing a workstation for Scale and/or Printer:

One pairing covers both capabilities — you never pair separately for the scale and the printer. Pair the workstation once; whether you then use it for the scale, a printer, or both just depends on which setup steps you follow afterward.

1. Go to **Settings** → **POS Settings** → ⚖️ **Scale & Weighing**, then follow the **"Workstation Agents"** link near the bottom of the Scale Hardware section (or go directly to `/admin/workstation-agents` for the current business).

2. With the local agent already downloaded and running on the target workstation — this page has its own **Download r710-agent.zip** link right in the pairing card (same file, same install steps as R710's) — open this page **from that workstation** and click **Pair this machine**, giving it a label like "Front Desk PC — Bulawayo Branch".

   > **If this exact workstation is already paired to this server for R710** (Section 13's "Remote Sites" pairing — same download, same agent), this page recognizes that automatically: instead of the plain "waiting to be paired" message, it shows **"✅ This machine is already connected to this server as '<label>' (R710). Add the printer/scale to that same connection below,"** and the label field is pre-filled with that same name so you don't have to invent a new one for what's obviously the same machine. Still editable if you want a different display name here specifically. You're not reusing the R710 pairing itself — a printer/scale pairing is a genuinely

> separate record tied to this business — but you no longer have to re-verify or relabel a machine the system already knows is live.

3. Once paired, the page shows two setup cards, one for each capability — use whichever apply to this workstation:
    - ⚖️ **MG-S8200 Scale Setup** — pick the COM port (with a **List Ports** button, and a **Detect Baud** button so you don't have to know the scale's baud rate) and save. See Section 53 for the full weighing workflow once this is done.
    - 🖨️ **Receipt Printer Setup** — the printer itself is declared right on this workstation's own row: **"Set up printer"** (or **"Edit"** once one exists) opens **List Printers** to pull the actual Windows printer names on this workstation, plus two independent checkboxes — **" 🔌 Enable remote printing"** (this workstation's printer receives jobs from the server at all) and **" 🔗 Share this printer"** (lets *other* devices/workstations also use it, disabled unless remote printing is on). No separate registration step and no picking a workstation from a dropdown — see Section 26's **"Workstation Printers — Remote Printing & Sharing"** for the full walkthrough of what each flag does. There's also a reminder link to 👤 **Profile → Printer Setup** for QZ Tray, since that's configured separately, per browser/machine, not on this page.

> Saving a printer here pushes an immediate refresh to that workstation's tray, instead of the tray waiting up to 10 minutes to catch up.

Each paired workstation row on this page also has a **Start with Windows** toggle — same auto-start setting as the tray and the R710 Agent panel's version of it, described above.

Agent update required banner (MBM-281): if any paired workstation's agent build is out of date relative to what this server now ships, a red banner appears at the **top of this page** — not just a small per-row note — naming which workstation(s) and linking straight to the download. Each affected row also shows its version in red with "— update required." See the R710 Agent panel's "Updating the agent to a newer version" section above for why this matters (an outdated agent's connection can look fine while newer features like business-switching silently don't work) and how to update — the steps and the "pairing survives an update" guarantee are identical for this pairing type.

Two more page-top banners for the more basic "nothing's actually working" cases: found live — a workstation had its agent redeployed but the new build hadn't been reinstalled yet on the actual PC, and there was no signal of that anywhere until you scrolled down and noticed the row still said Offline.

- **"No workstation agent paired for this business yet"** — shown when this business has never paired a single workstation, with the download link and a reminder to pair one below.
- **"Agent not running"** — shown when a workstation *is* paired here but its `connectionStatus` is currently Offline, naming which one(s). Covers both "never got reinstalled after a redeploy" and "was just closed/stopped" — the server can't tell those apart, only that nothing is actually connected right now.

A related but different check also runs on the dashboard homepage, right after login — visible to system admins and business owners only. Where the two banners above read the *server's* database of paired workstations (so they cover every workstation this business has ever paired, from any machine you happen to be viewing the admin page on), the homepage check instead probes `http://127.0.0.1:47710` **live, from**

the browser's own machine — the same local call the "Pair This Workstation" card uses to detect an unpaired agent. It only ever tells you about the one machine you're actually sitting at right now:

- ⚠️ **No workstation agent running on this machine** — shown, unconditionally, whenever nothing answers on that port at all: not installed, or installed but not started. This doesn't depend on whether this business (or any business) has ever paired anything here — it's a fact about the machine, not about pairing state, so it fires even for a completely fresh workstation.
- ⚠️ **Agent update required on this machine** — shown when an agent *does* answer but reports an older version than this server currently expects (the agent's `/probe` response includes its own version precisely so this works before any pairing exists).
- **Nothing shown** if the agent is running and current but this particular business simply hasn't paired it — that's treated as a legitimate "doesn't use a workstation agent (yet)" state, not a problem, regardless of business type.

The same live local check also feeds the small status pill in the bottom-right corner of every page (the one that otherwise just says "● Running" with the app's uptime) — it's no longer server-health-only. For a system admin/business owner, that same `/probe` result can turn the pill orange instead of green:

- **"Agent Offline"** — nothing answered on `127.0.0.1:47710` (mirrors the homepage box above, but visible from *any* page, not just the dashboard).
- **"Agent Update"** — the agent answered but its version doesn't match what this server expects.

Unlike the homepage box, the pill is **clickable** whenever it's showing an agent issue — click (desktop) or tap-to-expand then follow the link (mobile) goes straight to `/admin/workstation-agents`. If the server itself is down or its database is disconnected, that takes priority and shows as the usual red "Offline"/yellow "Degraded" pill instead — a dead server is a bigger problem than an agent issue, so the two are never shown layered on top of each other. The same pill (a smaller inline version) also appears in the account dropdown menu next to Sign Out, for the same reason and with the same click-through.

Both the homepage box and the pill clear themselves live, without a page reload, once the underlying problem is actually fixed — no need to remember to refresh after installing or restarting the agent:

- A background check every 30 seconds is the fallback.
- Switching back to the browser tab (after alt-tabbing away to run the installer) triggers an immediate re-check, rather than waiting out whatever's left of that 30 seconds.
- **Clicking a "Download the latest r710-agent.zip" link (or the pill's click-through to this page) starts a faster check every 3 seconds**, which stops itself the moment the problem clears — so realistically, the banner/pill catches up within a few seconds of the agent actually starting, not up to 30. That fast check also gives up and falls back to the normal 30-second pace after 3 minutes, in case the download was never actually finished, rather than hammering the agent's local port forever.

Each paired profile in the tray shows its own detail lines (right-click the tray icon, then open a specific profile's submenu). Status lines carry a real colored dot icon — green (connected/ready), amber (connecting/in use elsewhere), red (offline/error), gray (not configured) — not just text, so a glance at the tray tells you what needs attention:

Line	What it means
Server	The URL of the server this profile is paired to

Line	What it means
R710	Same meaning as the "Using the Agent panel day-to-day" status above, plus the device's own IP address once known (e.g. "Connected (192.168.1.50)")
Business	Which business is currently shown as **focused** on this row (workstation profiles only) — matters for the **scale** (only one business can own it at a time) and for which printer info this specific row displays; it does **not** mean any other paired business's printer relay is disconnected — every paired business's printer connection stays live regardless. See "Multiple Businesses, One Workstation" below if this machine is paired for more than one.
Printer relay	Whether this profile's printer-relay pairing is currently reachable by its server. Print jobs can only be relayed while this shows Ready. Multiple profiles can print at the same time with no restriction — jobs simply queue on the printer like any other application's print jobs would.
Configured printer(s)	The actual printer(s) routed through **this agent** — i.e. jobs relayed from the server over this pairing (declared on this workstation's own row in Admin → Workstation Agents). This is one of *two* independent print paths a workstation can have — see the QZ Tray line next.
QZ Tray printer (this machine)	A completely separate print path this agent has no part in: whichever printer **QZ Tray** (its own program, driven directly by a browser — see Section 26) is set up to use on this exact machine, if any. Set at **Profile** → **Printer Setup**, not here — this line is purely informational, so the tray doesn't look "unconfigured" on a machine that's actually already printing fine via QZ. A machine can have neither, either, or both of these two configured at once; they don't conflict, but they also don't know about each other beyond this display.
Printers on this PC	The raw list of every printer Windows has installed on this workstation — not a claim that this agent (or QZ Tray) actually uses any of them. Useful only for checking that a name you expect to see is actually installed here; compare against the two lines above to see what's *actually* in use.
Scale	Only one profile can hold the physical scale connection at a time (it's a single serial port, not something two programs can share). The profile currently connected to it shows its live reading (Connected on COMx / Not connected / Error); every *other* profile's Scale line instead shows **"in use by <label> — Release,"** letting you explicitly hand the scale over rather than it being silently stolen — or, if nothing's connected yet, "configured for COMx @ baud — not connected" so you can see what *should* be there. This only comes up on a workstation paired to more than one server for a scale — most setups only ever pair one.
Start with Windows	The same shared, whole-agent setting described above (also on the Preferences submenu and both admin pages) — reachable from every profile's own submenu too, for convenience

Finding the agent's version (MBM-281 follow-up): the version is machine-wide, not per-profile, so it isn't one of the per-profile lines above — it's shown in two places instead, both without opening any specific profile's submenu:

- **Hover over the tray icon** — the tooltip reads "MBM Local Agent vX.Y.Z — N profiles (M connected)."
- **Right-click the tray icon** — "Agent version: X.Y.Z" is its own line, just above **Preferences**.

The same number is also visible from inside the app itself without touching the tray at all — **hover over the status pill in the bottom-right corner of any page** (or its smaller copy next to Sign Out in the account dropdown) to see "Workstation agent vX.Y.Z on this machine," and on mobile, tapping the pill to expand it lists the same version as one of its detail rows. That's the version this exact browser detected live from `127.0.0.1:47710/probe` moments ago — compare it against whatever the "Agent Offline"/"Agent Update" banners or the Workstation Agents admin page say to confirm they agree.

None of this is a one-time snapshot from when you paired — the agent quietly re-checks the server every 10 minutes (and immediately on every reconnect) and updates these lines automatically, so an IP address or printer assignment changed later on the admin side shows up here without needing to re-pair.

Recent Activity for the Scale/Printer pairing works the same way as R710's — click **Recent Activity** next to a paired workstation on the Workstation Agents page to see its last 50 scale/print jobs, who requested each one, how long it took, and any error.

Offline behavior: if the workstation's agent is offline, a scale connection attempt or a relayed print job fails with a clear "the local agent is offline — contact IT" message rather than a silent failure or a generic error, matching the R710 pairing's existing behavior described above.

Two businesses sharing one physical till each declare their own printer independently and print at the same time, with no exclusivity (MBM-283 follow-up). Each business's own pairing (Section 26) gets its own printer declaration — Happy Eater's pairing and Jiffy Lube's pairing on the same physical dell-hwandaza till, say, each have their own "This workstation's printer" entry, both able to relay jobs concurrently. There's no "currently active business" concept for printing at all — that only ever applied to the scale (below), which is a genuine single-serial-port hardware exclusivity. An earlier version of this app *did* auto-move a shared printer's routing to whichever business's connection came online most recently — that caused a real bug (one business's printer setup silently disappearing the moment the other business reconnected) and has been removed; each business's printer setup now stays exactly as declared, indefinitely. Each business also keeps its **own** "default printer" preference (**POS Settings → Printer Preferences**) — picking a default printer while working one business has never carried over as the default when you switch to a different business on the same browser/PC.

Multiple Businesses, One Workstation — Active Business Switching (MBM-279)

A single physical scale can be shared by **several businesses** on the same workstation — common on a shared till that different businesses use at different times. Each business pairs it once (**Pair this machine**, above) the normal way, from its own Workstation Agents page; the workstation keeps every business's pairing it's ever seen, permanently, rather than only remembering whichever one paired most recently.

This entire section is about the scale only. The printer never needed any of this — see "Two businesses sharing one physical till..." just above: every paired business's printer-relay connection stays live simultaneously, regardless of which business currently has your attention on this workstation. Only the **scale** has genuine hardware exclusivity.

Only **one business is ever active for the scale** at a time on a given workstation — that's a real hardware fact (one COM port, only one program can hold a serial connection open at a time), not a limitation of the app.

Which business is active follows you automatically:

- **Switching business from the header dropdown — on the same PC the workstation agent is running on — switches the workstation's active business (for the scale) to match**, instantly. No separate step needed; it happens the moment you pick a different business, from any page.
- **Switching browser/tab focus back to an already-open tab does the same thing (MBM-282), even with no business switch involved.** If you have two tabs open on this exact workstation — say Business A in one tab, Business B in another, whether that's two tabs on the *same* server or, per "One agent, many servers at once" above, two tabs on two *different* paired servers — simply clicking back into whichever tab you want active re-asserts it as the workstation's active business, with no dropdown action needed in that tab. This is what makes the scale follow your attention correctly: previously, only an actual in-tab business *switch* counted, so alt-tabbing between two already-loaded tabs left the workstation pinned to whichever one last performed an explicit switch, not whichever one you'd actually clicked into.
- If the business you switch (or focus) to has never been paired on this exact workstation, its scale is simply cleared/deactivated here — nothing from the previous business is left connected. Its printer relay, if it has one, is completely unaffected either way.
- If you switch business from a **different** computer (e.g. checking a report from your laptop while the shop till keeps serving whoever it's currently set to), nothing on the till is affected — this only ever applies to the one specific PC the browser and the agent are both running on.
- Creating a brand-new business and being switched into it automatically works the same way — the new business has no pairing yet, so the workstation's scale is simply deactivated until you pair it there.
- **The receipt printer and R710 never needed any of this switching logic in the first place** — every print job and R710 request is a single, self-contained round trip carrying its own printer name/device details, so two businesses' jobs already run at the same time with no conflict (the same way two unrelated desktop apps can print to one shared printer without stepping on each other). The scale is the one physical device that's genuinely exclusive, which is why it's the only one that needs "active business" tracking at all.

Switching manually, without the browser doing it: both the tray (right-click → a profile's submenu) and the **Manage Profiles** page (`http://127.0.0.1:47710` on the workstation itself) show an **"Other businesses paired here"** list with a **Switch to this** button per business — useful if several people share one till, or if you want to switch without opening a browser tab for that business first.

A business that isn't currently active here shows the same "local agent is offline" message as a genuinely disconnected agent if you try to use its scale — the workstation's agent process is running fine; it's simply connected on behalf of a *different* business right now for the scale specifically. Switching to that business (dropdown, tray, or Manage Profiles) resolves it immediately, with no re-pairing needed. **Its printer never shows this message, regardless of which business is active** — see below.

The printer itself needs no "which business is active" switching at all, and never has since MBM-283 — unlike the scale above, each business's printer declaration (Section 26) is independent and stays connected for that business at all times, regardless of which business is currently active on this workstation for the scale. An earlier version of this app briefly disconnected the whole printer-relay connection on every business switch, not just the scale — that was a real bug (a shared till's Business B printer would go offline the moment someone switched focus to Business A), fully fixed. Switching active business only ever matters here for the scale; a receipt for any paired business on this workstation prints correctly at any time, with no "Bring Online" or re-save needed after a business switch.

Nothing about existing setups changes. A scale connected via the desktop (Electron) app, or a printer already working through QZ Tray or a direct network connection, needs no changes and keeps working exactly as before — the workstation-agent pairing is purely an additional option for hardware that the central server can no longer reach directly.

ESP32 System — Captive Portal Integration

How ESP32 Tokens Work

The ESP32 system uses a **captive portal** — when a customer connects to the WiFi network, their browser is automatically redirected to a login page hosted on the ESP32 device. The customer enters a **token code** to gain access.

Token codes are generated by the system and sold through the POS in the same way as R710 tokens. The difference is what the customer receives: a single code (not a username/password pair).

Selling an ESP32 Token

The POS flow is identical to R710:

1. Search for the WiFi package and add to cart.
2. Process payment.
3. The receipt prints the **token code**:

```
──────────────────────────
      📶 WiFi Access
──────────────────────────
  Package:   1 Hour Pass
  Token:     AB12CD
──────────────────────────
  Connect to: GuestWiFi
  Go to any website to
  enter your token code.
──────────────────────────
```

4. The customer connects to the guest WiFi network, opens any browser, and the captive portal page appears.
5. They type in the token code and are granted access for the purchased duration.

ESP32 Integration Setup (Manager / Admin)

1. Go to **Settings** → **Integrations** → **ESP32 / Captive Portal**.
2. Enter the connection details for the ESP32 device (IP address, port, API key).
3. Test the connection.
4. Configure the token packages (duration and price) — these sync with the ESP32 device.
5. Save.

> The ESP32 integration must be set up before any tokens can be sold through this system. If no integration exists, the system returns an empty token list and the WiFi products will not appear in the POS.

Printing a WiFi Advertising Flier

A printable A4 flier can be generated for any business that has a WiFi integration active (R710 or ESP32). The flier tells customers the network name, how to connect, what packages are available and their prices, and the terms of use.

Where to Find the Print Button

Location	How to reach it
R710 settings page	Open any business WiFi settings page (e.g., Restaurant → Settings → R710 WiFi). Click the 📶 **Print WiFi Flier** button in the top-right corner of the configuration panel.
ESP32 settings page	Open the ESP32 WiFi token menu settings. Click the 📶 **Print WiFi Flier** button in the top-right corner of the info panel.
Restaurant POS — WiFi tab	Switch the category tab to 📡 **ESP32 WiFi** or 📶 **R710 WiFi**. A 📶 **Print Flier** button appears above the product grid.

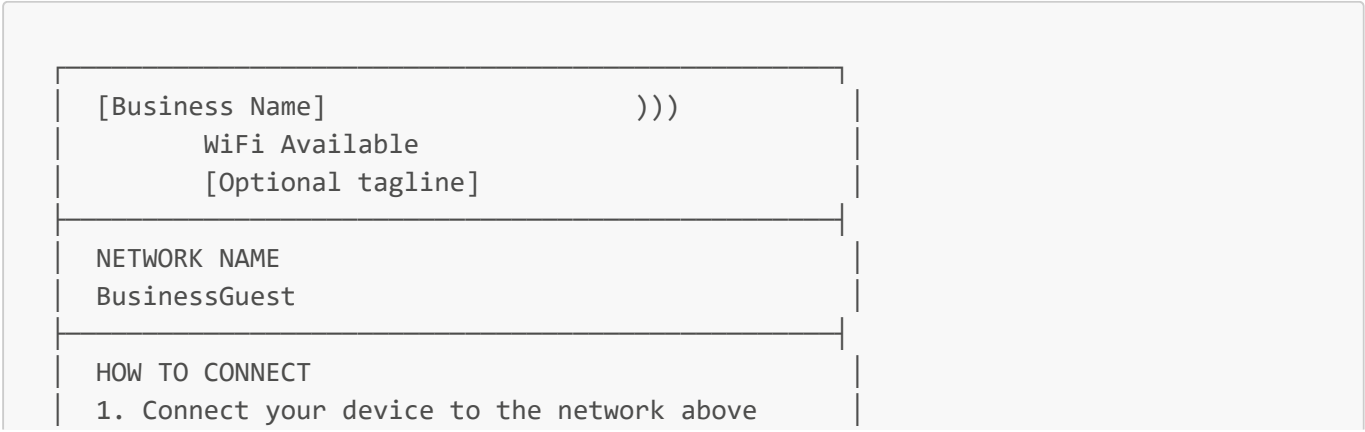
Before the PDF is Generated

A small modal opens asking for:

Field	Notes
Network Name (SSID)	For R710 this is pre-filled from the system. For ESP32 it must be entered manually (SSID is not stored).
Tagline *(optional)*	A short marketing line printed under "WiFi Available" — e.g., "*Fast and reliable internet for all*". Leave blank for no tagline.

Click **Print PDF** — the A4 flier downloads immediately.

What the Flier Contains



```
│  2. Purchase a token from the cashier                │
│  3. Open your browser — a login page appears         │
│  4. Enter the USERNAME & PASSWORD on your slip       │  ← R710
│     (or: Enter the TOKEN CODE on your slip)          │  ← ESP32
│  5. Click Connect and enjoy your session!            │
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  PACKAGES                                            │
│  1 Hour     $0.20  │  8 Hours    $0.50               │
│  1 Day      $1.10  │  1 Week     $2.00               │
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  TERMS & CONDITIONS                                  │
│  • Tokens are single-use and non-transferable        │
│  • One active session per token                      │
│  • No refunds on purchased tokens                    │
│  • For help, speak to staff at the counter           │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

- Packages are listed **shortest-to-longest duration** and shown in a two-column grid.
- The connection instructions automatically adapt to the hardware type — ESP32 fliers say "Enter the TOKEN CODE"; R710 fliers say "Enter the USERNAME & PASSWORD".
- The flier is entirely black and white — optimised for toner-saving on standard A4 printers.

> Print one flier and laminate it, or print multiples to place at tables and counters. The PDF is re-generated each time, so it always reflects your current packages and prices.

WiFi Receipt Structure

Regardless of which system is used, WiFi credentials always appear in a clearly separated block at the bottom of the receipt, after the payment summary. This keeps the financial details and the access details easy to read separately.

Full receipt structure when WiFi is included:

```
──────────────────────────────
  YOUR BUSINESS NAME
  123 Main Street
  Tel: +263 77 000 0000
──────────────────────────────
  Order #: ORD-000842
  Date:    15 Mar 2026  14:32
  Cashier: Tendai
──────────────────────────────
  ITEMS
  Burger & Chips          $4.50
  Orange Juice            $0.80
  WiFi — Daily Pass       $2.00
  ──────────────────────────────
  TOTAL                   $7.30
  Cash received          $10.00
  Change                  $2.70
```

```
──────────────────────────────
      📶 WiFi Credentials
──────────────────────────────
  Network:   BusinessGuest
  Username:  guest_5021
  Password:  Rp8vN3tK
  Valid for: 24 hours
──────────────────────────────
  Thank you for your visit!
──────────────────────────────
```

If multiple WiFi tokens are purchased in the same order (e.g., two hourly passes), each token's credentials appear as a separate block on the receipt.

---

14. Inventory & Barcode Labels

> **Who reads this:** Stock managers, clothing store managers, and anyone responsible for labelling products or receiving stock.

Understanding the Two Inventory Workflows

There are two distinct operations that both involve "adding inventory":

Workflow	When to use it	What it does
Create a new product	Product does not exist in the system at all	Creates a new product record + assigns barcode + sets initial stock quantity
Receive stock (restock)	Product already exists, you received more units	Adds quantity to an existing product — does not create a new record

Confusing these two is the most common inventory mistake. Always check whether the product already exists before creating a new one.

Inventory List Sort Order

The inventory list defaults to **most recently updated first** — so a change made anywhere in the system (this screen, Bulk Stock, POS Quick-Edit, a price change, a stock adjustment) surfaces at the top without anyone needing to know to look for it. Use the **Sort by** dropdown above the list to switch to Name, Category, Stock, Cost, or Sell Price instead — your choice only lasts for the current visit; it resets to most-recently-updated next time you open the page.

Workflow 1 — Creating a New Product (Product Does Not Exist Yet)

Step 1: Navigate to the Add Product screen

Business type	Path
Grocery	**Grocery → Inventory → Add Item**
Clothing	**Clothing → Products → New Product**
Restaurant	**Restaurant → Menu → Add Item**
Universal / Hardware / Other	**[Business] → Products → New**

Step 2: Fill in the product details

Core fields (all business types):

Field	Required	Notes
Product Name	Yes	What customers and staff will see
SKU	Yes	Short internal code (e.g. `GRO-001`, `CLO-TRK-42`). Can be auto-generated — click the ⚙ icon next to the SKU field.
Category	Yes	Organise products into categories for reports and menus
Selling Price	Yes	The price charged to customers
Cost Price	No	What you paid for it — used for profit margin calculation
Initial Stock	No	How many units you are putting into stock right now
Description	No	Optional longer description

Grocery-specific fields:

Field	Notes
Temperature Zone	Room Temperature / Refrigerated / Frozen
Shelf Life (days)	Auto-calculates expiry date when stock is received
PLU Code	For produce items weighed at point of sale
Batch Number	Supplier's batch reference
Organic Certified	Tick if the product is certified organic
Low Stock Threshold	Alert is triggered when stock drops below this number (default: 10)

Clothing-specific fields:

Field	Notes
Product Type	New / Used / Refurbished
Condition	New / Like New / Good / Fair / Poor

Field	Notes
Brand	Select from the brand list or leave blank

Step 3: Assign a barcode

The barcode is the number a scanner reads. There are three ways to assign one:

Option A — Type or scan it directly into the form

- Look for the **Barcode / UPC** field on the product form.
- If you have the physical product with a barcode label on it, hold the scanner over it — the code is entered automatically into the field.
- If you typed it manually, double-check the number is correct.

Option B — Assign it after saving

- Save the product first without a barcode.
- Open the product in the product list.
- Click **Assign Barcode** (or the barcode icon).
- Scan or type the barcode in the modal that appears.
- Click **Save**.

Option C — Auto-generate (bulk, clothing stores)

- From the product list, select multiple products using the checkboxes.
- Click **Bulk Actions** → **Assign Barcodes**.
- Choose **Auto-generate sequential barcodes**.
- Enter a **Barcode Prefix** (e.g. `CLO` produces `CLO000001`, `CLO000002`, etc.).
- Click **Generate** — all selected products get sequential barcodes.

> **SKU vs Barcode:** The SKU is a human-readable internal code (e.g. `TRK-BLK-L`). The barcode is what the scanner reads (e.g. `5901234123457`). Both can be the same value, but they serve different purposes. A product can have an SKU without a barcode, but a barcode must be assigned before the item can be scanned at the POS.

Step 4: Print the barcode label

Once a barcode is assigned, print a label to stick on the product:

1. Go to **Universal** → **Barcode Management** → **Templates**.
2. Click **New Template**.
3. Choose **From Existing Product** — search for your product.
4. The template is pre-filled with the product name, price, SKU, and barcode.
5. Adjust label size, font size, and paper format if needed.
6. Go to **Universal** → **Barcode Management** → **Print Jobs** → **New Print Job**.
7. Select your template, enter the quantity of labels to print, and click **Print**.

> Labels print with: business name, product name, description, size, barcode, SKU, and price. Two fold lines are printed on the label for folding-tag style clothing labels.

Adding a Photo When Creating a New Item

The **Add Item** form only shows the image upload option once the item has been saved (a photo needs a real item to attach to). To add one:

1. Fill in the item details as normal and click **Create Item** — the button appears both at the top and bottom of the form, so you don't have to scroll down on a long form just to save.
2. Instead of closing, the form switches into **edit mode for the item you just created** and a 📷 **Add Image** button appears.
3. Click it for the full set of options: upload a photo, paste one, choose from your business's image gallery — or use 📷 **Take Photo / Upload (Crop & Edit)** to crop it square and remove the background before saving. See Take Photo / Upload with Crop & Background Removal for the full walkthrough of that option.
4. Close the form (×) when done — your photo and item details are already saved.

> If you close the form immediately after creating without adding a photo, that's fine too — you can always add one later from the inventory list's 🖍️ edit button.

Editing an Existing Item — Unsaved Changes Warning

When editing an item, an 📦 **Adjust** stock change and any photo you add or change save immediately — you don't need to click **Update Item** for those. Everything else on the form (name, price, category, barcodes, etc.) only saves when you click **Update Item**. If you close the form (×) with other fields changed but not yet saved, you'll be asked to confirm — **Close without saving** or **Keep editing** — so an edit in progress is never silently lost.

Duplicate Product Name Detection

When you click **Save** on a new product, the system checks whether any active item in this business already has a similar name. If a match is found:

- An **amber warning banner** appears below the form, listing the matching items (name and SKU).
- You have two options:
  - **Create anyway** — saves the new item even though a similar name exists. Use this only if the two products are genuinely different things.
  - **Cancel** — dismisses the warning so you can rename the item or locate the existing one instead.

> This check only runs when **creating** a new item. Editing an existing item does not trigger it.

Template Products — Hidden Draft Items

A 📋 **Template** badge on a product (visible next to its name) means it's an unconfigured draft — no price and no stock yet. Template products are hidden from normal inventory search and lists so they don't clutter results, until either:

- **Someone gives it a real price** — the next time a price is saved for it (via editing the item, a variant price change, or activating it from a barcode scan), it automatically graduates to a regular item. No manual step needed.
- **A manager converts it manually** — useful for a legitimately $0-priced item that still needs to show up now. In the inventory list, turn on 📋 **Show Templates**, then click ✅ **Convert to Regular Inventory** on the item's row (requires the `canManageInventory` permission or admin). The converted row stays visible with a green ✅ **Converted** badge so you can see what just changed, without needing to refresh the page.
- Once you've converted one or more items, a 🙈 **Hide Converted** button appears next to Show Templates, letting you tuck the converted rows out of view again without losing your place.

> Refreshing the page naturally drops converted items out of the Show Templates view, since the server no longer flags them as templates.

Workflow 2 — Receiving Stock for an Existing Product

Use this when a product already exists in the system and you have received more units.

Receive Stock Page (Grocery, Restaurant, Clothing, Hardware, Construction)

1. Go to **[Business]** → **Inventory** → **Receive Stock** — or click **Receive Stock** on the Inventory Overview card on the business home page.
2. A grid shows all your existing products.
3. For each item you received:
    - Enter the **quantity received** in the "Receive Qty" column.
    - Optionally update the **Cost/Unit** (if the supplier price changed).
    - Optionally add a **Batch #** and **Expiration date**.
4. Click **Submit Receipt** — the system increases the stock levels and records a stock-received movement.

> You can update multiple products in a single session — fill in quantities for everything you received and submit once.

> **Services** businesses don't have a Receive Stock page — services have no physical stock to receive. **Chicken Run** uses its own **Add Purchased Stock** flow instead (Chicken Run → Inventory → Add Purchased Stock), which records a feed/stock purchase directly.

Clothing / Hardware / Universal — Single-Item Add Stock Form

For a new barcode inventory item (not yet in the system), use the **Add Stock** form:

1. Go to **Inventory** → **Add Stock** (or click the **+ Add Stock** button in the Bulk Stocking panel for individual entry).
2. Fill in the form:

Field	Required	Notes
Barcode	Auto-filled if from scan	Read-only if pre-filled from a scan

Field	Required	Notes
Product Name	Yes	What this item is called. Once you've typed at least 2 characters, a 💡 **Suggest Classification** button appears next to the label — click it to get department/category suggestions matched from the product name, instead of hunting through the dropdowns manually.
Domain	No	Top-level classification (e.g. "🥦 Fresh Produce"). Available for all business types.
Category	Yes	Filtered by the selected domain. Create inline with **+ New category**.
Supplier	No	Searchable dropdown. Create inline with **+ New supplier**.
Description	No	Optional note (replaces the old "Notes" field)
Sell Price	Yes	Tick **Free Item** to set price to $0 and disable the input
Cost Price	No	What you paid — used for margin reporting
Quantity	Yes	Number of units you are adding
SKU	No	Leave blank to auto-generate (e.g. `GRO-INV-00042`)

3. Click **Add to Stock & Print** to save and immediately print a barcode label, or **Save** to save without printing.

Domain → Category cascade: When you select a domain, the category dropdown is automatically filtered to show only categories within that domain. Selecting a new domain clears the category field.

> **For existing products (updating stock or price):** Open the product's detail page (from the product list, click on the product name), then click **Adjust Stock**. Enter the quantity and reason. The new units are added to the current stock count.

> The Add Stock form doesn't have a photo field — it's built for fast barcode/print intake. If you want a photo on the item, save it here first, then open it from the inventory list with 🖍️ **Edit** and use **Add Image** there.

What a stock receipt records

Every time you receive stock, the system logs:

- Date and time received
- Quantity added
- Unit cost (if provided)
- Batch number and expiration date (if provided)
- Who recorded it

This history is visible under the product's **Stock History** tab and feeds into the inventory movement report.

Workflow 3 — Scanning a Barcode to Add New Inventory

This is the fastest method when you are physically holding items and want to add them one at a time by scanning. See the full lookup sequence below.

Adding Inventory by Scanning a Barcode

The fastest way to add a new product is to scan its barcode. Every scan triggers a **multi-step global lookup** — the system searches not just the current business but across all businesses you have access to, in a defined order.

The Full Lookup Sequence

```
Barcode scanned
       │
       ▼
Step 1 ── Does this business already have this barcode?
       │   YES → product found → add to cart / show in inventory
       │   NO  ↓
       ▼
Step 1.5 ── Is this a clothing bale (by barcode or SKU)?
       │   YES → bale found → add to cart with unit price
       │   NO  ↓
       ▼
Step 2 ── Does a barcode template exist for this code?
       │   YES → template found → open pre-filled product form
       │   NO  ↓
       ▼
Step 3 ── Global cross-business lookup
       │   FOUND in another business → show match details
       │                               offer "Stock to this business"
       │   NOT FOUND anywhere ↓
       ▼
Step 4 ── Barcode is completely unknown
           → Open Quick Stock Add form
           → User enters name, price, quantity
           → Product created + barcode registered here
```

Step 1 — Barcode Found in This Business

Scan the barcode at the POS or inventory screen. The product is found immediately and added to the cart (POS) or shown in the inventory list. Nothing else is needed.

Step 1.5 — Clothing Bale Match

If the barcode or SKU matches a bale record (e.g. `BALE-HXI-042`), the bale is found and can be added to the cart at the configured unit price. See the Clothing Bales section for full details.

Step 2 — Barcode Template Match

If a label template was previously created with this barcode value, a template card appears showing the product name, default price, size, and colour from the template.

1. Click ✨ **Create Product from Template**.
2. A product form opens with all fields pre-filled.
3. Confirm or adjust and click **Save** — the product is created with the barcode attached.

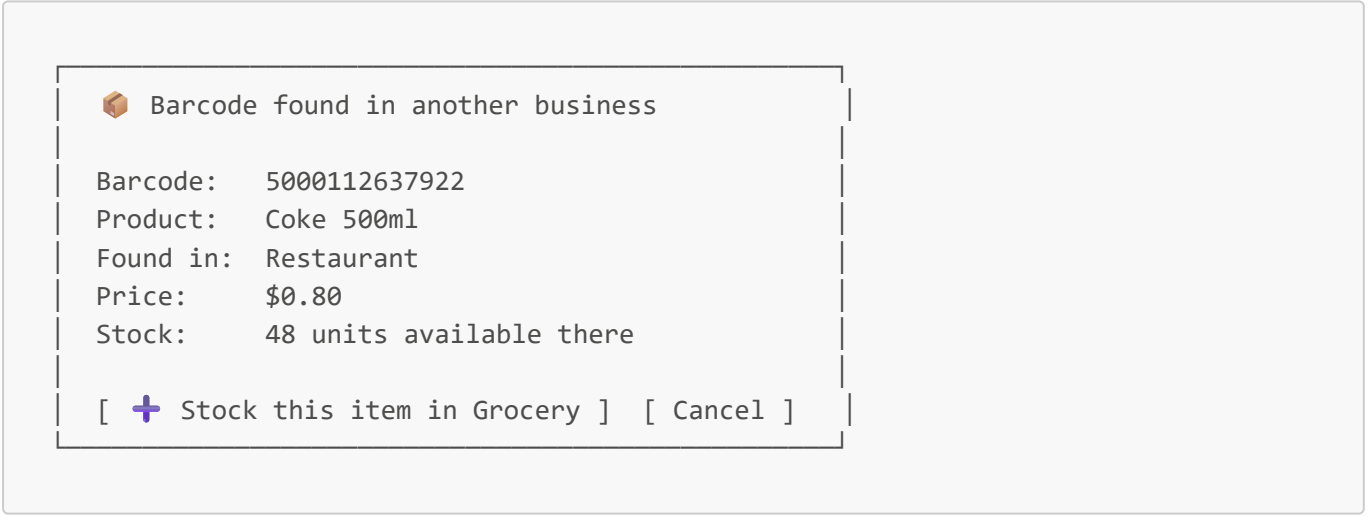
> This is the standard workflow for pre-labelled wholesale stock: templates are set up once per product line, and any staff member can add stock by scanning thereafter.

Step 3 — Global Cross-Business Lookup

If the barcode is not found in the current business and no template matches, the system performs a **global search across all businesses** in the organisation that the current user has access to.

What this means in practice:

Suppose the grocery store scans a can of Coca-Cola with barcode `5000112637922`. That barcode is not in the grocery's product list yet. But the restaurant already stocks it as "Coke 500ml". The system finds the match in the restaurant and shows:



Options:

Button	What happens
➕ **Stock this item in [current business]**	Opens the Quick Stock Add form pre-filled with the product name and price from the other business. You set the quantity and any adjustments, then save — the product is created in the current business with this barcode attached.
Cancel	Dismisses without doing anything.

> The system is offering information — it found the same barcode somewhere else in your organisation. You are **not forced** to copy the other business's details. You can change the name or price when you fill in the form.

The Same Barcode Can Mean a Different Product in a Different Business

This is an important concept: **a barcode is not globally unique across your businesses**. The same barcode number can be registered against completely different products in different stores, and this is perfectly normal and correct.

Example:

Business	Barcode	Product registered against it
Grocery	`4006381333931`	Nivea Cream 50ml
Clothing	`4006381333931`	White Buttons Pack (10pcs)

Both are correct. The grocery received goods labelled with that barcode and it means Nivea Cream to them. The clothing store happened to receive different goods with the same printed barcode and registered it as button packs.

When a cashier in the grocery scans `4006381333931`, they see Nivea Cream. When a cashier in the clothing store scans the same code, they see Button Packs. Neither store sees the other's product — the lookup is always **scoped to the current business first**.

The global cross-business lookup (Step 3) only triggers when the barcode is **not found at all** in the current business. If the current business already has the barcode registered — even as something different from what another business has — the current business's product is used and the lookup stops there.

> **Summary rule:** Each business owns its own mapping of barcodes to products. The same barcode can safely exist in multiple businesses pointing to different products. There is no conflict.

Step 4 — Barcode Completely Unknown (Quick Stock Add)

If no match is found anywhere — not in the current business, no template, and no other business — the **Quick Stock Add** form opens automatically:

1. The scanned barcode is pre-filled — do not change it.
2. Enter:
    - **Product name** — what this item is called in your store
    - **Price** — the selling price
    - **Quantity received** — how many units you are stocking
    - **Size / Colour** *(optional, for clothing)*
3. Click **Save Product**.

The system creates the product in the current business, registers the barcode against it, and records a stock-received movement. You are taken to the full product edit page to add more details (category, cost price, image, etc.) if needed.

> **Tip for clothing stores:** Use Quick Stock Add for one-off items. For items received in bulk batches, use the Bales system instead.

Summary: What Happens at Each Scan Stage

Situation	What the cashier / stock manager sees
Barcode in this business	Product found instantly — added to cart or shown in stock
Bale SKU/barcode	Bale found — added to cart at unit price
Barcode template exists	Template card shown — one click creates the product
Barcode in another business	Cross-business match shown — option to stock here
Barcode in multiple businesses	All matches shown — cashier chooses which to use
Completely unknown	Quick Stock Add form opens — user creates the product now

---

Predefined Domains, Categories & Sub-Categories — All Business Types

When stocking products in the Bulk Stocking Panel or the single-item Add Stock form, you can classify each item using a three-level hierarchy:

```
Domain (top level)  →  Category  →  Sub-Category
e.g. 🥦 Fresh Produce  →  Vegetables  →  Leafy Greens
e.g. 🔧 Power Tools    →  Drills      →  Hammer Drills
```

The system ships with a predefined taxonomy for every business type. You do not need to create these — they are already available in the dropdowns when you open the panel.

Grocery Store Domains

Domain	Example Categories
🥦 Fresh Produce	Vegetables, Fruits
🥛 Dairy & Eggs	Milk & Cream, Cheese, Eggs & Butter, Yogurt
🥩 Meat & Poultry	Beef, Chicken, Pork
🐟 Fish & Seafood	Fresh Fish, Dried & Salted Fish
📦 Bakery & Bread	Bread, Pastries
🥤 Beverages	Soft Drinks, Water, Alcohol, Hot Drinks
🍫 Snacks & Confectionery	Crisps & Chips, Chocolates & Sweets, Nuts & Dried Fruit
🍚 Pantry & Dry Goods	Grains & Cereals, Pasta, Cooking Oils, Sauces, Canned Goods, Sugar & Spices
🧹 Household & Cleaning	Laundry, Dishwashing, Surface Cleaners, Air Fresheners
🧴 Personal Care	Body Care, Hair Care, Oral Care, Feminine Care, Baby & Kids

Domain	Example Categories
🖊️ Office & Stationery	Writing Instruments, Paper Products, Desk Accessories
🐾 Pet Care	Pet Food, Pet Accessories

Hardware Store Domains

Domain	Example Categories
🔧 Power Tools	Drills & Drivers, Saws, Sanders & Grinders
🔨 Hand Tools	Striking Tools, Measuring & Marking, Wrenches & Spanners
🧱 Building Materials	Cement & Aggregates, Bricks & Blocks, Roofing, Timber
🚿 Plumbing	Pipes & Fittings, Taps & Valves, Water Tanks
⚡ Electrical	Cables & Wiring, Switches & Sockets, Lighting, Distribution
🎨 Paint & Finishes	Interior Paint, Exterior Paint, Primers
🌿 Garden & Outdoor	Irrigation, Lawn & Garden, Outdoor Furniture
🔒 Safety & Security	Personal Protective Equipment, Locks & Access
🔩 Fasteners	Bolts & Nuts, Screws & Nails, Anchors & Adhesives
🛁 Bathroom Fittings	Sanitaryware, Shower Systems

> This table is a sample — Hardware's full taxonomy covers **30 domains** (Home Depot/Lowe's-style department coverage), including several not shown above: Doors & Windows, Flooring & Tiles, Home Appliances, Adhesives & Sealants, Generators & Power, Workshop Equipment, Hooks/Chains & Rope, Furniture & Home Furnishings, Automotive & Vehicle Supplies, and more. All are already available in the Domain dropdown — nothing needs to be created manually.

Category-Specific Fields When Adding a Hardware Item

When you add or edit a hardware product from the main **Inventory** page (not the quick barcode "Add Stock" form above), the form shows extra fields under **Hardware-Specific Fields** based on the category you pick:

- A small set of fields always shows regardless of category: Manufacturer, Model Number, Warranty Period, Unit of Measure, Pack Size, Colour/Finish, Dimensions, Material.
- Picking certain categories adds more specific fields underneath — for example, **Lighting** adds Wattage, Voltage, Bulb Base, Colour Temperature, Lumens, and Indoor/Outdoor; **Plumbing** categories add Pipe Diameter, Pressure Rating, Fitting Type, and Hot/Cold Suitability; **Lumber and Sheet Goods** adds Species, Treatment, Grade, and dimensions. Categories without a specific set still get the fields above.
- A **Specifications** box at the bottom accepts free-form JSON for anything not covered by the fields above.

These extra fields are optional — leave any blank if not relevant to the item.

Restaurant Domains

Domain	Example Categories
🍽️ Food Menu	Starters & Appetizers, Main Courses, Sides, Desserts, Breakfast
🥤 Beverages	Soft Drinks, Hot Drinks, Alcohol, Mocktails & Smoothies
⭐ Specials	Daily Specials, Combo Meals
🍕 By Cuisine	Grills & BBQ, Seafood, Vegetarian & Vegan

Retail Store Domains

Domain	Example Categories
📱 Electronics	Phones & Accessories, Audio & Visual, Computing
🏠 Home & Living	Kitchenware, Bedding, Décor
👗 Clothing & Footwear	Men's, Women's, Kids
💄 Health & Beauty	Skincare, Makeup, Fragrances
🎮 Toys & Games	Toys, Games
🖊️ Office & Stationery	Writing Instruments, Paper & Books

Services / Consulting Domains

Domain	Example Categories
🛠️ Professional Services	Consulting, Technical Services
💼 Administrative	Office Services, Communications
📋 Subscriptions	Software, Memberships

> **Creating your own:** If the predefined taxonomy does not cover your product, use **+ New category** inline in the panel to create a custom category. Custom categories are saved permanently for your business.

> **Clothing stores** have always had their own taxonomy (Men's, Women's, Kids, Footwear, Accessories). It works the same way — just select the domain in the Department column when stocking.

> **Clothing category pickers are now grouped** — clothing's ~1,800 categories are organized under broader headings (Tops, Bottoms, Activewear, and similar) wherever you pick a category, including this panel, product forms, and the Bulk Upload dialog in the Image Gallery. A category still belongs to its usual department (Men's/Women's/Kids/etc.) — the grouping is a separate, second way of organizing the same list to make a long dropdown easier to scan. When creating or editing a category (**Business → Inventory Categories**), a **Parent Category** field lets you assign it to one of these groups, or leave it ungrouped.

Used Clothing Bales — Complete Guide

A **bale** is a compressed bundle of second-hand clothing items purchased as a single lot. The bales system tracks each bale from purchase through to individual item sales, giving you stock levels, cost recovery, and BOGO (buy-one-get-one) promotions per bale.

How Bales Work

When you buy a bale you know:

- How many items are in it (e.g. 200 pieces)
- What you paid for the whole bale (cost price)
- The selling price per item

The system divides the cost across all items and tracks how many items remain unsold. When items from the bale are sold at the POS (by scanning the bale's barcode), the **remaining count decreases automatically**.

Creating a Bale

1. Go to **Clothing** → **Inventory** → **Bales** → **New Bale**.
2. Fill in:
    - **Batch number** — leave blank to auto-generate (format: `BALE-{SHOP}-{NUMBER}`)
    - **Category** — e.g. "Ladies Tops", "Kids Mixed", "Winter Jackets"
    - **Item count** — total number of pieces in the bale
    - **Selling price per item** (unit price)
    - **Cost price** — what you paid for the whole bale (used for cost-recovery reporting)
    - **Barcode** — scan or type a barcode to attach to this bale (optional but recommended)
    - **Employee** — the staff member receiving the bale
    - **Notes** — supplier name, delivery date, anything useful
3. Click **Save Bale**.

The system assigns a SKU automatically (e.g. `BALE-HXI-00042`). The bale now appears in the bale inventory list.

Printing Bale Labels

After creating the bale, print its barcode label so shelf staff can scan items to the POS:

1. From the bale record, click **Print Label**.
2. Choose the label template (see "Creating a Label Template" below).
3. The label will include:
    - Business name
    - Category / product name
    - Selling price (large)
    - Batch number and date
    - **Barcode** (scannable by the POS)
    - Size and colour if set
4. Click **Print** — the job is sent to the label printer.

Stick the label on the shelf edge or bin where the bale is displayed. Cashiers scan this label when ringing up items.

Selling from a Bale at the POS

Cashiers do not need to know which bale items came from. They simply:

1. Scan the bale's barcode label (or type the SKU).
2. The bale appears as a product in the cart with the unit price.
3. Adjust the quantity to the number of pieces being purchased.
4. Complete the sale normally.

The bale's **remaining count** decreases by the quantity sold.

BOGO Promotions on a Bale

To run a "buy 2 get 1 free" or similar offer:

1. Open the bale record.
2. Enable **BOGO Active**.
3. Set the **BOGO ratio** (e.g. 3 means "buy 2 pay, 1 free" → every 3rd item is free).
4. Save.

The POS will automatically apply the free item when the quantity meets the ratio. The bale report tracks how many free items have been given out.

Bale Inventory Report

Go to **Reports** → **Bale Inventory** to see:

- Remaining item count per bale
- Items sold vs total
- Cost recovery percentage (how much of the purchase cost has been recovered so far)
- Sales velocity (average items sold per day)
- BOGO free items given out
- Transfers between business locations

Transferring a Bale Between Locations

If items from one bale are moved to another shop:

1. Go to **Inventory** → **Transfers** → **New Transfer**.
2. Select the bale as the item being transferred.
3. Enter the quantity moving.
4. Select the destination business.
5. Confirm — both locations' remaining counts update.

Custom Bulk Products — Complete Guide

A **Custom Bulk Product** is a container of identical items purchased in bulk and sold individually — for example, a box of 300 chocolates sold at $0.35 each, or a crate of 50 shampoo bottles sold at $1.20 each.

> **Custom Bulk vs Bales:** Bales are used for used clothing where the exact item count is estimated. Custom Bulk is for packaged goods where the item count is exact and the per-item selling price is fixed.

> **September 2026 update — bulk products now register directly into your Inventory.** Registering a new bulk product used to create a separate record that only the Bulk Products modal and the Custom Bulk Products sidebar page could see — invisible to the main Inventory list, Edit Item, and the Pricing/Cost/Value Exceptions report. **Register New** now creates a real Inventory item instead, so it shows up, is editable, and is price-checked everywhere immediately. **This only affects new registrations.** Anything registered before this update keeps working exactly as documented below under "Managing Existing Bulk Products" — see the callout there.

Accessing Custom Bulk Products

There are two ways to reach the Custom Bulk Products management page:

Option 1 — Sidebar (direct link) Click 📦 **Custom Bulk Products** in the left sidebar. This link is visible to any user with inventory management permission and takes you directly to the full management page.

Option 2 — Via the Bulk Stocking panel Open the Bulk Stocking panel (e.g. Grocery POS → 📦 **Bulk Stock**), then click the 📦 **Bulk Product** button in the panel header. This opens the Bulk Products modal, which has two tabs: **Register New** and 📋 **Manage Existing**.

The sidebar page and the modal's **Manage Existing** tab cover the same (legacy) products — use whichever suits your workflow; the sidebar page gives a full table with richer detail, while the modal is handy when you're already in the stocking panel. **Register New** is only in the modal, and its results now go straight to the main Inventory rather than this sidebar page — see the update note at the top of this section.

Registering a New Bulk Product

1. Open the Bulk Products modal (sidebar → 📦 **Custom Bulk Products** then use the 📦 **Bulk Product** button in the Bulk Stocking panel, or go directly via the panel header).
2. In the **Register New** tab, fill in:

Field	Required	Notes
Business	Yes	Shown only when you belong to more than one business. Select the business this product belongs to.
Product Name	Yes	e.g. "Chocolates", "Hand Sanitiser 500ml". Type a name and click ✨ **Suggest** to auto-fill the expense classification.
Barcode	No	Scan an existing barcode on the container, or click **Generate** to auto-create one
Item Count	Yes	How many individual units the container holds — becomes the item's starting stock quantity

Field	Required	Notes
Bulk/Case Cost	No	What you paid for the whole case — the system shows the calculated cost per item beneath this field (e.g. "Cost/item: $0.33") and saves that computed per-item figure as the item's real cost price, never the whole-case number. This does **not** auto-fill the selling price.
Selling Price	Yes	The price charged to the customer per individual item. As soon as a Bulk/Case Cost is entered, a **live pricing calculator** appears below this field showing the effective per-unit cost, landed cost, and margin, plus one-click markup suggestions (10%–100% over cost) — pick one to fill the field, or type your own price and watch the calculator's warnings update as you type.
Expense Domain → Category → Sub-category	No	Three-level hierarchy for expense classification. Use ✨ **Suggest** next to the product name to auto-populate these fields. Saved on the item and editable later from its Edit Item screen.
Supplier	No	Select from the list. Click **+ New supplier** to add one inline.
Notes	No	Optional internal note

3. Click **Register Bulk Product**.
4. The success screen shows:
    - The assigned **batch number** and **barcode**.
    - A 🖨 **Print Barcode Label** button — click this to immediately print a scannable label for the container.

> **Auto-generated barcode:** If you leave the Barcode field empty, the system generates a unique 8-character hex code (e.g. `a3f2b7c9`). This becomes the barcode scanned at the POS.

> **Selling below cost is blocked, not just warned about.** The pricing calculator flags a below-cost price as you type, but registering is the last line of defence: if you click **Register Bulk Product** with a selling price below the calculated cost per item, a confirmation modal interrupts the save — showing the cost/item, the price you entered, and the exact loss per item — and you must explicitly click **Yes, sell at a loss** before it's saved. This is the same mistake that originally caused case costs to be recorded as if they were a single unit's cost, so it's deliberately hard to do by accident now.

> ✨ **Suggest:** After typing a product name, click the ✨ **Suggest** button next to the name field. The system scores your name against known expense categories and pre-fills the Domain, Category, and Sub-category dropdowns with the best match. You can accept the suggestion or change it manually.

After Registering — Where the Item Lives Now

A newly-registered bulk product is a normal Inventory item, so:

- It appears immediately in the business's main **Inventory** list, searchable and scannable exactly like anything else.

- **Edit Item** opens the standard item editor — you can change price, stock, category, supplier, and the Expense Classification fields there at any time, not just at registration.
- It's covered by the **Pricing, Cost & Value Exceptions** report (§66) and every other inventory report, using its real per-item cost.
- Adding more stock later, adjusting the reorder level, and everything else works the normal Inventory way — not through the Bulk Products modal's Top Up/Edit tools, which now only apply to items registered before this update (see the callout below).
- Unlike the old behaviour, the item does **not** auto-deactivate when it sells out — it stays visible with zero stock, like any other inventory item, until you restock or manually deactivate it.

Printing a Barcode Label

Right after registering, click 🖶 **Print Barcode Label** on the success screen to print a label immediately — this works the same way regardless of when you registered the product.

To print a label again later:

- **For a product registered before September 2026** — go to 📦 **Custom Bulk Products** (sidebar) or the Bulk Products modal's 📋 **Manage Existing** tab, find the row, and click 🖶 **Print**.
- **For a product registered since** — it's a normal Inventory item now, so print its label the same way you'd print a label for any other inventory item (from the Inventory list or Edit Item screen), not from the Bulk Products modal.

The print modal lets you:

- Select a **label template** (size, font, layout)
- Set the **quantity** of labels to print
- Send to a **receipt/label printer** or **save as PDF**

Stick the printed label on the container or shelf edge. Cashiers scan this label at the POS.

Selling a Custom Bulk Product at the POS

1. **Scan the barcode** on the container label at any POS terminal, or search by product name in the POS search bar.
2. The product is added to the cart at the selling price (e.g. $0.35).
3. Adjust the quantity to however many units the customer is buying.
4. Complete the sale normally.

The product's remaining stock decreases by the quantity sold. **For products registered before September 2026,** reaching zero automatically deactivates the product and it stops appearing in barcode lookups. **For products registered since,** it's a normal Inventory item — it stays visible with zero stock, like any other inventory item, until restocked or manually deactivated.

Stock Badge on POS Product Cards

Custom bulk products display a **remaining stock badge** on their product card in the POS grid — the same badge shown for regular inventory items:

Badge colour	Meaning
Grey	5 or more items remaining
Orange	Fewer than 5 items remaining
Red	Out of stock

The badge shows the count (e.g. **3 left**) so cashiers know at a glance whether a container is nearly empty before adding items to the cart.

Managing Existing Bulk Products

> **Legacy only, since September 2026.** Everything from here through "Searching in the Manage Tab" below applies only to bulk products registered **before** this update. A product registered since then is a normal Inventory item — manage its stock, price, and category from the main Inventory list and its Edit Item screen instead; it will not appear on this page or in the Bulk Products modal's Manage Existing tab.

Go to 📦 **Custom Bulk Products** in the left sidebar. The page shows all products — active, low-stock, and deactivated — in a single table:

Column	What it means
Product	Name, notes, and a **Deactivated** badge if the product is inactive
Batch / Barcode	Auto-generated batch number and barcode value
Category	Assigned category
Items Left	Remaining count with a colour-coded progress bar
Selling Price	Per-item price charged to customers
Container Cost	Original purchase cost of the full container (read-only guidance)
Added	Date registered
Actions	+ Top Up · Edit · 🖶 Print · Deactivate

Use the **Show inactive / sold-out** toggle to include deactivated products in the table. Use the search box to filter by name, batch number, or barcode. Click the **×** button that appears inside the search box to clear the filter instantly.

Restock Candidates Panel

Products that are low on stock or fully sold out appear in an **orange panel** at the top of the page. This includes:

- Active products with 5 or fewer items remaining
- Products that were automatically deactivated when they reached zero items

Each card shows the product name, batch number, a stock progress bar, and a **+ Top Up** button.

- **Click a card** to jump straight to that product's row in the table below (the row is highlighted in orange for 2 seconds so you can find it instantly).
- **Click + Top Up** on a card to open the top-up form for that product without scrolling.

Topping Up Stock (Restocking a Container)

When a new delivery arrives for an existing bulk product, use **Top Up** to add stock to the same product — the barcode and batch number stay the same, so existing labels remain valid.

To top up:

1. Click **+ Top Up** in the Actions column of a table row, or click **+ Top Up** on a Restock Candidates badge card.
2. The top-up form expands below the row showing the current state:
   - **Remaining stock** — how many items are left in the existing container
   - **Current selling price** — the price currently charged per item
   - **Current cost/item** — the original container cost divided by original item count (shown when a container cost was recorded)
3. Fill in the new delivery details:

Field	Required	Notes
New container item count	Yes	Number of individual items in the new delivery
New container cost ($)	No	What you paid for the new delivery
New selling price ($/item)	Yes	Pre-filled with the existing selling price — change it if pricing has changed

4. As you type, the system calculates and displays a **weighted average cost per item** — this blends the cost of remaining existing stock with the cost of the new delivery:

   ```
   Weighted avg = (remaining items × old cost/item + new container cost) ÷ (remaining + new items)
   ```

   This is shown in a blue panel and gives you a realistic cost basis for deciding your new selling price. A warning appears if the new selling price is below the weighted average cost.

5. Click **Confirm Top Up** to save.

What happens after a top-up:

- The item count increases by the number of new items added.
- The remaining count increases by the same amount.
- If the product was deactivated (stock had hit zero), it is automatically **reactivated** — it reappears in POS barcode lookups immediately.
- The selling price and container cost are updated to the new values you entered.
- The existing barcode and batch number are unchanged — no relabelling required.

> **Top Up is also available from the 📋 Manage Existing tab** inside the Bulk Products modal (accessible via the Bulk Stocking panel). The same weighted-average form appears there in compact form, including all three inputs and the calculated average cost guidance.

Editing a Bulk Product

Click **Edit** on any row. You can update:

- Product name
- **Selling price** — press **Enter** to save or **Escape** to cancel
- Notes

The **Container Cost** column is shown as read-only guidance during editing, including the calculated cost per item (e.g. `$0.33/item`) so you can set the selling price with full margin visibility.

> **Selling below cost warning:** If you set a selling price lower than the cost per item, the system shows a confirmation modal before saving. It displays the cost/item, the new selling price, and the resulting loss per item. You must confirm to proceed.

> Item count cannot be changed via Edit. Use **+ Top Up** to add stock to an existing product, or deactivate the old product and register a new one to correct a count error.

Updating the Price from the Bulk Products Modal

You can also update the selling price directly from the 📋 **Manage Existing** tab inside the Bulk Products modal (accessible from the Bulk Stocking panel):

1. Find the product in the list (use the **search box** to filter by name or batch number).
2. Click ✏ **Price** on the product row.
3. An inline editor expands showing:
    - **Container cost** and **cost per item** as read-only guidance
    - A **New price $** input — type the new selling price
4. Press **Enter** or click **Save**. Press **Escape** or click **Cancel** to dismiss without saving.

The same below-cost warning applies here.

Deactivate vs Delete

The action button label changes based on whether any items have been sold:

Button	When shown	What happens
Delete	No items have been sold yet	Permanently removes the product from the database
Deactivate	At least one item has been sold	Marks the product as inactive — it disappears from the POS but sales history is preserved

Use **Deactivate** when:

- The container is physically removed from sale before it is fully sold.

- You registered it with incorrect details but sales have already occurred.

Deactivated products appear in the Restock Candidates panel with a **Deactivated** badge. If new stock arrives, use **+ Top Up** to reactivate the product without creating a new record.

Searching in the Manage Tab

The 📋 **Manage Existing** tab inside the Bulk Products modal includes a search box. Type any part of the product name or batch number to filter the list in real time. Click the **×** inside the search box to clear it.

Dismissing the Drafts Modal

When opening the Bulk Stocking panel with existing saved drafts, a **Your Saved Drafts** screen appears. You can now close this screen by clicking the **×** button in the top-right corner — returning to the panel without selecting or creating a draft.

Inline Supplier Creation

When registering a new bulk product, if the supplier you need does not exist:

- Click **+ New supplier** under the Supplier dropdown — fill in the supplier form and save. The new supplier is immediately selected.

Bulk Stocking Panel — Receiving and Counting Stock

The **Bulk Stocking Panel** is a full-screen workspace used by stock managers to receive incoming deliveries and run formal stock takes. It is accessed from:

- **Clothing** → **Inventory** → 📦 **Bulk Stock**
- **Restaurant** → **POS** → 📦 **Bulk Stock** (admin only)
- **Grocery** → **POS** → 📦 **Bulk Stock**

The panel supports scanning many items in a single session, saving work in progress as named drafts, and submitting a full report with employee sign-off.

Barcode Input & Filter Bar — Clear Buttons

Both text inputs in the panel header have an inline **×** clear button:

Input	Clear button behaviour
Barcode field	Appears when text is present and the scanner is idle. Click **×** to clear the field and return focus to it — ready for the next scan.
Filter bar (below the table)	Appears when text is present. Click **×** to clear the filter and show all rows. A match count (e.g. *12 / 165*) shows how many rows are currently visible.

Opening the Panel — Draft Selection

When you open the Bulk Stocking panel, the system first checks for existing saved drafts:

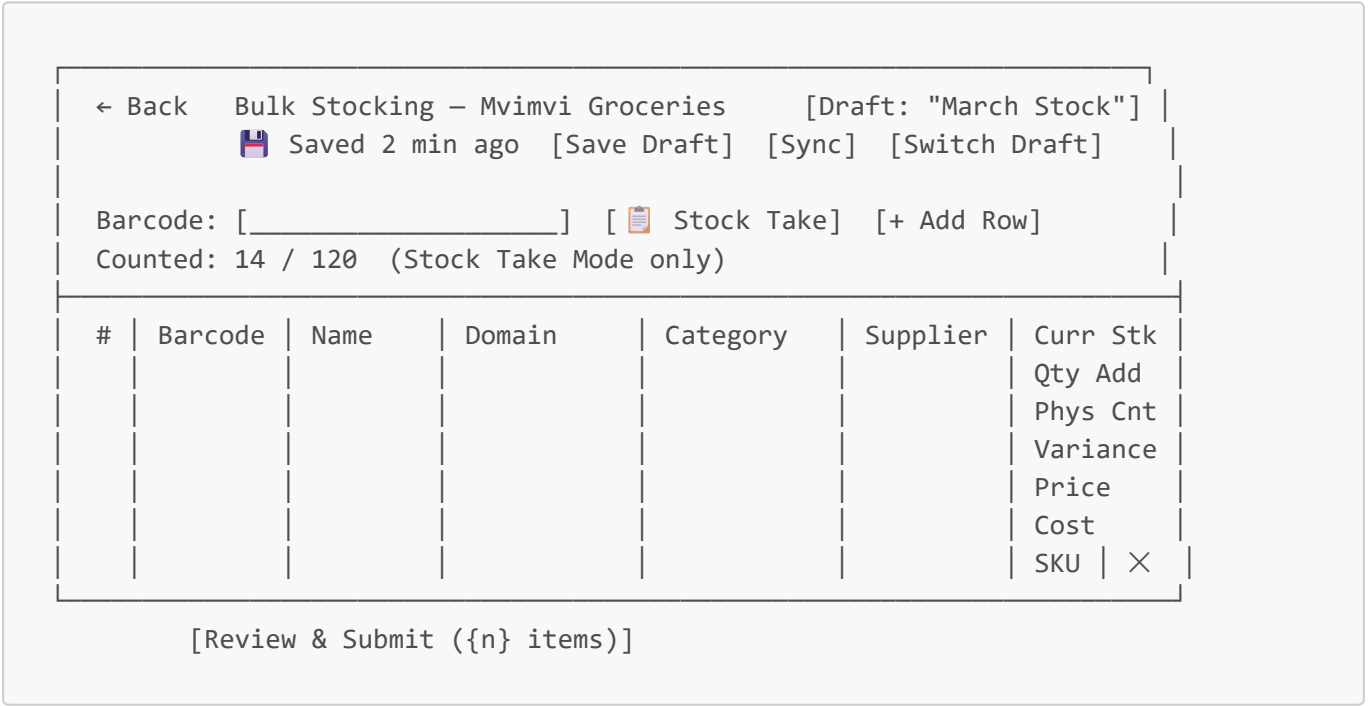
- **Spinner shown** — "Looking for drafts…" and the scan input is disabled until the check completes.
- **No drafts found** — a prompt asks you to enter a name for a new draft (required), then the panel opens ready to scan.
- **One or more drafts found** — a **Draft Selection screen** appears showing all your saved drafts for this business:
  - Draft name (e.g. "March Delivery" or "Full Store Count")
  - Number of items in the draft
  - Date and time last saved

From here:

- Click a draft to **Resume** it — all previously entered rows are restored.
- Click **+ Start New Draft** to enter a name and begin fresh (your previous drafts remain saved).

> You can have multiple named drafts open at the same time (e.g. one for each supplier delivery or one per section of the store). Use **Switch Draft** in the panel header to save the current draft and pick a different one.

The Panel Layout



Adding Items — Scanning or Manual Entry

Scan a barcode:

- Point your scanner at any product barcode or type the barcode value and press **Enter**.
- If the barcode **matches an existing product** in your inventory, a new row is added with the name, SKU, and current stock quantity pre-filled (read-only).

- If the barcode **is not found**, a blank row is added with the barcode pre-filled — fill in all details manually.

Duplicate detection:

- If the same barcode is already in the current batch, an alert appears: "Already in batch (row #N). Update that row or skip?" — click **Go to Row** to scroll to it, or **Skip** to dismiss.

Manual row: Click **+ Add Row** to add a blank row without scanning.

Table Columns

Column	Editable	Notes
Barcode	Read-only if from scan	Editable if manually added
Product Name	Read-only if existing match	Editable for new items
Domain	Yes	Top-level grouping (e.g. "🥦 Fresh Produce"). Optional. Available for all business types — see predefined taxonomy below.
Category	Yes	Sub-group within a domain (e.g. "Vegetables"). Required. Filtered by the selected domain.
Supplier	Yes	Searchable dropdown. Optional.
Description	Yes	Free text note. Optional.
Current Stock	Read-only / overridable	System quantity at last sync. In Stock Take mode you can override it — see Overriding the System Quantity below.
New Qty	Yes	How many new units you are receiving
Physical Count	Yes	What you counted on the shelf (for Stock Take mode — see below)
Variance	Read-only	Physical Count − Effective System Quantity. Red = shortfall, green = surplus. Only calculated when Physical Count is entered.
Sell Price	Yes	Selling price per unit. Tick **Free** for $0 items.
Cost Price	Yes	Optional purchase cost
SKU	Yes	Leave blank to auto-generate
✕	—	Remove the row from the batch

Auto-classify from name: After typing a product name, a 💡 icon appears in the row number column. Click it to get domain/category/sub-category suggestions based on the product name. See Bulk Stocking Panel — Auto-Classification for details.

Inline creation: If the domain, category, or supplier you need does not exist yet:

- Click **+ New category** below the Category dropdown — enter a name and save. It is immediately available in all rows and saved for future sessions.
- Click **+ New supplier** below the Supplier dropdown — same pattern.

Drafts — Saving and Managing

Action	How
Save now	Click **Save Draft** in the header
Auto-save	The panel saves automatically every 60 seconds when rows are present
Draft status	Shown as a pill: "💾 Saved 3 min ago" or "● Unsaved changes"
Rename draft	Click the draft name in the header to edit it inline — saves on blur
Switch drafts	Click **Switch Draft** — saves current work then shows the draft selection screen
Delete draft	Use the delete option in the draft selection screen

---

Submitting a Batch — Review & Submit

When all items are entered, click **Review & Submit**. This opens the **Stock Take Report Preview** — a full-screen summary before anything is committed:

Existing items section:

Column	What it shows
Barcode	Product barcode
Name	Product name
System Qty	Quantity recorded in the system at last sync
Physical Count	What you entered
Variance	Shortfall (red) or surplus (green)
New Stock Added	New Qty you entered
Sell Price	Per unit price
Shortfall Value	|Variance| × Sell Price (shown for shortfall rows)

New items section — products not previously in the system, with name, quantity, price, and new stock value.

Totals panel:

- Total shortfall quantity and value
- Total new stock value
- Estimated total inventory value after submit

Responsible employees (required):

- Select at least one employee from the dropdown.
- The system shows each employee's share of the shortfall (total shortfall value ÷ number of employees).
- Employees will receive a digital sign-off request after submission.

Click **Go Back** to return and make corrections. Click **Confirm & Submit** to apply all stock changes and create the report.

> **What happens on submit:** Stock quantities are updated immediately. The report enters **Pending Sign-off** status. Responsible employees must sign off digitally. A manager gives the final sign-off. Once all sign-offs are complete, the report is marked **Signed Off** and any shortfall deductions are available for payroll sync.

Overriding the System Quantity (Stock Take Mode)

Sometimes the system quantity recorded is known to be incorrect before you even begin counting — for example, a previous entry error or a unit that was lost and never logged. In Stock Take mode you can **override the system quantity for any row** without altering the live database. The override only affects the variance and shortfall calculations for this stock take report.

How to override:

1. In the **System Qty** column, click the small ✏️ pencil button to the right of the value. The button only appears for existing-item rows in Stock Take mode.
2. A modal opens showing:
    - The item name
    - A **New system qty** number input (pre-filled with the current value)
    - A **Reason** text area — this is **mandatory**
3. Enter the corrected quantity and type a clear reason (e.g. "*Previous count had a data entry error — confirmed via delivery note*").
4. Click **Apply Override**.

What you see after overriding:

- The System Qty cell turns **amber** and shows the overridden value.
- A small ⚑ **flag** appears next to the value — hover over it to see your reason.
- Variance and Shortfall Value are recalculated using the overridden quantity.
- The row stays flagged (amber System Qty + ⚑) until the draft is submitted.

Removing an override:

- Open the ✏️ modal again — a **Clear** button appears. Click it to restore the original system quantity.

Audit trail:

- The override value, reason, your username, and the timestamp are saved with the draft and included in the submitted report — managers reviewing the report can see exactly what was changed and why.

> **Important:** Overriding the system quantity does **not** change the actual stock in the database. It only adjusts the reference point used to calculate variance for this stock take. The final stock quantity applied on submit is always **Physical Count + New Qty**.

Stock Take Mode — Full Store Count

Stock Take Mode is a specialised version of the Bulk Stocking Panel designed for a complete physical inventory count.

Activating Stock Take Mode:

1. Open the Bulk Stocking panel (creating or resuming a draft).
2. Click the 📋 **Stock Take** button in the scan bar.
3. If you already have rows in the current draft, a confirmation appears: "This will start a new Stock Take draft. Your current work will be saved first. Continue?" — confirm to proceed.
4. Once activated, the mode is **locked for the lifetime of this draft** — the button changes to "📋 Stock Take Mode — Active" (greyed out, cannot be toggled off).

Loading inventory:

- The system immediately loads **all active inventory** for your business into the table. This includes all tracked products and variants.
- A loading overlay shows progress: "Loading inventory… 87 / 120 products".
- All rows are pre-filled with system quantities and are read-only for name/barcode. You only need to fill in the **Physical Count** column.

Counting items:

- In the **Physical Count** column, type what you counted on the shelf for each item.
- **Rows turn green** as soon as a physical count is entered — this gives you a clear visual of what has and hasn't been counted yet.
- A **"Counted: X / Y"** badge in the scan bar updates in real time.

Scanning a barcode during stock take:

- Scan any product barcode — if it is already in the list, the row **moves to the top of the table** and is highlighted so you can immediately enter its count. No duplicate warning appears — scanning an existing product is normal behaviour.
- If the barcode is not in the list (a new product), a new row is added at the top.

Resuming a Stock Take draft:

- When you resume a draft that was created in Stock Take Mode, the system automatically runs a sync to refresh all system quantities.
- After the sync, **all physical counts are reset to blank** so you start counting fresh with up-to-date system figures.
- A notice is shown: "Physical counts have been reset — synced stock levels are up to date."

Sales During a Stock Take — Sync & Submit Guard

Sales are **never blocked** while a stock take is in progress. The system tracks the impact automatically:

- When a sale occurs for a product that is in your active stock take draft, the draft is marked as having sales activity.
- Affected rows show an **amber highlight** with a "⚠ Review" badge and are sorted to the top of the table.
- A **warning banner** appears at the top of the panel:

> ⚠ Sales occurred since your last sync. Stock quantities may have changed. **[Sync Now]** | **[View Affected Rows]**

Syncing: Click **Sync Now** (or the **Sync** button in the header) to re-fetch the current system quantities for all affected rows. The affected row highlights are cleared after sync.

Submitting after sales: If sales occurred since your last sync, the **Review & Submit** button is disabled with a tooltip: "Sync required before submitting." You must sync first to ensure the report reflects accurate system quantities.

Item Type Badges (Stock Take Mode)

Each row shows a small badge to identify the item type:

Badge	Colour	Meaning
Stk	Blue	Regular tracked product (variant)
BCI	Teal	Barcode Inventory Item
Bulk	Purple	Custom Bulk Product
Bale	Orange	Clothing Bale

Sold Out / Restock Candidates (Stock Take Report Preview)

In the **Review & Submit** screen, when submitting in Stock Take Mode:

- A dedicated **"Sold Out / Zero Stock — Restock Candidates"** section appears in orange.
- It lists all items where your physical count is zero OR the system quantity is zero.
- This is informational only — it does not affect the stock update. Use it as a procurement checklist.

Stock Take Reports

Go to **Inventory** → 📋 **Stock Take Reports** (button in the inventory page header — visible to users with financial data access).

Each report shows:

Column	Meaning
Date	When the stock take was submitted
Employees	Responsible employees — green tick = signed, grey = pending

Column	Meaning
Status	Pending Sign-off / Signed Off / Voided
Shortfall	Total value of missing stock
New Stock Value	Total value of stock received
Submitted by	User who submitted

Signing off a report:

1. Click **View** on a report.
2. Each responsible employee can click **Sign Off** against their own name (only visible to that employee or a manager acting on their behalf).
3. Once all employees have signed, the manager signs off using **Sign Off as Manager**.
4. Status changes to **Signed Off** with a timestamp.

After sign-off: Shortfall deductions are now available to pull into payroll — the manager clicks **Sync Stock Shortfall** on the payroll period page.

Voiding a report: Managers can click **Void** on any report with **Pending Sign-off** status. This marks it as voided — stock quantities that were already applied are **not** reversed. Use this if the count was done incorrectly and needs to be restarted.

> **Admin note:** If a stock take draft with Stock Take Mode enabled is blocking sales for a business (e.g. the count was abandoned and the cashier cannot process transactions), a system administrator can force-delete it from **Admin** → **Blocking Stock Take Drafts**. See Admin — Blocking Stock Take Drafts.

Merging Duplicate Inventory Items

If the same product was accidentally created twice (e.g. "Miller Genuine Draft Beer" appearing twice with separate stock quantities), managers can merge them into a single record without losing any stock data.

> **Who can merge:** Managers and business owners only.

Starting a Merge

1. On any inventory page (Grocery, Clothing, Hardware, or Restaurant), click 🔀 **Merge Mode** in the toolbar.
2. Checkboxes appear on every row — the grid switches to selection mode.
3. Tick **two or more** items you want to merge.
4. A **Merge** button appears in the toolbar showing the count (e.g. *Merge 2 items*).
5. Click **Merge** to open the confirmation modal.

The Merge Modal

Field	Description
Winner	The item that survives — auto-selected as the one with the highest current stock.

Field	Description
Being merged	All other selected items — they are deactivated after the merge.
Combined stock	Total units that will be on the winner after the merge.
Final name	Editable — defaults to the winner's name. Change it if neither original name is ideal.

The modal uses a **two-step confirm** for safety: first click turns the button amber with a warning; second click (red) executes the merge. This action is permanent.

What Happens After a Merge

- The winner's stock quantity is increased by the sum of all merged items' stock.
- An **ADJUSTMENT** stock movement is recorded on the winner, labelled *"Merged from [item names]"* — visible in the stock movements log as the audit trail.
- All merged items are marked **inactive** and no longer appear in the inventory list.

Exiting Merge Mode

Click **Exit Merge** (or 🔀 **Merge Mode** again) to return to the normal inventory view. Any unconfirmed selections are discarded.

Inventory Activity Report — Per-Item Stock History

The **Activity Report** shows a day-by-day breakdown of stock movements for a single inventory item: units received, sold, adjusted, lost, and any unexplained variance.

Opening the Report

- From the inventory grid, click the 📊 button in the item's Actions column.
- Or open an item's detail view and click 📊 **Activity**.

Reading the Report

Each row represents one calendar day:

Column	What it shows
Date	The calendar day
Added	Units received into stock (restocked)
Sold	Units sold at the POS
Adjusted	Manual stock corrections
Lost	Units marked as lost or damaged
Variance	Unexplained difference between expected and actual closing stock

Showing and Hiding Blank Days

Days with no activity are included by default.

- Click **Hide blank days** to collapse them and show only days with actual movement. The button switches to **Show blank days** to restore the full view.
- When blank days are hidden, a **dashed amber line** and a `+Nd` **badge** appear between any two non-consecutive dates, indicating how many days were skipped. For example, `+4d` between two rows means four consecutive days had no activity.

Printing / Saving as PDF

Click **Print / Save PDF** — a new browser window opens with a clean, print-ready version of the report. Blank days are always removed from the printed version automatically to save paper. Use your browser's **Print** → **Save as PDF** option to create a PDF copy.

Barcode Templates — Creating and Using Label Designs

A **barcode template** is a saved label design. It stores the visual layout (font size, paper size, what to print) AND default product data (name, price, size, colour). Once a template is set up, anyone can create a perfectly formatted product label just by scanning the barcode.

When to Create a Template

Create a template when:

- You receive the same product line regularly and want to label items consistently.
- You want to pre-define the price and name so staff cannot accidentally enter them wrong.
- You want to scan a barcode to instantly create a product with all details pre-filled.

Creating a Template

1. Go to **Universal** → **Barcode Management** → **Templates** → **New Template**.
2. Fill in the **Product details**:
    - **Template name** — e.g. "Ladies T-Shirt $2.50"
    - **Product name** — the name that will appear on the label
    - **Barcode value** — the actual barcode number (scan it in or type it)
    - **Default price** — the selling price pre-filled when creating a product from this template
    - **Default size** — e.g. "M", "XL", "One Size"
    - **Default colour** — e.g. "Assorted"
    - **Batch ID** — optional grouping reference
    - **Type** — choose the business type (clothing, grocery, hardware, etc.)
3. Fill in the **Label layout**:
    - **Paper size** — A4 (for laser/inkjet), Label 2×1 or Label 4×2 (for dedicated label printers), Receipt strip (for receipt printers)
    - **Orientation** — Portrait or Landscape
    - **Barcode symbology** — CODE128 is the most universal; EAN-13 for standard retail products

- **Width / Height** — label dimensions in millimetres
- **Display value** — tick this to print the barcode number below the bars (recommended)
- **Font size** — size of the human-readable text
- **Background colour / Line colour** — leave as white/black unless you have a specific need

4. Click **Save Template**.

How a Label Looks When Printed

Labels generated from templates follow this layout (top to bottom):

```
┌──────────────────────────────┐
│  BUSINESS NAME               │  ← bold, centred
│  Product Name                │  ← centred
│  Description (if any)        │
│  Size: XL                    │  ← large text
│  Batch: BALE-HXI-042  Qty:5  │
│  ┌────────────────────┐      │
│  │ ||| BARCODE |||    │      │  ← scannable barcode
│  │ 1234567890123      │      │  ← number below bars
│  └────────────────────┘      │
│  SKU: BALE-HXI-042           │
│  $2.50                       │  ← price, very large
│  Colour: Assorted            │
│  Template: Ladies T-Shirt    │  ← small footer
├──────────────────────────────┤  ← fold / cut line
```

> For thermal label printers (e.g. Zebra, HPRT), the print job uses ESC/POS commands and prints immediately. For laser or inkjet printers, the system produces a grid of labels on A4 (3 columns × 6 rows = 18 labels per page) with cut guides.

Printing Labels from a Template

1. Go to **Universal → Barcode Management → Print Jobs → New Print Job**.
2. Select your template.
3. Choose the item type:
   - **Product** — prints a label for an existing product
   - **Bale** — prints a label for a bale (pre-fills from bale record)
   - **Custom** — manually enter the data for this print run
4. Enter **quantity** (how many labels to print — up to 1,000).
5. Select the printer.
6. Click **Print**.

The job is added to the print queue with status **Queued → Processing → Completed**. You can track it under **Barcode Management → Print Queue**.

Editing or Deactivating a Template

1. Go to **Universal → Barcode Management → Templates**.

2. Find the template and click **Edit**.
3. Make changes and save — existing labels already printed are not affected.
4. To stop the template appearing in print job dropdowns, toggle **Active** to off.

> The template list shows **usage count** and **last used date** so you can see which templates are actively in use.

Copying a Product to Another Business

If you sell the same product or service across multiple businesses — for example a "Cellphone Charge" service offered at both a clothing shop and a grocery store — you can copy an existing product definition from one business to another without re-entering it manually. The copy includes the product name, prices, barcode definitions, and attributes. Stock starts at zero in the target business.

Who can use this

Any user who is a member of **both** the source and the target business. Admins can copy between any businesses.

Business type compatibility

The system only offers compatible businesses in the target dropdown:

Source business type	Can copy to
Restaurant	Other restaurant businesses only
Grocery, Clothing, Hardware, Retail, Services, Other	Any non-restaurant business

Restaurant menu items contain food-specific fields (ingredients, allergens, preparation time) that are not meaningful outside a restaurant context, so cross-type copying is blocked for that type.

How to copy a product

1. Go to **Inventory** for the business that has the product you want to copy.
2. Find the product in the inventory list — use the search box to locate it quickly.
3. Click the 📋 button in the Actions column for that product row (on mobile, tap 📋 **Copy** in the card action buttons).
4. The **Copy to Another Business** modal opens. Type in the search box to filter your businesses by name or type.
5. Click the target business to select it — a ✓ **BusinessName selected** confirmation appears below the search box.
6. Click **Copy to [Business Name]**.

A green banner confirms the copy was successful. The product now appears in the target business's inventory with zero stock.

What is copied

Field	Copied
Product name	✅
Description	✅
SKU	✅
Selling price	✅
Cost price	✅
Barcode definitions	✅
Product attributes (PLU code, brand, etc.)	✅
Stock quantity	❌ — starts at 0
Category	✅ Auto-matched — see below
Supplier, location	❌ — business-specific, set these after copying

Category auto-matching

The system tries to place the copied product into the correct category in the target business automatically, in this order:

1. **Same category ID** — if the exact category exists in the target, it is used.
2. **Same category name** — if a category with a similar name exists in the target (e.g. "Service" in clothing matches "Services" in grocery), that category is used.
3. **Alphabetical fallback** — if no name match is found, the product is placed in the first available category alphabetically. You can reassign it afterwards.

This means a service product copied from a clothing business to a grocery business will be placed in the grocery **Services** category automatically.

If the SKU already exists in the target

The copy is blocked and an error is shown: *"A product with SKU '...' already exists in [Business Name]."* This prevents accidental duplicates. Either edit the existing product in the target business or delete it first if you want a clean copy.

After copying — making the product available at the POS

Once copied, the product appears in the target business's inventory list immediately.

For physical products: The product appears in the POS once it has a price greater than zero. Add opening stock via **Inventory** → **Receive Stock** before selling.

For service products (no stock): The service appears automatically in the POS with no stock step required. In the **Grocery POS**, service products appear directly in the Desk Mode product grid under the **Services** category tab — tap the tile to add to cart. No stock quantity is shown because services do not deplete.

To add a product to **Quick Add** (category-pinned shortcuts in the POS), open the POS, switch to the category tab, and click the **pin icon** on the product card.

Receiving stock after copying (physical products only)

After copying a physical product, it has zero stock in the target business. To add opening stock:

1. Go to **Inventory** → **Receive Stock** for the target business.
2. Search for the copied product by name or SKU.
3. Enter the quantity and click **Receive Stock**.

---

15. Restaurant Menu Management

> **Who reads this:** Restaurant managers and owners who maintain the menu.

Menu Structure Overview

The restaurant menu is organised into **categories** (e.g., Starters, Mains, Beverages, Desserts) and **items** within each category. Each item can optionally have **variants** for different sizes or options (e.g., Small / Large, Regular / Extra Spicy).

Creating a Menu Category

Before adding items, ensure the correct category exists:

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **Menu**.
2. Click **Add Category** (or use the category field in the item form — it includes a "Create New" option inline).
3. Fill in:
    - **Name** — e.g., "Grills", "Cold Drinks", "Sides"
    - **Emoji** — choose an emoji to represent the category (e.g., 🥩 for Grills)
    - **Colour** — pick a colour used for the category button in the POS
    - **Display order** — lower number = appears first
4. Save.

The category appears immediately as a filter tab in the POS.

Adding a Menu Item

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **Menu** → **Add Menu Item**.
2. Fill in the details:

Field	Notes
Name *(required)*	What appears on the POS and receipt (e.g., "Chicken Burger")
Category *(required)*	Choose from existing categories or create one inline

Field	Notes
Base Price *(required)*	The standard selling price
Original Price	The "was" price — shown with a strikethrough if set (for promotions)
Discount %	Automatic percentage off the base price
Description	Shown on the customer display screen
Preparation time	Minutes — informational, for kitchen display
Spice level	1 (mild), 2 (medium), 3 (hot)
Calories	Informational
Dietary flags	Tick any that apply: Vegetarian, Vegan, Gluten Free, etc.
Allergens	Tick any that apply: Nuts, Dairy, Eggs, Wheat, etc.
Available	Toggle off to hide the item from the POS without deleting it
Barcode	Optional — assign a barcode so the item can be scanned at the till

3. Click **Save Menu Item**.

Adding Variants (Small / Large, Options)

If the same dish is sold in different sizes or options at different prices, use variants instead of creating separate items.

On the item form:

1. Scroll to the **Variants** section.
2. Click **Add Variant**.
3. For each variant enter:
    - **Variant name** — e.g., "Regular", "Large", "Boneless"
    - **Price** — can differ from the base price
    - **Available** — toggle off if a size is temporarily out
4. Add as many variants as needed.
5. Save.

At the POS, when the cashier adds this item to the cart, a size/option picker appears for them to choose which variant.

Cloning a Menu Item

If you need a new item that is similar to an existing one (e.g., a variant without the size picker, or a seasonal special based on an existing dish):

1. On the Menu page, hover over the item card.
2. Click **Clone** (or the duplicate icon).
3. The system copies all fields except the ID, barcode, and image.

4. The name is pre-filled as **"[Original Name] (Copy)"** — rename it.
5. Adjust the price, category, and any other details.
6. Click **Save** — a new product is created.

> Cloning is the fastest way to build out a menu when many items share similar settings (e.g., a range of burgers that differ only in name and price).

Marking an Item as Unavailable

If an ingredient runs out or a dish is temporarily off the menu:

1. Find the item on the Menu page.
2. Click the **availability toggle** (the on/off switch on the item card).
3. The item is immediately hidden from the POS.
4. Toggle it back on when it is available again.

> Use "Unavailable" for temporary situations. Use **Delete** only if the item will never be sold again — deletion removes all historical data links.

Menu Promotions

To run a promotion on a specific item (e.g., "20% off all burgers on Tuesdays"):

1. Open the item for editing.
2. Set the **Original Price** to the current price.
3. Set the **Discount %** to 20 (or the **Discounted Price** directly).
4. The POS will show the strikethrough original price and the new lower price.
5. Remove the original price and reset the discount when the promotion ends.

For buy-one-get-one or min-order promotions, use **Restaurant** → **Promotions** (a separate promotions module that applies rules automatically at checkout).

15a. Services as Products — Selling Services via Barcode

> **Who reads this:** Any business that sells services (labour, access, utilities) alongside physical products.

A **service** is any non-physical item you charge for — examples include:

- Cellphone charging (e.g., $0.50 per charge)
- Shoe repair / alterations (clothing store)
- Device repair assessment fee
- Consultation fee
- Parking fee
- Access fee (e.g., pool, gym)

Services are created exactly like products but with **no stock quantity** — they never run out.

Creating a Service Item

1. Go to your business's **Products / Inventory** → **Add Product** (or **Restaurant** → **Menu** → **Add Item**).
2. Fill in:
    - **Name** — e.g., "Phone Charging", "Trouser Hem", "Shoe Sole Repair"
    - **Category** — select or create a "Services" category
    - **Price** — the fee charged
    - **Barcode** — assign a barcode (type one in or scan a sticker) so the cashier can add it by scanning
    - **Stock tracking** — set to **None** or leave quantity blank — services do not deplete stock
    - **Description** — optional, shown on the customer display
3. Save.

The service appears in the POS and can be added to any order just like a physical product. In the **Grocery POS**, it appears as a tile in the Desk Mode grid under the **Services** category tab — no stock receiving required.

> **Tip — offering the same service at multiple businesses:** Use the **Copy to Another Business** feature (Section 14) to copy a service from one business to another. The category is matched automatically so it lands in the correct Services tab at the target business.

Assigning a Barcode to a Service

Assign a barcode so the cashier does not have to type the service name — they simply scan a sticker placed at the counter.

Option A — Assign during creation:

- In the product form, click the **Barcode** field and scan a barcode sticker (or type in a code).
- Save.

Option B — Assign after creation:

1. Open the service item.
2. Go to the **Barcodes** tab.
3. Click **Add Barcode**.
4. Scan a sticker or enter the code manually.
5. Set as Primary.
6. Save.

Print a barcode sticker label (via **Barcode Management** → **Print Jobs**) and stick it at the service point. The cashier scans it to add the service to the cart instantly.

Example: Cellphone Charging at a Clothing Store

1. Create a product: Name = "Phone Charging", Category = "Services", Price = $0.50, Barcode = (scan a sticker), No stock tracking.
2. Print a label and stick it next to the charging station.
3. When a customer wants to charge their phone:
    - Cashier scans the sticker.
    - "Phone Charging $0.50" appears in the cart.

    - Process payment.
    - Receipt is printed as normal — the service appears as a line item.
4. If the customer is a loyalty card holder, the $0.50 is added to their monthly spend total and counts toward campaign thresholds.

Services in Combos

A service can be bundled into a combo deal just like a physical product — e.g., "Meal + Phone Charge" for $6.00. See the Combos section in the menu/POS settings to set this up.

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16. Quick Reference Cards

Quick Reference: POS Cashier

```
MAKING A SALE
──────────────────────────────────────────────
1. Search product name OR scan barcode
2. Click to add to cart
3. Adjust quantity if needed
4. (Optional) Select customer
5. (Optional) Apply coupon code
6. Click CHARGE / PAY NOW
7. Choose payment method
8. Enter amount received (for cash)
9. Click COMPLETE SALE
10. Print receipt
──────────────────────────────────────────────

SCANNING BALES / BULK PRODUCTS / BARCODE ITEMS
  Scan the container/shelf label barcode
  Product appears in cart at its unit price
  Adjust quantity to units being purchased

PAYMENT METHODS
  Cash   → Enter received amount → change is shown
  Card   → Select Card → confirm
  Split  → Enter cash amount first → remaining on card

COUPONS
  Click "Add Coupon" → type code → discount applied

CANCEL A SALE
  Click "Clear Cart" (before payment only)
  After payment → call manager
```

Quick Reference: Stock Take

```
BULK STOCKING — RECEIVING A DELIVERY
──────────────────────────────────────────────────
1. Inventory → 📦 Bulk Stock
2. Name your draft (e.g. "March Delivery") → Open
3. Scan each item barcode
   → Existing item: name/price pre-filled, enter Qty
   → New item: fill in all details
4. Set Domain, Category, Supplier per row (optional)
5. Click Save Draft to pause / auto-saves every 60s
6. Click Review & Submit when done
7. Select responsible employees → Confirm & Submit
──────────────────────────────────────────────────

RUNNING A STOCK TAKE (full count)
──────────────────────────────────────────────────
1. Inventory → 📦 Bulk Stock → click 📋 Stock Take
2. Confirm to start new Stock Take draft
3. System loads ALL active inventory automatically
4. Enter Physical Count for each item on the shelf
5. Scan barcode → row moves to top for fast entry
6. Rows turn GREEN when counted
   "Counted: X / Y" shows progress
7. Click Review & Submit → select employees → Confirm
──────────────────────────────────────────────────

IF SALES OCCUR DURING A STOCK TAKE
  Amber rows with ⚠ Review badge appear
  Warning banner shows at top of panel
  Click "Sync Now" to refresh quantities
  Submit button blocked until synced

MULTIPLE DRAFTS
  Can have multiple named drafts at once
  Switch Draft button saves current, shows list
  Resume any draft from the draft selection screen

AFTER SUBMITTING
  Stock updated immediately
  Report: Pending Sign-off
  Each responsible employee signs digitally
  Manager gives final sign-off → Signed Off
  Shortfall available for Payroll → Sync Stock Shortfall

ITEM TYPE BADGES (in table)
  Stk  (blue)   = Regular product
  BCI  (teal)   = Barcode inventory item
  Bulk (purple) = Custom bulk product
  Bale (orange) = Clothing bale

VOIDING A REPORT (manager only)
  Inventory → 📋 Stock Take Reports → View → Void
  Stock changes already applied are NOT reversed
```

```
CUSTOM BULK PRODUCTS
──────────────────────────────────────────────
REGISTER:  Bulk Stocking → 📦 Bulk Product
           Fill name, item count, unit price
           Click Generate for auto barcode

PRINT LABEL:
  After register → 🖨 Print Barcode Label
  OR: 📦 Custom Bulk Products (sidebar) → 🖨 Print

SELLING: Scan container label at POS
         Remaining count decreases per item sold
```

Quick Reference: Cash Office (End of Day)

```
EOD CHECKLIST
──────────────────────────────────────────────
□ Count all physical cash
□ Open Expense Accounts → Payment Batches (or EOD)
□ Confirm date range covers today
□ Enter physical cash count
□ Note any discrepancies
□ Submit reconciliation
□ Manager reviews and approves
──────────────────────────────────────────────

PAYROLL CASH WITHDRAWAL
□ Receive voucher from manager
□ Count cash as per voucher per cash box
□ Hand cash to payroll officer
□ Both parties sign voucher
□ System updates automatically
```

Quick Reference: Manager — Payroll

```
PAYROLL CHECKLIST
──────────────────────────────────────────────
□ Payroll → New Period → set dates → Create
□ Click ⟳ Sync All (absences + clock-in)
□ Click 📋 Sync Stock Shortfall (if stock takes
  were signed off this period)
□ Review all employee entries
  - Per Diem column visible in table (read-only)
  - Stock shortfall deductions shown in entry detail
□ Check total needed vs. account balance
□ If short → Fund Payroll → print voucher
```

```
□ Submit for Owner Approval
□ Owner Approves → Export to Excel
□ Make all payments
□ Reconcile and Close period
──────────────────────────────────────────────

EXPORT INCLUDES
  Basic, Commission, Overtime, Per Diem,
  Benefits, Advances, Loans, Gross, Net

APPROVING EXPENSE REQUESTS
  Bell icon → Pending Actions → Open item
  Review → Approve OR Decline (add reason)
```

Quick Reference: Manager — Reports

```
WHERE TO FIND REPORTS
──────────────────────────────────────────────
Sales          → Reports → Sales Summary
Payroll        → Payroll → Account → Reports
Expenses       → Expense Accounts → Reports
Customers      → Customers → Reports
Cash Bucket    → Cash Bucket → Report
Petty Cash     → Petty Cash → Reports
Chicken Run    → Chicken Run → Reports
Employees      → Employees → Clock-In → Reports
──────────────────────────────────────────────

TO SAVE A REPORT
  Set filters → click Save Report → give it a name
  Find again under Reports → Saved Reports

TO EXPORT
  Set filters → Export CSV (for Excel)
              → Export PDF (for printing/sharing)
```

Quick Reference: Employee (Clock-In & Leave)

```
CLOCK IN
──────────────────────────────────────────────
  Employees → Clock-In → Find your name
  → Click CLOCK IN

CLOCK OUT
  Employees → Clock-In → Find your record
  → Click CLOCK OUT
```

```
FORGOT? → Tell your manager immediately
  Manager can manually add or fix the entry:
  Employees → Clock-In → Records → Edit/Add Entry

_____________________________________________


LEAVE REQUEST
  Employees → Your Name → Time Off
  → Request Time Off → choose type & dates
  → Submit
  (manager gets notified and approves/declines)

PER DIEM
  1. Get blank form: Employees → Per Diem → Request Form → Print
  2. Fill in dates, amounts, purpose (by hand)
  3. Get manager to sign the Approver line
  4. HR/cashier enters approved data:
     Employees → Per Diem → New Entry
     → Select employee + month/year
     → Add one row per travel day (date, amount, purpose)
     → Save
  5. Per diem is automatically included in payroll export for that month
```

Quick Reference: Petty Cash

```
REQUEST PETTY CASH
──────────────────────────────────────────────
  Petty Cash → New Request
  → Enter amount & reason → Submit
  (wait for approval notification)

APPROVAL RELEASES THE CASH
  Approval debits the cash bucket automatically
  → no separate "collect from cashier" step

RECORD SPENDING AS YOU GO
  Petty Cash → your request → + Record Spend
  (+ Record EcoCash Spend for EcoCash requests)

RETURN WHAT'S LEFT OVER
  CASH:    → Return unused funds → cashier confirms receipt → Settled
  ECOCASH: → Settle Request (self-settle, one step) → Settled
──────────────────────────────────────────────


STATUS MEANINGS
  Pending             = waiting for manager approval
  Approved            = cash released, spending in progress
  Awaiting Settlement = CASH only — return reported, awaiting cashier confirmation
  Settled             = unused funds returned and confirmed
  Cancelled           = withdrawn before approval
```

Quick Reference: Chicken Run

```
DAILY ROUTINE
──────────────────────────────────────────────
□ Check dashboard for alerts
□ Record morning feed (batch → Feed Log)
□ Record any deaths (batch → Mortality Log)
□ Record weight check if weigh day
□ Check vaccination schedule for due vaccines

STARTING A BATCH
  Chicken Run → New Batch
  → Enter chick count, arrival date, supplier
  → Start Batch

HARVEST / PROCESSING
  Inventory → select batch → Record Harvest
  → enter count and weight → save
──────────────────────────────────────────────


ALERTS
```

```
  Red warning = mortality > 5% → tell manager immediately
  Orange warning = low inventory → plan purchase
```

Quick Reference: WiFi Tokens

```
SELL A TOKEN (via POS)
──────────────────────────────────────────────
  Open POS → search WiFi package name
  → add to cart → process payment
  → print receipt (token credentials on receipt)
  → give receipt to customer

TOKEN IS THEIR PASSWORD — ONE USE ONLY

CHECK AVAILABILITY
  Product card shows count (e.g., "12 available")
  If low → click "Request 5 More"
──────────────────────────────────────────────

DIRECT SALE (not via POS)
  R710 Portal → Sales → New Direct Sale

ADMIN-ISSUED LONG-TERM TOKEN (workstations, not customers)
  Package must be flagged "Admin-issued" + $0 price
  Max 1 year (365 days) — R710 device hard limit, not adjustable
  Check WLAN's own "Token Validity (Days)" too — it can override the package
  [Business] → R710 Menu Config → 🔐 Issue Long-Term Access
  System Admin or that business's owner only
  Revoke = Invalidate (blocks device's MAC if connected)
```

---

17. Suppliers & Payees

> **Who reads this:** Managers and accounts staff who create and maintain the supplier list used in expense accounts, rent accounts, and purchase orders.

What Is a Supplier / Payee?

A **supplier** (also called a payee) is any business or individual that your company pays money to. This includes:

- Goods suppliers (wholesale grocers, clothing bale vendors, hardware merchants)
- Service providers (cleaners, security firms, IT contractors)
- Landlords (for rent payments)
- Utilities (electricity, water, internet)
- Any recurring or one-off payee

Suppliers are recorded in the system so that payments can be linked to the correct payee, expense account reports show who was paid, and the manager can see spending patterns per supplier.

Adding a Supplier

1. Go to **Suppliers** in the menu (or **Expense Accounts → Suppliers → New Supplier**).
2. Fill in the required fields:
    - **Name** *(required)* — the trading name of the supplier or individual
    - **Phone number** *(required)* — used for contact and verification
3. Fill in the optional fields (recommended for a complete record):
    - **Contact person** — the name of your point of contact at the supplier
    - **Email address** — for sending purchase orders or payment remittances
    - **Tax ID / VAT number** — the supplier's tax registration number (needed for VAT-registered businesses)
    - **Physical address** — delivery or correspondence address
    - **Supplier type** — choose the most appropriate type:
        - **General** — for most suppliers
        - **Landlord** — for property owners you pay rent to (these are shared across all your businesses)
        - **Utility** — electricity, water, internet, etc.
        - **Service** — labour contractors, cleaners, security, etc.
4. Click **Save Supplier**.

The supplier is now available in dropdown menus when creating expense payment requests, payment batches, and rent accounts.

Suppliers vs Landlords — Key Differences

Although landlords are a type of supplier, they behave differently in the system. Understanding the distinction prevents confusion when setting up rent accounts or expense payments.

	Regular Supplier	**Landlord**
Purpose	Goods, services, utilities — anything you buy or pay for	Property owner you pay rent to
Tied to a business?	Yes — each business has its own supplier list	**No — landlords are global** and shared across all businesses
Where created	Suppliers menu	Suppliers menu **or** directly from the Rent Account → Manage screen
Used in	Expense payment requests, payment batches, purchase orders	Rent Account configuration only
Appears in expense dropdowns?	Yes	No — landlords only appear in the Rent Account landlord picker

	Regular Supplier	Landlord
Can be linked to multiple businesses?	No — supplier belongs to one business	Yes — one landlord record can be the landlord for multiple business locations

Practical example:

> You have three shops — a grocery, a clothing store, and a restaurant — all renting from the same property company "Harare Properties Ltd". You create **one** landlord record for "Harare Properties Ltd". Each shop's rent account then links to that single landlord record. When you search for the landlord in any shop's rent account, it appears because landlords are global.

> By contrast, your grocery's flour supplier "City Millers" only appears when you are in the grocery's expense accounts — it does not appear in the clothing store's supplier list.

Landlord Suppliers — Setup Detail

Landlords are handled separately from regular suppliers:

- They are **global** — not tied to a specific business. A landlord you add can be linked to any business's rent account.
- They are created either from the **Suppliers** menu (choose type = Landlord) or directly from the **Rent Account** → **Manage** screen using the **+ Add Landlord** quick-add form.
- The quick-add form pre-fills the name from whatever you typed in the search box — so if you searched "Harare Properties" and found nothing, clicking **+ Add Landlord** opens a form with "Harare Properties" already filled in.
- If a landlord name already exists in the system, the system will find it by search — you should link to the existing record rather than creating a duplicate.

Required for a landlord:

- Name
- Phone number

Editing or Deactivating a Supplier

1. Go to **Suppliers** and find the supplier.
2. Click **Edit**.
3. Update any details and click **Save**.

To deactivate a supplier (so they no longer appear in dropdown menus):

1. Open the supplier record.
2. Toggle **Active** to off.
3. Save.

Deactivated suppliers are hidden from new transactions but their historical payment records are preserved.

Supplier Payment History

To see all payments made to a specific supplier:

1. Open the supplier record.
2. Click the **Payments** tab.
3. The full list of expense payments, batch payments, and rent payments linked to this supplier is shown, with dates and amounts.

Attaching Receipts to Expense Payments

> **Who reads this:** Cashiers and managers who process expense account payments. Physical receipts can be captured after a payment is recorded — even days later.

Each expense account payment can have one or more receipts attached to it. A receipt records the actual physical document details: the date on the receipt, the amount, a description of what was purchased, and which supplier or individual was paid.

The Receipt Badge

On the transaction history table, every payment row has a small receipt icon (🧾) at the right side:

Badge appearance	Meaning
🧾 **N** (green, with a number)	N receipts are already attached — click to view or add more
🧾 (grey, no number)	No receipt yet — click to attach the first one

Payments that require receipt accountability (combo pay disbursements, and any payment flagged **"This is an advance"** — see Combo Payment Requests) show a different, colour-coded version of this badge instead, showing the dollar total of receipts entered so far:

Badge colour	Meaning
🟢 **Green**	Receipts have been reviewed and **approved** by a cashier — fully accounted for
🟠 **Orange**	Receipts submitted or still being added, less than 7 days since the funds were issued
🔴 **Red**	Still not approved after 7 days — overdue

Hovering over this badge shows a small popup with the review status, the total entered so far, the expected amount, and the remaining balance (which reads $0.00 once fully accounted for).

The Project Badge

Payment rows also show a **project badge** (📁) when the business has active projects:

Badge appearance	Meaning
📁 **ProjectName** (indigo/purple, with name)	Payment is linked to that project — click to reassign or unlink

Badge appearance	Meaning
📁 (grey, no label)	No project assigned — click to assign one

Clicking either state opens a compact **inline dropdown** directly on the row. Select a project to link it, or choose **— No project —** to remove an existing link. The change takes effect immediately — no page reload needed.

Attaching the First Receipt

1. In the transaction history, find the payment row and click the grey 📄 icon.
2. The **Add Receipt** form opens.

Step 1 — Payee:

- If the payment already has a known payee, their name is shown and pre-selected. Click **Change** if the receipt is from a different person or supplier.
- If no payee is recorded, click **Select** and type to search.
- As you type, matching individuals, suppliers, and contractors appear in a dropdown. Select the correct one.
- If the payee does not exist yet, create one directly from the search results — the newly created payee is attached to this receipt automatically, no extra selection step needed:
  - **+ Create individual** — a person who isn't a contractor (full name, optional national ID, phone, service category).
  - **+ Create contractor** — a person doing contract work (same fields as individual, plus a contractor category).
  - **+ Create supplier** — a real supplier record with a generated supplier number, products/services supplied, and a supplier category (e.g. "Building Materials") — the same kind of record created from the **Suppliers** menu (see Suppliers & Payees), just without needing to leave the receipt form. A supplier created this way isn't tied to any one business.
- If it's a one-time or unknown vendor not worth saving as a permanent record — click **Use "[name]" as one-time payee** instead. The name is stored on this receipt only; no Person, Business, or Supplier record is created, and it won't offer to update the payment's registered payee.
- ↻ **Use last payee** — when you've entered a receipt before on this device, this button appears offering to reuse that same payee with one click. Handy when adding several receipts in a row for the same vendor.

> **National ID is optional** when creating an individual or contractor payee on the fly — some vendors don't have one. When entered, pick the right **ID Format Template** first (e.g. Zimbabwe National ID vs. Zimbabwe Driver Licence) so the field validates correctly; leave it blank entirely if the vendor has no ID at all.

Payee mismatch — correcting a wrong payee:

Sometimes a payment is recorded with a placeholder name (the person who collected the cash) rather than the actual supplier. When you select a different payee from the one on the payment, an amber banner appears:

> ⚠️ Payment was recorded under **[old name]**. Update it to **[new name]**?

- Click **Yes, update payment** to correct the payment record to point to the right payee. The transaction row updates immediately.
- Click **No, keep original** to save the receipt linked to the new payee without changing the payment record itself.

Step 2 — Receipt details:

Field	Required	Notes
Receipt Date	Yes	The date printed on the physical receipt — may differ from the payment date
Amount	Yes	The amount on the receipt — may differ from the payment amount
Expense Type	No	Search and select a category/sub-category for this specific receipt (e.g. "Groceries → Fresh Produce") — independent of any category set on the payment itself, so a single combo-pay disbursement can have receipts spanning several expense types. Type to search existing categories; this is the same searchable picker used elsewhere in the system.
Receipt Number	No	The number printed on the receipt or invoice, if there is one
Description	No	Brief note of what was purchased (e.g. "Cleaning supplies — March")
Attachment	No	Upload a photo or scan of the physical receipt
Internal Notes	No	Any internal memo that does not need to appear on reports

3. Click **Save Receipt**.

For payments that require receipt accountability (combo pay disbursements and advance payments — see the colour-coded badge above), the form also shows a live running balance as you type the Amount:

Row	Meaning
💰 Requested	The approved/expected amount for this payment
🧾 Receipted so far	Total of all receipts already saved against it
✅ / ⚠️ After this receipt	What the remaining balance (or overage) will be if you save this receipt at the amount currently typed

If the amount you enter would push the total **over** the requested amount, the panel turns red and, on save, an amber **"Reason for exception"** box appears instead of saving immediately — a cashier or admin can type a reason and click **Save Anyway (Exception)** to record it as a deliberate over-limit exception; anyone without that permission just sees a message asking them to have a cashier approve it.

Viewing and Managing Existing Receipts

Click the 🧾 badge on any payment row to open the receipts panel. This shows:

- Each receipt with its date, amount, receipt number, payee name, description, and an 🖇️ **Attachment** link if one was uploaded
- Who added the receipt and when
- A 🖍️ **Edit** button — visible to the receipt's creator for as long as it hasn't been approved by a cashier yet (no time limit), or to admins or a reviewing cashier at any time. Once approved, only an admin or cashier can still make corrections.
- A ✕ delete button — visible to the receipt's creator within 7 days (and, same as edit, never after cashier approval), or to admins or a reviewing cashier at any time

Editing a receipt opens the same form used to add one — including the full payee picker. You can search and switch to a different individual/supplier, create a new one on the fly, or mark it a one-time payee, exactly as described in Attaching the First Receipt above. If you change the payee to something other than what's on the payment record, the same **amber mismatch banner** appears, asking whether to update the payment's payee too.

To add another receipt to the same payment, click **+ Add Receipt** at the bottom of the panel.

For payments that require receipt accountability (see the colour-coded badge above), this panel also shows the review status and, when applicable, **Submit to Cashier** and ✅ **Approve** buttons — see Accounting for the Funds — Adding Receipts in Section 39 for the full workflow.

Returning Unused Funds

If money is left over after a payment — the full amount wasn't needed, or only part of it was spent — the requester can formally return the unused balance rather than it just sitting unreceipted forever.

Requester — reporting a return:

1. Open the payment's receipts panel (click its 🧾 badge).
2. Click 💰 **Return unused funds**. This button is available any time there's still an un-receipted balance left on the payment — even if the payment was later cancelled.
3. Enter the **amount** you're returning (click **Max** to fill in the full remaining balance) and an optional note.
4. Click **Submit Return**.

This does **not** credit the account yet — it stays **pending** until a cashier confirms they've physically (or electronically) received the funds. A purple **" 💰 Return Pending Confirmation"** banner appears at the top of the receipts panel, and the cashier is notified.

Cashier — confirming receipt:

1. You'll find the item under **Return Confirmations Needed** in Pending Actions (bell preview or the full page), or directly on the payment's receipts panel if you open it.
2. Review the reported amount and note.
3. Click ✅ **Confirm Return Received**.

Confirming automatically **credits the returned amount back to the expense account** (as a deposit) and **locks the payment** — no further receipts, edits, or a second return can be made against it. The requester is notified that their return was confirmed. A teal **" 🔒 Returned & Confirmed — read-only"** banner replaces the pending one, and all existing receipts and the return details stay visible for reference.

> **Submitting receipts and returning unused funds are independent** — adding a receipt never marks the balance as returned, and reporting a return never marks it as received. Only the cashier's confirmation does that.

> **Reminders:** if a payment is flagged **"This is an advance"** or is a combo-pay disbursement (see the colour-coded badge above), you're reminded daily to either submit receipts or return the unused balance, starting from when the funds were approved. If nothing is done after **7 days**, the cashier group is also notified to follow up.

Why Attach Receipts?

- Provides a paper trail linking physical documents to digital payments
- Corrects the payee on a payment when the original entry used a placeholder name
- Enables per-payee spending reports (see Payee Receipt Report below)
- Helps with audits — each receipt shows who recorded it and when

---

Payee Receipt Report

Once receipts are attached to payments, you can view a spending summary for any individual or business payee directly from the Payees page.

1. Go to **Payees** in the menu.
2. Find the person or business payee.
3. Click the 🧾 **Receipts** button on their card.

The report shows:

- **Summary card** — total number of receipts and total amount across all receipts linked to this payee
- **Receipt table** — each receipt listed with its date, the payment it belongs to, the expense account, the amount, and the description
- Results are sorted newest first

This gives managers a quick view of total spending with a specific supplier or contractor across all expense accounts and all time.

Missing / Partial Receipts Report

While the Payee Receipt Report above shows you spending for one payee at a time, this report flags payments across the board that still need attention — a worklist, not a spend breakdown.

Who can use it: Anyone with expense account report access.

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** → **Reports**.
2. Click the 🚩 **Missing / Partial Receipts** card.

A payment is flagged if:

- 🧾 **No Receipts** — nothing has been attached yet, or
- 🟡 **Partial** — at least one receipt is attached, but the total doesn't yet cover the full payment amount

Pick a date range (or switch to **All Time**), optionally filter to just one of the two statuses, and search by payee, business, or category. Each row shows the payment amount, how much has been receipted so far, and the outstanding balance. **Click any row** to open the receipts panel directly and add or review receipts for that payment — no need to go hunting for it in Transaction History first.

> **What's deliberately left out:** a payment with receipts already fully submitted and just waiting on a cashier's approval isn't flagged here — see the **Payee Receipt Report** or the payment's own receipt badge for that. Internal transfers and loan movements aren't expenses, so they're excluded entirely, not flagged as missing a receipt.

Payee Payment History Report

The Payee Payment History report shows every individual payment transaction made to any recipient in the system — employees, persons, suppliers, businesses, or users — for any date range you choose.

Who can use it: Anyone with expense account report access.

Opening the Report

Option A — From the Expense Accounts Reports Hub

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** → **Reports**.
2. Click the **Payee Payment History** card.

Option B — From a Contractor's Profile (shortcut)

1. Go to **Contractors** in the menu.
2. Find the contractor and click **View Details**.
3. In the **Payment History** section, click **View Payment History**. The report opens pre-filtered to that contractor — no searching needed.

Selecting a Payee

The **Select Payee** dropdown at the top of the report searches across all payee types:

Type	Who	Badge colour
Employee	Staff on payroll	Blue
Person	Named individuals (e.g. contractors, relatives)	Green
Supplier	Business suppliers registered in the system	Orange
Business	Other registered businesses	Purple
User	System user accounts	Amber

1. Click the **Select Payee** field.
2. Start typing a name — the list filters instantly.
3. Scroll to the right group (Employees, Persons, Suppliers…) and click the name.

4. To change the payee, click the × on the selected name and search again.

Filtering by Date

Use the **date pills** to filter the payment history:

Pill	Covers
Today	Current calendar day
Yesterday	Previous calendar day
Last 7 Days	Rolling 7 days back from today
Last 30 Days	Rolling 30 days (default)
Last 90 Days	Rolling 90 days
Custom Range	Type start and end dates manually
Specific Date	Pick a single day
All Time	No date filter — returns every payment ever recorded

Click a pill to apply it immediately. The payment table and summary cards refresh automatically.

Reading the Results

Once a payee is selected, two summary cards appear at the top:

- **Total Paid** — sum of all payments in the selected period
- **Payments** — count of individual payment transactions

Below the cards, the **payments table** lists each transaction:

Column	What it shows
Date	Date the payment was recorded
Amount	Payment amount
Category	Expense category (if set)
Receipt #	Receipt or reference number (if attached)
Account	Which expense account the payment came from
Status	SUBMITTED, APPROVED, or REJECTED
Notes	Free-text notes entered at payment time

Payments are returned newest first. If no payments exist for the selected period, the table shows "No payments found for the selected period."

Exporting to CSV

Click **Export CSV** (top-right of the table) to download all visible rows as a spreadsheet. The file is named `[Payee Name]_payment_history.csv`.

---

18. Batch EOD Catch-Up — Manager and Cashier Roles

This section explains who does what when multiple days of EOD have been missed and need to be caught up at once.

When Is a Batch Catch-Up Needed?

If the business traded for several days without running EOD (e.g. the manager was away, or there was a system outage), the system detects all unclosed trading days and offers a grouped catch-up. The system looks back up to **60 days** to find dates that:

- Had actual sales orders, OR
- Have an active rent or auto-deposit config (meaning money should have been set aside even on quiet days)

Manager's Role in the Catch-Up

The manager drives the catch-up process.

Step 1 — Open the Catch-Up Wizard

Go to **[Business]** → **Reports** → **EOD Catch-Up** (or from Cash Allocation → Catch-Up button).

Step 2 — Select the Days to Close

A list of unclosed dates appears, each showing the sales total for that day. The manager:

- Ticks the days to include (can select all or just a subset).
- Leaves out dates that genuinely had no activity if needed.

Click **Next** → **Preview**.

Step 3 — Review the Preview

A table appears showing each selected date with:

- Total sales
- Number of orders
- Estimated rent transfer (if configured)
- Estimated auto-deposits (if configured)

The manager reviews this to confirm the numbers look right before committing.

Click **Next** → **Sign-Off**.

Step 4 — Manager Sign-Off

The manager enters:

- **Manager name** — this is the electronic authorisation signature for all the selected days.
- **Total cash received** — a single lump-sum figure representing all cash taken across all the selected days combined. This is the physical cash the cashier or manager is handing over to reconcile.
- **Notes** (optional) — e.g. "Closed 5 days, manager was on leave".

Click **Run Catch-Up**.

What the system does automatically:

1. Processes each selected date in order from oldest to newest.
2. For each date: runs rent transfer (if configured), runs auto-deposits (if configured).
3. Creates a locked EOD report for each date.
4. Creates a **single combined Cash Allocation Report** covering all selected dates.
5. Returns a summary showing total days closed, total sales, total rent transferred, total auto-deposits processed.

Cashier's Role in the Catch-Up

After the manager completes the catch-up run, the cashier has one task: **complete the Cash Allocation Report**.

Step 1 — Open the Report

The cashier receives a 🔔 notification: "Batch EOD catch-up complete — cash allocation report ready for review."

Go to **[Business]** → **Reports** → **Cash Allocation** (or follow the notification link). The report shows as a grouped allocation report covering all the catch-up dates.

Step 2 — Review Line Items

The report lists every money movement across all closed dates:

- All rent transfers (one per trading day)
- All auto-deposits (one per config per trading day)

The cashier counts out the physical cash matching the **total reported amount** for all line items combined.

Step 3 — Check and Confirm Each Line

For each line item, the cashier:

1. Confirms the amount looks correct.
2. Ticks ✅ the checkbox.

Step 4 — Lock

Click **Lock Allocation**. The report is locked, Cash Bucket INFLOW and OUTFLOW entries are recorded, and the catch-up is fully complete.

> **Key difference from a single-day EOD:** In a catch-up, the cashier is reconciling cash for multiple days at once. The **Total Cash Received** entered by the manager in Step 4 is the total physical cash for all days — the cashier's job is simply to confirm the breakdown adds up and sign it off.

Summary of Roles

Step	Who Does It	What They Do
Select days	**Manager**	Chooses which unclosed days to catch up
Preview	**Manager**	Checks sales totals before committing
Sign-off	**Manager**	Enters name + total cash received, runs the batch
Cash allocation review	**Cashier**	Ticks off each line item, confirms amounts
Lock allocation	**Cashier**	Locks the report — catch-up complete

---

20. Team Chat

> **Who reads this:** All users — employees, managers, cashiers, and owners. Chat is available to everyone with a system account.

What is Team Chat?

Team Chat is a built-in **company-wide messaging tool** — no need for WhatsApp groups or external apps. It covers four kinds of conversation, all from the same panel:

- **Team Chat (General)** — one shared, company-wide room everyone with a system account can see and post in.
- **Direct Messages** — a persistent, private 1:1 conversation with one other person.
- **Groups** — a persistent, private conversation with several people you choose, with a name.
- **System Alerts** — a read-only, automated channel (currently used for vehicle & driver licence compliance alerts) visible only to the people who need to act on it. See System Alerts (Read-Only) below, and Vehicle & Driver License Compliance Alerts for the full alert workflow.

Direct Messages and Groups are real, ongoing conversations you can return to any time — not a one-off tag on a single message.

Opening the Chat Panel

The chat lives in a **floating panel** that you can open without leaving whatever page you are on:

- **Sidebar:** Click the **Chat** button in the left navigation bar.
- **Mobile:** Tap the chat icon in the mobile menu (the floating bubble itself only shows on wider screens).
- **Dashboard:** Click the chat shortcut button on the dashboard.

Each time you open the panel this way, it opens to the **conversations list** by default — switch it to open straight into **Team Chat** instead from Chat Settings (see below).

The Conversations List

Click the ⌄ **back arrow** at the top-left of the chat header to see your conversations:

- **Team Chat** is pinned at the top, with its own unread badge and online count.
- Below it, your **Direct Messages and Groups**, most recently active first — each row shows a snippet of the last message and its own unread badge.
- **Search** at the top of the list: type a name to instantly filter the list, or type a phrase to also search message content — matching conversations appear below with a short snippet of the matching message; click one to open it and jump straight to that message. See Searching Across All Conversations below for more.

Click **Team Chat** or any conversation row to open it.

If you receive vehicle/driver licence compliance alerts, a 🔔 **System Alerts** row also appears in the list, with its own unread count — see System Alerts (Read-Only).

System Alerts (Read-Only)

Some automated alerts are delivered as chat messages instead of (or in addition to) a bell notification — currently this is used for **vehicle and driver licence compliance alerts** (see Vehicle & Driver License Compliance Alerts). These arrive in a dedicated **System Alerts** conversation, separate from Team Chat.

- **Who sees it:** only people who need to act on the alert — for licence compliance, that's users with the **Manage Vehicles** permission plus system admins. Nobody else sees this conversation at all, including other chat users. It is **not** part of Team Chat, so people who don't manage vehicles are never shown licence information through chat.
- **Read-only:** nobody can reply here, including admins — there's no message box, just a note confirming *"Read-only system channel — nobody can reply here."*
- **Collapsed by default:** each alert shows as a one-line summary (icon, headline, item count, and a chevron) so a room that accumulates alerts over weeks doesn't turn into a wall of text. Click a summary line to expand it and see the full detail — every affected vehicle/driver, its licence number, exact expiry date, and days overdue or remaining — plus an **Open in Fleet Management** → link that takes you straight to the vehicle.
- **Delete — only for you:** each alert card has its own 🗑 delete button. This removes it from **your** view only — it has no effect on what other admins/cashiers in the room see. If the same vehicle is still outstanding next time the alert sweep runs, you'll see it again.
- **Auto-expiry:** messages in this channel are automatically removed after **30 days**, regardless of whether anyone dismissed them.

Starting a Direct Message or Group

1. Click **+** at the top-right of the chat header (works from the conversations list or from any open conversation).

2. Search for people and click to select them — a checkmark shows who's picked.
3. **One person selected:** click **Start Chat** — this opens your existing Direct Message with them if you already have one, or starts a new one.
4. **Two or more people selected:** a **Group name** field appears — name the group and click **Create Group**.

> Only **active staff members** appear in the people list — terminated or deactivated employees are automatically excluded.

Online Presence

- In **Team Chat**, click the **"N online"** label in the header to see who's currently connected, and click any name to start a Direct Message with them.
- Wherever people are listed (new chat picker, member lists), a small dot shows 🟢 online or ⚫ offline, updating live.
- Anywhere a person's photo is set in their profile, it's shown instead of their initials — in messages, member lists, and the people picker.

Multiple Chat Windows at Once (Desktop)

Opening a Direct Message or Group doesn't take over your screen — it opens as its own small window next to the main panel, so you can keep several conversations visible side by side:

- Each window gets its own colour so open conversations are easy to tell apart at a glance.
- Up to **4 windows** can be open at once by default. Opening one more automatically closes whichever open conversation has gone longest without a new message — it isn't lost, just reachable again from the conversations list.
- **Drag** any window by its header to move it out of your way; once moved, it stays exactly where you put it, even as other windows open and close. Team Chat itself is the one window that doesn't move.
- **Mobile / narrow screens:** only **one** conversation window is open at a time, sized to fill most of the screen — there's no room to show several side by side.

Chat Settings

Click the ⚙ **gear icon** in the chat header to open Chat Settings:

Setting	Default	Notes
🏠 Default view	**Chats list**	What the panel opens to when you open it — choose **Chats list** or **Team Chat**.
🔊 Notification sound	**On**	Plays a short chime when a new message arrives from someone else. Turn off if you'd rather rely on the visual badge only.
🪟 Max open chat windows	**4**	Choose 1–5 (desktop only — mobile is always limited to 1).

Group Chats

- **Who's in it:** click the group's name in its window header to open the member list.
- **Recently active:** next to the group name, small avatars show who's actually been chatting — most recent sender first — so you can see real engagement at a glance. You're never shown here, and a member who's joined but never spoken doesn't appear inline either (only in the full member list via the dropdown).
- **Managing members (group creator only):** from the member list, the person who created the group can:
  - **Remove** a member — they lose access immediately, including to a window they already had open, and can no longer see the conversation or its history.
  - **+ Add member** — search for someone and add them. They get the group's **full message history** right away, not just messages from when they joined, and an announcement line appears in the conversation for everyone ("Alice added Bob to the group") so the change is visible to the whole group.
- **Flagging a message as important:** in a group, start your message with **@** to open a picker of the other members — choose up to **2** people to flag. Flagged messages get a highlighted border and a 🚩 **Important** badge, and those recipients get a stronger notification than a normal message.

Threaded Replies

Any top-level message can have a thread of replies attached to it. Threads keep conversations focused without cluttering the main chat.

Starting a reply:

1. Hover over the message you want to reply to — a ↩ **Reply** button appears.
2. Click ↩ **Reply**, type your reply, and send.
3. **In Team Chat only**, a reply also has two scope buttons in the banner above the input:

Button	What it does
Reply to sender	Your reply goes only to the person who wrote the original message (marked 🔒 **Private**)
Reply to all	Your reply is visible to everyone who could see the original message

   In a Direct Message or Group, a reply is always visible to the whole conversation — everyone there already sees everything, so there's no separate scope to choose.
4. To cancel a reply and return to a normal message, click ✕ in the banner.

Viewing replies:

- After a message receives replies, a ▼ **N replies** link appears below it. Click to expand the thread inline (replies are indented underneath), click ▲ **Hide replies** to collapse it again.

Composing a Message

- The message box **grows as you type** past one line — up to about 5 lines, then it scrolls — instead of scrolling the text sideways, so you can see (and fix) the whole message, including blank lines, before sending.
- **Enter** sends the message; **Shift+Enter** adds a new line.

Typing Indicators

You can see when someone else is composing a reply, so you know a message is on its way:

- **Inside a conversation** — "*Name* is typing…" appears just above the message box in Team Chat and in any open Direct Message or Group window. If more than one person is typing, it shows "*Name* and *Name* are typing…", or "*Name* and N others are typing…" for a bigger group.
- **In the conversations list** — a conversation's row temporarily shows the typing indicator in place of its last-message preview, even if you don't have that conversation open as a window, so you know where to look.

The indicator clears itself a few seconds after the other person stops typing or sends their message — there's nothing you need to do.

> You'll only ever see a typing indicator for a conversation you're actually part of — the same privacy boundary as the messages themselves.

Read Receipts

Every message you send in a **Direct Message or Group** gets a small checkmark next to its timestamp, the same convention as most chat apps:

Tick	Meaning
✓ (grey)	Sent — it's reached the conversation, but the other person (or, in a group, at least one person) hasn't opened the conversation since you sent it.
✓✓ (green)	Read — everyone else in the conversation has opened it since you sent this message.

A few things worth knowing:

- **Groups only show the green double-check once *everyone* in the group has read it** — not just one person. If you want to know exactly who's seen something in a larger group, there's no per-person breakdown; the tick is all-or-nothing.
- **Updates live** — you don't need to reopen or refresh the conversation. The moment the other person opens it, your tick turns green right in front of you.
- **Team Chat doesn't show read receipts** — it's a large, company-wide broadcast channel where a per-message read state isn't meaningful; the typing indicator and unread badge still work there as normal.
- The **System Alerts** channel doesn't show ticks either — it's a read-only automated channel with no sender to show a receipt for.

Real-Time Updates & Notifications

- Messages, replies, and group membership changes are delivered using **WebSockets** — they appear instantly without refreshing, even if you're on a different page (that's when a Direct Message or Group auto-opens the chat panel for you).
- A **chime** plays for a new message from someone else, unless you've turned it off in Chat Settings.
- When the chat panel is closed, unread badges build up — Team Chat and your Direct Messages/Groups are counted separately — and you also get a 🔔 **bell notification** (private/group ones are marked so you can spot them at a glance).

Message History & Deletion

- **Team Chat** automatically prunes anything older than **7 days** — it's for day-to-day coordination, not a permanent record.
- **Direct Messages and Groups are not auto-pruned** — their full history stays available for as long as you're a participant.
- **System Alerts** automatically prunes anything older than **30 days** — see System Alerts (Read-Only) for its own per-user delete button, which works differently from the rule below.
- You can delete your **own most recent** message (replaced with 🚫 *This message was deleted* for everyone who saw it) — you can't delete anyone else's. (System Alerts messages are the one exception — see above: deleting one only hides it for you.)

Admin Message Management (Team Chat & System Alerts)

> **Who reads this:** System admins only — this section doesn't apply to anyone else.

Team Chat and System Alerts are shared, company-wide channels, so admins get extra cleanup powers there that nobody else has — **this does not extend to anyone's Direct Messages or Groups**, which stay private even from admins.

- **Delete any message** — hover over any message (or, in System Alerts, any alert) and click **Delete**. Unlike a normal self-delete, this is a genuine removal — the message is gone immediately for everyone, with no "*this message was deleted*" placeholder left behind, since the point is keeping the channel clean, not leaving a visible trail.
- **Clear the whole channel** — click the 🗑️ icon in the Team Chat or System Alerts window header to permanently delete **every** message in that channel for everyone. You'll be asked to confirm — this cannot be undone.

Older Messages

Opening a conversation only loads the **last 30 days** of messages right away, so long-running Direct Messages and Groups stay fast to open. Anything older sits behind a collapsed placeholder above the loaded messages, showing the month and how many messages it has (e.g. "*September 2026 (14) — click to load*") — click it to load that month in place. This is per-session: closing and reopening the conversation collapses older months again, so you're not stuck scrolling past old history every time. (Team Chat never shows this, since it already prunes everything past 7 days.)

Searching Within a Conversation

Every open conversation window has its own search:

1. Click the 🔍 search icon in the window's header (not shown for the read-only System Alerts channel).
2. Type at least 2 characters — every matching message in that conversation appears below, newest first, with a timestamp and a short snippet.
3. Click a result to jump straight to it — the view automatically scrolls there, loading that older month's history or expanding a reply thread first if needed, and briefly highlights the message with a blue ring so it's easy to spot.

This searches the **whole conversation**, not just what's currently loaded on screen — including messages behind a collapsed older-month placeholder.

Searching Across All Conversations

To find a message without knowing which conversation it's in:

- Open the chat panel's **conversations list** (the ⌄ back arrow) and type in the **Search** box at the top — this matches conversation names instantly and, after a brief pause, message content too, showing a snippet under a **Messages (N)** heading.
- Click a message result to open that conversation and jump straight to the matching message (expanding older history or a reply thread first, same as the in-conversation search above) — you don't need to scroll around looking for it afterward.
- **From inside a conversation's own search panel**, if your search doesn't turn up what you need there, click 🔎 **Search all conversations for "..."** at the bottom of the results to widen the same search to everywhere at once, without retyping it.

Editing a Message

You can correct a typo or fix your most recent message without deleting and resending it:

- Only your **single most recent message** in a conversation can be edited — as soon as you (or anyone, in Team Chat/Groups) send another message, the previous one is locked in and the ✎ **Edit** option disappears.
- You have **15 minutes** from when you sent it — after that, editing is no longer available, even if it's still your latest message.
- Click ✎ **Edit** (next to Delete, shown only while it qualifies), change the text, and press **Enter** (or click **Save**) — **Shift+Enter** for a new line, **Esc** or **Cancel** to back out without saving.
- Edited messages show **(edited)** next to the timestamp, visible to everyone in the conversation — editing more than once shows a count, e.g. **(edited 3x)**, so nobody is misled about a message having changed after they read it.
- Thread replies can't be edited — only top-level messages.

Attachments

You can attach documents, images, audio, and short videos to a message in any Direct Message, Group, or Team Chat conversation:

- **Attach a file** — click the 📎 (paperclip) icon next to the message box and pick one or more files, or **drag and drop** them straight onto the chat window (a "Drop to attach" overlay appears while dragging). You can send a message with just an attachment and no typed text, or combine both.

- **Multiple files at once** — up to **10 files per message**, any mix of the types below. Each shows as its own small chip while it uploads; remove one before sending by clicking its ✕.
- **Limits per file type:**

Type	Formats	Max size
Document / Image	PDF, JPEG, PNG	10MB
Audio	MP3, M4A, WAV, OGG	15MB
Video	MP4, MOV, WebM	25MB — keep clips short

- **Picking a video over 25MB doesn't reject it** — a 🎀 **Trim Video** dialog opens instead, showing the video with a Start and End slider. Drag either handle to select just the section you want (an estimated output size updates live, in red while still too big, turning green once your selection is small enough), optionally click ▶ **Preview selection** to check it, then click **Use Trimmed Video**. The original is cut down on the server to just that section; only the trimmed clip is attached to the chat message — the full original isn't kept.
- **Viewing** — an image shows as a thumbnail (click to open full-size); audio and video play **inline right in the chat** with their own player controls; a PDF shows as a file card. Both the sender and everyone else in the conversation see the exact same preview — it's not just visible to the person who sent it.
- **Download** — for an image, audio clip, or video, downloading is optional (a small download icon sits alongside it, since it's already viewable/playable in the chat). A **PDF always shows a clear Download button** alongside View, since a PDF is the kind of file you'll usually want to open in your own PDF reader outside the browser.
- **Deleting the message removes the attachment** — same as any other message content; there's no separate step.
- **Backups** — attached documents, images, and audio are included in system backups like any other data. **Video attachments are deliberately excluded from backups** to keep backup file sizes manageable — if you need to preserve a video long-term, save your own copy outside the chat.

Feature Summary

Feature	Available?
Team Chat (company-wide broadcast)	✅ Yes
Persistent Direct Messages & Groups	✅ Yes
Multiple chat windows open at once (desktop)	✅ Yes — up to 5, configurable
Conversation search (by name and message content, jumps to the matching message)	✅ Yes
Search within a single conversation (every match, jumps to the message)	✅ Yes

Feature	Available?
Group member management (add/remove, creator only)	✅ Yes
@-mention flagging ("important", up to 2 people, groups)	✅ Yes
Threaded replies	✅ Yes
Reply to sender only (Team Chat)	✅ Yes
Typing indicators	✅ Yes
Profile photos on avatars	✅ Yes
Notification sound (configurable)	✅ Yes
Real-time delivery via WebSocket	✅ Yes
Attachments — PDF, image, audio, and short video	✅ Yes — video excluded from backups
Read receipts	✅ Yes — Direct Messages & Groups (see Read Receipts below)
Message editing	✅ Yes — own most recent message only, within 15 minutes, shows an edit count
Collapsed older-than-30-days history (per-month, loaded on demand)	✅ Yes — Direct Messages & Groups
System Alerts — read-only automated channel, visible only to the relevant people	✅ Yes
Per-user "delete for me" (System Alerts only)	✅ Yes

Chat Tips

- **Start a Direct Message or Group for anything ongoing** — it stays in your conversations list, so you're not re-picking recipients every time the way a one-off tagged message used to work.
- **Use @-flagging sparingly** — it's meant to cut through a busy group for something genuinely time-sensitive, not every message.
- **Use threads to keep replies organised** — if a Team Chat message needs follow-up, reply in the thread rather than sending a new top-level message.
- **Keep sensitive financial information out of Team Chat** — it's visible to every user. Use a Direct Message/Group, or Expense Account notes/payroll records, for anything that shouldn't be company-wide.
- **On desktop, drag a window somewhere out of the way** rather than closing it if you'll be coming back to it soon — it'll stay put.

21. Grocery POS — Desk Mode

> **Who reads this:** Grocery cashiers and floor staff who use the product-badge layout instead of a barcode scanner.

What is Desk Mode?

The Grocery POS has two operating modes:

Mode	How you add items	Best for
Scan Mode (default)	Scan a barcode or type a PLU code	Cashier with a physical scanner
Desk Mode	Tap product badges on screen	Counter service, shared till, or stock managers browsing

Toggle between modes using the 🖥️ **Desk Mode** button in the top bar of the POS:

- When **off**, the button is grey with text "🖥️ Desk Mode".
- When **on**, the button turns blue with text "🖥️ Desk Mode ON".

The barcode entry field and PLU entry field are **hidden** in Desk Mode. Products are added by tapping their card on screen.

Stock Badges on Product Cards (Desk Mode)

In Desk Mode, every product card shows a **stock count badge** in the bottom-right corner of the card:

Badge colour	Meaning
Grey pill — "42 left"	Normal stock level
Orange pill — "3 left"	Low stock (fewer than 5 units)
Red pill — "Out of stock"	Zero units in system

These badges refresh when you open the POS and when you complete a sale. Use them as a quick at-a-glance guide — if a badge shows "Out of stock", the product cannot be sold until restocked.

Performance Bars (Desk Mode)

Each product card also shows a **performance bar** — a thin coloured bar below the price showing how well this item is selling today relative to its best recent day:

- **Green bar** — strong sales day
- **Yellow bar** — moderate sales
- **Blue bar** — low sales today compared to recent history

Below the bar you will see:

- **"X sold"** badge — units sold today
- **Revenue figure** — today's revenue for this item (visible to users with financial access)

- **"yesterday: Y"** — yesterday's unit count for quick context

---

Category Sidebar Stock Totals

The left-hand category sidebar (when Desk Mode is on) shows each category with a total stock count beside it, e.g. **"Fresh Produce · 142 in stock"**. This helps you quickly identify which departments need restocking.

Bulk Stock from Desk Mode

The 📦 **Bulk Stock** button is always visible in the POS, regardless of mode. Click it to open the full Bulk Stocking Panel (see Section 14) without leaving the POS screen. This lets a stock manager receive deliveries on the same till used for sales.

Service Items in Desk Mode

Service products (such as Cellphone Charging, Airtime Top-Up, or any other in-store service) appear in the Desk Mode grid alongside physical inventory items. They behave differently in two ways:

Behaviour	Physical inventory item	Service item
Stock badge	Shows "X left", turns orange/red when low	No badge — services have no stock limit
Disappears when sold out	Yes	No — always available for sale
Stock receiving required	Yes	No — available immediately after creation or copy

Service items appear under the **Services** category tab in the category bar. Tap their card to add to the cart — no quantity entry needed unless selling more than one session at a time.

Cart in Desk Mode

Adding items to the cart in Desk Mode works identically to Scan Mode — click a product card to add one unit. A **blue quantity badge** appears on the card showing how many of that item are in the cart. Click again to add more.

Scale in Desk Mode

The ⚖️ **Scale** toggle button in the top bar works in **both Desk Mode and Scan Mode**. Click it to show or hide the live scale reading panel below the toolbar.

When the panel is visible it shows:

- Green / red dot — scale connected or disconnected
- Live weight in **kg** (3 decimal places, e.g. `1.350 kg`)

- **Tare** button — zeros the scale (remove all items first, then tare)

Products marked as *Sell by Weight* open the **Weigh Item** modal when tapped — regardless of whether Desk Mode is on or off. See Section 53 — Scale Integration for the full weighing workflow.

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22. Expense Account — Quick Payment & My Payment Queue

> **Who reads this:** Managers and cashiers who process expense payments. Covers the Quick Payment modal and the My Payment Queue panel on the account detail page.

Emoji Picker — How It Works

Several fields throughout the system combine **auto-suggest** with a full **searchable emoji picker**. The same behaviour applies in Line Items (this section), Selling Presets and Vendor Purchase Presets in POS Settings (Section 53), and category editors throughout the system.

Auto-suggest (no click needed): As you type a name or description, the system searches the expense taxonomy and auto-fills the emoji field after 350 ms. For example, typing *chicken* suggests 🍗, typing *fuel* suggests ⛽. You can accept the suggestion or override it at any time.

Manual selection — click the emoji button: The emoji field is displayed as a large clickable button showing the current emoji. Clicking it expands an inline searchable picker:

Action	What happens
Click the emoji button	Expands the picker below the button
Type a keyword in the picker	Suggestions from the database appear (300 ms debounce) — most-used shown first with ⭐
Paste any emoji into the picker search box	Sets it immediately and closes the picker
Click any emoji in the results grid	Sets that emoji and closes the picker
Click outside the picker	Closes without changing the current emoji
Type in the name field (after closing)	Auto-suggest re-activates for a new suggestion

---

Quick Payment Modal

The **Quick Payment** button appears on any expense account detail page. It opens a focused payment form directly on the account, without navigating away. This is the fastest way to record a payment from an account.

Opening Quick Payment

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** and open the account you want to pay from (e.g. "Fashions HXI Expense Account — Balance: $329.43").

2. Click the **+ Payment** button in the account header.
3. The Quick Payment modal opens.

Business / Domain Selector

If your login covers more than one business, a **Business** field appears at the top of the modal. This is a **searchable dropdown** — type to filter by business name or domain name.

The dropdown contains two types of entries:

Entry type	Example	What it does
Business name	"HXI Fashions"	Switches to that business's primary expense account and loads its default category set
Business Domain	"Services Business Domains"	Overrides the category picker to show categories from that specific domain (e.g. Services expenses)
🏠 **Personal Expenses**	"Personal Expenses"	Available on personal accounts only — loads the Personal Expenses domain so you can classify your own spending

Use a **Business Domain** entry when you are recording a payment that belongs to a specific spending category that doesn't match your business's default domain — for example, paying a services supplier from a retail business account.

> **Personal accounts:** When you open Quick Payment from a **Personal** expense account, the Business dropdown automatically pre-selects 🏠 **Personal Expenses** and loads the personal spending categories (Housing, Food & Groceries, Transport, Health, Education, etc.). You do not need to select this manually.

> **Tip:** Selecting a domain does not change which account the payment is drawn from. It only changes which categories are available in the Category picker below.

Category Picker — Domain → Category → Sub-category

Payments can be classified using a three-level hierarchy:

```
Domain  ▶  Category  ▶  Sub-category
e.g. 🛒 Grocery  ▶  Fresh Produce  ▶  Vegetables
```

1. **Domain** — auto-selected based on the current business type or your Business/Domain dropdown selection.
2. **Category** — filtered to categories within the selected domain. Required.
3. **Sub-category** — optional, further classifies the payment.

Changing the **Business** or **Domain** clears the Category and Sub-category fields.

Payee Field

The **Payee** field lets you specify who is being paid. Start typing a name to search:

- Employees
- Suppliers
- Other contacts

If no payee applies (e.g. a miscellaneous cash expense), leave it as **General**.

What is this payment for? (Notes) — with Suggest Classification

The **"What is this payment for?"** field is where you describe the payment. As you type, two modes are available:

- **Saved phrases** — pick from a list of previously used payment descriptions (faster for recurring payments).
- **Type a note** — free-text description (e.g. "Replacement printer cartridge HP 63XL").

Once you have typed at least 3 characters, a 💡 **Suggest Classification** button appears next to the field label.

💡 Suggest Classification — Quick Category Assignment

Instead of manually stepping through Domain → Category → Sub-category dropdowns, you can let the system suggest the right classification based on what you typed in the notes field.

How to use it:

1. Type a description in the **"What is this payment for?"** field (at least 3 characters).
2. Click 💡 **Suggest Classification** (button next to the field label).
3. A **Suggested Classifications** modal opens with up to two sections:

```
💡 Suggested Classifications
Based on: "office printer ink"

In this business
  🏢 Business (General) › 🖨️ Office Supplies
     🖨️ Printer & Ink Supplies

Other Categories
  📋 Consulting › 🏢 Business and Office Services
     🖥️ Office Equipment & Supplies

  🛒 Grocery › 🏪 Store Operations
     🖨️ Print & Packaging Supplies
```

Section	What it shows
In this business	Best matches within the current business's expense domain
Other Categories	Additional matches from across all domains — shown when the business search alone isn't enough

If the current business domain returns no matches, **Other Categories** results are shown automatically — there is no separate step. A true "no results" is only shown when there are no matches anywhere.

4. Click any suggestion to **instantly fill** the Domain, Category, and Sub-category fields — no manual selection required.
    - Picking from **Other Categories** automatically switches the Domain picker to match the selected category.
5. While the fields are being filled, a pulsing " 💡 Applying suggestion..." indicator appears. The fields are ready when it disappears.

If no matches are found anywhere, the message "No matches found — please select manually." is shown — use the dropdowns to select manually.

> **Tip:** The more specific your description, the better the suggestions. "fuel pump repair" will match Vehicle Maintenance sub-categories more precisely than just "fuel".

Amount and Notes

Field	Required	Notes
Amount	Yes	Enter the payment amount in dollars
Payment Channel	Yes	Cash, EcoCash, Bank Transfer, etc.
Notes / Reference	No	Invoice number, receipt number, or free text description

Link to Project (optional)

If the account is linked to a business that has active projects, a **Link to Project** dropdown appears in the payment form. Use it to associate the payment with a specific project — for example, recording a material purchase against a building project.

- Select a project from the dropdown to link the payment.
- Leave it blank if the payment does not relate to a project.
- You can also **create a new project inline** directly from the dropdown without navigating away.

The project link is also available in the **Edit Payment** modal, so you can assign or change a project on a payment that was already submitted.

Line Items (Optional Breakdown)

Below the amount field, both the **Quick Payment** and **Edit Payment** modals include a **Line Items** section. Use it when a single payment covers multiple distinct expenses and you want an itemised breakdown on the receipt or for reporting.

Adding a line item:

1. In the **emoji field** (left side of the input row), type or paste an emoji to set it — or just start typing the item name and the emoji auto-suggests after a short pause (e.g. typing *beef* → 🥩, *fuel* → ⛽).
2. In the **name field**, type a description or pick from the category dropdown that appears as you type (categories are loaded based on the domain/business selected above).
3. Enter the **amount** for this line.
4. Optionally add a **description** in the second row (e.g. invoice number, supplier reference) — indented below the name field.
5. Click **Add** (or press **Enter** in the amount field).

The item appears in the list below with its emoji, name, optional description, and amount. Repeat for each line. A running total is shown at the bottom.

> **Tip:** Line items are entirely optional. If you don't add any, the payment is recorded as a single lump sum. If you do add them, the total of all line items should match (or be close to) the main payment amount.

Click **Submit Payment** to record the payment.

- **Personal accounts:** The balance is debited immediately and the payment appears in the transaction history.
- **Business accounts (non-admin):** The payment is placed **IN QUEUE** (amber badge) and appears in your **My Payment Queue** panel. It will be included in the next batch submitted by a cashier or manager. Your balance is debited when the batch is submitted.
- **Business accounts (admin / owner):** The payment is submitted directly without queuing.

Recent Payments to Payee

When you select a **Payee** in either the **Quick Payment** modal or the **Edit Payment** modal, the system automatically looks up the two most recent payments previously made to that payee from this account and displays them directly below the payee field.

```
Recent payments to Ngonidzashe Mapfumo
  $45.00   🏠 Home › Vehicle and Transport   SUBMITTED   View →
  $12.50   🛒 Grocery › Staff Welfare         SUBMITTED   View →
```

This helps you:

- Spot duplicate payments before submitting (e.g. the same supplier was just paid yesterday).
- Check how much was paid last time and for what category.
- Quickly confirm the correct payee is selected before entering an amount.

The panel appears automatically as soon as a payee is chosen and disappears if you clear the payee field. If the payee has no previous payments in this account the panel is not shown.

Viewing Full Payment Details

Each row in the recent payments list has a **View** → link on the right side. Clicking it opens a **Payment Detail** overlay — a compact popup that shows all information about that payment without leaving the current modal.

The Payment Detail overlay shows:

Field	Notes
Payee	Full name of the person, employee, or supplier
ID	National ID of the payee (employees and individuals only, if recorded)
Phone	Formatted phone number (employees, individuals, and suppliers)
Amount	Payment amount
Date	Payment date
Category	Domain category (with emoji)
Subcategory	If set
Channel	📲 EcoCash or 💵 Cash
Status	Colour-coded status badge
Receipt #	If recorded
Notes	Payment notes
Created by	Staff member who created the payment

Close the overlay by clicking **Close** or clicking anywhere outside the popup. The Quick Payment or Edit Payment modal remains open underneath.

Repeating a Previous Payment

The **Repeat** button in the transaction history lets you open the Quick Payment modal pre-filled with all the details of an existing payment — saving time for recurring payments such as rent, regular supplier runs, or standing wages.

Where the button appears:

The **Repeat** link appears on any payment row in the transaction history that is:

- A regular payment (not a deposit, not an auto-transfer, not a combo request disbursement)

Any user with access to make or edit payments on the account can see the button.

How to use it:

1. Open the expense account detail page and scroll to the **Transaction History**.
2. Find the payment you want to repeat and click **Repeat** on the right side of the row.
3. The **Quick Payment** modal opens, pre-filled with:
    - **Payee** — same person, employee, or supplier
    - **Amount** — same amount (edit as needed)
    - **Payment date** — today's date (not the original date)
    - **Category / Sub-category** — same classification
    - **Notes** — same description
    - **Payment channel** — same channel (Cash, EcoCash, etc.)
    - **Priority** — same priority
4. A blue banner at the top of the modal confirms: "*Pre-filled from a previous payment — review and adjust as needed.*"
5. Make any adjustments (amount, date, notes) and click **Submit Payment**.

> **Note:** The **Requester** field always defaults to you (the currently logged-in user), not the original requester. This is intentional — the repeat creates a new payment request under your name.

> **Tip:** Use Repeat for recurring fixed payments (same payee, same amount, same category). For payments where only the amount changes, it is faster to Repeat and update the amount than to fill in the form from scratch.

My Payment Queue Panel

The **My Payment Queue** panel appears on any expense account detail page. It shows **your own** payments that are awaiting action — payments you submitted that have not yet been fully disbursed. You do not need special cashier permissions to see your own payments here.

Panel Header

```
My Payment Queue   [12]   ▼
```

- The **count badge** (blue pill) shows the total number of items across all statuses.
- Click the header to **collapse or expand** the panel. It defaults to open.

Pending Summary Strip

When the panel is open and you have at least one IN QUEUE or AWAITING CASHIER payment, a summary strip appears directly below the header:

```
Pending requests: $1,275.00  ·  Projected balance: $5,496.00
```

Field	Who sees it	What it shows
Pending requests	Everyone	Total amount across all your IN QUEUE and AWAITING CASHIER payments — how much is currently outstanding
Projected balance	Users with cashier / edit-payments permission	What the account balance would be if every pending request were approved and paid in full

The projected balance turns **red** if honoring all pending requests would take the account into a negative balance.

> **Tip:** Use the projected balance to check whether the account has enough funds before approving a batch. If it shows red, there is not enough balance to cover all queued requests at once.

Search

When the panel is open, a **search box** appears below the pending summary strip (or directly below the header if there are no pending amounts). Type any part of a payee name, category name, or payment description to filter the list in real time.

Payment Statuses

Payments in the queue are grouped by status, each with a colour-coded badge:

Badge	Colour	Meaning
AWAITING CASHIER	Blue	Payment request submitted — cashier is reviewing (personal accounts only)
APPROVED	Green	Approved and ready to be physically disbursed
IN QUEUE	Amber	Queued for batch approval (business accounts) — awaiting manager review

Actions per Status

APPROVED payments — payments that have been approved but not yet physically handed over:

- 📄 **Voucher** — generate a payment voucher document for record-keeping.
- ✓ **Mark as Paid** — confirm physical handover. The item disappears from the queue immediately and the account balance updates instantly.
- 📲 **Mark as Sent** (EcoCash only) — enter the EcoCash transaction code to confirm mobile transfer. Balance also updates instantly.

AWAITING CASHIER payments (personal accounts) — requests pending cashier approval:

- ✎ **Edit** — change the amount or description before the cashier acts on it. An inline editor expands in-place. Click **Full Edit** within the inline editor to open the full Quick Payment modal with all fields (category, payee, line items, etc.) pre-filled for editing.
- ✕ **Cancel** — withdraw the request before the cashier acts on it. A confirmation modal appears requiring you to enter a reason for cancellation (required for audit trail).

> **Who can edit:** The payment creator can always edit their own AWAITING CASHIER requests. Users with the "can edit payments" permission on this account can also edit requests made by others.

IN QUEUE payments (business accounts) — payments awaiting the next batch submission:

- ✎ **Edit** — change the amount or description before the batch is submitted. An inline editor expands in-place. Click **Full Edit** within the inline editor to open the full Quick Payment modal with all fields (category, payee, line items, etc.) pre-filled for editing.
- ✕ **Cancel Request** — withdraw the payment request entirely. A confirmation modal appears requiring a cancellation reason. The reason is stored in the payment notes for audit purposes.

> **Activity banner:** The queue polls for changes every 10 seconds when you have payments awaiting cashier approval. If a payment is approved or rejected while you have the page open, an amber banner appears at the top of the queue:
>
> **"Payment activity detected on this account. Refresh now"**
>
> Click **Refresh now** to update the transaction list and balance. The page does **not** refresh automatically — this protects any unsaved work (open forms, amounts being typed) from being wiped mid-entry.

My Payments Page — Approved & Rejected Tabs

Go to **Expense Accounts** → **My Payments** (or click the notification link from a rejection notification) to see a full view of your payments organised into two tabs.

✓ Approved Tab

Lists all your approved payments that are awaiting physical collection. For each payment you will see:

- Amount, category, business name, and payee.
- Tap **Payment Made** once you have physically received the cash — the payment is marked complete.

✗ Rejected Tab

Lists all your payment requests that were **rejected** by the cashier during a batch review. The tab badge shows the count of rejected requests requiring your attention.

For each rejected payment you will see:

- **Rejection reason** (amber panel) — the message the cashier provided when rejecting.
- **Rejected by** and **date** of rejection.
- Three action buttons:

Button	What it does
Edit & Resubmit	Opens the payment edit page with the rejection banner visible. Update the details (e.g. fix the payee phone number), then click **Save & Resubmit** to return the payment to the EOD queue for the next batch.

Button	What it does
Resubmit As-Is	Resubmits the payment with no changes. Use this when the rejection was due to a temporary issue (e.g. insufficient funds) and the details are correct.
Cancel Request	Permanently withdraws the request. A confirmation modal appears — you must enter a reason. The reason is stored in the payment record for audit purposes.

> **Notification link:** When the cashier rejects your payment, the 🔔 notification links directly to the **Rejected** tab so you see it immediately. The tab badge also appears on the **My Payments** page header.

Cancelling a Submitted Request (Before the Cashier Acts)

If you submitted a payment but want to withdraw it **before** it reaches a batch review:

1. Open the payment via **Expense Accounts** → **[Account]** → **[Payment]**.
2. In the status panel at the top of the detail page, click **Cancel Request**.
3. A confirmation modal appears. Enter a reason for cancellation (required).
4. Click **Confirm Cancel**. The request is withdrawn and will not appear in any future batch.

Cashier-Assisted Payment Requests (Personal Accounts)

> **Who reads this:** Personal expense account holders who want to hand cash to a cashier for verification, and the cashiers who review and approve those requests.

Sometimes you have cash ready to pay out, but you need a cashier to physically handle the transaction before the balance is debited. The **"Request cashier approval before payment"** checkbox lets you submit a payment as a **request** rather than an immediate deduction — the balance is only debited when the cashier approves it.

This is available on **personal expense accounts only**. Business accounts use the EOD batch workflow instead.

For the Requester — Submitting a Payment Request

1. Open quick payment from your personal expense account.
2. Fill in the payment details (amount, category, notes).
3. Tick the **"Request cashier approval before payment"** checkbox (appears only on personal accounts).
4. **Payee is optional** when this box is ticked — you can leave it blank if the recipient is not yet known. The label changes to *(optional — required at payment)* as a reminder.
5. Click **Submit Payment**.

The payment is created with status ⏳ **Awaiting Cashier** — your balance is **not** debited yet.

You will receive a **bell notification** once a cashier approves or rejects your request.

> **Tip:** Only tick this box when you need a cashier to physically handle or verify the cash. For normal personal payments you process yourself, leave it unticked.

Marking the Payment as Paid — Adding the Payee

Once the cashier approves your request, the payment moves to **APPROVED** and appears in the **My Queue** panel on your account page with a green ✓ **Mark as Paid** button.

If you submitted the request without a payee:

Clicking ✓ **Mark as Paid** will open a small popup asking you to select the payee **before the payment can be confirmed**. Select the person or supplier who received the funds and click ✓ **Mark as Paid** to finalise.

If you already provided a payee upfront:

Clicking ✓ **Mark as Paid** opens the standard confirmation dialog and marks the payment immediately.

Flagging a Payment as an Advance

If you're handing over cash before knowing the exact purchase or supplier — the same situation combo pay handles, but for a single one-off payment — tick **"This is an advance — receipts required"** on the Quick Payment form before submitting.

This starts the same receipt-accountability tracking combo pay disbursements get automatically: a reminder to add receipts, a colour-coded badge on the payment row, and a cashier approval step once you submit them. See Accounting for the Funds — Adding Receipts in Section 39 for the full workflow — it applies the same way here.

> **Why is the payee required at this point?** The payment record must have a payee before it is finalised so that expense reports and receipts are accurate. The flexibility to skip it during submission is provided so that approval can start before all details are available — but the name must be captured before funds are confirmed.

Viewing Your Pending Request

On the payment detail page the request shows an amber panel:

> ⏳ This payment is awaiting cashier approval. You will be notified when it is reviewed.

The status badge reads ⏳ **Awaiting Cashier** (amber). On the recent payments panel of your account page, the same amber badge appears next to the payment.

To cancel the request before a cashier acts on it:

1. Open the payment detail page.
2. Click **Cancel Request** in the amber info panel.
3. Confirm the dialog.

The payment is set to **CANCELLED** and any notified cashiers receive a bell notification that the request was cancelled.

For the Cashier — Reviewing Payment Requests

When a user submits a cashier-assisted payment request, you receive a **bell notification** (only if you have a grant on that account). These requests also appear on the **Admin → Pending Actions** page under the **"Personal Payment Requests"** section. Note: this section covers both accounts explicitly typed as Personal and any standalone expense accounts not linked to a business.

Each request shows:

- Requester name
- Payee name
- Amount and payment date
- Categories and notes
- Priority (Normal / Urgent)

To approve a request:

1. Go to **Admin → Pending Actions**.
2. Find the request under **Personal Payment Requests**.
3. Click **Approve**.

The system performs a live balance check. If the account has sufficient funds, the payment is moved to **SUBMITTED**, the balance is debited, and the requester receives a notification:

> ✅ Payment Request Approved — $X.XX was approved by [your name]

After approving, the **Payment Voucher** form opens automatically so you can capture the payee's signature immediately (see Section 24 — Payment Vouchers).

If the account does not have enough funds, you will see a **422 Insufficient Balance** error — ask the requester to top up the account first.

To reject a request:

1. Click **Reject** on the request row.

The payment is set to **REJECTED**, no balance change is made, and the requester receives:

> ❌ Payment Request Rejected — $X.XX was rejected by [your name]

Status Reference

Status	Colour	Meaning
⏳ Awaiting Cashier	Amber	Request submitted — balance not yet debited
SUBMITTED	Default	Approved by cashier — balance has been debited
REJECTED	Red	Rejected — no balance change
CANCELLED	Grey	Cancelled by the requester before approval

> **Who reads this:** System administrators only.

Go to **Admin → Blocking Stock Take Drafts** to see a list of all active stock take drafts that have **Stock Take Mode** enabled. These drafts block sales for their respective businesses until the draft is deleted or submitted.

The Drafts Table

Column	What it shows
Business	Which business is currently blocked
Draft Title	Name given to the draft (e.g. "March Full Count")
Created By	Employee name and email who started the draft
Created At	Date and time the draft was created
Action	Delete button to forcibly remove the draft and unblock sales

Warning Banner

If any blocking drafts exist, a banner appears at the top of the page:

> ⚠️ **2 business(es) currently blocked from processing sales**

This means those businesses' cashiers cannot complete sales until the draft is resolved.

Deleting a Blocking Draft

1. Find the draft in the table.
2. Click **Delete**.
3. Confirm the dialog: "This will delete the stock take draft '[title]' for [business name]. Sales will be unblocked immediately."
4. Click **Delete Draft** (red button).
5. A toast notification confirms: "Draft deleted — [business name] sales unblocked".

> **Warning:** Deleting a draft discards all counted data in it. The responsible employee will need to start a fresh stock take. Only delete a draft if the count was abandoned or if a technical error is blocking operations.

Adding Inventory Items Directly to Cart

> **Who reads this:** Stock managers and cashiers who use the Inventory page to add stocked items to the POS cart.

From any **Inventory** page (Clothing, Hardware, Restaurant, Grocery), each item row has a 🛒 (cart) button. Clicking it adds the item directly to the active POS cart — no need to navigate to the POS first.

How It Works

1. Go to **[Business] → Inventory**.
2. Find the item you want to add (use search, domain filter, or scroll).
3. Click the 🛒 button on the item's row.

4. A toast appears: "Added [Item Name] to cart".
5. Navigate to the POS (or click **Proceed to Checkout** in the mini-cart) to complete the sale.

Product Types

The inventory page shows two types of items, both cartable:

Type	How to recognise	Notes
Tracked product	UUID-style ID, linked to a product variant	Has variants — if multiple variants exist, you are redirected to the POS to select the variant
Barcode inventory item	Shown with a "📦 POS tracked" badge	Single unit, adds directly — no variant selection

Stock and Price Checks

Before adding to cart, the system checks:

- **Selling price must be set** — if the item has no selling price, an error toast appears: "Product has no selling price set".
- **Stock must be available** — if stock is zero, an error toast appears: "Product is out of stock".

If a product has only one variant with a valid price and stock, it is added to the cart directly. If it has multiple variants, you are redirected to the POS product selection screen.

Bulk Stocking Panel — Auto-Classification (Suggest Feature)

When entering product names in the Bulk Stocking Panel, the system can **suggest a domain, category, and sub-category** based on the product name.

Using the Suggest Feature

1. Type a product name in the **Name** column of any row (at least 2 characters).
2. A 💡 **lightbulb icon** appears in the row number column.
3. Click the 💡 icon to open the **Suggested Classification** popover.
4. The popover shows up to 5 best-matching classifications, scored by how well the product name matches known category names:

```
💡 Suggested Classification
Based on: "ladies underwear"

🛍️ Retail › 👙 Intimates and Sleepwear
   👙 Bras & Bralettes

👗 Clothing › 👙 Intimates and Sleepwear
   🩲 Underwear & Briefs
```

```
→ No matches found — select manually.
```

5. Click any suggestion to **auto-fill** the Domain, Category, and Sub-category fields for that row.
6. The popover closes and the fields are filled — you can adjust them manually if needed.

> **How scoring works:** Sub-category name matches score highest (3 points), followed by category matches (2 points) and domain matches (1 point). The top 5 unique sub-category matches are shown.

If no matches are found, the message "No matches found — select manually." is shown. Select the domain and category manually using the dropdowns.

---

23. Quick Deposit — Income Categorisation

> **Who reads this:** Anyone who deposits money into an expense account — personal account holders, cashiers, and managers.

When you deposit money into an expense account, you can now classify **where the money came from** using a three-level income hierarchy. This helps with financial reporting and keeps personal and business income properly separated.

Opening Quick Deposit

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** and open the account you want to deposit into.
2. Click the **+ Deposit** button in the account header.
3. The **Quick Deposit** modal opens — it is now a wider two-column layout to reduce scrolling.

The Two-Column Layout

The modal organises fields into two columns to fit more information on screen:

- **Left column:** Amount
- **Right column:** Deposit Date

Below these, the Income Source section and Sender fields appear full-width.

Income Source Section

Every deposit now shows an **INCOME SOURCE** panel (blue-tinted border). This lets you classify the deposit's origin.

Income Type

A searchable dropdown lets you choose the income domain:

Option	When to use
💵 **Personal Income**	Auto-selected for personal accounts — salary, freelance work, investments, government grants
🏢 **Business Income**	Auto-selected for business-linked accounts — sales revenue, service income, financial income

> **Auto-selection:** The system pre-selects the correct income type based on the account:
>
> - Personal accounts → **Personal Income** is selected automatically.
> - Business-linked accounts → **Business Income** is selected automatically.
> - You can change this manually if needed.

Category (appears after Income Type is selected)

Once an income type is selected, a **Category** dropdown appears showing categories within that domain:

Personal Income categories:

Category	Examples
Employment Income	Salary & Wages, Allowances, Self-Employment
Business Income	Freelance / Contract, Consulting, Online Business
Investment Income	Capital Gains, Dividends, Rental Income
Government Income	Social Grants, Pension, Tax Refunds
Other Income	Gifts, Inheritance, Miscellaneous

Business Income categories:

Category	Examples
Sales Revenue	Product Sales, Service Sales, Recurring Sales
Operating Income	Professional Income, Commission & Referral, Rental & Usage
Financial Income	Interest Earned, Investment Returns, Currency Gains
Government & Support	Grants, Subsidies, Tax Incentives
Other Business Income	Asset Sales, Insurance Proceeds, Miscellaneous Revenue

Subcategory (appears after Category is selected)

An optional **Subcategory** dropdown gives finer classification. For example:

- Employment Income → **Salary & Wages**
- Business Income → **Product Sales** → **Online Sales**

Who Sent This Money? (Sender field)

The **Who sent this money?** field is now open by default (type-a-name mode) so it is always ready to fill in. Enter the name of the person or organisation that sent the deposit.

You can:

- **Type a name** (default) — free-text, e.g. "Mary Hwandaza"
- **Select from list** — choose from previously saved senders
- **Not specified** — leave blank if not relevant

The sender appears as the **Source** in the transaction history.

Deposit Source (non-personal accounts)

For standard business expense accounts, a **Deposit Source** dropdown lets you specify how the money arrived:

Option	Meaning
Manual Entry	Cash counted in by hand
From Business Account	Transfer from a linked business account
Other Source	Any other origin

This field is hidden for **Personal** accounts (always Manual Entry).

The Transaction List — Source Column

After a deposit is saved, the **Source** column in the transaction history shows:

- The **sender name** if one was entered
- Or a friendly label based on the deposit type (e.g. "Manual Entry", "Bank Transfer") if no sender was specified
- The **Category** column now shows the income category and subcategory for deposits that were classified (e.g. "💵 Employment Income / Salary & Wages")

---

24. Payment Vouchers — Creating, Viewing & Locking

> **Who reads this:** Managers and cashiers who process expense payments.

A **Payment Voucher** is an official payment record generated for an expense account payment. It captures the collector's name, ID, signature, and the purpose of the payment, and can be printed or saved as a PDF.

When Vouchers Are Created

Flow	How the voucher form opens
Personal payment request (cashier-assisted)	Automatically after the cashier clicks Approve

Flow	How the voucher form opens
Standalone account group approval	Post-approval panel — cashier picks which payments to voucher individually
Any APPROVED or PAID payment (fallback)	Open the payment detail page → click 📄 **Create Voucher**
Transaction history row	Click the faint 📄 icon on any row without a voucher

---

Generating a Voucher (First Time)

1. In the **Transaction History**, find the payment row.
2. A faint 📄 icon appears at the right of the row — hover over it to see: *"No voucher yet — click to generate one"*.
3. Click 📄 to open the **Payment Voucher** form.
4. Fill in:
    - **Collector Full Name** (required)
    - **Phone Number** (optional)
    - **National ID** (optional)
    - **Driver's Licence No.** (optional)
    - **What is this payment for?** (required — a description of the purpose)
    - **Notes** (optional)
    - **Collector Signature** — draw on the pad using mouse or touch
5. Click 📄 **Save & Generate PDF**.
6. A **preview** of the voucher opens showing all the details, voucher number (e.g. VCH-2026-0003), and a footer with the business name.
7. Use 🖨️ **Print** or ⬇️ **Save PDF** to keep a copy.
8. Click **×** to close.

> A notification is sent to all admins and managers when a new voucher is generated.

Viewing an Existing Voucher

Once a voucher has been generated, the row in the transaction list changes:

- The faint 📄 icon is replaced by a teal ✅ **VCH** badge.
- Hover over the badge to see: *"Voucher issued: VCH-2026-0003 — click to view PDF"* (the actual voucher number is shown).
- Click the ✅ **VCH** badge to open the **voucher preview directly** — the form is not shown again.
- From the preview you can **Print** or **Save PDF** the voucher.

Vouchers on the Payment Detail Page

For any payment that has been **APPROVED** or **PAID** and has no voucher yet, the payment detail page shows a 📄 **Create Voucher** button. Click it to open the voucher form for that individual payment.

Once a voucher exists, the button is replaced by a 📄 **Voucher VCH-XXXX** badge — click the badge to view and print the voucher.

This is the fallback path for payments that were skipped during the post-approval panel, or for vouchers created outside the normal approval flow.

Locking Payments After Voucher Issuance

Once a voucher is issued:

- The **Edit** button for that payment row **disappears**.
- The payment record is considered finalised — it cannot be changed through the normal edit flow.
- This prevents accidental modification of a payment that has an official voucher on record.

> If a correction is genuinely needed after a voucher has been issued, contact your system administrator.

Voucher Details Reference

Every generated voucher includes:

Field	Source
Voucher Number	Auto-generated (VCH-YYYY-NNNN)
Date	Payment date
Amount Paid	Payment amount
Paid To — Name	Payee name from the payment record
Paid To — Type	Payee type (Employee, Supplier, etc.)
Purpose	Description entered in the voucher form
Category	Payment category (if classified)
Collector Name	Entered in the voucher form
National ID	Entered in the voucher form (optional)
Collector Signature	Drawn on the signature pad (optional)
Prepared By	Name of the staff member who generated the voucher
Business Name	The business the account belongs to

---

25. Eco-Cash to Cash Conversions

> **Who reads this:** Cashiers and managers who handle mobile money (EcoCash) and need to convert it to physical cash for customers or staff.

A **Cash Bucket** cashier can convert eco-cash (mobile money) into physical cash. The system tracks the transaction through a multi-step workflow so that both the eco-cash wallet balance and the physical cash

bucket balance stay accurate.

Who Is Involved

Role	What they do
Requester	Submits a request for a specific amount to be converted from eco-cash to cash
Cashier / Approver	Reviews the request, verifies the eco-cash wallet has sufficient balance, and confirms the tendered amount
Cashier / Completer	Physically sends the eco-cash transfer, receives the cash, and records the final amounts

Approver and Completer can be the same person.

Step 1 — Submitting a Conversion Request (Requester)

1. Go to **Cash Bucket** in the menu.
2. Click **New Eco-Cash Conversion**.
3. Select the **business** whose eco-cash wallet will be used.
4. Enter the **amount** you want converted (in USD).
5. Add any **notes** — e.g. the reason or the recipient's name.
6. Click **Submit Request**.

The request is created with status **PENDING** and cashiers with approval access are notified.

Step 2 — Approving the Request (Cashier)

1. Open the 🔔 **bell** menu or go to **Pending Actions**. Pending conversions appear under *Eco-Cash Conversions*.
2. Click **Review** to open the Cash Bucket page.
3. Find the PENDING conversion and click **Approve**.
4. Confirm the **Tendered Amount** — the exact eco-cash amount that will be sent to the requester. This may differ slightly from the requested amount (e.g. requested $66.00 but eco-cash fees round it to $66.35).
5. Click **Approve**.

The system checks that the eco-cash wallet has sufficient balance before approving. If the balance is too low the approval is blocked.

Status changes to **APPROVED**.

Step 3 — Completing the Conversion (Cashier)

1. Use the eco-cash app or USSD to send the approved amount to the requester's eco-cash number. The requester must have the **cash ready** to hand over.
2. Note the **transaction code** from the eco-cash confirmation SMS or app (e.g. `66567DE`).

3. In the system, find the APPROVED conversion and click **Complete**.
4. Fill in the three fields:

Field	What to enter	Required?
Eco-Cash Transaction Code	The reference code from the eco-cash confirmation message	Optional but strongly recommended
Eco-Cash Total Sent	Exact decimal amount debited from the eco-cash wallet (e.g. `66.35`) — may include fees	Required
Cash Tendered	Whole dollar amount of physical cash received from the requester (e.g. `67`)	Required

5. Click **Confirm & Complete**.

The system records:

- An **OUTFLOW** from the eco-cash wallet for the eco-cash amount sent.
- An **INFLOW** into the cash bucket for the cash received.
- The conversion status changes to **COMPLETED** with the transaction code stored.

Step 4 — Rejecting a Request (if needed)

1. Find the PENDING conversion and click **Reject**.
2. Enter a **rejection reason** — this is saved and visible to the requester.
3. Click **Reject**.

Status changes to **REJECTED**. No ledger entries are created.

Status Overview

Status	Meaning
PENDING	Request submitted, awaiting cashier approval
APPROVED	Cashier confirmed the tendered amount; ready to complete
COMPLETED	Eco-cash sent, cash received, both ledgers updated
REJECTED	Request declined; no ledger entries created

Important Tips

- Always record the **transaction code**. If the eco-cash payment is disputed later, the code is your proof.
- The **Eco-Cash Total Sent** (decimal) and **Cash Tendered** (integer) may differ — fees, rounding, or change. Enter both exactly as they occurred.
- The eco-cash balance check happens at **Approve** time. If another transaction reduces the balance between approval and completion the system will still allow completion — always verify the balance yourself before sending.

- Completed conversions appear in the list with a summary: *EcoCash: $66.35 → Cash: $67* and the transaction code for quick reference.

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26. Printer Setup & QZ Tray

Receipt and label printing uses **QZ Tray** — a small desktop application that runs in your Windows system tray and bridges the browser to locally-attached or network printers. Because it runs on your own machine, **every user must install it on their own computer**. Your saved printer is stored in your browser (not on the server), so it stays with your device.

Who Needs This

Every user who wants to print receipts or ID cards directly from the app — cashiers, managers, HR, stock managers. There are no special permissions required; the **Printer Setup** page is accessible to all users via 👤 **Profile → Printer Setup**.

Step 1 — Install QZ Tray

1. Download QZ Tray from **https://qz.io/download/** — choose the Windows installer. Java is bundled; you do not need to install Java separately.
2. Run the installer and follow the prompts.
3. After installation, QZ Tray starts automatically and shows as a **QZ icon in the system tray** (bottom-right corner near the clock). If you don't see it, open it from the Start menu.

> QZ Tray must be running whenever you want to print. If receipts stop printing, check that the QZ icon is visible in your system tray.

Step 2 — Trust the Site Certificate (first time only)

The system uses a signed certificate so QZ Tray can verify the connection is genuine. The first time you connect from this site, QZ Tray will ask for approval:

1. Go to 👤 **Profile → Printer Setup**. The page automatically tries to connect to QZ Tray.
2. A QZ Tray security dialog will appear — it may open as a separate window or show as a taskbar notification.
3. The dialog will show the site certificate as **Third-party issued** with a **Trusted** status.
4. Click **Allow**. To avoid being asked again, select **"Always allow from this site"** or **"Remember this decision"** before clicking Allow.

> **If no dialog appears** and the page shows "QZ Tray not detected": check the system tray — QZ Tray may have an open dialog behind other windows. Right-click the QZ Tray icon → **Open Site Manager** to manually add this site as trusted.

> **HTTPS is required.** QZ Tray will not connect to a plain `http://` address. The app must be accessed via `https://` (e.g. `https://192.168.0.108:8080`) for QZ Tray to work.

Step 3 — Select and Save Your Printer

1. Once connected, the Printer Setup page shows a green **QZ Tray connected** indicator.

2. A dropdown lists all printers detected on your machine — select your receipt printer (e.g. `EPSON TM-T20III`).
3. Click **Save Printer**. A green **"Saved '<printer name>' as your printer"** confirmation appears next to the button — if you don't see it, the save didn't go through.
4. Click **Test Print** to confirm a test receipt prints correctly.

Printer not listed? Enter the printer name manually:

- Open Windows **Start** → **Settings** → **Bluetooth & devices** → **Printers & scanners** and copy the exact printer name.
- Paste it into the manual entry field and click **Save Printer**.

Your selection is saved in your browser AND shared with the business. Saving no longer just writes to this one browser's local storage — it's also stored server-side, scoped to whichever physical machine you saved it from (or as a business-wide default if this machine has no paired Workstation Agent). This means: opening the Printer Setup page in a different browser on the *same* machine, or after clearing this browser's data, picks the saved printer back up automatically instead of starting blank. It also means that if this exact machine also has a paired **Workstation Agent** (Section 13), its tray and Manage Profiles page can show **"QZ Tray printer (this machine): <name>"** — worth knowing about specifically because it's a completely separate, independent print path from anything routed through that agent (see the tray reference table in Section 13 for how the two are distinguished).

> **One workstation shared by several businesses (MBM-280):** the saved printer name itself is genuinely machine-wide, not tied to any one business — so once QZ Tray is set up here for *any* business, every *other* business you use from this same machine (e.g. switching between them via the header dropdown on a shared till) automatically gets that same printer pre-selected on its own receipt screen too, with no separate Printer Setup step needed per business. You'll only need to repeat setup here if a *different* physical machine needs its own printer connected.

Step 4 — Printing Receipts from the POS

After completing a sale:

1. The **receipt preview modal** opens.
2. Select **QZ Tray Printer** from the print method dropdown — your saved printer is pre-selected.
3. Click **Print**.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
"QZ Tray not detected" even though it's running	Make sure the app is accessed over **HTTPS**, not HTTP. Check the system tray for a pending approval dialog and click **Allow**.
Approval dialog appears on every print	When the dialog appears, check **"Always allow from this site"** before clicking Allow. Or open QZ Tray **Site Manager** → set this site to Always allow.
"Invalid Signature" or certificate warning	Right-click the QZ icon → **Open Site Manager** → find this site → click **Trust**. Contact your admin if it persists — the server certificate may need re-generating.

Problem	Solution
QZ Tray connected but no printers in dropdown	Look for a pending QZ Tray dialog in the taskbar and click **Allow**, then click the refresh icon on the Printer Setup page. If the list is still empty, enter the printer name manually.
Receipt prints only top half or garbled output	Always use the **QZ Tray Printer** option — do not use the browser print dialog for thermal receipts. The system sends raw ESC/POS commands that a browser cannot interpret.
"No printers found" in the receipt modal	QZ Tray may not be running or no printer is saved. Go to **Profile** → **Printer Setup**, confirm QZ Tray is connected, and save a printer.

Clearing Stuck Print Jobs

If a printer is stuck or printing the same job on repeat, open the **Test Print** panel (printer icon in the top bar):

Button	What it does
Bring Online	Pings the printer to check its network status
Test	Sends a short test page
🗑 **Clear Print Queue**	Cancels all stuck jobs and restarts the Windows print spooler
■ **Stop QZ**	Disconnects QZ Tray and drops all pending QZ print jobs immediately

> Use **Clear Print Queue** first for a printer stuck printing the same job. Use **Stop QZ** if a QZ job is looping or printing garbage — reconnect from Printer Setup afterwards.

Workstation Printers — Remote Printing & Sharing (MBM-275 / MBM-283)

This is a separate, admin-only mechanism from QZ Tray above. QZ Tray (Steps 1–4 above) is per-user: each person's own browser talks to their own installed QZ Tray, which is inherently local to whoever is using it and needs no change when the app server moves. This section covers a different, lower-level path: a printer physically attached to a workstation, relayed by that workstation's paired agent so the application **server itself** — which may be centrally hosted, nowhere near that printer — can still dispatch jobs to it.

Two clearly separate ideas, easy to conflate because both used to be called "remote" at different points — pin these down first:

- **Remote printing** — a workstation's own local printer, printing from the (possibly remote/centralized) server. This is the original capability and works exactly like it always has: declare the printer on its own workstation's row, and the server can dispatch to it.
- **Sharing** — a separate, additional choice: whether *other* devices/workstations in the business can also route jobs to that same printer, on top of remote printing already working. A printer can have remote printing on and sharing off — it works perfectly for its own workstation, it's just not offered to anyone else.

Setup happens entirely on one page — `/admin/workstation-agents` — right on the paired workstation's own row:

1. Pair the workstation first if it isn't already — see Section 13's **"Remote Sites — R710 via Local Agent"** for the download/install steps, and the **"Same Agent Now Also Relays a Scale and a Printer"** subsection for pairing it as a Workstation Agent.
2. On its row, under 🖨️ **Receipt Printer Setup**, click **"Set up printer"** (or **"Edit"** if one's already declared).
3. The printer name field is a free-text box, not a locked picker — type the exact Windows printer name directly if you know it, or click **List Printers** to pull the actual names Windows sees on that workstation into a searchable dropdown (type to filter, click a result to fill the field). No separate "register a printer" step first, and no picking a workstation from a dropdown, since you're already on that workstation's own row. If two printers have similar names (e.g. "EPSON TM-T" and "EPSON TM-T(203dpi) Receipt6"), double-check you've picked the right one.
4. **Check "🕯️ Enable remote printing"** — this is what makes the printer reachable from the server at all. Leaving it unchecked leaves the printer declared (name and share choice remembered) but paused — nobody can print to it, including this workstation itself, until it's turned back on.
5. **Check "🔗 Share this printer"** if you also want *other* devices/workstations in the business to be able to use it — this checkbox is disabled while remote printing itself is off, since there's nothing to share yet. Leave it unchecked to keep the printer usable only by its own workstation.
6. Click **Save**.
7. Click 🖨️ **Test Print**, right there on the same row — no need to navigate to a different admin page to confirm the printer actually works. This sends a real test receipt through the same AGENT-relay path an actual sale would use (not QZ Tray, which is a completely separate print path — see the QZ section above). It's greyed out until remote printing is on, since there's nothing to reach otherwise.

Each printer's current state shows right on its row: a green **"🕯️ Remote printing on"** or grey **"⏸️ Remote printing off"** badge, plus (when remote printing is on) a blue **"🔗 Shared"** or grey **"This workstation only"** badge.

> **Recent Activity** for a printer's relayed jobs shows up on this same **Workstation Agents** page under that workstation's own activity log, alongside its scale jobs — there's no separate log per printer.

A Workstation Always Prints to Its Own Printer First

Once a workstation's printer is declared with remote printing on, that workstation automatically defaults to printing to it — no separate "set my default" step needed, and this works whether or not sharing is turned on. Sharing only controls whether *other* devices can also pick it; it was never required for the printer's own workstation to use it.

Same Printer, Both QZ Tray and AGENT Relay

If the exact same physical printer is set up **both** as a personal QZ Tray printer (Steps 1–4 above, on that workstation) **and** declared here for remote printing, that workstation's row shows an amber **"⚠️ Also set up for QZ Tray"** badge. This is informational only and doesn't block saving — both print paths ultimately go through the real Windows print spooler, which already safely queues concurrent jobs from different programs onto one printer with no risk of receipts merging or corrupting. It's just pointless to run both for the same physical printer, and the badge exists so that's not accidentally left half-configured without anyone noticing.

Default Printers — Per Terminal and Business-Wide

A **per-user** default printer has always been available at 👤 **Profile** → **Printer Setup**'s QZ section and the printer dropdown in the receipt preview — but that only helps once someone has actually picked a printer on that specific device before. A phone that's never printed before, or a new staff member's first shift, previously had nothing to fall back to.

If the device has no scale or printer physically attached to it (a till, tablet, or any browsing-only terminal that will only ever *use* a remote printer, never relay one) — use a **Print Terminal**, not a workstation pairing:

1. From that device, go to **Settings** → **POS Settings** → **Printer Preferences** → **This Device** and click **Register this device**, giving it a name (e.g. "Front Counter Till"). No agent, no download, no pairing — this is a single click that gives the browser a stable identity, nothing more.
2. From **any** machine — an admin does **not** need to be standing at the terminal — go to **Admin** → **Print Terminals** (`/admin/print-terminals`) and pick that terminal's **default printer** from the list of every printer currently shared in the business.

This is a deliberately separate, much simpler page from Workstation Agents — no pairing card, no "waiting for agent," no connection status, because none of that has any meaning for a device with nothing physical attached. If you land on the Workstation Agents pairing flow for a device like this, that's the wrong page — it exists for machines that have an actual scale or printer to relay, not ones that only consume a remote printer.

If the device *does* have its own scale or printer — pair it as a Workstation Agent as usual (Section 13) and declare its printer as described above; it defaults to itself automatically, with nothing further to set.

Overriding a paired workstation's default to point at a *different* workstation — a workstation always defaults to its own printer, but an admin can override that: on `/admin/workstation-agents`, each paired workstation's row has its own **"Default printer for this workstation"** picker, listing every printer currently shared in the business. This is for the case where several workstations share one business and you want a *specific* one of them (not the one that happens to have the printer attached) to route somewhere else by default — e.g. "Front Till" and "Bar Till" both exist, but Front Till should default to the Kitchen printer instead of printing to itself. Leave it on "No override" to keep the automatic self-default.

Business-wide default — the final fallback for a device with neither a terminal registration, a workstation pairing, nor an override (the common case for a phone that's never been set up specially). Set it either at **Settings** → **POS Settings** → **Printer Preferences** (business-owner/admin section, scoped to whichever business you currently have active — reachable from **every** business type now, via the sidebar's POS Settings link, not just restaurant/grocery/clothing/hardware), or at **Admin** → **Default Printer** (`/admin/network-printers`) — a system-admin-only page with a business selector, for setting it centrally without needing to switch your active business first. Both write to the exact same setting; either one works.

Resolution order when a receipt is about to print: the printer you personally picked on this device for this business (if it's still genuinely online) → **an admin-set override for this specific workstation**, if one exists and is online → **this workstation's own declared printer**, if this machine is a paired workstation with remote printing on and it's online → **this device's registered Print Terminal default** or the **business-wide default** (whichever applies — see below), if online → your saved **QZ Tray** printer on this machine, if any → if none of those apply, you're prompted to choose one manually. A device is only ever one of "registered terminal" or "paired workstation," never both, so only one of those two middle steps ever actually applies.

Two things worth knowing about this order:

- **"The printer you personally picked" is remembered per user *and* per business**, not globally per user — picking a printer while working one business never leaks into a different business you later open on the same browser/machine.
- **QZ Tray is always the last thing tried, even if it was the last printer you personally picked.** Every other step above is something the app can actually verify is online right now; QZ Tray's saved choice is just a remembered *name* — there's no way to confirm QZ Tray is actually running without connecting to it, which is deliberately not done automatically (it would trigger a permission prompt every time the receipt preview opens). An unverified guess should never win over a printer the app can confirm is actually reachable.

Clearing a default (selecting "No default set" wherever it's set) removes it and falls through to the next level in the order above. "Forget this device" on the This Device card removes its Print Terminal registration entirely — an admin would need to reassign its default after it registers again.

Mobile devices never register a Print Terminal automatically — registration is always a deliberate click, not something that happens on its own, so a personal phone never accidentally becomes a fixed "terminal" an admin has to manage. Nothing stops someone from registering a genuinely fixed mobile device (a tablet mounted at a table) the same way, if that's actually wanted.

Telling Two Remote Printers Apart, and Overriding On the Fly

Defaults set the automatic choice, but anyone can still open the printer dropdown at print time and pick a **different** one manually — useful when the default printer is busy, jammed, or out of paper and a nearby workstation's shared printer is free instead. For that to actually be usable, the picker needs to show *which workstation* each option belongs to — a bare printer name isn't enough once two workstations happen to use the same printer model (a very ordinary case, not an edge case), and two workstations can even share the same admin-typed label.

Every AGENT-relayed printer in the dropdown shows its paired workstation first, then the printer name, e.g. **"Kitchen Till (dell-hwandaza) — EPSON TM-T"** vs **"Bar Till (dell-04) — EPSON TM-T"** — the part in parentheses is the workstation's actual machine hostname, which is what actually disambiguates two workstations sharing one label (a workstation only shows a hostname here once its agent has reconnected at least once after pairing).

If the Default (or Any) Printer Is Offline

- The receipt preview's printer list shows **(Online)/(Offline)** per printer — for an AGENT-relayed printer this reflects the *real, live* connection status of its paired workstation agent, not a stale flag. An offline printer's row disables the **Print** button entirely until a different, online printer is selected.
- Every default above (terminal, workstation, or business-wide) is only ever auto-selected if it's actually online at that moment — an offline default is skipped silently in favor of prompting you to choose, rather than pre-selecting something that won't work.
- If a printer somehow goes offline in the moment between opening the receipt preview and clicking Print, the failure now surfaces properly: the preview stays open, shows the real error (e.g. "the local agent for its workstation is offline — contact IT"), and marks that printer offline in the list so you can immediately pick another one. (This used to fail silently — the app would say "Receipt sent to printer" and close even though nothing printed; that's fixed.)

- **A printer showing (Offline) that you know is actually working — click "Bring Online" right there in the receipt preview.** This re-checks the printer's real connection state and refreshes the list if it's actually reachable, clearing a stale "offline" reading without needing to reload the page. (This button used to be silently broken for every AGENT-relayed printer specifically — it was checking for a locally-installed printer on the central server itself, which could never succeed for a printer that lives on a remote workstation; that's fixed, so it now checks the same real connection state the admin's Workstation Agents page shows.)
- **You should rarely need "Bring Online" at all any more.** An AGENT-relayed printer's status is now read live from its workstation agent's actual connection every single time the printer list loads — the moment that workstation's agent connects, the printer shows Online automatically, with no manual check needed and no re-saving anything on the workstation's own row.
- **Seeing what looks like a duplicate printer entry — same name, same workstation, one Online and one stuck Offline forever?** This is a leftover from a workstation that was un-paired ("Revoke" on Admin → Workstation Agents) and then paired again — re-pairing always creates a fresh pairing rather than reusing the old one, so the old printer entry from before the revoke can briefly linger. This resolves itself automatically (it's excluded from every printer list the moment the fix is deployed, with no admin action needed) — if you ever see it persist, it's worth flagging to support rather than trying to delete it yourself, since the entry is deliberately kept (not deleted) to preserve that printer's print history.

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27. Stock Velocity & Reorder Reports

These two reports help grocery and retail businesses understand how quickly products are moving and which items need restocking. Both are available to **all salespersons** — no admin permission required. Access them from **Reports** → **Fast & Slow Moving Stock** or **Reports** → **Reorder Suggestions**.

Both show a thumbnail of the item's photo (or a "No image" placeholder) next to its name — same as the Pricing/Cost/Value/Performance reports (§66). Users with Manage Inventory permission (or admin) can click the name to open that item's edit screen directly; closing the edit form returns you to the report instead of the general inventory list.

Stock Velocity Report

Shows how fast every product is selling over the selected period, ranked from fastest to slowest.

How to use:

1. Go to **Grocery** → **Reports** → **Fast & Slow Moving Stock**.
2. Select a date range using the standard filter (Today / Last 7 Days / Last 30 Days / Custom).
3. The report loads automatically.

What you see:

Column	Meaning
Product	Product name, variant, and category
SKU	Product code
Units Sold	Total units sold in the period

Column	Meaning
Avg / Day	Average units sold per day
Current Stock	Stock on hand right now
Days of Stock Left	At the current sales rate, how many days until stock runs out

Sections:

- 🔥 **Fast Moving** — top 20 products by daily sales rate. These are your best sellers.
- 🐌 **Slow Moving** — products selling fewer than 0.1 units per day (or no sales at all). Consider markdowns or returns.

Colour coding for Days of Stock Left:

- 🔴 Red (bold) — fewer than 3 days of stock remaining. Urgent.
- 🟠 Orange — fewer than 7 days. Order soon.
- Grey — more than 7 days. No immediate action needed.

> **Note:** A product must have had at least one sale during the selected period to appear in the Fast Moving section. Products with no sales appear in Slow Moving.

Reorder Suggestions Report

Shows only the products that are running low and need to be reordered, based on their sales velocity. Includes a suggested order quantity and estimated cost.

How to use:

1. Go to **Grocery** → **Reports** → **Reorder Suggestions**.
2. Select a date range — use at least **Last 30 Days** for a reliable velocity estimate.
3. Adjust the thresholds if needed:
    - **Reorder when stock left ≤** — default 7 days. Items with fewer than this many days of stock appear.
    - **Order enough for** — default 30 days. Suggested order qty covers this many days of stock.
4. Click **Export CSV** to download the list for your supplier.

Urgency levels:

- 🔴 **Critical** — fewer than 3 days of stock left. Order immediately.
- 🟡 **Low** — approaching the threshold. Order within the week.

> **Items that never appear:** If a product has no sales history in the selected period and its reorder level is set to zero, the system cannot calculate velocity. Set a reorder level on the product (in inventory settings) to ensure it always appears when stock is low.

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28. Invoices & Quotations

> **Who this is for:** Managers, business owners, and system administrators who need to create formal invoices or quotations for customers.

Invoices and quotations are professional documents you can create, save, print, and track. They pull your company's name, address, and logo automatically from umbrella business settings.

Document Type	Number Format	Use When
Invoice	INV-0001	Billing a customer for goods or services delivered
Quotation	QUO-0001	Providing a price estimate before work begins

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Finding the Page

Click **Invoices & Quotes** in the left sidebar. If you do not see it, ask your system administrator to check your permissions.

Creating a New Invoice

1. Click **+ New Invoice** (blue button, top right).
2. The **New Invoice** modal opens.

Step 1 — Customer details

- Type a customer name in the search box. Matching customers from your customer list will appear — click one to auto-fill their name, phone, email, and address.
- If the customer is not in the system, type their name directly and fill in the remaining fields manually.

Step 2 — Document details

- **Issue Date** — defaults to today. Change if needed.
- **Valid Until** — the date the invoice expires. Defaults to 60 days from today.
- **Notes** — optional internal or customer-facing notes.

Step 3 — Line items

- Each row represents one product or service.
- Fill in **Description**, **Qty**, **Unit Price**, and optionally a **Disc %** (per-line percentage discount).
- The **Total** column calculates automatically.
- Click **+ Add line item** to add more rows (maximum 30).
- Click **×** on a row to remove it.
- Use the **Document Discount** field (below the table) to apply a flat amount discount to the whole document.
- If your business has tax enabled, a tax line and the final **Total** are calculated automatically.

Step 4 — Save

- Click **Save & Preview** to save the invoice and immediately view the printable document.
- Click **Save as Draft** to save without entering preview mode.

Creating a New Quotation

1. Click **+ New Quotation** (amber button, top right).

2. The process is identical to creating an invoice, with two differences:
    - The document is labelled **QUOTATION** with a **QUO-** number.
    - A disclaimer — "*This quotation is subject to change at any time prior to acceptance.*" — is printed at the bottom of the document.
    - Valid-until defaults to **30 days** (shorter than an invoice).

Printing a Document

1. Open an existing invoice or quotation by clicking **View** in the list, or save a new one.
2. In the preview panel, click 🖶 **Print**.
3. A new browser window opens with the formatted A4 document and the print dialog appears automatically.
4. Select your printer and click **Print**.

> **Tip:** The printed document includes your company logo, address, and registration number pulled from umbrella business settings. Make sure those are filled in for a professional result.

Viewing & Managing Existing Documents

On the **Invoices & Quotes** list page:

- **Tabs** — switch between *All*, *Invoices*, and *Quotations*.
- **Status filter** — filter by DRAFT, SENT, ACCEPTED, REJECTED, EXPIRED, or CANCELLED.
- **Search box** — type a customer name or document number (e.g. `INV-0003`) to filter the list. Typing an **exact** document number opens that document immediately.

Click **View** on any row to open the document in preview mode.

Document Status Lifecycle

Status	Meaning	Next Actions
DRAFT	Saved but not yet sent	Mark as Sent, or Cancel
SENT	Delivered to the customer	Mark as Accepted or Rejected
ACCEPTED	Customer agreed	No further transitions
REJECTED	Customer declined	No further transitions
EXPIRED	Quotation past its valid-until date	No further transitions
CANCELLED	Voided	No further transitions

To update a status, open the document (click **View**) and use the action buttons in the preview header.

> **Note:** Cancelled documents are never deleted — they remain in the history for audit purposes.

Setting Up Company Branding (Administrators)

The logo and company details printed on every invoice come from **Umbrella Business Settings**.

1. In the sidebar, click **Umbrella Business Settings**.
2. Scroll to the **Company Logo** card.
3. Click **Upload Logo** and choose a JPG, PNG, or WebP image (max 2 MB).
4. Click **Remove** to clear the logo.

Company name, address, phone, email, and registration number are taken from the main business details fields on the same settings page.

Setting the Invoice / Quotation Start Number (Administrators)

If your business has existing paper invoices and you want the system to continue from a specific number (e.g. start at INV-0051):

1. Go to **Umbrella Business Settings**.
2. Scroll to the **Invoice & Quotation Numbering** card.
3. Enter the desired starting number in the **Invoice Start Number** or **Quotation Start Number** field.
4. Click **Save Numbering Settings**.

The system will never assign a number lower than the start number you set. Existing numbers already issued will not be changed.

Quick Reference — Keyboard & UI Tips

Action	How
Add a line item	Click **+ Add line item** or press Tab past the last field
Remove a line item	Click **×** at the end of the row
Find a document by number	Type the exact number in the search box (e.g. `QUO-0007`)
Print	Open the document → click 🖶 **Print**
Cancel a document	Open the document → click **Cancel Document** in the preview header

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Last updated: April 2026

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29. Restaurant Prep Inventory Tracking

> **Who reads this:** Restaurant managers and owners who prepare food in advance and want to track how many portions are available throughout the day.

This feature lets you record how many portions of each menu item were prepared at the start of each day. The system tracks remaining counts in real time as orders are placed, shows live "N left" badges on the POS, and provides a revenue-vs-cost report.

How It Works — Overview

```
Morning: Manager initialises stock
  → "We prepared 20 portions of Grilled Chicken today, cost $3.50 each"

During the day: POS shows live counts
  → "12 left" badge on the Grilled Chicken card

Orders reduce the count automatically (FIFO)
  → Each sale deducts from the oldest batch first

Evening: Report shows profit per item
  → Revenue, cost, margin for every tracked item
```

Step 1 — Configure Which Items Are Tracked

Before initialising stock, a manager must mark which menu items should be tracked.

1. In the sidebar, click **Restaurant** → **Prep Track Config** (or **Configure Tracked Items**).
2. The page lists all active menu items with prices.
3. Use the **toggle switch** on the right to enable or disable tracking for each item:
    - **Toggle ON (teal)** — item appears on the Initialization page; a "N left" badge shows on the POS.
    - **Toggle OFF (grey)** — item is hidden from initialization; no badge shown. All historical batch data is preserved.
4. Items with **No price set** cannot be tracked (toggle is disabled until a price is added).

Tips:

- Use the search box to quickly find an item by name or category.
- Use the **Tracked only** button to see only the items currently being tracked.
- Click the **Product** or **Price** column headers to sort.

Step 2 — Daily Initialization (Adding Today's Prepared Stock)

Each morning (or whenever a batch is prepared), a manager enters the day's quantities.

1. In the sidebar, click **Restaurant** → **Prep Initialization** (or **Daily Initialization**).
2. Each tracked item appears as a card.
3. For each item, fill in:

Field	What to Enter
Portions today	How many portions were prepared (e.g., 20)
Cost per unit ($)	Price paid for one full raw unit (e.g., $14.00 for one whole chicken)
Portions per unit	How many portions come from that unit (e.g., 4 chicken portions)
Total cost	Calculated automatically — no entry needed

4. The **Cost/portion** figure (top right of each card) is calculated automatically: Cost per unit ÷ Portions per unit.
5. Click **Add Batch** to save. The carried-over count from previous days is shown in amber — no action required, it is already counted.

> **Carry-over:** If portions were left over from yesterday's batch, they are shown with an amber left border and "X carried over" label. You do not need to re-enter them — they are already in stock.

> **Permissions:** Only users with the **Manager**, **Owner**, or **Admin** role can add batches.

POS — Live "N left" Badges

Once stock is initialized, the POS automatically shows remaining counts on tracked item cards:

Badge colour	Meaning
Orange	More than 5 portions remaining
Amber	5 or fewer portions remaining — consider preparing more
Red "Out of prep"	0 portions remaining — the card stays enabled; selling is still allowed

Badges update automatically after each order is completed. If an item shows "Out of prep" but food was prepared, a manager can add a new batch on the Initialization page and counts will update immediately.

Reports — Revenue vs Cost

1. In the sidebar, click **Restaurant** → **Reports** → **Prep Inventory**.
2. Set a **Start Date** and **End Date** and click **Load Report**.
3. The summary cards show totals across all tracked items:
   - **Units Initialized** — total portions prepared in the date range
   - **Units Sold** — portions actually sold
   - **Total Revenue** — units sold × selling price
   - **Total Cost** — sum of batch costs
   - **Net Profit** — Revenue − Cost
4. The detail table breaks down each item individually with a **Margin %** column.

Backup & Restore — New Tables

The following tables are included in all system backups automatically:

Table	Contents
`menu_item_inventory_config`	Which menu items have tracking enabled
`menu_item_inventory_batches`	Every batch ever initialized (quantity, cost, remaining count)

Verification after restore: Confirm both tables are present and populated:

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM menu_item_inventory_config;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM menu_item_inventory_batches;
```

Both counts should match the source system. If either returns 0 but the source had data, re-run the restore — these tables are near the end of the restore order and may have been skipped due to a prior FK error on `businessProducts`.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Item not appearing on Initialization page	Go to **Prep Track Config** and ensure the toggle is ON for that item
Badge not showing on POS	Item may not have any initialized batches for today. Add a batch on the Initialization page
Cost/portion shows nothing	Enter both "Cost per unit" and "Portions per unit" — both fields are required for the calculation
"Add Batch" button greyed out	Fill in all required fields: Portions today, Cost per unit, Portions per unit
Counts not updating after an order	Refresh the POS page — counts update on each checkout completion
Report shows 0 revenue	No batches were initialized in the selected date range, or no sales matched tracked items

For technical support, contact your system administrator.

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30. Salesperson EOD Reporting

> **Who reads this:** Salespersons who submit daily cash/EcoCash reports, and managers who review those reports and reconcile them against the system's End-of-Day figures.

When **Salesperson EOD** is enabled for a business, every salesperson must submit a daily report declaring how much cash and EcoCash they collected. Managers see those reports alongside the system EOD figures to quickly spot discrepancies.

Overview — How It Works

```
Each day (before the deadline):
  Salesperson submits their cash + EcoCash totals
    → Status: PENDING → SUBMITTED

Manager runs End of Day:
  Salesperson EOD section shows on the EOD page
```

```
    If all submitted → Cash Counted auto-fills from their totals
    If any salesperson hasn't submitted → Save is blocked

  Manager can override a missing submission:
    → Status becomes OVERRIDDEN (with a reason)

  Saved (locked) EOD report captures the full salesperson breakdown
    → Shows each person's figures, status, and any discrepancies
```

Salesperson — Submitting Your Daily Report

Where: Sidebar → **EOD** → **Submit Daily Report**

1. Select today's date (defaults to today).
2. Enter the **Cash Total** — total cash you physically collected during the day.
3. The **EcoCash Total** is **automatically calculated** from POS system records and shown as a **read-only** field. You do not enter this — it is pulled directly from the system.
4. Add any **Notes** (optional).
5. Click **Submit Report**.

After submission you are taken directly back to the **POS** to continue serving customers.

> **Note for Grocery Associates:** The **Submit Daily Report** and **My EOD History** links are visible in the sidebar for grocery-associate role members on grocery businesses, in addition to the standard salesperson role.

Rules:

- **One report per date.** Once submitted for a date, the figures cannot be changed.
- The Submit button is **disabled** while the system fetches the EcoCash total. Wait for it to load before submitting.
- A manager can override an overdue or missing submission on your behalf.

Status badges:

Badge	Meaning
Submitted (green)	Report accepted for this date
Pending (amber)	Not yet submitted
Overdue (red)	Deadline passed and no report submitted
Overridden (purple)	Manager entered figures on your behalf

Salesperson — Viewing Your History & Catching Up Missed Dates

Where: Sidebar → **EOD** → **My EOD History**

The history page shows all your past reports in card format:

- **Date**, **Cash Total**, **EcoCash Total**, **Status**, and the time you submitted.
- If a report was **Overridden**, the override reason appears in a highlighted callout box.
- Use the **From / To** date filters to narrow the list.
- Pagination (20 per page) — use **Previous / Next** at the bottom to browse older records.

> **Today's pending record** is hidden from the history list until the business EOD deadline time has passed, so you are not distracted by it during your shift.

Submitting a Catch-Up Report for a Missed Date

If a past date shows as **Pending** in your history, a **Submit** button appears next to it.

1. Click **Submit** on the pending row to expand a form.
2. Enter the **Cash** you collected on that date.
3. The **EcoCash** field is **read-only** and auto-filled from order records for that specific calendar day — wait for it to load before submitting.
4. Add any notes (optional).
5. Click **Submit EOD Report**.

The record changes to **Submitted** and the row updates immediately.

> If a manager already submitted an override for a past date, it shows as **Override** with the manager's figures — you cannot re-submit over an override.

Manager — Reviewing Salesperson Reports

Where: Sidebar → **EOD** → **Manager EOD View** (or **Staff EOD Status**)

The manager page shows all salespersons' statuses for a selected date:

Column	Meaning
Name	Salesperson's display name
Cash Total	Amount they declared
EcoCash Total	EcoCash amount they declared
Status	SUBMITTED / PENDING / OVERDUE
Submitted At	Timestamp of submission

Filtering:

- Use the **Date** picker to view any past date.
- Use the **Status** filter to show only Pending, Submitted, or Overdue.

Overriding any submission:

The **Override** button appears on every record regardless of status. Use it to correct wrong figures or submit on behalf of a salesperson who didn't submit.

1. Click **Override** next to the salesperson's row.
2. Enter the correct **Cash** and **EcoCash** amounts.
3. Enter a short **Reason** (e.g. "Staff forgot to submit — figures confirmed from till").
4. Click **Submit Override**.

The record changes to **Overridden** and both the salesperson and manager can see the reason.

Back to EOD Report: A ← **Back to EOD Report** link at the top of this page takes you directly back to the business End-of-Day report page.

Manager — Dashboard Widget

On the main **Dashboard**, managers see a compact **Salesperson EOD Status** widget showing:

- **X / Y submitted** — how many salespersons have submitted out of the total required.
- A progress bar: green (all submitted), amber (some pending), red (deadline passed with missing reports).
- A **View all** → link that opens the full Manager EOD View.

The widget only appears when **Salesperson EOD** is enabled for the business and the logged-in user has the **Can Close Books** permission.

Manager — EOD Integration (Auto-Fill & Blocking Save)

When salesperson EOD is enabled, a **Salesperson EOD Reports** section appears on the End-of-Day report page, above Till Reconciliation. It shows:

- A progress bar (green = all done, amber = some pending).
- Each salesperson's name, status, cash total, EcoCash total, and submission time.
- An **Open EOD Manager** → link to jump directly to the Manager EOD View.
- An **Override** button for any salesperson whose report is overdue from a past date.

Auto-fill of Cash Counted:

When all salespersons have submitted (or been overridden), the **Cash Counted** field in the Till Reconciliation section is **automatically filled** with the combined cash total from all salesperson submissions. A note "✓ Auto-filled from salesperson EOD submissions — edit if different" confirms this. You can override the auto-filled value by typing directly in the field.

Blocking Save:

The Save & Lock buttons are blocked until all salesperson statuses show **Submitted** or **Overridden**. To unblock: either wait for the salesperson to submit, or click **Open EOD Manager** → and use the **Override** button.

Manager — Saved (Locked) EOD Report — Salesperson Breakdown

When an EOD report is saved and locked, the full salesperson submission breakdown is permanently captured inside the report.

Where: Reports → Saved Reports → View any locked EOD report.

The **Salesperson EOD Submissions** section in a saved report shows:

Status badge at the top:

Badge	Meaning
✅ **ALL CLEAR** (green)	All salespersons submitted, no cash discrepancy
⚠️ **ISSUES FOUND** (red)	One or more problems detected — see flags below

Issue flags (shown when relevant):

Flag	Meaning
⛔ Red alert	One or more salespersons did not submit before books were closed
⚠️ Amber alert	One or more reports were submitted via manager override
❌ / 💰 Cash discrepancy	The manager's Cash Counted differs from the salespersons' combined cash total — shows exact shortfall or overage

Per-person table:

Column	Meaning
Salesperson	Staff member's name
Status	Submitted / Override / ⛔ Not submitted
Cash	Cash amount they declared
EcoCash	EcoCash amount they declared
Submitted	Time of submission
By	Who submitted — shows "(mgr)" when a manager submitted on their behalf

Rows with ⛔ **Not submitted** status are highlighted red. The totals row at the bottom sums submitted records only.

This breakdown is permanently locked with the report and cannot be changed after saving.

Manager — Discrepancy Report

Where: Sidebar → **Reports** → **EOD Discrepancy**

This report compares what salespersons declared against what the POS system recorded.

Daily Tab:

Column	Meaning
Date	Report date

Column	Meaning
Salesperson	Name of the staff member
SP Cash	Cash total from the salesperson's submission
SP EcoCash	EcoCash total from the salesperson's submission
System Cash	Cash recorded in the system EOD for that day
System EcoCash	EcoCash recorded in the system EOD
Cash Variance	SP Cash − System Cash (red if negative, green if positive)
EcoCash Variance	SP EcoCash − System EcoCash

Colour coding:

- **Green** — Salesperson declared more than the system recorded (over-declaration).
- **Red** — Salesperson declared less than the system recorded (shortfall).
- **No highlight** — Figures match exactly.

Filtering:

- Use **From / To** date pickers to select a date range.
- Click **Export CSV** to download the data for further analysis.

Summary Tab (Weekly / Monthly):

Switch to the **Summary** tab and choose **Weekly** or **Monthly** grouping to see aggregated variances over time.

Each row shows:

- **Period** — week starting date or month name.
- **Reports** — number of individual daily reports in that period.
- **Total SP Cash / SP EcoCash** — sum of declared amounts.
- **Total Sys Cash / Sys EcoCash** — sum of system amounts.
- **Cash Variance / EcoCash Variance** — total difference for the period.
- **Trend arrow** — ↑ variance increased vs prior period, ↓ decreased, → unchanged.

Summary stat cards at the top show totals for the selected date range.

Admin — Enabling Salesperson EOD

Where: Business Settings → EOD Settings (or Admin → Business Config)

Setting	Description
Require Salesperson EOD	Toggle ON to activate the feature for this business

Setting	Description
EOD Deadline Time	The cut-off time by which reports must be submitted (e.g. `18:00`). Today's pending record is hidden from the salesperson's history list until this time passes.

Once enabled, the Submit Daily Report and My EOD History links appear in salespersons' (and grocery-associates') sidebars, and the Manager EOD View / EOD Discrepancy links appear for managers.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
"Submit Daily Report" not in sidebar	Feature may not be enabled for this business, or your role is not recognised. Ask your admin to turn on **Require Salesperson EOD** in Business Settings and verify your membership role
EcoCash field shows $0.00	No EcoCash sales were recorded since your last submission. If you believe there were EcoCash sales, ask a manager to check the POS records
Submit button is greyed out	The system is still fetching the EcoCash total — wait a moment for it to load, then the button will enable
Report already submitted — can't change figures	Ask a manager to use the **Override** button on the Manager EOD View page to correct the amounts
EOD Save button blocked	The Salesperson EOD section on the EOD report page shows who is still Pending. Click **Open EOD Manager** → and use Override to unblock
Cash Counted did not auto-fill	Auto-fill only triggers when **all** salespersons have submitted or been overridden, and Cash Counted is still empty. If one person is still Pending, auto-fill waits
EcoCash codes show "—" in the Save modal	Those transactions were processed before automatic code capture was enabled. All new transactions will show their codes correctly
Discrepancy report shows no data	Ensure the date range includes dates where both salesperson reports AND system EOD saves exist
Dashboard widget not visible	Widget only shows for users with **Can Close Books** permission when the feature is enabled
Saved report shows no Salesperson section	The salesperson section only appears in reports saved after this feature was enabled. Older locked reports do not have the breakdown

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For technical support, contact your system administrator.

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31. Restaurant Delivery Service

> **Who reads this:** Restaurant cashiers and sales staff who take phone-in orders, managers who dispatch drivers and review delivery reports, and delivery drivers who fulfil runs.

The Restaurant Delivery Service lets the restaurant accept phone-in orders, track delivery status from Pending through to Delivered, manage per-customer prepaid credit accounts, dispatch named drivers with vehicle and odometer tracking, print kitchen + customer receipts, and fully reconcile cash collected by drivers.

Delivery window: 12:00 PM – 2:00 PM daily (informational — orders outside this window show a warning but are not blocked).

Overview — How It Works

```
Customer calls in → Staff creates delivery order in POS
  → New customer created on the fly if needed
  → Credit deducted automatically (if available)
  → Two receipts auto-print: Kitchen copy (with items + barcode) + Customer copy

Manager prints Driver Sheet before dispatch
  → Staff or manager assigns orders to a delivery run
  → Driver takes the sheet, leaves customer receipt at each stop, collects cash

Driver returns → Manager marks orders Delivered
  → Staff or manager records cash collected per order
  → Payments page reconciles total due vs collected

Manager closes run → odometer end saved, run marked complete
```

Cashier / Staff — Taking a Delivery Order

1. Open the restaurant POS.
2. Select **Delivery** as the order type (alongside Dine-In / Takeaway).
3. Search for the customer by name or phone number, **or** click **New Customer** to register them on the spot — enter their name and phone number, then click **Create & Select**. Phone numbers are formatted automatically as you type.
    - **Credit badge:** Any customer with a delivery credit balance shows a green **$X.XX credit** badge next to their name in the search dropdown. This lets you confirm the balance at a glance without opening the account. Blacklisted customers show a red **Blocked** badge instead.
4. Add items to the cart as normal.
5. (Optional) Enter a **Delivery Note** — address or special instructions.
6. The customer panel shows their **delivery credit balance** and blacklist status:
    - If blacklisted → checkout is blocked; reason is shown.
    - If outside 12–2 PM → amber warning banner (order is not blocked).
7. At checkout, the credit deduction preview shows: **"Credit: −$X.XX | Due on delivery: $X.XX"**
8. Complete the sale. Two receipts print automatically:
    - **Kitchen copy** — full item names and quantities, no prices, "DELIVERY" header, plus a scannable barcode (`DEL-XXXX`) matching the order.
    - **Customer copy** — full receipt with credit used, balance due, remaining credit, and the barcode. This receipt stays with the customer.

Paying the Remainder with EcoCash (Credit + EcoCash Split)

If a customer's credit only partially covers the order total, you can collect the remainder via EcoCash at the POS:

1. At checkout the credit section shows the amount being applied and the **remaining balance due**.
2. Select **EcoCash** as the payment method.
3. Enter the EcoCash reference code.
4. Click **Complete Sale**.

The EcoCash fee is calculated **only on the remainder** (not the full order total). For example, if the order is $51.84 and the customer has $45.00 credit, EcoCash is charged on $6.84 — the fee is a fraction of what it would be on the full amount.

What the **customer receipt** shows:

```
CREDIT PAYMENT
  Opening balance      $45.00
  Credit applied      -$45.00
  Remaining balance    $0.00

Payment: EcoCash + Credit
  EcoCash Ref: XXXX
  EcoCash charged      $6.84
  EcoCash Fee          $0.24
  EcoCash Total        $7.08
```

What the **delivery copy** (printed at POS) shows:

```
** PAID **
Credit + EcoCash $7.08
```

The delivery copy confirms the order is fully settled — the driver does not need to collect any cash on delivery.

Manager — Customer Credit Accounts

Where: Sidebar → **Delivery** → **Customer Accounts**

Each customer can have a delivery credit account. Credit is pre-loaded by management and deducted automatically at checkout.

The page opens with a **Customer Balances** list showing all customers who currently have a credit balance, sorted highest first. Each row shows name, phone, and balance.

Quick top-up from the list:

1. Find the customer in the Customer Balances list.

2. Click **+ Top Up** next to their row.
3. Enter the amount and optional notes, then click **Add Credit**.
4. The balance on the row updates immediately — no page reload.

Adding credit via search (including new accounts):

1. Use the **Find Customer** search box to look up by name or phone.
2. Click the customer to open their account detail.
3. Click **Add Credit**, enter the amount and notes, then save.
4. The Customer Balances list updates instantly — if the customer was not previously on the list (first ever top-up), they are added automatically. No page reload required.

Partial credit: If a customer's credit is less than their order total, available credit is deducted and the remainder is collected on delivery.

Blacklisting a customer:

1. Open the customer's account page (via Find Customer).
2. Click **Blacklist Customer**.
3. Enter the reason (required).
4. Save. The customer is immediately blocked from placing delivery orders.

To lift a ban: click **Remove from Blacklist** on the same page.

Manager — Delivery Queue

Where: Sidebar → **Delivery** → **Delivery Queue**

Shows all delivery orders for today grouped by status:

Status	Meaning
Pending	Order received, not yet prepared
Ready	Kitchen has prepared the order
Dispatched	Order is with the driver on a run
Delivered	Driver has returned and delivery is confirmed
Cancelled	Order was cancelled before preparation

Who can advance status:

Transition	Who can do it
Pending → Ready	Staff with `canUpdateDeliveryStatus` or manager
Ready → Dispatched	Staff with `canUpdateDeliveryStatus` or manager
Dispatched → Delivered	**Managers only** (`canManageDeliveryRuns`)
Cancel (Pending only)	**Managers only**

Date restrictions on status changes:

Role	Allowed date range
Staff	**Today only** — cannot change status on orders from a previous day
Manager / Owner	Up to **5 days back** — older orders are locked

If you try to update a status outside your allowed range, the system will return an error with a clear message. This prevents accidental late edits or back-dated changes.

Viewing past orders: Use the date filter to see historical orders and runs.

Reverting Status (Correcting Errors)

Managers can reverse a status change if a mistake was made:

1. Find the order card on the Delivery Queue page.
2. Click **↩ Revert to [Previous Status]** (amber button, managers only).
3. Enter a **reason** — this is mandatory and is recorded in the audit log.
4. Click **Confirm**.

The status steps back one level: Delivered → Dispatched → Ready → Pending.

> **Lock rule:** If a Delivered order already has payment collected recorded, the revert button is hidden and the status is permanently locked. This prevents altering records after cash has been reconciled.

Cancelling an order (Pending only):

- Click **Cancel Order** (red button, managers only) on any Pending order.
- Enter a reason. If the customer had credit applied, it is automatically restored to their account.
- A cancelled delivery order is **excluded from all sales and EOD reports** — the underlying sale record is voided automatically so it does not inflate revenue figures or appear in end-of-day totals.

Status History & Audit Trail

Every status change — including who made it, when, and the reason — is permanently recorded.

To view the history of any order:

1. Click the 🕐 **clock icon** on the order card.
2. A history panel opens showing each transition: `FROM → TO`, the staff member's name, the timestamp, and the reason given.

This log cannot be edited or deleted.

Printing — Driver Sheet & Kitchen Batch

Three print options are available on the Delivery Queue toolbar:

Button	Who can use	What it prints
Driver Sheet (A4)	Staff + Managers	A4 browser-printable sheet: all active orders with customer names, phones, notes, amount due, checkbox column, and collected $ lines. Includes driver/vehicle blank fields and signature lines.
Driver Sheet (Thermal)	Staff + Managers	Same content printed to the receipt printer as a single continuous roll. Orders are separated by a `- - - FOLD HERE - - -` fold line (no paper cut between orders). Driver tears off the roll and folds at each line for easy handling.
Print Kitchen Batch	Managers	Sends a kitchen receipt for every Pending order — each showing the full item names, quantities, delivery note, and order barcode.

Recommended workflow:

1. Print the **Driver Sheet (Thermal)** before dispatch — driver carries the roll.
2. At each stop the driver leaves the **customer receipt** (printed at POS), collects cash, and marks the order as done on the sheet.
3. On return the manager marks each order **Delivered** and records cash collected.

Manager — Creating a Delivery Run

1. On the Delivery Queue page, click **Create Run**.
2. Select the **Driver** (from registered employees).
3. Select the **Vehicle** (from vehicle management) or enter the plate number manually.
4. Enter the **Odometer Start** reading.
5. Assign orders to the run — tick the orders the driver will deliver.
6. Click **Dispatch**. The orders move to **Dispatched** status.
7. A run sheet is sent to the receipt printer automatically on dispatch.

Closing a run:

1. When the driver returns, open the run.
2. Enter the **Odometer End** reading.
3. Click **Complete Run**.

Collecting & Recording Cash — Payments Page

Where: Delivery Queue → **Payments** button (green, top right)

After orders are marked Delivered, managers or staff record the cash actually collected from each order:

1. Open the Payments page and select the date.
2. Find any order showing **"+ Record"** in the Collected column.
3. Click **+ Record** to open an inline input field.
4. Type the amount received and press **Enter** (or click ✓).
5. The amount is saved and the person who recorded it is stored against the order.

The page shows:

- **Total Due** — sum of all delivered ON_DELIVERY orders
- **Collected** — cash recorded so far
- **Shortfall** — difference (shown in red if > $0)
- **Recorded by** — the staff member who entered each collection amount (shown in the Notes column)

Previously recorded amounts can be updated by clicking on the displayed amount.

Manager — Delivery Reports

Where: Sidebar → **Delivery** → **Reports**

Four report types available:

Report	What it shows
Delivery Sales	Orders, revenue, credit used, cash to collect — by date range
Customer Credit	Per-customer top-up and deduction history, current balance
Blacklist	All bans — customer, reason, banned by, date, lifted date
Driver Runs	Per run: driver, vehicle, odometer start/end, distance, orders delivered, cash collected

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EOD Integration — Delivery Prepayments

When a customer tops up their delivery credit account with cash, that cash goes into the till. The End-of-Day cash reconciliation automatically includes **Delivery Prepayments** as a separate line item in the expected cash calculation.

On days with no credit top-ups the line is hidden to keep the EOD clean.

Permissions

All delivery permissions are individually toggleable in **User Management** → **Edit Permissions** → **Delivery Service** for any restaurant staff member.

Permission	What it controls
`canViewDeliveryQueue`	See the delivery management page
`canCreateDeliveryOrders`	Place delivery orders at the POS
`canUpdateDeliveryStatus`	Mark Ready / Dispatched; print driver sheets; create customers on the fly
`canManageDeliveryRuns`	Create runs, assign driver + vehicle, enter odometer; **mark Delivered**; revert / cancel orders
`canManageDeliveryCredit`	Top up customer delivery credit accounts

Permission	What it controls
`canManageDeliveryBlacklist`	Ban or unban customers from delivery
`canViewDeliveryReports`	Access delivery reports and Payments page
`canPrintDeliveryMarketing`	Print delivery marketing materials

> **Key distinction:** Only users with `canManageDeliveryRuns` (managers) can mark an order Delivered or revert/cancel status changes. Staff with `canUpdateDeliveryStatus` (e.g. salesperson/cashier) can move orders from Pending → Ready → Dispatched and print driver sheets, but the final delivery confirmation belongs to the manager.

To grant or change individual permissions:

1. Go to **Business Settings** → **Members**.
2. Click the employee.
3. Open the **Permissions** tab.
4. Scroll to **Delivery Service** and toggle the required permissions.

Marketing Materials

Where: Sidebar → **Delivery** → **Marketing**

Two printable templates for promoting the delivery service:

- **A5 Flyer** — featured menu items (live from the active menu), delivery hours, restaurant name and phone number.
- **Business Card** (4-up on A4 for cutting) — bold "Order by phone" call-to-action with delivery hours and contact details.

Click **Print** on either template to send directly to your printer. Navigation is hidden in print mode.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Delivery order type not showing in POS	Feature requires the restaurant business type — contact your admin
"Insufficient permissions" when creating a new customer	User needs `canUpdateDeliveryStatus` or higher delivery permission
Checkout blocked — "Customer is blacklisted"	Management must lift the ban on the Customer Accounts page before the order can proceed
Receipts didn't print automatically	Check printer connection and QZ Tray status; use "Reprint" on the order detail page
Kitchen copy shows "Item x2" with no name	The product may not be linked to a menu item — check the product variant in the menu

Issue	Solution
"Mark Delivered" button not showing	Only managers with `canManageDeliveryRuns` see this button
Revert button not showing on Delivered order	Payment has already been collected — the status is locked to protect financial records
Driver Sheet (Thermal) not printing	No printer configured — set up your receipt printer via QZ Tray Setup on the delivery page or your profile
Barcode scan didn't open status modal	Ensure the barcode is a `DEL-` delivery barcode, not a product or customer barcode
Run Sheet not printing	Confirm orders have been assigned to the run before clicking Print Run Sheet

---

32. Business Asset Management

> **Who reads this:** Business owners and managers who want to track physical and digital assets, record depreciation, log maintenance history, and manage asset disposal.

Asset Management is available to all business types. It tracks every asset from purchase through to disposal, calculates book value over time using straight-line or declining-balance depreciation, and produces financial reports on asset values, maintenance costs, and disposals.

Access: Sidebar → **Assets**. Requires the **Manage Assets** permission.

Overview — Asset Lifecycle

```
Add Asset → Record Depreciation (monthly / annually) → Log Maintenance
                                                              ↓
                                                        Dispose Asset
                                                (Sale | Gift | Trade-In | Scrap | Write-Off)
```

Adding an Asset

1. Go to **Assets** in the sidebar.
2. Click **Add Asset**.
3. Fill in the details:

Field	Description
Name	Descriptive name (e.g. "HP LaserJet 4015")
Category	Select from the list (Vehicles, Office Equipment, Furniture, IT Equipment, Machinery & Tools, Land & Buildings, or any custom category)

Field	Description
Serial Number	Optional — useful for warranty and insurance claims
Location	Where the asset is kept (e.g. "Head Office", "Store Room")
Purchase Date	Date acquired
Purchase Price	Amount paid
Depreciation Method	Straight-Line, Double-Declining Balance, or None
Useful Life (years)	How many years before the asset reaches its salvage value
Salvage Value	Estimated residual value at end of useful life

4. Click **Save**. The system auto-generates a unique **Asset Tag** (e.g. `RST-AST-0001`) for labelling.

Depreciation Methods

Method	How it works	Best for
Straight-Line	Equal amount each year: (Purchase − Salvage) ÷ Useful Life	Furniture, equipment with steady wear
Double-Declining Balance	2× straight-line rate on current book value each year; front-loads depreciation	Vehicles, IT equipment (lose value quickly)
None	Book value never changes	Land, collectibles

Depreciation is **manually triggered** — the system calculates the amount but you choose when to record each period. This keeps your records under your control.

Recording Depreciation

1. Open the asset detail page (click any asset in the list).
2. Click **Record Depreciation** (in the footer action bar or on the Depreciation History tab).
3. Select the **Period Date** (typically the last day of the month or year).
4. The calculated amount is pre-filled — override it if needed.
5. Add optional notes.
6. Click **Save**. The book value updates immediately.

The **Depreciation History** tab shows all past entries. Entries cannot be edited or deleted — they are an append-only audit trail.

The **Details** tab shows a projected depreciation schedule for future periods.

Logging Maintenance

1. Open the asset detail page.
2. Click **Log Maintenance** (or go to the **Maintenance** tab and click **Add Maintenance**).
3. Fill in:

Field	Description
Date	When maintenance was performed
Type	Preventive / Corrective / Inspection
Description	What was done
Cost	Optional — what was paid
Vendor	Who performed the work
Next Maintenance Date	Optional reminder for next scheduled service

---

Asset Photos

The **Photos** tab on the asset detail page lets you attach photos of the asset (useful for insurance and audits).

- Click **Upload Photo** to add an image.
- Click **Set as Primary** to make a photo the main display image.
- Click the bin icon to delete a photo.
- Click any photo to open a full-size lightbox view.

Disposing of an Asset

When an asset is sold, gifted, traded in, scrapped, or written off:

1. Open the asset detail page.
2. Click **Dispose Asset**.
3. Select the **Disposal Method**: Sale / Gift / Trade-In / Scrap / Write-Off.
4. Enter the **Disposal Date** and **Sale/Trade Value** (for Sale or Trade-In).
5. Enter the **Recipient** (for Gift or Sale).
6. Review the **Gain/Loss on Disposal** (disposal value vs current book value).
7. Click **Confirm Dispose**.

> **This action cannot be undone.** The asset status changes to Disposed and it no longer appears in the active asset list.

Asset Register Page

The main `/assets` page shows:

- **Summary bar**: Total assets, total book value, assets with low book value, assets disposed this year.
- **Filters**: Business (multi-business users), Category, Status (Active / Maintenance / Disposed / Written Off).
- **Search**: by name, asset tag, or serial number.

- **Table**: Asset Tag | Name | Category | Purchase Price | Book Value | Status | Purchase Date.

Click any row to open the asset detail page.

Reports

Where: Assets page → **Reports** tab

Report	What it shows
Asset Value by Category	Total book value grouped by asset category
Depreciation Summary	Total depreciation charged YTD and cumulative since purchase
Disposal Report	All disposed assets with gain/loss calculation — filter by date range
Maintenance Cost Report	Total maintenance spend per asset and per category

---

Managing Categories

Where: Sidebar → **Assets** → **Manage Categories**

Six system-wide default categories are provided (read-only). You can create custom categories specific to your business with default depreciation settings so new assets in that category are pre-configured.

Permissions

The **Manage Assets** permission controls full access to the Assets module (view, create, edit, depreciate, dispose). Owners and Managers have this permission by default. It can be enabled per employee via the Permissions editor.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Assets link not visible in sidebar	Account needs the **Manage Assets** permission — ask your admin
"Record Depreciation" button greyed out	Asset may already be disposed, or depreciation method is set to "None"
Book value went below salvage value	The system warns if an entry would do this — override only if intentional
Asset tag not printing	Use the barcode label printing feature (reuse existing barcode templates) — tag format: `{BUS-TYPE}-AST-NNNN`
Photos tab not showing	Photos feature requires the asset to be saved first

---

33. Inventory Expiry Tracking

> **Who reads this:** Stock managers, purchasing officers, and any staff responsible for managing perishable inventory. Also relevant to managers who authorize disposing of or discounting expired stock.

Expiry Tracking lets you record the expiry date for each batch of stock received, see real-time alerts when batches are near expiry or have expired, and take action — either dispose of the stock (records an EXPIRED movement) or create a discounted product that appears in the POS with an "Expiry Deal" or "BOGO" badge.

Overview — How It Works

```
Stock received → Record batch with optional expiry date
                  (Custom Bulk Top-Up, Quick Stock Modal, or Bulk Stocking Panel)

System monitors expiry dates:
  → Within 7 days: 🟡 Near Expiry alert
  → Past expiry: 🔴 Expired alert

Manager takes action per batch:
  → Dispose: records EXPIRED stock movement, reduces qty
  → Price Reduction: creates new product at discounted price with "Expiry Deal"
badge
  → BOGO: creates new product at 50% price with "BOGO" badge
```

Recording Expiry Dates at Intake

Expiry dates are entered when stocking inventory. They are **optional** — if omitted, a batch row is still created (for intake history) but no expiry alert is generated.

Custom Bulk Top-Up:

- The bulk entry table has an **Expiry Date** column per row.
- Each line item creates its own batch. The same product can have multiple batches with different expiry dates.

Quick Stock Modal:

- An **Expiry Date** date field is available alongside the quantity field.

Bulk Stocking Panel:

- An **Expiry Date** column is available in the stocking table rows.

Dashboard Alert Widget

When any batches are near expiry or expired, a widget appears on the main **Dashboard**:

```
🔴  X batches EXPIRED — Requires action
🟡  Y batches EXPIRING WITHIN 7 DAYS — Review soon
                [View All Expiring Items →]
```

- Counts are batch-level (one product with two expiring batches counts as 2).
- Widget is hidden when both counts are zero.
- Visible to users with **Can View Stock Alerts** or **Can Manage Expiry Actions** permission.
- Click the link to open the Expiry Management page.

Expiry Management Page

Where: Sidebar → **Expiry**

Needs Action tab shows all unresolved batches that are expired or expiring within 7 days:

Column	Meaning
Barcode	Product barcode
Name	Product name
Batch Qty	Units in this specific batch
Expiry Date	When the batch expires
Status	🔴 "X days ago" (expired) or 🟡 "X days" (near expiry)
Actions	Dispose / Apply Discount buttons

Row background: red for expired, amber for near-expiry.

Resolved tab shows the full action history — what was disposed or discounted, by whom, and when.

Filters: Filter by All / Expired / Expiring This Week, or search by product name or barcode.

Taking Action on Expired Stock

Dispose

Use when the stock must be destroyed.

1. Click **Dispose** on the batch row.
2. Enter the **Quantity to Dispose** (up to the full batch quantity).
3. Add optional notes.
4. Click **Confirm Dispose**.

The system records an **EXPIRED** stock movement and reduces the product's inventory count by the disposed quantity. If the full batch quantity is disposed, the batch is marked Resolved.

Apply Expiry Discount — Price Reduction

Creates a new product at a reduced price that appears in the POS with an **"Expiry Deal"** badge.

1. Click **Discount** on the batch row.
2. Choose **Price Reduction**.
3. Enter:
    - **Quantity to move** — units to transfer to the discounted product.
    - **New price per unit** — the discounted selling price.
    - **New product name** — defaults to "{Original Name} - Expiry Deal".
4. The system auto-generates a new barcode (e.g. `EXP-2604-7291`).
5. Click **Apply**.

The source product's stock quantity reduces by the moved quantity. The new discounted product appears in inventory and the POS immediately.

Apply Expiry Discount — BOGO (Buy 1 Get 1)

Creates a new product at 50% of the original price with a **"BOGO"** badge.

1. Click **Discount** → **BOGO (Buy 1 Get 1)**.
2. Enter the quantity to move.
3. The price is calculated automatically at 50%.
4. Click **Apply**.

Expiry Deal Indicators in the POS and Inventory

Products created via a discount action carry a visible badge throughout the system:

Location	Badge
Universal POS card	Teal ribbon at the bottom: "Expiry Deal" or "BOGO"
Grocery POS card	Same teal ribbon
Inventory list	Teal pill badge next to the product name
Product detail	Info banner: "⚠️ Expiry-discounted product. [View original →]"

These badges render only on discounted items; no change to the appearance of normal products.

Inventory Item Batches View

On the **Inventory Item Detail** page (the insights panel), a **Batch History** section shows:

- All batches received for that item.
- Receipt date, quantity, expiry date (if set), and status (Active / Near Expiry / Expired / Resolved).

This gives a full picture of stock intake and expiry status without leaving the product record.

Permissions

Permission	What it controls
`canViewStockAlerts`	See expiry alerts on the dashboard and Expiry Management page
`canManageExpiryActions`	Take action — dispose or create discounted products

Owners and Managers have both permissions by default. Supervisors and below do not — enable per employee via the Permissions editor if needed.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Expiry date field not visible in bulk entry	Ensure you are on the Custom Bulk Top-Up, Quick Stock, or Bulk Stocking Panel — not an older entry form
Alert widget not on dashboard	User needs `canViewStockAlerts` or `canManageExpiryActions` permission; also hidden when no batches are near/past expiry
"Dispose" / "Discount" buttons not showing	Requires the `canManageExpiryActions` permission
New discounted product not appearing in POS	Products sync on page refresh — reload the POS after creating the discount product
Batch shows as expired but stock was already sold	The batch quantity reflects what was received; sold units reduce the parent product's total stock, not individual batch quantities. Use Dispose to write off remaining physical stock
Expiry deal badge not showing on POS card	Confirm the product was created via the Discount action (has `isExpiryDiscount = true`). Manually created products will not have this flag

---

34. Policy Management & Employee Acknowledgment

> **Who reads this:** Business owners, managers (creating and publishing policies), and all employees (reading and acknowledging policies).

Overview

The Policy Management system lets you create, version, assign, and track employee acknowledgment of workplace policies — HR policies, safety rules, conduct standards, and any other documents that require a sign-off trail.

Key Concepts

Term	Meaning
Policy	A document belonging to a specific business (e.g., Leave Policy, Code of Conduct)
Version	Each edit to a policy creates a new numbered version; previous versions are preserved
Assignment	A directive that tells one or more employees to read and acknowledge a specific version by a due date
Acknowledgment	The employee's recorded sign-off: timestamp, IP address, and confirmation they scrolled to the end
Policy Template	A pre-written starting-point (system-wide) you can copy from when creating a new policy

---

Manager — Creating and Publishing a Policy

1. Go to **Policies** in the sidebar (under your business section).
2. Click **New Policy**.
3. Fill in:
   - **Title** — e.g., "Leave & Absence Policy"
   - **Category** — HR, Safety, Conduct, Financial, IT, Operational, or Other
   - **Content** — write directly in the rich-text editor, or start from a **Template**
4. Click **Save as Draft** to keep it private, or **Publish** to make it live.

> Saving as Draft lets you review before employees can be assigned.

Manager — Assigning a Policy

After a policy is published:

1. Open the policy and click **Assign**.
2. Choose the scope:
   - **Individual** — pick one specific employee or user
   - **Role** — all users with a given role (e.g., all Salespersons)
   - **All Staff** — everyone in the business
3. Set a **Due Date** (optional but recommended — triggers overdue tracking).
4. Click **Assign**.

Employees included in the assignment immediately see a banner on their dashboard and a **Policy** badge in the header.

Manager — Tracking Acknowledgments

On the Policy detail page, the **Assignments** tab shows:

Column	Meaning
Assigned To	Employee name / role target
Due Date	When acknowledgment is required by
Status	Pending / Acknowledged / Overdue
Acknowledged At	Timestamp of sign-off

Export or print the acknowledgment list for compliance records.

Manager — Waiving an Acknowledgment

If an employee cannot acknowledge (e.g., no system access), a manager can:

1. Open the assignment.
2. Click **Waive** next to the employee.
3. Enter a reason.

This records a waiver instead of leaving the item as overdue.

Employee — Acknowledging a Policy

When a policy is assigned to you:

1. A red **Policy** badge appears in the top navigation bar showing the number of pending acknowledgments.
2. Click the badge or go to **My Profile** → **Policy Agreements**.
3. Open the policy — you must scroll to the bottom before the **Acknowledge** button activates.
4. Click **Acknowledge**. Your name, timestamp, and device details are recorded.

Employee — Viewing Past Acknowledgments

In **My Profile** → **Policy Agreements**:

Column	Meaning
Policy	Document title
Category	HR, Safety, etc.
Version	Which version you acknowledged
Acknowledged At	Date and time
Actions	View the document, Print signed summary

Print Signed Summary opens a formatted page showing the policy title, your name, acknowledgment time, and a disclaimer — suitable for filing.

Overdue Reminders

- If a policy has a due date **3 days away or less** and you have not yet acknowledged it, the system automatically sends a bell notification reminding you.
- Reminders are sent at most once per 24 hours per policy to avoid noise.

Permissions

Permission	Who has it by default	What it controls
`canManagePolicies`	Owner, Manager	Create, edit, publish, assign, and waive policies
(all users)	Everyone	View and acknowledge policies assigned to them

---

Policy Templates

System-wide policy templates are pre-written starting points. When creating a new policy:

1. Click **Use Template**.
2. Browse templates by category.
3. Select one — its content is copied into your new policy for editing.

Your customised copy is entirely separate from the template — edits you make do not affect the original.

Managing Policy Templates (System Admins Only)

System administrators can create, edit, and manage all global policy templates via **Admin** → **Policy Templates**.

Creating a Template

1. Click **+ New Template**.
2. Fill in the **Title**, **Category**, and optional **Description**.
3. Write the **Content** — full HTML is supported.
    - Use `{{BUSINESS_NAME}}` anywhere in the content; it will be substituted with the actual business name when an employee views a policy created from this template.
4. Use the **Preview** tab to see how the rendered HTML will look (with `{{BUSINESS_NAME}}` shown as *[Your Business Name]*) before saving.
5. Click **Create Template**.

Editing a Template

1. Click **Edit** next to the template in the list.
2. Update any fields — Title, Category, Description, or Content.
3. Switch to the **Preview** tab at any time to review the rendered output before saving.
4. Click **Save Changes**.

> Changes to a template do not retroactively affect policies that were already created from it.

Deactivating / Restoring a Template

- Click **Deactivate** to hide a template from the template picker (it is soft-deleted — data is preserved).
- Click **Restore** to make it available again.
- Use the **Show inactive** checkbox to include deactivated templates in the list.

Filtering

- Search by **title** using the text box.
- Filter by **Category** (HR, Safety, IT, Finance, Code of Conduct, Other).

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35. Salesperson Role — Access & Restrictions

> **Who reads this:** Business owners and managers setting up salesperson accounts.

What a Salesperson Can and Cannot Do

The **Salesperson** role is designed for front-of-house staff who should access the POS but not management areas.

Business Homepage

When a salesperson navigates to a business homepage (grocery, restaurant, clothing, hardware, etc.), they are **automatically redirected to the POS** for that business. No financial summaries, inventory widgets, or management dashboards are shown.

Inventory

Salespersons can view the inventory list (read-only) but:

Blocked	Why
🖍️ Edit and 🗑️ Delete buttons	Requires `canManageInventory`
Bulk Stock / Stock Take / Add New Item buttons	Requires `canManageInventory`
Stock Movements, Alerts, Analytics, Transfer History tabs	Requires `canViewInventoryReports`
Grocery Store Inventory Features panel	Requires `canManageInventory`

Sidebar Links

Link	Visible to Salesperson?
Services	No — requires `canViewServices`
All management areas	Only what their permissions grant

Unlocking Individual Permissions

Every restriction above can be individually overridden per employee in the **Business Permission Modal**:

1. Go to **Business Settings** → **Members**.
2. Click the employee.
3. Open the **Permissions** tab.
4. Toggle the specific permission on.

Permission Key	What it unlocks
`canManageInventory`	Edit/delete items, Bulk Stock, Stock Take, Add Item
`canViewInventoryReports`	Movements, Alerts, Analytics, Transfer History tabs
`canViewServices`	Services link in the sidebar
`canAccessFinancialData`	Financial reports, metrics, snapshots

Grocery Associate Role & EOD Access

The **Grocery Associate** role behaves like a salesperson on grocery businesses. In addition to the standard salesperson restrictions, grocery associates:

- See the **Submit Daily Report** and **My EOD History** sidebar links when **Salesperson EOD** is enabled for the grocery business.
- Can submit and catch up their own EOD reports exactly as a salesperson would.
- Do **not** see management EOD links (Manager EOD View, EOD Discrepancy) unless granted **Can Close Books**.

Other Restricted Roles

The same inventory restrictions apply to **Delivery Driver** and **Restaurant Associate** roles — they also default to `canViewInventoryReports: false` and `canViewServices: false`.

---

36. Manager Override Code

Overview

The **Manager Override Code** is a personal 6-character security code that identifies a manager and authorises sensitive actions — starting with order cancellations. Every manager must set up their own code before they can approve any override request.

The code is stored as a one-way hash (it is never readable, even by system administrators). Only the manager who set it knows their own code.

Setting Up Your Override Code

1. Open the **sidebar** → **Profile**.
2. Scroll down to the **Manager Override Code** section (visible only to users with manager permissions).
3. Click **Set Up Override Code** (or **Renew Code** if one already exists).

4. Enter a code that meets all four requirements:
    - Exactly **6 characters**
    - At least **one letter** (A–Z)
    - At least **one digit** (0–9)
    - **Not a recently used code** (last 12 months are blocked)
5. The composition bar turns green when all requirements are met. Click **Save Code**.

A green **Active** badge and the expiry date confirm the code is set.

Code Expiry

Override codes expire after **30 days**. Five days before expiry, a bell notification appears reminding the manager to renew. After expiry the code is blocked — a new one must be set before overrides can be approved.

To renew: follow the same steps as setup. The old code is retired automatically.

Permissions

Only users with the **Can Close Books** permission see the Manager Override Code section on their profile page.

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37. Order Cancellation

Overview

Any completed, paid order can be cancelled on the **same day it was placed**, before End-of-Day (EOD) is closed. Cancellations require a mandatory written reason and a manager's physical authorisation via their override code or employee card scan.

Both the cancellation and any denied/aborted attempts are logged in full — the audit trail cannot be edited or deleted.

Who Can Initiate a Cancellation

Any logged-in staff member can start a cancellation request. A manager (someone with **Can Close Books** permission) must physically be present to authorise it.

Staff Flow — Starting a Cancellation Request

Cancellations can be started from two places:

From the POS receipt modal (immediately after an order is completed):

- On the receipt that appears after payment, click **Cancel Order** (shown in red, below the Print button).

From Order History:

- Navigate to the business **Orders** page.
- Find the order (today's orders only — the Cancel button does not appear for older orders).
- Click **Cancel Order** on the order card.

Step 1 — Enter a reason:

A modal opens showing the order details and refund amount. If the order was paid by **EcoCash**, a fee notice explains the deduction (see EcoCash Refunds below). Enter a mandatory reason (minimum 10 characters) explaining why the order is being cancelled. Click **Request Manager Authorisation** when ready.

Manager Flow — Authorising the Request

Step 2 — Select manager and enter override code:

The modal switches to the authorisation screen. The staff reason is shown read-only so the manager can review it. Two options to identify the manager:

Option A — Manager name + code (keyboard entry):

1. Click the **Select manager** search box and type the manager's name. A dropdown lists all eligible managers for this business.
2. Click the correct manager name to select them (the box turns green and shows "Manager selected").
3. Click the **Override code** field and type the 6-character code, then press **Enter** or click **OK**.
    - The OK button stays disabled until both a manager is selected and a code has been entered.

Option B — Employee card scan:

1. Have the manager scan their employee card using the barcode scanner. The system detects the scan automatically and identifies the manager without needing to use the dropdown or type anything.

After a successful code or card scan:

- The manager's name appears confirmed on screen.
- Two buttons appear: **Approve Cancellation** and **Deny Request**.

If the code is invalid, an error appears and the manager can retry. After **3 failed attempts** the input locks for the session.

Step 3a — Approve:

The manager clicks **Approve Cancellation**. The order is immediately cancelled and the refund amount is shown on the success screen. The customer-facing display also updates to show the cancellation and refund amount.

Step 3b — Deny:

The manager clicks **Deny Request** and must enter a mandatory denial reason. After confirming, the denial is logged and the modal closes. **The first denial is final** — the same order cannot be submitted for cancellation again with a different manager.

EcoCash Refunds

EcoCash charges a fee on both the original payment and the refund. The net refund to the customer is:

```
Net refund = Order total − (2 × EcoCash fee)
```

```
Example:
  Order total   $88.51
  EcoCash fee    $0.51
  Fee deducted   $1.02  (2 × $0.51)
  Customer gets $87.49
```

This breakdown is shown in the modal **before** the manager authorises, so the customer can be informed. The customer-facing display also shows the breakdown after cancellation.

For Cash and Card orders, the full order total is refunded (no deduction).

What Happens When an Order is Cancelled

- The order status changes to **Cancelled** and the payment status to **Refunded**.
- Stock levels are restored for the cancelled items (except restaurant orders — food cannot be returned to inventory).
- Loyalty points earned on the original order are reversed (deducted from the customer's balance).
- A debit entry is recorded in the business account ledger for the refund amount.
- The cancelled order is **excluded from EOD calculations** — it does not appear in daily sales totals, cash counts, or EcoCash figures.

Constraints

Constraint	Detail
Same-day only	Orders can only be cancelled on the day they were placed, before EOD is closed
Manager required	A manager with Can Close Books permission must be physically present
One cancellation per order	An order can only be cancelled once
Denial is final	Once a manager denies a request, no further attempts are permitted for that order

Customer Display

If a customer-facing display screen is connected, it automatically shows a cancellation confirmation when the order is cancelled — including the refund amount and EcoCash fee breakdown where applicable. The display clears after 10 seconds and returns to the normal idle screen.

> **Applies to every business type**, including vehicle_service, services, vehicles, construction, and consulting — Universal POS now sends this same cancellation broadcast.

Receipt Watermarks — Reprints & Cancelled Orders

When a receipt is reprinted or belongs to a cancelled order, clear watermarks are added so the receipt cannot be confused with an original.

Reprinted Receipts

Every time a receipt is reprinted from the **Orders** page or the receipt detail modal, a **RE-PRINT** watermark is added automatically:

- **Thermal printer (paper):** A header `*** RE-PRINT ***` is printed at the top of the receipt showing the reprint date/time and who reprinted it. A matching footer `*** RE-PRINT ***` followed by **THIS IS A REPRINTED RECEIPT — NOT VALID FOR RETURNS/EXCHANGES** appears at the bottom.
- **Screen preview:** A large diagonal red **RE-PRINT** watermark is overlaid on the receipt preview.

The receipt detail modal also shows a **Reprint History** section listing every reprint event — who did it and when.

Cancelled Order Receipts

If a receipt is viewed or reprinted for an order that has been **cancelled and refunded**, an additional notice is printed at the top:

```
** ORDER CANCELLED / REFUNDED **
Refund amount: $XX.XX
Requested by: [Staff name]
Approved by: [Manager name]
```

This notice appears on both the thermal print-out and the screen preview so it is immediately clear to anyone reading the receipt that the order was voided.

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38. Cancellation Reports

Location: Sidebar → Reports → **Order Cancellations**

Access: System Admin, users with Can Close Books, or users with Can Access Financial Data.

Overview

The Cancellation Reports page provides a full audit of order cancellations and manager override attempts for a selected business and date range.

Filters

- **Business** — select a specific business or All (umbrella)
- **Date range** — From and To date pickers; click **Apply** to refresh

Summary Cards

Card	Description
Total Cancellations	Number of approved cancellations in the period
Total Net Refund	Sum of all refund amounts paid out (net of EcoCash fees)

Card	Description
EcoCash Fees Lost	Total fees deducted across EcoCash cancellations
Cancellation Rate	Cancellations as a percentage of all orders in the period
Denial Rate	Denied attempts as a percentage of all decided attempts

Approved Cancellations Tab

A table of all successfully cancelled orders, showing:

Column	Description
Date	When the cancellation was processed
Order #	Original order reference
Payment	Cash or EcoCash
Gross	Original order total
Fee Deducted	EcoCash fee deducted (blank for cash orders)
Net Refund	Amount returned to the customer
Customer	Name and loyalty number (or "Walk-in" if no linked customer)
Phone	Customer phone if captured
Items	Hover the count to see the full item list snapshot
Staff Reason	Mandatory reason entered by the requesting staff member
Requested By	Staff member who initiated the cancellation
Authorised By	Manager who approved it

Click **Export CSV** to download the full table.

Override Attempt Log Tab

All override attempts — including approved, denied, aborted, and failed-code outcomes — are listed here. This tab is the complete audit trail.

Column	Description
Date	When the attempt occurred
Order #	Target order
Amount	Original gross order amount
Payment	Cash or EcoCash
Customer	Name and number if available
Outcome	APPROVED / DENIED / ABORTED / FAILED_CODE

Column	Description
Manager	Manager who entered the code (blank for FAILED_CODE)
Requested By	Staff who initiated
Staff Reason	Cancellation reason
Denial Reason	Manager's reason (DENIED outcomes only)
Items	Item snapshot (hover the count)

Click **Export CSV** to download the full log.

Troubleshooting

Cancel Order button not visible on an order:

- The order must be from today and have status Completed + payment status Paid. Orders from previous days cannot be cancelled.
- If EOD has already been closed for today, cancellations are also blocked.

"Manager Override Code not set up" error:

- The manager must set up their override code on their Profile page before they can authorise any override.

"Override code expired" error:

- The manager's code has passed its 30-day expiry. They must go to Profile → Manager Override Code → Renew Code before authorising.

"Invalid code" error:

- The code or scanned card does not match any active manager. Check that the correct code was entered. After 3 failed attempts the input locks for this session.

"Cancellation denied — cannot retry" message:

- Once a manager denies a cancellation request, it is final. No further attempts are permitted for that specific order. If the denial was in error, contact a system administrator.

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39. Combo Payment Requests

> **Who reads this:** Staff who need to request multiple payments in a single bundled request (requesters), and cashiers or managers who approve and process those requests.

A **Combo Payment Request** lets you bundle several payment needs — grocery shopping, school fees, supplier payments, and more — into one structured request. A cashier reviews and approves the request, you spend the money, and then you mark each item paid as you go. You'll then need to show receipts accounting for the funds, reviewed and approved by a cashier. Any remaining change is returned through a formal settlement step.

Overview — How It Works

```
You create a request (DRAFT)
    ↓  Submit
Cashier reviews it (SUBMITTED)
    ↓  Approve                        ↓  Return for Edits
Request is funded (APPROVED)          You correct and re-submit (DRAFT)
    ↓  You spend and mark items paid
All items paid (PAID)
    ↓  You add receipts and Submit to Cashier
Cashier reviews and approves receipts ( 🟢 badge)
    ↓  You notify cashier of remaining change
Cashier confirms change received (SETTLED)
```

If only some items are funded, the status will be **PARTIALLY APPROVED** and you can still mark approved items as paid.

Requester — Creating a Request

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** and open the account you want to draw from.
2. Click **New Combo Request**.
3. Enter a **Title** (required) — e.g. "July School Fees + Grocery Run".
4. Optionally add **Notes** for the cashier — e.g. "Fees must be paid by Friday".
5. Click **+ Add Section** to add a spending category:

Section type	Use it for
Grocery	Supermarket or fresh produce shopping
Monthly Contribution	Recurring payments — clubs, SACCO, insurance
School Fees	Tuition, exam fees, school supplies
Custom	Anything else — give it a name

6. Within each section, click **+ Add Item** and fill in:
    - **Description** (required) — what is being bought or paid
    - **Quantity** and **Unit** (optional) — e.g. "3 × bags"
    - **Estimated Amount** — how much you expect to spend
    - **Domain / Category / Sub-category** — expense classification. You can select these manually or click ✨ **Suggest** to auto-classify based on the description (see below).
    - **Payee** — who is being paid (person, employee, supplier, business, or leave blank)
    - **Item Notes** — any extra details

> ✨ **Suggest on combo items:** After typing a description, click ✨ **Suggest** next to the Domain field. The system searches for matching expense categories and displays results in up to two sections — **matches within the selected domain** (if one is chosen) and **Other Categories** from across all domains. Selecting a result from either section fills in the Domain, Category, and Sub-category

> automatically. If no domain is selected, all results are shown as a flat list so you can discover the right classification from scratch.

7. Repeat for all sections and items. The **Grand Total** at the bottom updates automatically.
8. Click **Save Draft** at any time to save your work without submitting.

> **Tip:** You can re-open a saved draft any time from the Combo Requests list and continue editing before submitting.

Requester — Submitting a Request

When your request is complete:

1. Click **Submit Request**.
2. The system saves the latest draft and opens a **Confirm Submission** panel at the bottom of the screen.
3. The panel shows the **Estimated Total** calculated from all your items.
4. If the actual amount you need differs from the sum (e.g. you know an item will cost slightly more), you can type a different value in the **Amount to Request** field.
5. Click **Confirm & Submit**.

The request is sent to the cashier queue. You will receive a notification when it has been approved or returned.

> **Note:** After submitting you can still edit the request while it is **SUBMITTED** (before the cashier approves or returns it). See Editing a Submitted Request below.

Requester / Admin — Editing a Submitted Request

If you need to make changes after submitting but before the cashier acts:

1. Open the **Combo Requests** list from the account page.
2. Find the **SUBMITTED** request. A ✎ **Edit** link appears directly on the row — click it (or open the request and click ✎ **Edit** in the detail view).
3. The request form opens pre-filled with all your current items and sections.
4. Make your changes. The **Save Changes** button replaces the usual **Save Draft** button when editing a submitted request.
5. Click **Save Changes**. The request remains **SUBMITTED** — the cashier will see your latest version.

> **Submit button is hidden while editing a submitted request** — you cannot re-submit because the request is already in the cashier's queue. Save Changes is sufficient.

> **Admin note:** Admins can edit **any** SUBMITTED request, not just their own. This is useful when the original requester is unavailable.

Cashier — Approving a Request

When a user submits a combo request, you receive a notification and it appears on the **Submitted** tab of the Combo Requests list.

1. Open the request to review all sections and items.

2. Check the account balance shown at the top — it must cover the requested amount.
3. Click **Approve Request**.
4. An approval panel opens showing each item with its estimated amount. You can:
    - Leave an item's amount unchanged to approve it in full.
    - Reduce an item's amount if the account cannot cover it or you want to limit it.
    - Set an item's amount to **$0** to mark it as **Not Funded** — the requester will not be able to mark that item as paid.
5. Optionally add an **Approval Note** (e.g. "Approved $45 for school fees only — grocery budget not available this week").
6. Click **Confirm Approval**.

The request status changes to **APPROVED** (all items funded) or **PARTIALLY APPROVED** (some items set to $0 or reduced). The requester is notified.

Cashier — Returning a Request for Edits

If the request needs clarification or corrections before you can approve it:

1. Open the submitted request.
2. Click **↩ Return for Edits**.
3. An inline panel opens. Type your feedback in the **Return Note** field (minimum 10 characters — be specific so the requester knows what to fix).
4. Click **Confirm Return**.

The request goes back to **DRAFT** status. The requester receives a notification and sees a yellow banner at the top of the request showing your feedback.

Requester — Editing a Returned Request

When a cashier returns your request:

1. Open the request — you will see a yellow banner: **"↩ Returned for edits by [Cashier Name]"** with the cashier's note.
2. Make the requested changes — you can edit the title, notes, sections, and items freely while the request is in DRAFT.
3. When ready, click **Submit Request** again (same confirmation panel as the first submission).

Requester — Marking Items as Paid

Once your request is approved:

1. Open the approved request.
2. For each item you have spent money on, click **Mark Paid** next to that item.
3. A panel opens showing:
    - The item description
    - The approved amount

- A **Paid Amount** field (defaults to the approved amount — change it if you spent a different amount)
- A **Receipt Number** field (optional — enter the supplier's receipt or invoice number)

4. Click **Confirm**.

The item is marked as **Paid** and the total paid amount updates. Once all funded items are marked paid, the request moves to **PAID** status.

> **Not Funded items** (approved for $0) cannot be marked as paid.

🧾 **Add Receipt (per item)** — once the request has been approved and paid out, a separate 🧾 **Add Receipt** button also appears next to each funded item, independent of Mark Paid. This opens the full receipt form (payee/supplier, expense type, amount, etc. — see Attaching Receipts to Expense Payments in Section 17) pre-tagged to that specific item, rather than the whole disbursement. Use this when different items in the same combo request end up bought from different suppliers — each item can collect its own receipts, from its own supplier, whether or not it's been flagged Mark Paid, and an item isn't limited to a single receipt if you spent across more than one purchase.

Accounting for the Funds — Adding Receipts

The moment your request reaches **PAID**, you're expected to show receipts proving how the money was spent. You'll get a bell notification right away, and another reminder once a day for as long as receipts remain outstanding.

1. Find the disbursement in the account's **Transaction History** — it's the payment row tagged **COMBO PAY** — and click the colour-coded receipt badge (see Attaching Receipts to Expense Payments in Section 17 for what each colour means).
2. Add one or more receipts covering the full **approved amount** — each with a date, amount, and optionally a receipt number, description, and photo/scan attachment.
3. Once the total looks right, click **Submit to Cashier**. If your receipts don't quite add up to the approved amount, you can still submit — a warning is shown, but the cashier does the actual checking, not the form.
4. A cashier reviews your receipts, may correct amounts or details if something was entered wrong, and clicks ✅ **Approve**. The badge turns green and the reminders stop.

If receipts are still outstanding **7 days** after the funds were issued, the badge turns red and the cashier group is notified so they can follow up. Requesting settlement to return any remaining change (see below) also counts toward clearing this reminder — you don't need to receipt every last cent if the balance is instead formally returned.

> This same accountability flow can also be turned on for a one-off payment outside combo pay — tick **"This is an advance — receipts required"** when creating a Quick Payment. A standalone payment's own return-unused-funds flow works the same way as described here — see Returning Unused Funds in Section 17.

Requester — Requesting Settlement (Returning Change)

If you were approved for more than you actually spent, you must notify the cashier so they can collect the remaining change.

1. Open your **PAID** request. A **Remaining Balance** figure is shown (approved amount minus total paid).
2. Click **Request Settlement**.
3. An inline panel opens showing the exact amount to return, e.g. **$45.50 to return to cashier**.
4. Click **Notify Cashier**.

The status changes to **SETTLE REQUESTED**. The page automatically refreshes every 10 seconds while you wait. You will see a pulsing indicator: *"Awaiting cashier confirmation…"*

Cashier — Confirming Settlement

When a requester notifies you of remaining change:

1. You receive a notification or can find the request on the **Settle Requested** tab of the Combo Requests list.
2. Open the request and review the **Remaining Balance** shown at the top.
3. Click **Confirm Change Received**.
4. A panel opens showing the amount to collect.
5. Optionally add a **Note** (e.g. "Received $45.50 in cash from John").
6. Click **Confirm Receipt**.

The request is marked **SETTLED**. The audit trail records who confirmed and when.

> **Note:** The Confirm Change Received button is never shown to the person who created the request — only to cashiers and admins.

> **Once settled, the request is read-only** — no further items, receipts, or edits can be added. All existing items and receipts remain visible for reference.

Cancelling a Request

Either the requester or a cashier can cancel a request that has not yet been fully paid or settled.

1. Open the request.
2. Click **Cancel Request**.
3. Confirm the cancellation in the dialog that appears.

The request is marked **CANCELLED**. All cashiers and admins are notified, and if someone other than the creator cancels it, the creator is also notified.

> Requests that are already **PAID** or **SETTLED** cannot be cancelled.

Auto-Expiry — The 30-Day Deadline

A combo request that isn't fully paid within **30 days of submission** automatically **expires** — it can no longer be approved or paid, and must be resubmitted as a new request.

- The 30-day clock starts the moment you click **Submit Request**, not when a cashier approves it — approving late eats into the remaining time, it doesn't restart the clock.
- Once **any** item has been marked paid, the request is no longer eligible to expire — it's left for a cashier or admin to cancel or settle manually instead, since money has already moved.
- If a request does expire while funds were already approved, the earmarked amount is automatically reversed and returned to the account balance — nothing is lost, it just needs to be requested again.
- You'll get a warning notification at **7 days** and again at **2 days** before the deadline (sent to cashiers, so there's still time to approve and pay it), and a final notice when it actually expires (sent to you, the requester).
- An expired request shows a ⏰ **Expired** badge in the Combo Requests list, with a ↻ **Resubmit** button that creates a new draft copy of it — pre-filled with the same sections and items — so you don't have to re-type everything.

> **Why this exists:** requests that sat approved-but-unpaid for months made it easy to lose track of outstanding funds. The 30-day deadline forces stale requests to either get paid promptly or fall off cleanly, instead of quietly accumulating.

Status Reference

Status	What it means
DRAFT	Being built by the requester. Can be edited and re-submitted.
SUBMITTED	Waiting for cashier review. Creator and admin can still edit before approval.
APPROVED	All items funded. Requester can start spending.
PARTIALLY APPROVED	Some items funded; others marked Not Funded.
PARTIALLY PAID	Some items marked paid; others still outstanding.
PAID	All funded items marked as paid. Settlement may be needed if change remains.
SETTLE REQUESTED	Requester has notified cashier of remaining change. Awaiting confirmation.
SETTLED	Change collected and confirmed. Request fully closed.
CANCELLED	Request voided before completion.
EXPIRED	Not paid within 30 days of submission. Any approved funds were returned to the account. Must be resubmitted.

Permissions

Action	Who can do it
Create & edit requests	Request creator (DRAFT and SUBMITTED status); Admin
Submit	Request creator; Admin

Action	Who can do it
Approve / Return for Edits	Cashiers with expense payment permissions; Admin
Mark items as paid	Request creator; Admin
Add / submit receipts	Request creator; Admin
Approve receipts (edit or delete any receipt during review)	Cashiers with expense payment permissions; Admin
Request settlement	Request creator (PAID status, remaining balance > $0); Admin
Confirm settlement	Cashiers with expense payment permissions; Admin (not the creator)
Cancel	Request creator; Cashiers; Admin
View all requests	Cashiers; Admin; Users granted full view access
View own requests only	Users granted restricted access (see Section 40)

Troubleshooting

Submit button is greyed out:

- The title field must not be empty.
- At least one item with a description is required.
- Save a draft first if you need to come back to it.

"Only DRAFT requests can be edited" error:

- The request has already been submitted. Ask the cashier to return it if changes are needed.

Mark Paid button not visible on an item:

- The item was approved for $0 (Not Funded) and cannot be marked as paid.
- The request is not in APPROVED, PARTIALLY APPROVED, or PARTIALLY PAID status.

"Return note must be at least 10 characters" error:

- Cashiers must enter a meaningful explanation when returning a request so the requester knows what to fix.

Confirm Change Received button not visible:

- You created this request. The settlement confirmation must be done by a different cashier or admin.

Receipt badge is orange or red and I've already submitted receipts:

- Orange means submitted-but-not-yet-approved by a cashier, or still within the first 7 days — this is expected until a cashier clicks ✅ **Approve**.

- Red means it's been more than 7 days since the funds were issued and it's still not approved — the cashier group has been notified, but you can also follow up directly.

"This request expired" error when approving or marking an item paid:

- More than 30 days passed since the request was submitted without it being fully paid. Click ↻ **Resubmit** on the expired request to create a new draft copy, then submit it again — see Auto-Expiry — The 30-Day Deadline above.

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40. Expense Account — Restricted User Access

> **Who reads this:** Managers and admins who need to give staff members the ability to submit combo requests from a specific expense account, without giving them full cashier access to the whole system.

By default, only cashiers and admins can interact with expense accounts. The **Restricted Access** panel lets you grant named users a limited, account-specific permission set — for example, allowing a department head to submit their own combo requests without seeing anyone else's payments.

Granting Access

1. Go to **Expense Accounts** and open the account you want to share.
2. Scroll to the **Restricted Access** section near the bottom of the account detail page.
3. Click **+ Grant Access**.
4. A form opens:

   User — search by name or email to find the person you want to grant access to.

   Then configure their permissions using the three toggles:

Toggle	Default	What it controls
Can submit combo requests	ON	The user can create and submit new combo payment requests from this account
Can only view own requests	ON	The user sees only the requests they created — not other users' requests or the general payment history
Can view account balance	OFF	The user can see the current account balance on the account page

5. Click **Grant Access**.

The user appears in the active access list immediately. They receive a notification that access has been granted and the account will appear in their navigation.

> **Tip:** Leave "Can only view own requests" ON unless you specifically need the user to see the full payment history of the account.

Managing Existing Access

The active access list shows each user's current permissions. You can adjust individual toggles at any time:

- Toggle **Can submit requests** to enable or disable their ability to create new requests without revoking all access.
- Toggle **Can only view own requests** to expand or restrict what they can see.
- Toggle **Can view balance** to show or hide the account balance for that user.

Changes take effect immediately.

Revoking Access

To remove a user's access entirely:

1. Find the user in the active access list.
2. Click **Revoke Access** next to their name.
3. Their entry moves to the **Revoked Access** section (collapsed by default — click to expand and see the full history).

A revoked user immediately loses access to the account. Their past requests remain visible to cashiers and admins for audit purposes.

Re-granting access: If you revoke a user and later want to restore their access, click **+ Grant Access** and search for the same person. The system reactivates their record rather than creating a duplicate entry.

Permissions

Action	Who can do it
Grant / revoke access	Cashiers with expense payment permissions; Admin
Toggle individual permissions	Cashiers with expense payment permissions; Admin
View access list	Cashiers with expense payment permissions; Admin
Submit combo requests	Users granted "Can submit combo requests" permission

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Troubleshooting

User cannot see the expense account in their navigation:

- Check that their access record is **Active** (not revoked) in the Restricted Access panel.
- Confirm the **Can submit combo requests** toggle is ON.

User can see other users' requests when they should only see their own:

- Ensure the **Can only view own requests** toggle is ON for that user.

User reports they cannot see the account balance:

- The **Can view balance** toggle is OFF by default. Enable it for that user in the access list.

For technical support, contact your system administrator.

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41. Vehicle Renewal Receipts

Overview

When you renew a vehicle's licences at the licensing office, you receive a printed receipt. The **Record Renewal Receipt** workflow lets you capture that receipt inside the system so all payment details, fee breakdowns, and the specific licences that were renewed are stored against the vehicle record.

Access: **Fleet Management → Vehicles tab → select a vehicle → Record Renewal Receipt button**.

Recording a Renewal Receipt

1. Open Fleet Management and go to the **Vehicles** tab.
2. Click on the vehicle you are renewing.
3. Click **Record Renewal Receipt**.
4. Fill in the **Receipt Details** header section (see fields below).
5. Enter the **Payment Breakdown** (arrears, penalties, fees, total).
6. Switch between the **Registration**, **Radio / TV**, and **Insurance** tabs to record which licences were renewed and their new numbers and dates.
7. Optionally upload a scanned copy of the physical receipt.
8. Click **Save Receipt**.

The new receipt appears in the vehicle's renewal history, and the linked licences are updated with their new expiry dates.

Payment Breakdown Fields

Field	Description
Receipt Number	Reference number printed on the official receipt
Transaction Type	Defaults to "VEHICLE LICENSING"; edit if different
Date Paid	Date the payment was made at the licensing office
Currency	ZiG, USD, or ZWL
Payment Received By	Name of the official who processed the payment
Office of Issue	Name / code of the licensing office
Arrears	Any overdue amount included in the payment
Penalties	Late-payment penalties charged
Administration Fee	Admin processing charge

Field	Description
Transaction Fee	Any bank or system transaction fee
Surcharge / Debt Management	Additional charges (hidden if vehicle is exempt)
Deposit	Deposit amount paid
Total Paid	Grand total of the payment
Notes	Free-text notes

Upload a scanned copy of the physical receipt using the **Scanned Receipt** upload field (PDF, JPG, or JPEG).

Licenses Renewed

The renewal receipt form has three tabs — **Registration**, **Radio / TV**, and **Insurance**. On each tab you can specify:

Field	Description
License Number	New licence number issued
Issuing Authority	Authority that issued the licence (ZINARA, ZIMRA, etc.)
Issue Date	Date the licence was issued
Expiry Date	Date the licence expires
Renewal Cost	Amount paid for this specific licence
Late Fee	Any late fee charged for this licence
Reminder Days	How many days before expiry to show a reminder (default: 30)
Usage	Description of use — Radio / TV tab only (e.g., "PRIVATE VEHICLE")
Exempt	Tick if this licence has been waived / exempted

Each tab starts with an **"Include this licence in the renewal"** checkbox, unticked by default — tick it only for the licence type(s) actually renewed on this receipt. Once ticked, its Licence Number, Issue Date, and Expiry Date become required: the form checks every ticked tab for complete new licence details before it will save, even if you're not currently viewing that tab, so a tab you ticked and then forgot to finish can't slip through with blank data.

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42. Vehicle Exemptions

Overview

Some vehicles qualify for exemption from certain licensing fees — for example, vehicles exempt from radio/TV licence fees. The **Vehicle Exemptions** feature records the official exemption certificate details against a vehicle so renewal staff and auditors can see what is and is not payable.

Access: **Fleet Management → Vehicles tab → select a vehicle → Add Exemption**.

Adding an Exemption

1. Open the vehicle detail.
2. Click **Add Exemption**.
3. Select the **Exemption Type** (Radio/TV Licence, Road Use, Insurance, or Other).
4. Set the **Start Date** and **End Date** for the exemption period.
5. Choose the **Exemption Reason** from the dropdown (e.g., "NO RADIO/TV FITTED") and optionally add a description.
6. Fill in the **Requested By** fields (name, email, contact number).
7. Fill in the **Data Capturing Official** fields (name, user ID, issue office, issue date).
8. Upload the exemption certificate document (PDF or image).
9. Click **Save Exemption**.

The exemption appears in the vehicle's exemption history. When an active exemption exists, the renewal receipt form automatically hides the surcharge / debt management field for the relevant licence type.

Exemption Fields

Field	Description
Exemption Type	Category of the exemption (Radio/TV, Road Use, Insurance, Other)
Start Date	Date from which the exemption is valid
End Date	Date on which the exemption expires
Exemption Reason	Standardised reason code (e.g., "NO RADIO/TV FITTED")
Reason Description	Free-text description of the reason
Requested By — Name	Name of the person who requested the exemption
Requested By — Email	Contact email
Requested By — Contact	Phone or other contact number
Data Capturing Official — Name	Name of the licensing office official
Login User ID	Official's login / system ID
Issue Office	Name or code of the issuing office
Issue Date	Date the certificate was issued
Certificate Document	Scanned PDF or image of the exemption certificate
Notes	Any additional notes

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43. Vehicle Licence Documents & Issuing Authorities

Overview

When adding or editing a vehicle licence you can attach a scanned copy of the licence document and record the authority that issued it. Driver records also support attaching a copy of the driver's licence.

Uploading a Licence Document

1. Open **Fleet Management** → **Vehicles tab** and select a vehicle.
2. Click **Add Licence** (or the edit icon on an existing licence).
3. In the licence form, scroll to the **Licence Document** section.
4. Click **Choose File** and select a PDF, JPG, or JPEG file, or drag and drop the file into the upload area.
5. The file name appears once uploaded. Click the **×** to remove and replace it.
6. Complete the rest of the form and click **Save**.

The document is stored against the licence record and can be viewed or downloaded from the licence detail at any time.

Issuing Authorities

The **Issuing Authority** field on the licence form is backed by a shared list of known authorities (ZINARA, ZIMRA, etc.).

Selecting an existing authority:

- Click the **Issuing Authority** dropdown and type to filter the list.
- Select the authority.

Adding a new authority:

- If the authority is not in the list, click **+ Add new authority**.
- Type the name in the text field and press **Save**.
- The authority is saved to the shared list and selected immediately.

New authorities added by any user are available to all users going forward — each authority only needs to be added once.

Driver Licence Documents

When registering a new driver you can attach a copy of their driving licence:

1. Go to **Fleet Management** → **Drivers tab** and click **Add Driver**.
2. Fill in the driver's details.
3. In the **Licence Document** section, upload a PDF, JPG, or JPEG copy of the licence.
4. Click **Save Driver**.

The document is stored against the driver's record and is visible in their detail panel.

Permissions

Action	Who can do it
Record renewal receipt	Users with Manage Vehicles permission
Add / edit vehicle exemption	Users with Manage Vehicles permission
Upload licence documents	Users with Manage Vehicles permission
Add issuing authority	Users with Manage Vehicles permission
Upload driver licence document	Users with Manage Drivers permission
View vehicle detail and documents	Users with Access Vehicle Module permission

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For technical support, contact your system administrator.

43a. Vehicle & Driver License Compliance Alerts

> **Who reads this:** Users with the **Manage Vehicles** permission, and system admins — the people this feature actually notifies. Everyone else can skip this section.

Overview

Vehicle licences (registration, insurance, radio/TV) and driver licences all have expiry dates, and a lapsed one can mean a fine, an uninsured vehicle on the road, or a driver who legally shouldn't be driving. This feature automatically watches every vehicle and driver licence in the system and makes sure the right people are told **before** and **after** a licence lapses — not just once, but repeatedly until it's actually renewed.

Who Gets Notified

Alerts go to every **active** user who is either:

- a **system admin**, or
- granted the **Manage Vehicles** permission.

This is a fixed list resolved automatically each time the check runs — there's nothing to configure per-vehicle or per-driver.

Urgency Levels

Level	Meaning
⛔ **Overdue**	The licence has already expired. Shown with how many days overdue.
⚠️ **Expiring Soon**	The licence expires within the next **30 days** (includes the more urgent ≤7-day cases). Shown with how many days remain.

A licence stops being flagged the moment its expiry date is pushed out past the 30-day window by a renewal — see The Renewal Workflow below.

Where You'll See an Alert

The same information surfaces in three places, from quickest glance to most detail:

Where	What it shows	Detail level
🔔 **Bell notification**	A row titled e.g. "⚠️ *Action Needed: 3 Licenses Overdue, 2 Expiring Soon*" — refreshes in place as the real count changes, rather than adding a new row every time the check runs. Tap it to expand in place: the same per-vehicle/driver breakdown as the System Alerts chat, colour-coded, with a **Renew** → (or **Open driver** →) link on each item.	Full detail, expands in place — no need to leave the bell panel.
💬 **System Alerts chat**	A read-only message listing every affected vehicle and driver — licence type, licence number, make/model, exact expiry date, and days overdue/remaining — grouped under OVERDUE and Expiring Soon headings, each with its own **Renew** → link. Posted at most once every ~20 hours so it doesn't spam the channel.	Full detail, with links straight to the specific vehicle's Renew form. See System Alerts (Read-Only).
Compliance Alerts panel (Fleet Management → Overview tab)	A live, itemised list recalculated every time you open the page — always reflects the current state, not a snapshot.	Full detail, interactive (click through to the vehicle or driver).

All three are driven by the same underlying check and render from the same shared formatting component, so they never disagree with each other about what's currently outstanding or look inconsistent from one place to the next.

Every individual vehicle item — in the bell, the chat, or the panel — has its own **Renew** action that jumps straight to that vehicle, pre-opened on the Renew form for that exact licence. You never have to go hunting for the right vehicle in Fleet Management first.

How Often It Checks

- **Nightly** — an automatic scheduled sweep runs once a day.
- **On demand** — every time anyone loads their notifications (opens the bell), the system opportunistically re-checks if it's been more than 5 minutes since the last check, so a licence that just lapsed doesn't sit undetected until the next scheduled run.
- **Admins can force a check immediately** — see Manually Triggering a Check (Admin) below.

The Renewal Workflow

1. Renew the licence at the licensing office as normal.
2. Record it in the system either by:
    - clicking **Renew** → on the alert itself (bell, System Alerts chat, or Compliance Alerts panel) — opens that vehicle straight to the Renew form for that exact licence, or
    - using **Record a Renewal Receipt** (Fleet Management → Vehicles tab → select the vehicle → **Record Renewal Receipt**) if you're also logging the payment breakdown.

Either way, renewing **always requires entering the new licence number and the new issue/expiry dates** — there is no shortcut that marks a licence renewed without capturing what actually changed. The old licence record is kept as history, not overwritten, so you can always see what it looked like before.

3. **That's it — no separate "clear alert" step.** Saving the new licence automatically re-runs the check immediately for that vehicle/driver:
    - If the new expiry date is now more than 30 days away, the bell summary count drops, the vehicle/driver disappears from the Compliance Alerts panel, and (once nothing is outstanding for anyone) the bell notification clears itself entirely.
    - If it's still within the 30-day window (e.g. renewed for a short period), it simply shows with its new, later date and updated days-remaining.
4. **Already-posted alerts update themselves too — you don't have to wait for a new digest.** An alert you already saw (in the bell, the System Alerts chat, or reopened later) shows the overdue line crossed out, a green **"✅ Renewed [date/time] — new expiry [date]"** line, and the **Renew** link replaced with a plain "Renewed — no further action needed" label. This happens live, for everyone who had that alert, the moment the renewal is saved — not just for a fresh digest. The alert's original text is never rewritten (it stays an accurate record of what was found at the time); the resolved look is computed from the vehicle's current data every time the alert is opened.
5. **A resolved alert can't trigger another renewal for the same licence.** If you (or anyone else) reopen it and click what used to be the Renew link, the system re-checks first — if it's already been renewed since, you'll see a clear "already renewed" message instead of a form, even if your copy of the page hadn't refreshed yet.

Driver licences work the same way — update the **Licence Expiry** date on the driver's record and the same automatic re-check (including the retroactive resolved view) applies.

Manually Triggering a Check (Admin)

System admins can force an immediate check — useful right after a renewal, or to verify the whole pipeline is working — from **Admin** → **Vehicle License Compliance Sweep**:

1. Go to the **Admin** page.
2. Find the **Vehicle License Compliance Sweep** card.
3. Click **Run License Compliance Sweep**.
4. A result summary shows how many vehicle licences, driver licences, and notifications were processed.

This manual trigger always posts a fresh System Alerts chat message if anything is outstanding, bypassing the normal ~20-hour spacing — the automatic nightly/on-demand checks still apply that spacing so the chat channel doesn't fill up with repeats.

Permissions

Action	Who can do it
Receive compliance alerts (bell, chat, panel)	System admins, and users with Manage Vehicles permission

Action	Who can do it
View the Compliance Alerts panel	Same as above
Manually trigger a compliance sweep	System admins only
Clear an alert (by renewing)	Users with Manage Vehicles permission

43b. Vehicle Licensing Status, Retirement & Reinstatement

> **Who reads this:** Fleet Management users with the **Manage Vehicles** permission, and system admins.

Overview

Every vehicle has exactly one **licensing status** at a time:

Status	Meaning
Non-exempt	Standard — tracks a Registration licence and an Insurance licence, each with its own expiry date, renewal, and compliance alerts (see §43a). The default for every vehicle.
Exempt	The vehicle holds a single Exemption licence instead of Registration/Insurance (e.g. "No Use Public Road"). The exemption licence has its own expiry date and is tracked and alerted on exactly like any other licence — just under its own "Vehicle Exemption Expiry" alert title so it's never confused with a standard registration alert.
Retired	The vehicle is out of service. All licensing tracking stops — no licences are active, no alerts are generated, and its licence section shows **"Not applicable"** instead of blank or overdue. Nothing is deleted; all past licence and status records remain visible in reports.

> **Don't confuse this with Vehicle Exemptions (§42)** — that's a separate feature for recording a *fee-certificate* exemption (e.g. no radio/TV fitted) against a vehicle that can be in any licensing status. Licensing status (this section) is about whether the vehicle is tracked as Non-exempt, Exempt, or Retired as a whole.

Changing a Vehicle's Status

1. Open the vehicle in Fleet Management and click **Change Status**.
2. Pick a destination from the options offered — only the statuses that vehicle is actually allowed to move to are shown. Nothing changes yet at this point.
3. Fill in what the new status requires:
    - → **Non-exempt**: Registration and Insurance licence details (number, issue/expiry date, issuing authority, renewal cost).
    - → **Exempt**: Exemption licence details (number, issue/expiry date, issuing authority, exemption fee).
    - → **Retired**: a retirement reason (pick from the list, or **+ Add new reason** to add one for everyone to reuse) — if the reason is "Other", you must also enter a short explanation.
4. Click **Save**. The change happens all at once — old licences that no longer apply are deactivated, the new licence(s) are created, and the vehicle's status updates together. If anything fails, nothing is changed.

Every status change is recorded with who changed it, when, and why — visible in the vehicle's status history and in reports (below).

The One Rule: Retired → Exempt Isn't Allowed Directly

A retired vehicle can only become Exempt by first being reinstated to **Non-exempt**, then changed to Exempt as a second step. This is enforced by the system — "Exempt" simply isn't offered as an option while a vehicle is Retired, so there's no illegal transition to even attempt.

From \ To	Non-exempt	Exempt	Retired
Non-exempt	—	✅	✅
Exempt	✅	—	✅
Retired	✅ (reinstate)	❌ not directly	—

Reporting

- **Fleet Overview** report now shows a **Licensing Status** breakdown (Non-exempt / Exempt / Retired counts).
- **Vehicle Status History** (Fleet Management → Reports) lists every currently-retired vehicle with its retirement reason, date, and status beforehand, plus the full change log of every status transition for every vehicle (who changed it, when, from what, to what, and why). A reinstated vehicle drops off the "currently retired" list immediately but stays fully visible in the change log.
- Compliance alerts and Fleet Overview totals never include retired vehicles — their licensing is considered not applicable, not overdue.

Permissions

Action	Who can do it
Change a vehicle's licensing status	Users with Manage Vehicles permission, and system admins
Add a new retirement reason	Same as above
View Vehicle Status History / status counts in reports	Same as above

---

44. Stock Additions Report

> **Who reads this:** Store managers, purchasing staff, and business owners who need to track what inventory was received, when, from which suppliers, and by whom.

The **Stock Additions Report** shows every inventory receipt — bulk restocks, stock-take submissions, and individual add-stock operations — for a selected date range. It is available under **Grocery → Reports → Stock Additions**.

> **Note:** The report covers items with stock movement records. Items created before movement logging was introduced may not appear for the period before that date.

Opening the Report

1. Go to **Grocery** → **Reports**.
2. Click the 🗃️ **Stock Additions** card.
3. The report loads automatically showing the last **7 days**.

Date Range Filters

Use the date-range pills at the top of the page to change the period:

Pill	What it shows
Today	Movements recorded today only
Yesterday	Movements recorded yesterday only
7 Days	Last 7 days (default)
30 Days	Last 30 days
All Time	Every movement on record

Summary Cards

Below the date pills, four summary cards give a quick snapshot of the period:

Card	Meaning
Movements	Total number of stock-in events
Units In	Combined units received across all items
Total Value	Combined cost value of all received stock
Suppliers	Number of distinct suppliers involved

The Movements Table

Each row represents one stock addition event:

Column	What it shows
Item	Product name and SKU
Category	Product category
Supplier	Supplier the item is linked to (if set)
Qty Added	Number of units received in this event
Unit Cost	Cost per unit at time of receipt
Total Cost	Qty × Unit Cost

Column	What it shows
Added By	The employee who processed the receipt
Date / Time	When the movement was recorded
Reference	Purchase order or reference number (if entered)

Exporting: Click **Export CSV** (top right of the table) to download the current filtered view as a spreadsheet.

Pagination: Results are paginated at 50 rows per page. Use the **Next / Previous** buttons at the bottom of the table to navigate.

Zero results: If no stock was added in the selected period, the table shows an empty-state message. Try widening the date range.

Dashboard Activity Feed — Stock Additions

Recent stock additions appear in the **Recent Activity** feed on the main Dashboard (visible to managers and owners). Each card shows:

```
📦  Stock Added  ·  [Business Name]
    [Qty] units of [Item Name] received      > View Report
    [Date / Time]
```

The feed shows stock additions from the **last 7 days** (up to 5 entries). Clicking **View Report** navigates directly to the Stock Additions report filtered to the business and today's date.

Permissions

Action	Who can do it
View Stock Additions report	Users with financial data access or manager role
Export CSV	Users with financial data access or manager role
See stock additions in dashboard feed	Managers and business owners

---

45. Clothing POS — Live Sales Activity

> **Who reads this:** Clothing store cashiers, floor supervisors, and managers who want to monitor what is selling during the day without leaving the POS.

The Clothing POS displays real-time sales activity indicators directly on each product and bale card. These indicators update automatically after every sale and give staff an instant read on what is moving, what is slowing down, and what has sold out.

The POS browse panel has three tabs — **Bales**, **R710 WiFi**, and **Quick Add** — and all three show the same types of indicators.

Sold-Today Badge

A small green badge appears on a product or bale when at least one unit of that item has been sold today.

```
Ladies Tops M    (2 left)   [ 3 sold ]   $5.00   [ Add ]
```

Who can see it	Permission required
Admins	Always visible
Managers / financials	Users with **financial data access** permission
Sales staff	Users with the **View POS Sold Count** permission
All other staff	Badge is hidden — they see stock counts only

The number inside the badge is the total units sold **today** (since midnight in the store's local timezone). It updates immediately after each checkout without requiring a page refresh.

Today vs Yesterday Progress Bar

Below each variant or bale row, a thin progress bar appears whenever any units have been sold today. The bar compares today's sales to yesterday's sales for that same item.

Bar colour	Label	Meaning
Green	**Good**	Today's sales ≥ yesterday's sales
Amber	**Fair**	Today's sales are 50–99% of yesterday's
Red	**Low**	Today's sales are less than 50% of yesterday's
Green	**New**	Sold today, but no sales yesterday to compare against

The bar fills proportionally — if yesterday you sold 10 and today you have sold 10, the bar is 100% full and green. If today you have sold 5 out of yesterday's 10, the bar is 50% full and amber.

Yesterday's count is shown to the right of the bar (e.g. `yest: 8`) so staff can see the reference figure at a glance.

The progress bar is visible to **all users** regardless of permissions — it shows pace, not exact revenue figures.

Bales Tab

Each bale card shows:

- **Items remaining** count
- **Sold-today badge** (permissioned) — how many individual pieces from this bale have been sold today
- **Progress bar** — today's piece count vs yesterday's piece count for this bale

Bales with the highest today's sales bubble to the top of the list, sorted by the time of their first sale today (earliest first). Bales with no sales today appear below.

After a sale, the bale's remaining count and badge update immediately in the UI without a page refresh.

R710 WiFi Tab

Each WiFi package card (e.g. "1 Hour", "24 Hours", "Weekly") shows:

- **Available tokens** — how many pre-generated tokens are ready to sell
- **Sold-today badge** (permissioned) — tokens sold today from this package
- **Progress bar** — today's token count vs yesterday's

Packages with today's sales sort to the top. If a package is running low on available tokens (fewer than 5 remaining), a **Request More** button appears on the card — clicking it notifies the admin to generate more tokens.

Quick Add Tab

Products pinned or available in Quick Add show the same badges and progress bars as Bales and WiFi. Each variant row within a product card displays:

- **Stock remaining** count (or **Out** in red when stock reaches zero)
- **Sold-today badge** (permissioned) — units of this specific variant sold today
- **Progress bar** — today vs yesterday comparison

Sorting: Pinned products (starred ★) always appear first. Among unpinned products, those with any variant sold today sort ahead of those with no sales, and within that group they are ordered by time of first sale today (earliest first).

Sold-out variants stay visible — if a variant's stock reaches zero but units were sold today, the row remains in the card so the sold-today badge and progress bar remain visible. The Add button is disabled and the count shows **Out** in red.

After a sale, the Quick Add tab updates the badge, progress bar, and stock count **immediately** — the sold count increments and the stock count decrements without waiting for a page refresh.

Showing Hidden Sold-Out Items

By default the Quick Add tab hides products where **all variants have zero stock AND zero sales today**. These are items that are fully sold out and have not moved at all today — showing them would just be clutter.

When any products are hidden, a button appears in the Quick Add tab header:

```
[ Show 3 hidden ]
```

Clicking it reveals all hidden sold-out products, greyed out, with their Add buttons disabled. The button label changes to:

```
[ Hide 3 sold out ]
```

Click again to collapse them back.

Why this is useful: If a badge you expected to see is missing, click "Show hidden" to check whether the product is there but sold out. If the product does not appear even in the hidden list, it may need to be restocked or re-activated in Inventory.

Permissions Summary

Feature	Who sees it
Sold-today badge (exact count)	Admin, financial data access, or View POS Sold Count permission
Progress bar (today vs yesterday pace)	All users
Stock count / "Out" label	All users
"Show hidden" toggle	All users

---

46. Missing Cost Price Report (superseded)

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → ⚠️ Missing Cost Price (old link) now shows a redirect notice.

This report has been superseded by **66. Pricing, Cost, Value & Performance Intelligence Reports** (see the end of this guide). Missing cost price is now one exception type inside the broader **Pricing & Value Exceptions** report, which also covers missing/zero selling prices, below-cost sales, suspicious values, price-change anomalies, and a review/approval workflow — scoped to the business currently selected in the business switcher (the old report's "all businesses at once" view has no direct replacement; the new reports work one business at a time).

---

47. Payee Expense Insights

Who can access: Admins and users with financial data access.

Where: Expense Accounts → Reports → Payee Expense Insights

This report shows spending patterns broken down by payee group — how much has been paid to **Contractors** and **Suppliers** over any date range, with charts and a per-payee breakdown.

Tabs

Tab	Covers
Contractors	All persons/contractors who received expense payments
Suppliers	All business suppliers who received payments

Click a tab to switch the entire report view to that group.

Date Filter

- Use the date range pill at the top to pick a preset period (this month, last month, last 3 months, last year) or enter a custom date range.
- Check **All time** to remove the date restriction and see totals across all records.

Summary Card (per tab)

Shows the total paid to that group in the selected period, the number of unique payees, and the payment count.

Charts

Chart	What it shows
Spending by Group	Bar chart comparing total paid to Contractors vs Suppliers side-by-side
Top Payees	Horizontal bar chart of the top individual payees in the active tab, sorted by amount paid
Monthly Spending Trend	Line chart of total payments per calendar month for the active tab

Payee List

Below the charts, a searchable table lists every payee in the active group with their total paid and payment count. Click any row to jump to that payee's full payment history.

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48. Supplier, Contractor & Payee Categories

The system supports a two-level category system — **groups** and **categories** — for classifying suppliers, contractors, and payees. These categories help with filtering, reporting, and organising who you work with.

Structure

Each of the three areas (Suppliers, Contractors, Payees) has its own independent category hierarchy:

```
Group (e.g. "Building Materials")
  └─ Category (e.g. "Cement Suppliers")
  └─ Category (e.g. "Steel Merchants")
```

```
Group (e.g. "Transport & Logistics")
  └─ Category (e.g. "Fuel Suppliers")
```

Where Categories Appear

- When adding or editing a **Supplier** — you can assign a supplier category from the drop-down.
- When adding or editing a **Contractor** (person/payee) — you can assign a contractor category.
- When adding or editing a **Payee** — you can assign a payee category.

Start typing in the category picker and matching groups/categories are suggested as you type (e.g. typing "Electrician" suggests 🏗️ **Construction, Hardware and Trades → Electrician**).

Category Coverage

All three areas share a broad, general-purpose taxonomy — 16 domains covering food and beverage, retail, construction and trades, automotive, personal care, health, technology, education, professional services, agriculture, manufacturing, cleaning, events, utilities, and community/public services. Contractors additionally keep their original, more specific construction-and-trades-only groups (General Construction, Plumbing Services, Electrical Services, etc.) alongside the general set, so a search for a trade-specific category still finds the more precise option first.

Managing Categories

Admins can manage the category groups and categories from the relevant settings pages. Categories are shared across all businesses — they are global reference data, not per-business.

Why Use Categories?

- Filter the payee insights report by category to see spending patterns by supplier type
- Group contractors by trade (plumbing, electrical, construction) for organised reporting
- Classify payees so that expense reports are more meaningful

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49. Edit Business Settings

Who can access: System admins and business owners with the appropriate permission.

Where: Admin → Businesses → Edit (pencil icon), or Business Settings page.

The Edit Business modal is arranged in two columns to make all settings accessible without excessive scrolling.

Left Column

Section	Fields
Basic Information	Business Name, Business Type (read-only when editing), Description
Contact & Location	Business Address, Business Phone
Rent Account	Manage or create the rent expense account for this business

Section	Fields
Sales Target	Enable or manage sales target tracking — see Chapter 58
Branding	Business Slogan, Show on Customer Display toggle, Default Landing Page, Display Colour
Receipt & Tax	Return Policy Message (printed on receipts), Enable Tax Calculation, Tax Included in Price, Tax Rate (%), Tax Label

Right Column

Section	Fields
Features	Accepts Eco-Cash (+ fee config), Include Transport Cost in Pricing (+ distance/rate config), Require Salesperson EOD Report (+ deadline time), Enable Coupons, Enable Customer Promos, Show Test Data

Branding

- **Business Slogan** — up to 200 characters. Displayed on receipts and, if toggled on, on the customer-facing display screen.
- **Show on customer display** — tick to show the slogan on the second screen (customer display). Untick to hide it.
- **Default Landing Page** — the page users land on after selecting this business. Options vary by business type (e.g. POS System, Dashboard, Inventory).
- **Display Colour** — a colour picker used to visually tell businesses apart wherever multiple businesses are shown side by side (the Cash Bucket page, Cash Position Report, and the businesses list). Leave it unset and the business is automatically given a stable colour based on its ID — every business gets a colour with no setup required, but you can override it here for a colour that better matches the business's branding. Click **Reset to automatic** to clear a manual choice.

Receipt & Tax

- **Return Policy Message** — printed at the bottom of every receipt. Leave blank for no policy message.
- **Enable Tax Calculation** — when ticked, tax is applied to sales. When unticked, prices are shown as-is.
- **Tax Included in Price** — when ticked, the tax is embedded in product prices (no separate line on receipt). When unticked, tax is calculated on top at checkout.
- **Tax Rate (%)** — e.g. enter `14.5` for 14.5% tax.
- **Tax Label** — the label shown on receipts, e.g. `VAT`, `GST`, `Sales Tax`.

EcoCash Fee Configuration

Shown when **Accepts Eco-Cash** is enabled.

Field	Description
Fee Type	Fixed amount ($) or Percentage (%) of the sale total
Fee Value	The dollar amount or percentage to charge

Field	Description
Min Fee ($)	Minimum fee charged when using Percentage mode

Cash Rounding Configuration

Shown when **Enable Cash Rounding** is ticked (on by default). Controls how cash payment totals are rounded to avoid impractical change.

Field	Options	Default	Description
Rounding Step	$0.01 / $0.10 / $0.50 / $1.00	$0.50	The boundary interval totals are rounded to. A $0.50 step means totals land on $0.50 or $1.00 multiples.
Auto-apply Threshold	$0.01 / $0.05 / $0.10 / $0.20	$0.05	When the rounding gap is ≤ this amount, rounding is applied automatically at the POS without a button press.
Max Round-Down Discount	$0.05 / $0.10 / $0.20 / $0.50	$0.10	The largest courtesy discount the system will offer via the round-down button. If rounding down to the next step boundary would give the customer a discount larger than this amount, the round-down option is hidden entirely and the cashier can only round up or keep the exact price.

How it works at the POS:

Non-AYLI orders (regular menu items):

- If the cart total is $2.62 with a $0.50 step, an amber rounding panel appears in the payment screen.
- The cashier can round up to $3.00 (+$0.38), or keep $2.62 exact. The round-down option (to $2.50, −$0.12) is only shown if $0.12 ≤ the Max Round-Down Discount setting.
- Since $0.38 > the $0.05 threshold in this example, the cashier must choose manually. A $0.03 gap would auto-apply.

AYLI combo orders:

- Rounding is decided **inside the AYLI modal** before the combo enters the cart — not in the payment screen.
- **Round up:** The gap is distributed proportionally across ingredient prices. The combo enters the cart at the rounded-up total. No separate line is added.
- **Round down:** Only shown when the discount does not exceed the Max Round-Down Discount. Ingredient prices stay exact. A separate **Promotional Discount (CR)** line is injected into the cart below the combo, giving the customer a visible courtesy discount on their receipt. The "(CR)" label is internal shorthand — the customer simply reads "Promotional Discount" on their receipt.
- **Keep:** The combo enters at its exact price. Since the cart contains an AYLI item, the payment screen will **not** show a rounding panel — what the customer pays is the exact total.

> **Example:** Total is $2.94 with a $0.50 step. Round-down target is $2.50 — a $0.44 discount. With the default limit of $0.10, the round-down button is hidden because $0.44 > $0.10. Only round up to $3.00 (+$0.06) or Keep $2.94 are offered.

All rounding events (direction, original amount, rounded amount, cashier) are permanently logged in **Reports → Cash Rounding** for audit and end-of-day reconciliation.

Transport Cost Configuration

Shown when **Include Transport Cost in Pricing** is enabled. Used by the pricing calculator to factor in delivery cost.

Field	Description
One-way distance to supplier (km)	Distance from the store to the supplier in kilometres
Cost per km ($/km)	Fuel/transport cost per kilometre

The estimated round-trip cost is shown automatically as a guide.

EOD Submission Deadline

Shown when **Require Salesperson EOD Report** is enabled. Set the time by which salespersons must submit their end-of-day cash and EcoCash totals. After this time, overdue warnings appear at the POS.

Show Test Data

Any product or menu item with `[test]` anywhere in its name (case-insensitive — e.g. `[test] Beef Stir-Fry`, `[TEST] Auto-Generated Bale`) is hidden from the POS, product lists, and search for every business by default, so testing/demo data never clutters what cashiers see.

Tick **Show Test Data** to temporarily reveal those items at the POS for this business — useful when you need to test a workflow with disposable products. Untick it afterward to hide them again. This does not delete or deactivate the items — it only controls whether they appear in POS product listings.

---

50. Warehouse Import & Move Wizard

The Warehouse module is a staging layer that sits between supplier orders and your business inventory. You import an Excel spreadsheet from your supplier (or buying agent), optionally reconcile it against a post-clearance Container Batch report, review the items, then move them into business inventory or record them as personal expenses.

Who Can Use It

Warehouse access is controlled by two permissions:

Permission	What it allows
`canAccessWarehouse`	View the warehouse, import batches, edit items
`canMoveWarehouseToInventory`	Move items into a business's product inventory

Admins automatically have both permissions. Grant them to staff in the user permissions panel.

Workflow Overview

```
Excel File → Import → Warehouse Batch → Review & Edit → Move to Business / Personal
```

1. **Import** — Upload an `.xlsx` spreadsheet to create a batch.
2. **Review** — Check items: edit costs, exchange rates, short names, flag personal items.
3. **Move** — Send items to a business's inventory (with selling prices) or log personal items as expenses.

Step 1 — Import a Batch

Navigate to **Warehouse** → **Import Batch**.

Field	Description
Excel File (.xlsx)	Drag-and-drop or browse. Only `.xlsx` files accepted.
Batch Name	Auto-filled from the filename (e.g. `batch_29 — 2026-05-25`). Edit if needed.
Notes	Optional notes about this batch.
Picked up at collection point	Toggle if you collected the goods yourself rather than having them delivered. Enter the transport cost (US$) — it will be divided equally across all items.

Duplicate file detection: The system checks a SHA-256 hash of the file. If you upload the same file twice, you'll see an error with the name of the existing batch.

Overlapping order numbers: If any order numbers in the new file already exist in a previous batch, you'll see a warning with the list. You can cancel or import anyway (duplicate rows are allowed for re-orders).

Expected spreadsheet columns:

Column	Contents
A	Product image (embedded)
B	Order number
C	Tracking number
D	Product name (full, may be in Chinese)
E	Quantity
F	Cost (USD)
G	Order date
H	Price (Yuan ¥)

Column	Contents
I	Row number
J	Exchange rate
K	Stage
L	Shipment
M	Location
N	Courier name
O	Courier status
P	Courier time
Q	Parent order
R	Parcel number

Source batch columns (optional — present when your supplier groups orders into clearance batches):

Column	Contents
`Batch ID`	Integer — identifies which source batch this item belongs to
`Batch Name`	Human-readable batch label (e.g. `Pre-Batch Import 5-31`)
`Clearance Cost (USD)`	Total customs/clearance cost for the whole batch — the **same value repeats on every row** in that batch. Empty for OPEN batches.
`Batch Status`	`OPEN` (clearance not yet paid) or `CLOSED` (clearance confirmed)

When these columns are present the system reads the total clearance cost once per source batch and allocates it **pro-rata by Yuan cost** across all items in that batch. Items in OPEN batches receive $0 clearance allocation until the batch is closed and re-imported.

Sub-parcels (`_p2`, `_p3`, …) are automatically merged into the primary row (`_p1`), with their tracking numbers stored alongside.

Container Batch Import — Reconciling Post-Clearance Costs

After your goods clear customs, your supplier or agent may issue a "Container Batch" report with the true landed cost per item, an estimated selling price, and its own tracking/order number references. Navigate to **Warehouse → Container Batch Import** to reconcile this against what's already in the Warehouse.

1. Upload the Container Batch `.xlsx` file and click **Preview →**.
2. The system matches each row to an existing warehouse item **by order number and tracking number** and shows a status badge per row:

Badge	Meaning
🆕 new item	No matching warehouse item found — this will be imported as a new row.
🔄 will update existing item	Matches an item still `IN_WAREHOUSE` — its landed cost, estimated selling price, and shipping-per-unit will be refreshed from this file.
💲 already moved — will update price only	The matched item has already been moved to business inventory. SKU and barcode are left untouched; only the price and margin are refreshed on the live product (hover the badge for the current SKU/barcode/price).
⚠ possible duplicate — already reconciled	This exact tracking/order combination was already reconciled in a previous Container Batch import (shown by name) — check before including it again.

3. Untick any rows you don't want to apply (or use **Select all** / **Skip all**). You can override the estimated selling price per row before confirming.
4. Confirm the import. The batch name, exchange rate, and item counts read from the file header are shown at the top of the review screen for a quick sanity check.

This is what makes the system "self-correct" when you reconcile the same shipment twice — instead of creating duplicate stock, it recognizes an item is already tracked and simply refreshes its numbers.

Step 2 — Review the Batch

Open a batch from the **Warehouse** list to see the item grid.

Status tabs

Tab	Meaning
ALL	Every item in the batch
IN WAREHOUSE	Items not yet moved — available for editing
PERSONAL	Items flagged as personal purchases
MOVED TO BUSINESS	Items already added to a business's inventory
MOVED TO PERSONAL	Items recorded as personal expenses

> **On a phone**, these show as a single dropdown instead of a row of tabs — same 5 options, same counts, just easier to reach one-handed.

Manifest Qty filter pills

Below the status tabs, three pills let you sub-filter by received quantity:

Pill	Shows
All (default)	Every item in the current tab

Pill	Shows
= 0 / unknown	Items whose Manifest Qty is null or zero — goods not yet recorded as received
> 0 received	Items with a positive Manifest Qty — goods confirmed received

The count on each pill updates live as you search or switch tabs. Switching tabs resets the pill to **All**; typing in the search box does not reset it.

Understanding the two quantity columns

Column	What it is	Editable?
Qty	Ordered quantity — what the supplier recorded for this tracking line	Read-only
Manifest Qty	Received quantity — what physically arrived, updated when you count the delivery	Yes — click to edit

ORDER MAX is the total ordered quantity across all unique tracking lines for the same order number. It is computed automatically from every batch that has ever contained that order number and never decreases — even if you import fewer items later, the max only increases when new unique trackings appear.

Rules enforced:

- `Manifest Qty` per item ≤ ordered qty for that tracking line
- Total manifest qty moved for an order ≤ ORDER MAX for that order number
- Items with null or zero Manifest Qty **cannot be selected or moved to business**

Editing items

Field	How to edit
Manifest Qty	Click the value (or the ⚠ unknown badge) — enter received qty. A **/ N** indicator shows the per-tracking cap. Optionally enter a reason. Click **Save**.
Cost USD	Click the cell. If a Rate is already set (row-level or bulk toolbar), a suggested cost (≈ ¥ price ÷ rate) is pre-filled in italic blue — accept or override.
Rate	Click the cell and type the exchange rate.
Short Name	Click the bold product name line.
Notes	Inline edit on the item row.

When a Manifest Qty has been edited, the original value is shown above the current value as `orig: N`. Click it to see the full change record (before/after qty, before/after ¥ price, reason, timestamp).

When the ¥ Price changes because Manifest Qty was edited, the original price is shown above the current price as `orig: ¥NN.NN`.

Bulk Fill toolbar

When **no items are selected**, a fill bar appears at the top of the grid. Enter a Rate or Cost value and click **Apply to empty** to fill all items that are currently blank — useful for applying a single exchange rate to an entire batch.

When **one or more items are checked**, the toolbar shows additional actions:

- **Rate / Apply to empty** — fill the exchange rate for selected items that are blank.
- **Cost / Apply to empty** — fill the USD cost for selected items that are blank.
- **Flag Personal** — mark selected items as personal (removes them from business inventory candidates).
- **Flag Business** — un-flag selected items (returns them to IN_WAREHOUSE).
- **Move to Personal** — immediately record selected items as personal expenses.

Personal items panel

A collapsible panel at the bottom of the page lists all items flagged as personal. Use the **Move all X to Personal** button to record them as personal expenses in one click. Each expense is logged under the category *Warehouse* with the order number and batch name in the notes.

Source batch filter

When an import file contains items from **multiple source batches**, a filter dropdown appears above the item grid. Select a specific source batch to narrow the view to just those items. Each item row shows a coloured badge with the batch name and an OPEN / CLOSED status indicator, plus the allocated clearance cost per item.

Scan mode

Click **Scan Mode** (top-right) to open a persistent scan panel. Scan or type an order number, tracking number, or short name. The matching item is shown with its image, cost, and status. From the result you can go directly to **Move to Business** or **Move to Personal**.

Step 3 — Move to Business Inventory

Before you can move an item, its **Manifest Qty must be set to a value greater than zero**. Items with unknown or zero manifest qty are greyed out and cannot be selected. Set the received quantity on the batch review page first.

Click **Move to Business** on the batch detail page (or from the scan panel) to open the move wizard.

1. **Select target business** — choose which business will receive the stock (global selector at the top).
2. **Set markup %** — enter a markup percentage and click **Apply** to auto-calculate selling prices for all items. Default is 30%.
3. **Review each item card** — items are displayed as cards. Each card shows:
    - Product image on the left (click to zoom to full size).
    - Full product name.
    - **Sell $ [price]** field — always displayed to two decimal places (e.g. `75.50`). Edit directly.
    - 💡 button — opens the inline pricing calculator for that item.

    - **Move** → button — moves that single item immediately once business, category, and price are set.
    - Order number and tracking number (second line).
    - Cost breakdown: `Cost $XX.XX +$X.XX transport +$X.XX fee +$X.XX clearance | Unit cost $XX.XX`
    - Business combobox, Domain, Category, Sub-category dropdowns, 🏷 **Suggest** button, and Barcode field — all filling the full card width.
4. **Classify each item** — pick Domain → Category → Sub-category. Use the 🏷 **Suggest** button (next to the Barcode field) to auto-suggest classifications based on the product name (see Classification Suggestion below).
5. **Set per-item target business (optional)** — override the global business for individual rows using the searchable business combobox in the classification row (see Per-Item Target Business Override).
6. Click **Move selected (N)** at the bottom to move all selected items at once.

The **Qty** column in the move wizard shows the **Manifest Qty** (received qty), not the ordered qty. Cost-per-unit calculations use manifest qty so the numbers reflect what was actually received.

ORDER MAX guard: The system checks that the total quantity being moved for each order number (including any previously moved items from other batches) does not exceed the ORDER MAX for that order. If it would, the move is blocked with a message showing how many units have already been processed and how many remain.

For each item moved, the system creates:

- A **Business Product** record with the short name as product name.
- A **Product Variant** with the calculated selling price, stock quantity set to **Manifest Qty**, and optional barcode.
- A **Stock Movement** of type `PURCHASE_RECEIVED` for the manifest qty received.
- A **Product Image** linked from the warehouse item (if one was in the spreadsheet).
- A **Product Barcode** entry if a barcode was supplied (scanner-ready immediately).

The warehouse item status changes to **MOVED_TO_BUSINESS**.

Cost price shown: The unit cost reflects `costUsd per unit + transaction fee + transport per unit + clearance per unit`. All four components are shown separately in the cost breakdown line so you know exactly what margin you are working with. Clearance is only non-zero when the source batch is CLOSED and a clearance cost was present in the Excel file.

Bulk-Stock Conversion — Packets vs. Individual Units

Sometimes what was recorded as "1 unit" in the spreadsheet is really a packet containing several separate sellable items — e.g. a pack of 5 pairs of socks, costed and counted as one row, but actually five individual items once it reaches the shelf. Bulk-Stock Conversion turns that packet-level record into the true individual-unit picture — quantity, cost, and selling price all recalculated together — without you doing the math by hand.

Example: 2 packets, $4.85 cost per packet, 5 items per packet, listed at $9.00/packet → after conversion: **10 individual units**, **$0.97 cost/unit**, **$1.80 selling price/unit** (editable). Total inventory cost stays the same ($9.70) — only how it's counted and priced changes.

At Move to Business time — check **"This is bulk stock"** on the item card, enter **Items per packet**, and optionally override the individual selling price (it defaults to the packet price ÷ items per packet). A live preview shows the resulting unit count and price before you move it. The product is created already at the converted, individual-unit numbers — there's no separate conversion step afterward.

After it's already been stocked — open the item in **Edit Item**. If it hasn't been converted yet, an amber **"This item is actually bulk stock — convert to individual units?"** box lets you enter the items-per-packet and preview the same before/after numbers, then confirm. This is a **one-way conversion**: quantity, cost, and price for that item can never contain a mixture of packet and individual-unit values.

If some of the packets have already been sold before you convert: the conversion always uses whatever is *currently* on hand, not the original received quantity — e.g. converting after 1 of 2 packets already sold turns the remaining 1 into 5 individual units, not 10. Nothing about the already-completed sale is changed retroactively.

Correcting a mistake: if you entered the wrong items-per-packet, Edit Item lets you correct it — but **only while nothing has been sold or otherwise moved since the original conversion**. The moment any other stock activity happens on that item, the conversion becomes permanent and the correction option disappears.

Once converted, it stays converted everywhere:

- The Edit Item cost box that recorded the original packet size/cost becomes read-only, showing the permanent record.
- The batch detail page (both the item table and, on mobile, the item cards) shows a 🔁 **Bulk (N/pack)** badge plus a **"Now: $X/unit \cdot Y in stock$" $*$ $*line with the live current per - unit cost and stock — alongside, not replacing, that item's own original warehouse - side cost figures (Cost$, Landed Cost, Est. Selling), which continue to show exactly what was true at move time.
- Move Sessions and the Warehouse home page's "Potential Value" totals automatically account for the conversion factor, so they stay accurate whether the item was converted at move time or later.

A later batch for the same product: if a new warehouse batch's item matches an existing, already-converted product (by barcode, or by exact product name if no barcode match is found), the system **tops up that product's stock automatically** instead of creating a duplicate — using the existing product's own bulk classification and items-per-packet, and blending the incoming cost into a weighted-average unit cost. Any bulk setting you entered on that new row is ignored in this case, since the existing product's classification always wins. If the item genuinely doesn't match anything existing, it's created as a new product and you classify it independently.

Classification Suggestion

Each item card in the move wizard has a 🏷 **Suggest** button, located in the classification row next to the Barcode field. Clicking it analyses the product name and suggests the best-matching Domain → Category → Sub-category combinations, scoped strictly to the **target business** for that row (its per-item business override, or the global Target Business if none is set).

How it works:

1. The product name is split into whole words (numbers included); common English filler words ("for", "with", "and"…) are removed.
2. Each word is matched as a **whole word** — not a substring — against the target business's own domain, category, and sub-category names, including singular/plural forms in both directions (e.g. "screws" matches "M6 screw", and "shirt" matches a category named "Shirts").
3. Results are ranked by score and shown in a searchable list, including a small thumbnail of the item so you can confirm it's suggesting for the right product without looking away. The search box inside the popup lets you type to filter — there is no cap on results.

A thumbnail is shown next to "Based on:" at the top of the popup so you can visually confirm which item the suggestions are for, especially useful when several rows have similar product names.

If a Domain is already picked for that row, Suggest only offers Category/Sub-category combinations that actually belong to that domain — it will not suggest something from a domain you've already ruled out.

Applying a suggestion:

- Click any row in the popup — the Domain, Category, and Sub-category dropdowns for that item are filled automatically, and are always guaranteed to belong to the row's own target business (a suggestion can never assign a category from a different business — doing so used to fail the move with a database error; it's now prevented at the source).

"Group" categories (e.g. "Phones And Mobile Accessories") are organizational headers, not real products — Suggest (and the manual dropdowns) show them as the **Category**, with their real, specific items appearing as **Sub-category** options once picked. This gives a proper 3-level Domain → Category → Sub-category picker for these kinds of departments, instead of dumping dozens of specific items directly into the Category list.

When no suggestions appear:

- The product name has too few recognisable keywords — edit the **Short Name** on the batch page to use plain English terms before clicking 🏷 Suggest.
- The category truly doesn't exist yet for this business — the popup offers a **"+ Create new category"** link right there so you don't have to leave the wizard (see Creating a Category or Sub-category On the Fly below).

"⚠ re-pick category for this business" warning: if a row's Category/Domain shows this red badge, the values currently selected don't match the row's target business (most often left over from switching the row's business after already picking a category). Re-select Domain/Category for that row before moving it.

Per-Item Target Business Override

By default, all items in the move wizard go to the **global target business** selected at the top of the page. If you are moving items destined for different businesses in the same session, you do not need to change the global selector for each item.

Each item row has a compact searchable dropdown underneath the product name:

- **Empty (default):** The row uses the global business (shown as `↑ BusinessName` in the placeholder).
- **Select a business:** Type to search, then click a business name. That item will go to the selected business when you click **Move**.

- The dropdown is portal-rendered and scrolls with fixed positioning — it is never clipped by the table.

When you click **Move X Items to Business**, items are grouped by their effective business (row override or global fallback) and a single API call is made per business group.

Creating a Category or Sub-category On the Fly

If nothing in the Category or Sub-category dropdown fits, you don't need to leave the move wizard:

- **+ Category** (next to the Category dropdown) opens the full category editor — set a name, emoji, optional Domain, and optional Parent Category. When a Domain is already selected for the row, the Parent Category list is scoped to that domain's own categories, so you can nest the new category under something that already makes sense (e.g. put a new "Boys" category under an existing "Kids" category) instead of seeing every category across the whole business.
- **+ Sub-cat** (next to the Sub-category dropdown, enabled once a Category is chosen) opens a lightweight inline form — just a name and an optional emoji — for quickly adding a specific item under the selected category.

Either way, the new category/sub-category is created for the row's **target business only**, immediately selected on that row, and available for every other row in the same wizard session without needing to refresh.

Domain → Category → Subcategory for "Grouped" Categories

Some categories (mostly in general-merchandise domains like Electronics, Home & Kitchen, or Bags & Luggage) are organized as a **group**: a broad heading (e.g. "Phones And Mobile Accessories") containing many specific items (Screen Protectors, Power Bank, Charger Cable Adapters, …), where each specific item can belong to a different domain than its siblings.

When you pick one of these as the **Category**, the **Sub-category** dropdown fills with its real, specific items — filtered to whichever Domain is currently selected on the row, since siblings under the same group can span multiple domains. Picking a Sub-category here is what actually determines the item's final classification; the group itself is never saved as the product's category.

This same Domain → Category → Subcategory breadcrumb is shown consistently everywhere the item's classification is displayed afterward — the batch item list, the move wizard's "already moved" rows, and the standard Edit Item screen — so what you picked here is exactly what you'll see later.

Transport Cost, Transaction Fee & Clearance

When importing a batch you can supply:

Field	What it does
Transport cost (USD)	Total freight cost for the batch — divided equally across all IN_WAREHOUSE items
Transaction fee %	Percentage added to each item's USD cost (e.g. 3% PayPal or agent fee)

In addition, if the Excel file contains source batch columns, a **clearance cost** is automatically allocated per item (see Source batch columns) .

All three adjustments are visible in the move wizard cost breakdown line and are factored into the default selling price:

```
selling price = (costPerUnit + txFee + transportPerUnit + clearancePerUnit) × (1 + markup%)
```

Individual rows can override the transport per-item amount using the **Transport Override** field in the row (visible when the batch has a non-zero transport cost).

Reversing a Warehouse Move (Admin)

If an item was moved to business inventory by mistake, an administrator can reverse it using the CLI script. This is an admin-only operation run from the server.

```
node scripts/reverse-warehouse-move.js <batchId>
```

Or to reverse a single item by barcode:

```
node scripts/reverse-warehouse-move.js <batchId> --barcode 183212005
```

What happens:

- The Business Product (and all its variants, stock movements, barcodes, and images) is deleted.
- The warehouse item status is reset to `IN_WAREHOUSE` — the item becomes available for re-classification and re-move.
- The batch delete lock is also lifted for that item (a batch can only be deleted when no items have been moved).

> **Note:** The script requires database credentials in `.env.local` and must be run by someone with server access. It is not available through the web UI.

After the Move — Tracking Live Price Changes

Once an item is moved to business inventory, both the batch item list and the move wizard's "already moved" rows show its **live current selling price** pulled straight from the product record — so if someone edits the price later from Edit Item, you see the up-to-date number here too, not the stale price it was moved at.

If the price has ever been changed since the move, the **original selling price** (the price it was actually moved at) is shown alongside the current one, with the reason for the change and when it happened available on hover. If the price was never touched after the move, only the current price is shown.

Barcode Scan & Assign (After Moving)

A barcode from the supplier spreadsheet is assigned automatically when an item is moved, if one was present. For items that didn't come with one, or need a different one, both the batch item list and the move wizard offer a quick 📷 **Scan Barcode** action on any already-moved row:

1. Click **Scan Barcode** on the item row.
2. Scan the barcode (or type it) and press Enter, or click the ✓ button.

The barcode is written to the product's actual barcode registry — the same one the POS scanner checks — so it's scannable at checkout immediately, not just displayed as text on the item. If a barcode is already assigned and isn't scanning correctly at POS, use the 🔄 button next to it to re-save and re-sync it to the registry.

Opening a Moved Item in Edit Item

Once an item shows **Moved**, click ↗ **Edit Item** under its name to open it directly in the standard inventory editor. If the item was moved to a different business than the one you currently have active, the system switches your active business automatically first, so the link always works regardless of which business you're currently viewing.

Closing Edit Item returns you to exactly where you were — the same batch, the same status tab, and the same scroll position, rather than dropping you back at the top of the warehouse list.

Move Sessions — Reviewing What Was Moved Together

Every time you move one or more items to a business — whether one row at a time with **Move** → or several at once with **Move selected** — those items are grouped into a **Move Session**. This gives you a way to look back at exactly what was moved in a particular sitting, long after the fact.

Where to find it:

- On the batch detail page, a **Move Sessions** panel (green, near the top of the page) lists every past session for that batch, most recent first, with the date/time, target business, item count, and the **expected total selling price** for everything in that session (current selling price × quantity, summed). Click a session to open it.
- Clicking a session takes you into the move wizard filtered to just that session's items — the exact same screen you saw right after moving them, including the Domain → Category → Subcategory breadcrumb for each item.
- From inside the move wizard, a session switcher is always available in the same banner — pick a different session from the dropdown, or choose **Show all items** to go back to the full list, without ever needing to return to the batch page first.

How sessions are grouped: moves done within 30 minutes of each other, for the same batch and the same target business, are treated as one session — so working through a batch one row at a time still lands in a single session instead of creating one per click. A longer gap (or switching target business) starts a new session.

Step 4 — Move to Personal Expenses

Items that are personal purchases (not business stock) can be recorded as personal expenses.

- **From the batch page:** Flag items as Personal, then use the Personal Items panel → **Move all to Personal**.
- **From the bulk toolbar:** Select items → **Move to Personal**.
- **From the scan panel:** Scan an item → **Move to Personal**.

Each item creates a **Personal Expense** entry:

- Category: `Warehouse`
- Description: the item's short name
- Amount: `costUsd` (USD)
- Notes: `Warehouse import — {batchName} / {orderNumber}`

The warehouse item status changes to **MOVED_TO_PERSONAL**.

Deleting a Batch

A batch can be deleted only if **no items have been moved** (to business or personal). To delete, click the trash icon on the Warehouse list page. All items and their images are permanently removed.

If items have already been moved, the delete button is hidden — the batch record is kept for audit purposes.

Reference Locks

The **Manage Locks** link (top-right of the batch detail page) opens the reference lock panel. Locks prevent an order number or tracking number from being imported again.

Lock type	Trigger
Auto-lock	Applied automatically when the total manifest qty moved for that reference equals the ORDER MAX. The lock label shows the qty ratio (e.g. `9/9 rcvd`).
Manual lock	Applied by a user — prevents any further imports for that reference even if the ORDER MAX has not been reached.

A locked reference shows a 🔒 badge on every item row that contains it. Locked items can still be edited and their manifest qty adjusted, but the lock itself must be removed from the reference lock panel before a new import of the same reference is allowed.

Warehouse Home — Search & Stats

The Warehouse home page has a **search box** that filters the batch list in real time by batch name or original filename. Type any part of the name to narrow the list.

It also shows summary cards:

Card	Meaning
Total Batches	Number of imported batches
In Warehouse	Items still sitting in staging
Moved to Business	Items added to business inventory
Moved to Personal	Items recorded as personal expenses
Potential Value (Moved)	The combined current selling price of everything ever moved to business inventory, at today's prices — a quick read on how much revenue this warehouse pipeline has fed into your stores. The same figure also appears as a column on each batch row, scoped to that batch.

Each batch row shows a progress bar indicating what fraction of items have been moved out of the warehouse.

Within a batch's item list, **every status tab is sorted by most recently added or updated first** — so anything you just moved, edited, or scanned a barcode onto surfaces at the top instead of requiring a scroll to find it.

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51. Salesperson Shortfall Report

> **Who reads this:** Managers and finance staff who need to cross-check salesperson EOD declarations against actual system figures.

The **Salesperson Shortfall Report** is a dedicated reconciliation view that compares what each salesperson declared in their daily EOD report against the expected cash/EcoCash collected according to system orders. It is separate from Section 30 (Salesperson EOD Reporting) — that section covers the salesperson's own submission workflow; this report is for managers reviewing the numbers.

Opening the Report

Navigate to **Reports → Salesperson Shortfall**.

Permission required: `canCloseBooks`, `canAccessFinancialData`, or system admin.

Filters

Filter	What it does
Date range	Preset pills (Today, Last 7 days, This month, Last month) or custom start/end date picker
All time	Toggle to remove the date filter entirely and show the complete history
Salesperson	Dropdown to drill into one person's daily history

Filter	What it does
Status	Filter to show only a specific status (see Status Reference below)
Search	Free-text filter on salesperson name

Summary Cards

When no specific salesperson is selected, four summary cards show totals across the filtered period:

Card	Meaning
Days with data	Number of days at least one salesperson submitted
Missing submissions	Days × salespersons with no report at all
Overrides	Rows where a manager submitted on the salesperson's behalf
Total collected	Sum of all reported cash + EcoCash

By-Person Summary Table

With no salesperson filter active, the table shows one row per salesperson:

Column	Meaning
Name	Salesperson name
Days present	Days with a submitted or overridden report
Missing	Days with no submission
Overrides	Days a manager submitted on their behalf
Cash / EcoCash / Total	Sum across the period

Click **Export CSV** to download this summary.

Daily Detail Table

When you select a specific salesperson from the filter, the table switches to a per-day view:

Column	Meaning
Date	The business day
Cash	Declared cash amount
EcoCash	Declared EcoCash amount
Total	Cash + EcoCash
Expected share	System-calculated expected total for that salesperson on that day

Column	Meaning
Variance	Total − Expected share (green ≤ $1, amber ≤ $10, red > $10)
Status	Submission status badge (see below)
Override reason	Shown when a manager submitted instead of the salesperson

Click **Export CSV** to download the daily detail.

Status Reference

Badge	Meaning
Submitted (green)	Salesperson submitted their own report
Override (amber)	A manager submitted on the salesperson's behalf
Zero reported (yellow)	Report submitted with $0 declared
Not submitted (red)	No report exists for that day

Cash Counted Amendments

If a manager amended the "Cash Counted" figure on a saved EOD report after locking, a 🖍 **Amended** badge appears on the relevant row. Click the badge to open a detail popup showing:

- Original cash counted
- New cash counted
- Who made the amendment and when
- The reason provided

Permissions

Action	Permission required
View report	`canCloseBooks` or `canAccessFinancialData` or system admin
Export CSV	Same as view

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52. Backup & Restore — Full Guide

> **Who reads this:** System administrators responsible for data safety and migration. Regular users do not need this section.

The system has a built-in backup and restore engine that covers every table in the database. Backups are downloaded as compressed JSON files (`.json.gz`) that can be stored offline and restored to any compatible installation.

Navigate to **Admin** → **Data Management** to access all backup and restore functions.

Creating a Backup

1. Go to **Admin → Data Management**.
2. Select a **Backup Type** (see Backup Types below).
3. Set any options (include business data, include audit logs, include/exclude demo businesses).
4. Click **Create Backup**.
5. A **live progress log** appears showing each table as it's written, the same style as a restore's progress display (see Restore Progress & Warnings).
6. Once every table finishes, the file downloads automatically as `MultiBusinessSyncService-backup_<type>_<timestamp>.json.gz`.

Store the file in a safe location — cloud storage, an external drive, or a second server.

Backup Types

Type	What it includes
Full Backup (Production)	All tables — users, employees, businesses, products, orders, inventory, payroll, chat, reports, assets, and more — excluding demo businesses by default
Demo Businesses Only	All data for businesses marked as demo — useful for resetting a demo environment
Users & Permissions	User accounts, business memberships, and permission settings only
Business Data	Business records, settings, and business-specific data
Employee Data	Employee records, contracts, and employment history
Reference Data	Job titles, compensation types, benefit types, policy templates

Options available for Full Backup:

Option	Default	Effect
Include business data	✅ On	Includes products, inventory, orders, categories, suppliers, customers
Include audit logs	❌ Off	Adds last 10,000 audit log entries (makes file larger)
Include demo data	❌ Off	Excludes demo businesses — leave off for production backups

---

Pre-Restore Validation

Always validate a backup before restoring. This checks the backup file against the live database without making any changes.

1. Go to the **Restore** section of Data Management.
2. Drag and drop your `.json.gz` (or `.json`) backup file into the upload area, or click to browse.
3. Click **Validate Backup**.

4. The system compares table-by-table record counts between the backup and the live database.

Validation result statuses:

Status	Meaning
✅ Success	All tables match exactly
⚠️ Warning	Some tables differ by expected amounts (e.g. images table is always partial; demo business tables may be excluded) — safe to proceed
❌ Error	A table count is unexpectedly different — investigate before restoring

Expected differences (will always show as warning, not error):

- `images` — only backed up partially by design (large binary data)
- `clothingLabelPrintHistory` — partial backup by design
- `projects` / `vehicleLicenses` — belong to demo businesses excluded from a production backup

If validation shows ⚠️ Warning with only these expected differences, the backup is safe to restore.

Restoring a Backup

> **This overwrites existing data. Run validation first and ensure you have a second backup as a safety net.**

1. Select your backup file (drag-and-drop or browse).
2. Click **Validate Backup** first and confirm the result.
3. Click **Restore Backup**.
4. Confirm the warning dialog.
5. A **live progress log** appears showing each table being restored and its record count.
6. When complete, an alert shows the total records restored and any warnings.
7. Click **OK** — the page reloads automatically.

The restore uses upsert (insert or update) — existing records with matching IDs are updated, new records are inserted. This makes it safe to run on a live database without wiping it first.

Restore Progress & Warnings

While restoring, the progress panel shows:

```
✅ Restored users            12 records
✅ Restored businesses       8 records
✅ Restored businessProducts 3,241 records
⚠️  Skipped 4 records — foreign key constraint (referenced data not in backup)
✅ Restored orders           18,504 records
...
```

Skipped records are logged with the reason:

- **Foreign key errors** — the record references another record that was not in the backup or has not been restored yet.
- **Validation errors** — duplicate unique constraint or invalid data.
- **Other errors** — check server logs for details.

A small number of skipped records is normal. If a large table has many skips, run validation again post-restore to identify the gap.

Verifying a Restore

After a restore, run validation again using the **same backup file** to confirm the live database now matches:

1. Select the same backup file.
2. Click **Validate Backup**.
3. All tables should now show ✅ Success (or the same expected ⚠️ warnings as before).

If any table shows ❌ Error (an unexpected mismatch), that table may need a targeted re-restore. Contact your system administrator.

SQL verification (optional — requires database access):

```
-- Check a specific table count
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM business_products;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM orders;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM employees;
```

Compare these numbers to what was shown in the validation report.

Schema Version

Each backup file records the schema version at the time it was created (e.g. `6.31.0`). When restoring to a different installation, the schema versions should match. If they differ, run `prisma migrate deploy` on the target installation first to bring the schema up to date, then restore.

The current schema version is **6.35.0** (adds `display_product_configs` and `display_global_settings` for the smart customer display advertising engine — MBM-232).

Tables added in schema 6.34.0 — As-You-Like-It Combos

Table	Contents	Scoped by
`as_you_like_it_combos`	Combo definitions (name, max weight, max items)	`businessId`
`as_you_like_it_combo_sizes`	Size tiers per combo (small / medium / large base prices + meat threshold)	`comboId`

Table	Contents	Scoped by
`as_you_like_it_pool_items`	Shared pool of food items with per-size kg prices and buying cost	`businessId`
`as_you_like_it_combo_items`	Which pool items belong to each combo	`comboId` + `poolItemId`
`ayli_pricing_calibrations`	Saved pricing calibration runs (simulation lines, generated options, applied state)	`comboId` + `businessId`

Verification after restore:

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM as_you_like_it_combos;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM as_you_like_it_combo_sizes;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM as_you_like_it_pool_items;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM as_you_like_it_combo_items;
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM ayli_pricing_calibrations;
```

All four counts should match the source system.

Backup Best Practices

Practice	Reason
Run a full backup before every migration or major update	Migrations alter schema — always have a pre-migration snapshot
Store backups off-site (cloud or external drive)	A server failure would destroy on-disk backups
Validate before restoring	Saves time — catch mismatches before the restore runs
Keep at least two backups: yesterday and last week	Provides a recovery window if an issue is discovered late
Exclude demo data from production backups	Keeps files smaller and avoids polluting production with test data
Test a restore on a staging environment periodically	Ensures the restore process actually works before you need it in an emergency

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53. Scale Integration — Star Micronics MG-S8200

The system supports a **Star Micronics MG-S8200 RS-232 weighing scale** for two workflows:

1. **Selling by weight** — products priced per kg (e.g. deli meat, loose spices). The scale reading is captured at the POS and the item price is calculated automatically.

2. **Livestock purchase** — buying live animals from a vendor. Each animal category is weighed in turn, the total is calculated, and an expense payment voucher is printed at the end.

> **Two ways to connect the scale.** The steps below cover the original setup — the scale is physically attached to the same PC running the desktop (Electron) app. If the scale is attached to a *different* workstation than wherever the app server runs, see **"Remote Workstation Scale"** further down instead — the scale panel, tap-to-weigh cards, and everything else on this page work identically either way once connected.

Connecting the Scale

The scale connects via a standard RS-232 serial cable. On a modern PC use a USB-to-RS-232 adapter. The MG-S8200 default settings are **9600 baud, 8N1**.

Steps to configure:

1. Plug the scale into the PC and note the COM port assigned (e.g. `COM3`). Windows Device Manager → Ports will show it.
2. Open the POS for your business (Restaurant or Grocery).
3. Click ⚙️ **POS Settings** (top-right of the POS page).
4. Click the ⚖️ **Scale & Weighing** tab.
5. In the **Scale Hardware — MG-S8200** section, click ↺ to refresh the port list, then select the correct COM port from the dropdown.
6. Click **Connect**. The status indicator turns green and a live weight reading appears below.
7. Place an empty container on the scale and click **Tare** to zero it before weighing.

The selected COM port is saved locally on this PC only — it is not synced to the server. Repeat this step on every computer that has a scale attached.

Status indicator:

Colour	Meaning
Green dot	Scale connected and streaming
Grey dot	Disconnected
Red dot	Error — check cable and COM port

The scale service auto-reconnects every 5 seconds if the cable is briefly disconnected.

Remote Workstation Scale (MBM-275)

Use this instead of the steps above when the scale is attached to a workstation that is **not** the same machine as the application server — for example, the server has moved to a central/cloud location, but the scale still needs to stay at the branch.

1. A **local agent** must already be downloaded and running on the workstation with the scale attached — see **"Remote Sites — R710 via Local Agent"** in Section 13 for the download/install steps (it's the same agent program used for R710; you do not need R710 to use it for a scale).

2. From that same workstation, open **Settings** → **POS Settings** → ⚖️ **Scale & Weighing** and follow the **Workstation Agents** link (or go to `/admin/workstation-agents`), then **Pair this machine**.
3. Under **MG-S8200 Scale Setup**, pick the workstation you just paired, click **List Ports** to see its available COM ports, select the correct one, and click **Detect Baud** if you don't already know the scale's baud rate.
4. Click **Save Scale Configuration**. The scale connects automatically from then on — including every time this business is opened in a browser on any machine, not just the one with the scale attached, since the connection is now relayed through the paired workstation.
5. A **Test Scale** panel appears right below the saved configuration on this same Workstation Agents page (MBM-277) — no need to open the POS just to check it worked. It shows a live weight reading and unit, stability/overload/error flags, connection status, when the reading last updated, and a **Tare** button, all scoped to whichever business you have this page open for. Every test read or tare shows up in that workstation's **Recent Activity** log just like a real POS reading would.

Everything documented above and below on this page — the scale status panel, tap-to-weigh cards, AYLI weight-based combos (Section 54) — works identically once connected this way. The only difference from the desktop-app path is *how* the connection reaches the physical scale.

Checking status: the paired workstation's tray icon shows a live **Scale** status line (Connected on COMx / Not connected / Error) — see Section 13's tray reference. If the scale shows unavailable anywhere in the app, check that workstation's tray icon first.

Scale Status Panel — Live Weight Display

Both the **Grocery POS** and the **Restaurant POS** have a built-in scale status panel accessible directly from the POS toolbar — no need to open POS Settings just to check the weight or tare.

Showing the panel:

Click the ⚖️ **Scale** button in the top bar of the Grocery or Restaurant POS. Click it again to hide the panel. Your preference is remembered per business.

What the panel shows:

Element	Description
Dot (green / red)	Scale connected or disconnected
Connected / Disconnected label	Confirms hardware status at a glance
Weight reading	Live weight in kg to 3 decimal places (e.g. `1.350 kg`)
Tare (Zero Scale) button	Zeros the scale — remove all items first, then press Tare
Tap to Weigh & Sell cards	Clickable product cards for every sell-by-weight item — tap one to open the Weigh Item modal directly from the scale panel
⚙️ **Configure pricing rules** →	Link to the Scale & Weighing settings tab

Tap to Weigh & Sell cards: Each sell-by-weight product configured for this business appears as a clickable card showing the product name, price per kg, and (for users with financial access) sold count, revenue, and a performance bar. Cards are sorted identically to the main menu grid — items sold today appear first by first-sale time. Tap any card to open the **Weigh Item** modal — place the item on the scale, wait for the 2-second stable hold (● **CONFIRMED — READY**), and tap **Add to Cart**. After confirming, the scale automatically tares so it is ready for the next item. If the panel is re-opened after navigating away, the product list refreshes automatically.

Grocery POS: The panel is visible in both **Scan Mode** and **Desk Mode** — use it whenever the scale is in use regardless of which mode you are in.

Restaurant POS: The panel sits alongside the Live POS / Manual Entry / Meal Program mode selector in the top area of the POS. When the scale panel is open, the **Today's Sales** summary is hidden to reduce distraction while weighing.

> This panel is for monitoring weight and selling weight-based items. To connect the scale or change the COM port, go to ⚙ **POS Settings** → ⚖ **Scale & Weighing**.
>
> **Tip:** If the product cards do not appear after navigating away and returning, click the ⚖ Scale button to close and re-open the panel — it reloads the product list automatically on open.

Scale Integration Toggle (Enable / Disable)

Owners and managers can switch the scale integration on or off business-wide. When disabled the ⚖ **Scale & Weighing** tab is hidden from all staff and the ⚖ **Scale** button is removed from the POS toolbar — the hardware is completely hidden from cashiers.

Where: POS Settings → ⚖ Scale & Weighing → **Scale Integration** toggle (top of the tab)

State	Effect
Enabled (default)	Scale tab visible to users with `canAccessScaleSettings`; Scale button visible in POS
Disabled	Scale tab hidden from all non-admin users; Scale button removed from POS toolbar

> **Re-enabling:** Admins and owners still see the tab even when disabled (with a notice). Toggle it back on to restore access for all staff.

Permission required to toggle: `canAccessScaleSettings`

POS Settings — Scale & Weighing Tab

POS Settings has been reorganised into two tabs:

Tab	Contents
🖨 **Printing & Performance**	Receipt printer preferences, sales performance thresholds
⚖ **Scale & Weighing**	Scale hardware connection, selling presets, vendor purchase presets

Open POS Settings from the ⚙️ **POS Settings** button (top-right of the POS page), then click ⚖️ **Scale & Weighing**.

Permission required: `canAccessScaleSettings` (Restaurant and Grocery only).

> **Vendor pricing sub-sections** (Selling Presets and Vendor Purchase Presets) within this tab require the separate `canAccessVendorPricing` permission. A user with `canAccessScaleSettings` but not `canAccessVendorPricing` can configure the hardware connection but cannot view or edit pricing rules.

Selling Presets — Setup

Selling presets are the prices you charge customers per kilogram. They are separate from vendor purchase presets and are what the POS uses when a cashier weighs an item for a customer.

Where: POS Settings → ⚖️ Scale & Weighing → 🛒 **Selling Presets**

Adding a preset:

1. Click **+ Add selling preset**.
2. Type the **Preset name** (e.g. *Beef Mince*). The Icon field auto-suggests an emoji as you type — it updates after a short pause.
3. To change the auto-suggested icon, **click the emoji button** to expand the full searchable picker. Type a keyword or paste any emoji to override.
4. Enter the **Price / kg**.
5. Click **Add Preset**.

The preset appears in the list with:

- An **Active** toggle — disable without deleting
- A **"X items"** badge showing how many inventory products are currently linked
- The emoji is editable inline — click any row's emoji to open the picker and change it

Dynamic pricing: Updating a preset's price instantly affects every inventory item linked to it — no product re-save needed.

Linking a Preset to a POS Menu Item

A selling preset only does something at the POS when it is linked to an inventory product. Here is the full setup workflow:

Restaurant — creating a weight-priced menu item:

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **Inventory**.
2. Click **Add Item** (or find an existing item and click **Edit**).
3. Fill in the **product name** (e.g. *Grilled Chicken*, *Beef Mince*) and select a category.
4. In the **amber "Sell by Weight" bar** above the form, tick **Sell by Weight (kg)**.
5. In the **"Use preset"** dropdown, select the selling preset (e.g. 🍗 *Grilled Chicken — $7.50/kg*).

    - The bar shows **"Effective price: $7.50/kg (follows preset)"** — the price is always live from the preset.
6. Click **Save**.

Grocery — same steps at Grocery → Inventory.

What happens at the POS after linking:

- The product appears as a normal card in the POS product grid.
- The price on the card shows **$X.XX/kg** (the preset price per kilogram) — not a fixed unit price — so cashiers always know the rate before weighing.
- A small ⚖️ **badge** in the corner confirms it is weight-priced.
- Tapping the card opens the **Weigh Item** modal directly — no quantity prompt, just place on scale, lock weight, confirm.
- The total is calculated as `weight (kg) × preset price` and added to the cart as `Product Name (X.XXX kg)`.

> **$/kg display applies in both modes:** Desk Mode and Scan Mode in Grocery POS, and the standard Live POS grid in Restaurant POS.

Multiple products, one preset: You can link many products to the same preset (e.g. *Prime Beef*, *Beef Offcuts*, and *Minced Beef* all linked to 🥩 *Beef Mince — $8.50/kg*). Change the preset price once — all three update instantly.

No preset yet? If you open Inventory before creating a preset, the amber bar shows a link **"⚙️ Configure selling presets →"** — click it, create the preset, then come back to finish linking.

Vendor Purchase Presets — Setup

Vendor purchase presets are the prices you pay suppliers per kilogram. They are used in the livestock purchase workflow and for cost tracking in AYLI combo pricing.

Where: POS Settings → ⚖️ Scale & Weighing → 🚚 **Vendor Purchase Presets**

Two sub-tabs: 🐃 **Livestock** and 🥦 **Goods** — choose based on what you are buying.

Adding a preset:

1. Select the correct sub-tab (Livestock or Goods).
2. Click **+ Add livestock / goods purchase preset** — opens the **Add Purchase Preset modal**.
3. Type the **Category name** (e.g. *Whole Chicken*, *Offals*). A suggestion dropdown appears as you type; selecting a suggestion also fills in the matching Icon automatically.
4. To override the icon, type or paste an emoji in the Icon field, or click 🔍 **Browse more emojis** in the dropdown to open the searchable picker.
5. Enter the **Price / kg**.
6. For Livestock, click 🧮 **Calculate $/kg from unit price** to derive the rate from a sample weighing (count × price/unit ÷ total weight).

Editing an existing preset:

Each preset row has an **Edit** button. Clicking it opens the row for inline editing:

- **Category name** — editable with live suggestion dropdown (same search as the add form). Selecting a suggestion updates the icon automatically.
- **Price / kg** — editable number field.
- **Icon** — click the emoji button to open the picker. While in edit mode the icon change is held in memory and saved only when you click **Save**.

Click **Save** to apply all three changes in one API call. Click **Cancel** to discard.

Setting purchase price from a Pool Item card:

If a pool item has no cost price set, its card shows a **"Set purchase price"** link. Clicking it opens the Add Purchase Preset modal pre-loaded with the item's name and emoji — the suggestion search runs immediately on open. After saving, the vendor preset is created and the pool item's buying price is updated in the same action so the card immediately reflects the cost. 7. Click **Save Preset**.

Rules matched by category name in the livestock purchase wizard. If no match exists, the cashier can enter a custom price manually during the session.

Marking a Product as Sold by Weight

Any **restaurant** or **grocery** inventory item can be flagged as "sold by weight". When a customer buys that item at the POS the cashier is prompted to place it on the scale — the total price is calculated automatically.

Steps (same for both Restaurant and Grocery Inventory):

1. Go to **Grocery** → **Inventory** (or **Restaurant** → **Inventory**).
2. Find the product and click **Edit**.
3. In the **amber weight bar** at the top of the form, tick **Sell by Weight (kg)**.
4. Choose how to set the price:

   Option A — Use a preset (recommended):

   - Select a selling preset from the **"Use preset"** dropdown (e.g. 🥩 *Beef Mince — $8.50/kg*).
   - The bar shows **"Effective price: $8.50/kg (follows preset)"** — the price is dynamic. If you update the preset later, all linked products automatically reflect the new price without any re-save.

   Option B — Enter a manual price:

   - Leave the dropdown at "*None — enter price manually*".
   - Type the **Price per kg** in the field that appears.
   - This price is fixed at save time — it does not follow any preset.

5. Optionally select a **vendor purchase preset** in the 🚚 **Cost per kg** dropdown — this records what you pay the supplier per kg and is used in the pricing calculator for margin analysis. When you re-open the product for editing, the saved preset is pre-selected automatically.

6. Click **Save** (or **Update Item** when editing).

Automatic emoji: When a selling preset is linked, its emoji is automatically prepended to the product name on save (e.g. *Beef Manyama* → 🥩 *Beef Manyama*). If the name already starts with an emoji, it is not duplicated.

Once flagged, tapping the product card at the POS opens the **Weigh Item** modal instead of adding directly to the cart. Product cards for weight-priced items show:

- The price as **$X.XX/kg** (preset rate) instead of a fixed unit price
- A small ⚖️ badge in the corner so cashiers can identify them at a glance
- Performance stats (sold count, revenue, progress bar) for users with financial access — sorted by first-sold-today order so popular items stay at the top

> **No presets yet?** A link **"⚙️ Configure selling presets →"** appears in the amber bar. Click it to go directly to POS Settings and create your first preset, then come back to link it.

> **Changing preset vs unlinking:** Unchecking "Sell by Weight" clears the preset link and the price — the product reverts to normal fixed-price selling.

> **Sell by Weight saved on create:** When you create a new product with Sell by Weight ticked, the flag is saved immediately. Re-opening the product for editing will show the checkbox correctly checked — no need to re-tick it.

Selling by Weight at the POS — Grocery

In the Grocery POS, tapping a product card that is marked *Sell by Weight* opens the **Weigh Item** modal automatically — in both Scan Mode and Desk Mode.

Two ways to open the modal:

- **Scale panel** — click ⚖️ **Scale** in the toolbar to show the **Tap to Weigh & Sell** cards. Tap any card to open the modal instantly.
- **Product grid** — weight-priced products appear with an ⚖️ badge and **$X.XX/kg** price. Tap the card — the modal opens instead of adding to cart.
- **Sell this Item** — clicking **Sell this Item** from the inventory edit form navigates to the POS and opens the weigh modal automatically.

Workflow:

1. Place the item on the scale (tare the container first if needed — use the **Tare (Zero Scale)** button).
2. The modal shows the **live scale reading** and a stability status:
   - **Amber border / ○ HOLDING… Xs** — the scale just became stable. A 2-second hold timer counts down.
   - **Green border / ● CONFIRMED — READY** — the reading has held stable for 2 seconds. **Add to Cart** is now enabled.
   - **Amber border / ○ READING…** — the scale is still settling; wait.
3. The weight is **always live and never locks.** If an employee adds more food during the hold countdown, the scale goes unstable, the timer resets, and **Add to Cart** disables again — the full 2-second hold must complete at the new weight before confirming.

4. Click **Tare (Zero Scale)** to zero the scale at any point.
5. Click **Add to Cart** once the green **CONFIRMED — READY** state is reached.

After confirming, the scale **automatically tares** so it is ready for the next item.

Cart display for weight items:

- Name shows `Beef Manyama` (weight removed from display name)
- Subtitle shows `GRC-00002 · $13.00/kg` (actual $/kg rate)
- Middle column shows `0.367 kg` (actual weight weighed)
- No +/− quantity buttons — weight items are fixed; only the × remove button appears

Customer display: shows `0.367 kg @ $13.00/kg` so the customer can verify both the weight and the rate.

Receipt: prints the item name, total price, and a sub-line `0.367 kg @ $13.00/kg` so the customer has a complete record.

Selling the same product twice at different weights: tap the product card again. Each weigh produces a separate cart line billed independently.

Control	Action
Tare (Zero Scale)	Zeros the scale — remove all items first, tare, then place items back
Add to Cart	Enabled only after 2 continuous seconds of stable reading
Cancel	Closes the modal without adding anything to the cart

> **No scale connected?** The modal shows "Scale not connected" and Add to Cart is disabled. Go to ⚙ **POS Settings** → **Scale** to connect the hardware first.

Selling by Weight at the POS — Restaurant

The Restaurant POS has two ways to sell a weight-priced item:

Option A — From the scale panel (recommended): Click the ⚖ **Scale** toggle in the top bar to open the scale panel. The **Tap to Weigh & Sell** section shows a card for every sell-by-weight product, sorted by first-sold-today order (same as the main menu grid). Tap the card — the Weigh Item modal opens immediately.

Option B — From the main product grid: Sell-by-weight products appear in the standard POS grid with a ⚖ badge and show their price as **$X.XX/kg**. Tap the card — the Weigh Item modal opens instead of adding directly to the cart.

Option C — Sell this Item from Inventory: Clicking **Sell this Item** on a sell-by-weight product in the inventory edit form navigates to the Restaurant POS and opens the weigh modal automatically.

Workflow: identical to Grocery — place item on scale, wait for the 2-second hold countdown (○ **HOLDING… Xs**), then tap **Add to Cart** once ● **CONFIRMED — READY** shows. Any food added during the countdown resets the timer. After confirming, the scale auto-tares for the next item.

Performance cards in the scale panel show the same stats as the main menu grid (sold count, revenue, progress bar) — gated by the same financial permissions (`canAccessFinancialData` or

`canViewPOSSoldCount`). Cards are sorted: items sold today come first (by first-sale time), unsold items alphabetically below.

> **No scale connected?** The modal shows "Scale not connected" and Add to Cart is disabled. Go to ⚙ **POS Settings** → **Scale** to connect. For the livestock purchase vendor workflow a manual weight entry field appears automatically when the scale is offline — see Scale Offline — Manual Weight Entry.

Livestock Purchase Workflow

Use this when a vendor brings live animals to the premises and you need to weigh and pay for each category (whole chickens, offals, feet, etc.). The system records each weigh-in, submits an expense payment request for the total, and prints a vendor payment voucher.

Prerequisites:

- Scale connected (see Connecting the Scale)
- Vendor registered as a **Supplier** for this business (Suppliers page → Add Supplier)
- PURCHASE pricing rules configured (optional but recommended)

Opening the page:

- Restaurant: **Restaurant** → **Livestock Purchase**
- Grocery: **Grocery** → **Livestock Purchase**

Step 1 — Select Vendor & Start Session

1. Click **Start New Purchase**.
2. Select the vendor from the dropdown.
3. Click **Start Session**. The weighing screen opens.

Step 2 — Weigh Each Category

For each category of animals (e.g. whole chickens first, then offals):

1. Place the animals on the scale and wait for **STABLE** — the weight auto-locks.

   > **Scale offline?** If the scale is not connected, a **"Scale offline — enter weight manually (kg)"** input field appears below the weight display. Type the weight you read from the physical scale and the workflow continues as normal. The weight box shows the value in purple with a **MANUAL** badge so it is clear the reading was entered by hand. See Scale Offline — Manual Weight Entry below.

2. Select the **Category** from the dropdown. The matching purchase price per kg fills in automatically.
   - Choose *Other (custom)* to type a category name and enter the price manually.
3. Adjust the price if needed.
4. Add optional notes.
5. Click **+ Add Line**. The line appears in the table and the running total updates. The manual weight field clears automatically so you are ready for the next item.

6. Click **Re-weigh** to unlock for the next group of animals.

Repeat for every category. To remove a mistaken line, click the × on that row.

Step 3 — Submit & Print Voucher

1. When all categories are entered, click **Submit & Print Voucher**.
2. The system:
   - Creates an **Expense Account Payment** (SUBMITTED) for the full total, payee = selected vendor, charged to the default business expense account.
   - Marks the session SUBMITTED.
   - Opens the **Receipt Preview** modal.
3. Select a printer and click **Print**.

The printed voucher shows: business name, date, vendor name, each line (category / kg / $/kg / total), and the grand total. Hand it to the vendor — the cashier completes the cash payment through the normal expense approval process.

Cancelling a session: Click **Cancel** (bottom-left of the wizard). No expense payment is created and the session is marked CANCELLED.

Scale Offline — Manual Weight Entry

If the scale cable is unplugged, the COM port is unavailable, or the integration is not working, you do not need to abandon the session. The livestock purchase wizard detects the disconnection automatically and shows a manual fallback:

What you see	What it means
Grey dot · *Scale not connected*	The scale driver has lost the connection
"Scale offline — enter weight manually (kg)" field	Type the kg value you can read on the physical scale display
Weight box with purple **MANUAL** badge	The entered weight is in use — proceed normally

Using the manual field:

1. Read the weight from the physical scale display.
2. Type the value into the **Enter weight manually** field (e.g. `2.450`).
3. The weight box updates immediately — the total preview appears as normal.
4. Select a category, set the price, and click **+ Add Line**.
5. The manual weight field clears after each line so you can type the next weight.

> **When the scale reconnects** the manual field disappears and live weight reading resumes automatically. Any value you had typed is discarded to prevent it overriding a real scale reading.

> **Audit note:** Lines added with a manual weight are indistinguishable from lines added via the scale in the submitted session data. Accuracy is the responsibility of the person reading the physical display.

Livestock Purchase — Column Reference

Column	Description
Category	Animal type (e.g. Whole Chicken, Offals)
kg	Weight captured from scale
$/kg	Price per kilogram at time of weighing
Total	kg × $/kg, calculated automatically

Permissions

Action	Required permission
Enable / disable scale integration toggle	`canAccessScaleSettings`
Access the Scale & Weighing tab in POS Settings	`canAccessScaleSettings`
View / edit Selling Presets and Vendor Purchase Presets	`canAccessVendorPricing`
Mark product as sold by weight	`canManageInventory`
Sell by weight at POS	Standard cashier access
Start / submit / cancel livestock purchase	Standard cashier access

> Default grants: **Owner** and **Manager** receive both `canAccessScaleSettings` and `canAccessVendorPricing` by default. Employees, associates, and salespersons do not. Grant individually via the user permissions panel if needed.

For technical support, contact your system administrator.

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54. As-You-Like-It (AYLI) Weight-Based Combo — Restaurant

> **Who reads this:** Restaurant managers configuring combos in the back office, and cashiers selling AYLI combos at the POS.

Concept

An **As-You-Like-It Combo** lets a customer fill a single pre-marked container with a mix of food items, sold by weight. The customer picks what goes in, the scale measures each ingredient, and the POS calculates the price as items are added.

Key principles:

- One container = one cart line (the **combo parent**), with child lines for each ingredient.

- The **size** (Small / Medium / Large) is chosen first and determines the flat **base price** and the **per-kg rates** for every ingredient.
- **Size is locked** once the first ingredient is captured — it cannot be changed mid-fill.
- Maximum **8 kg** total net weight and **7 distinct ingredients** per combo.

Back-Office Configuration

AYLI combos are configured in two parts: **Pool Items** (the shared ingredient library) and **Combo Definitions** (the combo itself with its sizes).

Where: Restaurant → AYLI Combos (sidebar)

Pool Items — Setting Up Ingredients

Pool Items are the ingredients that can appear in any AYLI combo. Each pool item carries its own per-kg pricing at three size tiers.

To add a pool item:

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **AYLI Combos** → **Pool Items**.
2. Click **+ Add Pool Item**.
3. Fill in:

Field	Description
Name	Ingredient name shown on the receipt and POS (e.g. *Chicken*, *Beef*, *Veggies*)
Emoji	Icon shown on the cashier and customer display
Price/kg — Small	Per-kg rate when the customer chooses a Small combo
Price/kg — Medium	Per-kg rate for a Medium combo
Price/kg — Large	Per-kg rate for a Large combo

Size-based pricing example:

Ingredient	Small $/kg	Medium $/kg	Large $/kg
Chicken	$10.00	$9.50	$9.00
Beef	$12.00	$11.50	$11.00
Veggies	$8.00	$7.50	$7.00

> Larger combos can offer a slight per-kg discount to reward bigger purchases.

4. Click **Save**.

Combo Definition

To create an AYLI combo:

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **AYLI Combos** → **Combos**.
2. Click **+ New Combo**.
3. Fill in:

Field	Description
Combo name	Shown on the POS card and receipt (e.g. *Build-Your-Own Bowl*, *Mama's Choice*)
Max weight (kg)	Hard cap on total net weight — default 8 kg
Max distinct items	Cap on different ingredients — default 7
Sizes	Add Small, Medium, Large with a fixed **base price** each
Allowed items	Select which pool items can go in this combo

Example size configuration:

Size	Base price
Small	$1.00
Medium	$1.50
Large	$2.00

4. Click **Create AYLI Combo** (or **Save Changes** when editing an existing combo).

The combo appears as an AYLI card (green badge ⚖️ AYLI) in the restaurant POS menu grid and on the Scale Tab.

> **Important — pool items are required for display:** An AYLI combo with no pool items configured will not appear on the customer display. Always add at least one pool item before assigning a menu number.

> **Warning — menu number assignment:** When you assign or change a menu number from the **Menu Numbers** page, only the number is updated. The combo's pool items and sizes are never touched. Editing the combo directly from the AYLI Combos page and clicking **Save Changes** is the only action that modifies pool items.

Cloning an Existing Combo

Use **Clone** when you want to create a new combo that shares the same ingredients and pricing model as an existing one — for example, a "Chicken Deluxe" variant that uses the same pool items and per-kg rates as "Chicken Standard" but needs its own photos and menu number.

What gets cloned:

- All selected pool items
- Size base prices (Small / Medium / Large)
- Per-kg pricing rates for every item

- Calibration data (so the pricing history carries over and the wizard can be loaded from history)

What does NOT get cloned:

- Images / advertising photos (set these up separately in Display Settings)
- Menu number (assign separately in Menu Numbers)
- The combo name (you must enter a new one)

Steps:

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **AYLI Combos**.
2. Find the combo you want to copy and click **Clone** (next to Edit).
3. The form opens pre-filled with the source combo's data. The name defaults to `Clone of [original name]` — change it to the new combo's name.
4. Adjust pool items or base prices if needed, then click **Create AYLI Combo**.
5. The system copies the pricing automatically:
    - If the source had a calibration: a new calibration record is created for the clone and the exact same per-kg rates are applied immediately.
    - If no calibration existed: prices are copied directly via the override API.
6. A toast confirms: `"[New Name]" cloned from "[Source Name]" — pricing copied`.
7. To make minor pricing adjustments, go to **AYLI Pricing** → **select the new combo** → **3. Adjust** and apply a blanket percentage change or edit individual cells.

POS Workflow — Step by Step

Step 1 — Open the Combo

1. Tap the AYLI combo card (e.g. *Mama's Choice*) in the POS menu or Scale Tab.
2. The **AYLI Combo modal** opens full-screen, blocking other POS actions until complete.

Step 2 — Place the Container

3. The modal shows **"Step 1 of 3 — Place container"**.
4. Place the **empty combo container** on the scale.
5. Once the scale reads a stable weight it automatically **tares** (zeroes) after 2 seconds — the container weight is removed from all subsequent readings.
6. Tap **Skip (no container)** to tare immediately without a container.

Step 3 — Select Size

7. The modal advances to **"Step 2 of 3 — Select size"**.
8. Tap **Small**, **Medium**, or **Large**.
9. The base price locks in. Size **cannot be changed** after the next step.

Step 4 — Fill the Container

10. The modal shows **"Step 3 of 3 — Fill"** with the scale reading, capacity bars (weight and item count), and the ingredient grid.

11. For each ingredient:
    - Tap the ingredient card (e.g. *Chicken*). Cards already added show a **green border** and a weight badge.
    - Have the customer add that ingredient to the container.
    - After **2 seconds stable**, the scale readout shows the pending details below the weight:
        - `+0.133 kg → Beef dishes (+$0.83)` — the weight being added and its cost at the current rate.
        - `New total: $1.89 · +$0.11 to reach $2.00` — what the combo total will be after capture and the remaining cash rounding gap (shown only when cash rounding is configured).
    - The capture button turns green: ✓ **Capture +0.133 kg of Beef dishes**.
    - Tap the capture button. A child line appears in the **Contents** list: 🍗 `Beef dishes 0.133 kg × $6.21/kg $0.83`.
12. Repeat for each additional ingredient.
13. The **weight bar** and **items bar** show capacity used. Exceeding 8 kg or 7 items is blocked with a warning.

Removing from a Previously Captured Ingredient

If you have already captured a portion and the customer wants less of a particular ingredient, you can remove weight without restarting the combo:

1. **Physically remove some food** from the container (e.g. take back some beef). The scale weight drops.
2. **Tap the ingredient card** you are removing from (e.g. *Beef dishes*). You do not need to tell the system you are removing — the negative weight change is detected automatically.
3. The scale readout switches to **red removal mode**:
    - Counter shows **"Removing... 2s"** while holding the reduced weight.
    - Delta line shows `- 0.032 kg → Beef dishes (-$0.20)` in red.
    - Info line shows the new total after removal and the updated rounding gap.
4. After 2 seconds stable, the button turns red: ✕ **Remove 0.032 kg from Beef dishes**.
5. Tap it. The ingredient's line in **Contents** updates immediately.

Removal rules:

- You cannot remove more weight than was captured for that ingredient. If you try, the line shows `Only X.XXX kg of [item] captured — reduce less` and the button stays disabled.
- If the removal brings an ingredient to zero, its line is removed from Contents entirely.
- If the removed ingredient was the first meat item and its line is cleared, the meat threshold resets.

Cash Rounding Preview and Decision (bottom of totals)

While filling the combo, the totals section shows a live rounding preview beneath **Combo Total** (only when cash rounding is enabled for the business):

```
Combo Total          $1.89
🪙 Cash rounding (+$0.11)   $2.00   ↓ $1.50 (-$0.39)
```

This tells you at a glance: to round up you need $0.11 more; to round down the customer saves $0.39. Use the pending cost readout on the scale to decide whether to add or remove a small amount of food to get closer to a boundary before tapping Capture.

> If the round-down discount shown in the preview exceeds the configured **Max Round-Down Discount** (default $0.10), the ↓ round-down button will not appear in the footer — only round up and Keep will be available. In that case, add a small amount of food to close the gap, or proceed with round up or Keep.

Step 5 — Choose Rounding, Then Add to Cart

Once at least one ingredient has been captured, the footer shows the rounding options and the add-to-cart button. **This is where you finalise the price — make the rounding decision here, before the item enters the cart.**

```
[ ↑ $2.00 (+$0.11) ]  [ ↓ $1.50 (−$0.39) ]  [ Keep $1.89 ]  [ Cancel ]
```

14. Choose one of the available actions:

Choice	Effect on cart
↑ **$2.00 (+$0.11)** (green)	Combo enters the cart at **$2.00**. The $0.11 is distributed across ingredient line prices proportionally. The receipt shows the adjusted prices.
↓ **$1.50 (−$0.39)** (orange)	Combo enters the cart at its exact price **$1.89**. A separate **Promotional Discount (CR) −$0.39** line is added immediately below it in the cart. The customer's receipt shows both lines — the exact combo price and the courtesy discount. **Only appears when the discount (here $0.39) does not exceed the configured Max Round-Down Discount.**
Keep $1.89 (grey)	Combo enters the cart at its exact calculated price with no adjustment. The payment screen will not offer rounding when an AYLI combo is present — the total charged is exactly as shown.
Cancel	Discards the combo entirely and returns to the POS.

15. After tapping a rounding option or **Keep**, the combo (and discount line if applicable) is added to the cart.
16. The receipt prints a full breakdown: size tier, base price, each ingredient with weight and per-kg rate, the combo total, and the discount line if round-down was chosen.

Price Calculation Reference

```
Combo total = Base price (for chosen size)
            + Σ (ingredient weight × ingredient price/kg for chosen size)
```

Example — Medium combo:

Base price		$1.50
Chicken	0.200 kg × $9.50/kg	$1.90
Beef	0.150 kg × $11.50/kg	$1.73
Veggies	0.150 kg × $7.50/kg	$1.13
Total		**$6.26**

Example — Large combo (same weights):

Base price		$2.00
Chicken	0.200 kg × $9.00/kg	$1.80
Beef	0.150 kg × $11.00/kg	$1.65
Veggies	0.150 kg × $7.00/kg	$1.05
Total		**$6.50**

The Large combo has a higher base but cheaper per-kg rates — a "buy more, save per kg" effect.

Rules & Constraints

Rule	Detail
Max weight	8 kg net (container tared out)
Max distinct ingredients	7 different items per combo
Size lock	Locked after first ingredient is captured
Same ingredient twice	Allowed — weight is added to the existing child line
Removing weight	Remove food from the container, tap the ingredient card — system detects the negative delta and shows a red Remove button. Cannot remove more than was captured for that ingredient.
Scale required	Capture button is disabled if scale is not connected
Tare	Container is auto-tared so container weight is excluded from the total
Round up	Rounding adjustment is distributed proportionally across ingredient prices; calibration data in the database is never modified
Round down	Ingredient prices remain unchanged; a separate "Promotional Discount (CR)" cart item (negative price) is injected below the combo and printed on the receipt

Rule	Detail
Round-down limit	The ↓ button is hidden when the round-down discount exceeds the configured Max Round-Down Discount (default $0.10). Only round up or Keep are offered in that case.
No rounding buttons without lines	Round-up/down buttons only appear once at least one ingredient has been captured
Rounding is final at AYLI modal	"Keep" exits the modal at the exact price. The payment screen does not show a rounding panel for AYLI orders — the decision is made in the modal, not at payment time.

AYLI on the Scale Tab

AYLI combo cards appear in the ⚖️ **Scale** panel (alongside regular sell-by-weight products). Tap a combo card from the Scale Tab to open the AYLI modal — identical workflow to tapping it in the main menu grid.

Customer Display — Live Weighing

As each ingredient is captured, the customer display updates in real time showing the in-progress combo with each captured ingredient, its weight, and line price. When the combo is confirmed the display shows the finalised line like any other cart item.

Receipt — AYLI Breakdown

The printed receipt and the on-screen preview both show a full ingredient breakdown for each AYLI combo. The combo appears as a single item with its total on the right, followed by indented breakdown lines that are informational only (not counted again in the totals):

```
Lunch Special (Small)              $4.04
  [SMALL] Base: $2.00
    Beef dishes
      0.072kg x $9.50/kg = $0.68
    Family chicken meal
      0.091kg x $4.50/kg = $0.41
    Bean soups
      0.236kg x $4.00/kg = $0.94
```

The breakdown shows the size tier, base price, and for each ingredient: name on one line, then weight × rate = line total on the next line, both indented to the left so they are clearly informational and do not interfere with the item totals column.

Permissions

Access to AYLI back-office management is controlled by fine-grained permissions. All three actions (create, delete, disable) are separately grantable:

Action	Required permission	Default
View the AYLI Combos page (read-only)	Any authenticated member	All roles
Create or edit pool items	`canCreateAYLIPoolItems`	Owner, Manager
Delete (remove) pool items	`canDeleteAYLIPoolItems`	Owner, Manager
Enable / Disable pool items	`canDisableAYLIPoolItems`	Owner, Manager, Restaurant-associate, Grocery-associate, Salesperson
Create or edit combos	`canCreateAYLICombos`	Owner, Manager
Delete combos	`canDeleteAYLICombos`	Owner, Manager
Enable / Disable combos	`canDisableAYLICombos`	Owner, Manager, Restaurant-associate, Grocery-associate, Salesperson

What this means in practice:

- **Cashiers / associates / salespersons** can enable or disable pool items and combos (e.g. to hide a sold-out ingredient during service) but cannot create new ones or permanently remove them.
- **Managers and owners** have full access to create, edit, and delete.
- Buttons are hidden in the UI when the user does not have the required permission — no error message, just a clean read-only view.
- Any permission can be granted or revoked individually per user via **Settings** → **User Permissions**.

> **API enforcement:** Permission checks are enforced server-side on every write endpoint — hiding buttons in the UI is not the only protection.

AYLI Pricing Calibration

The **2. Calibrate** tab on the AYLI Pricing page lets you mathematically derive per-kg selling prices for each ingredient so that any combination a customer builds hits a consistent target selling price for the small size.

Where: Restaurant → AYLI Pricing → select a combo → **2. Calibrate**

The wizard has three steps shown at the top: **[1. Set Price]** → **[2. Build on Scale]** → **[3. Review & Apply]**

Step 1 — Set Target Price

Before touching the scale, decide what you want to charge.

Field	Description
Target selling price (small)	What the customer pays for a full small container ($)

Field	Description
Medium multiplier	Capacity of medium relative to small (default 2×)
Large multiplier	Capacity of large relative to small (default 3×)

If you have run a previous calibration, these fields are pre-filled from the last applied run — adjust only if the price is changing.

Click **Next — Build on Scale** → when ready.

Step 2 — Build on Scale

Step 2 offers **two calibration methods**. Both produce the same result — per-kg rates derived from captured weights — but differ in how you capture them. Choose whichever is more convenient for your kitchen workflow.

Method A — Add items one by one (forward)

Click **Start Calibration Build**. If you have already built a capture in this session using this method, the button reads **Resume Calibration** and reopens the modal with all previously captured lines intact.

The modal is visually distinct — an **amber border and banner** ("⚙ CALIBRATION MODE") make it clear you are not in a normal sale.

Opening the modal:

1. Place the empty container on the scale. The scale auto-tares after 2 seconds of stability.
2. The modal skips the size picker and goes directly to the fill panel set to the **Small** size — calibration always builds the small reference portion.

Capturing weights: 3. Tap an ingredient card to select it, then add it to the container. Once the scale stabilises, the **Capture** button turns green — tap it to record that ingredient's weight. 4. Repeat for each ingredient you want to include in a typical small portion. 5. To remove weight already captured, select the ingredient, physically remove some from the container, and wait for the scale to stabilise — the button switches to red "✕ Remove". Tap it to reduce that item's captured weight by the difference.

Live pricing feedback while you build:

As soon as the first item is captured the system computes projected per-kg rates in real time. You can see these immediately:

- **Item cards** — each card's $/kg badge updates to show the computed rate for the active size tab. Cards with a pending removal show a red `−X.XXX kg` badge.
- **⚙ Captured Weights section** — lists every captured item with weight × rate = line price for the active size tab. A **S / M / L** tab switcher lets you see how rates and costs differ across sizes. Items whose computed line price falls below $0.10 show a **MIN $0.10** badge — the minimum charge per item — and their cost is reserved before distributing the remaining budget to other items.

- **Bottom totals** — always shows the target pricing for the active size tab: Base + Items = Combo Total. For S this is always exactly your target (e.g. $1.00 + $1.00 = **$2.00**). These are not the simulation-fill totals; they are the pricing targets the rates are set to hit.
- **Pricing target per size panel** — confirms the revenue target for all three sizes at a glance.

Size	Reference fill	Example target
Small	Simulation fill (e.g. 0.454 kg)	$1.00 base + $1.00 items = **$2.00**
Medium	Small × (minW_M / minW_S)	$1.50 base + $1.17 items = **$2.67**
Large	Small × (minW_L / minW_S)	$2.00 base + $1.33 items = **$3.33**

Target price override: A target field at the top of the scrollable area shows the original target from Step 1 (e.g. $2.00). Type an override value to experiment with a different price — all rates and projected totals recompute instantly.

When satisfied: 6. Click **Done — Review Pricing** →. The captured weights become the simulation lines and you advance to Step 3.

> **Tip:** Build a realistic full small portion. The simulation weights are the direct reference — at exactly these captured weights the customer pays the target price ($2.00 for S). More realistic proportions produce more accurate per-kg rates.

Method B — Remove from full container (reverse)

Click **Start Reverse Calibration**. This method is ideal when it is easier to fill the container first and remove items one at a time.

How it works — no tare needed:

The container sits on the scale throughout. The system measures only the *difference* between consecutive readings, so the container's own weight cancels out automatically and is never recorded.

System instruction	Your action	Scale	Weight captured
Confirm items, place full container	Fill with selected items, place on scale	0.802 kg	—
"Remove 🥩 Mazondo"	Take all Mazondo out	0.518 kg	0.284 kg
"Remove 🫘 Bean soups"	Take all soups out	0.386 kg	0.132 kg
"Remove 🥦 Vegetables"	Take all vegetables out	0.367 kg	0.019 kg
"Remove 🧅 Potatoes"	Take all potatoes out	0.348 kg	0.019 kg
(auto-advance to Review)	—	0.348 kg (ignored)	Σ = 0.454 kg

Step by step:

1 — Confirm items for this portion

The modal opens showing all items assigned to the combo, all ticked by default. This is the item confirmation screen.

- If the combo has a single fixed set of items (e.g. Mazondo + Bean soups + Potatoes + Vegetables), simply tap **Next → place X items on scale** without changing anything.
- If the combo offers multiple choices in the same category (e.g. three meat options but you are only calibrating for Mazondo), **untick** the items that will not be in this specific build. Only the ticked items will be included in the removal sequence.

> **Note:** If you see items here that should not belong to this combo at all, remove them from the combo definition first — go to **Restaurant → AYLI Combos → Edit [combo name]** and remove the unwanted pool items. The calibration modal reflects whatever is saved in the combo definition.

2 — Place the full container on the scale

Fill the container with exactly the items you ticked, then place it on the scale. Wait for the reading to stabilise (2 seconds) — the **Start removing items →** button enables automatically.

3 — Follow the removal instructions

The system shows one item at a time: **"Remove [emoji] [Item name] from the container"**

- **Meat items always appear first** — removing meat first sets the minimum meat weight for pricing.
- Physically remove all of that item from the container.
- When the scale stabilises, the green **✓ Captured X.XXX kg of [Item]** button appears.
- Tap once to confirm. The next instruction appears automatically.
- A running log at the bottom shows all items captured so far.

4 — Auto-advance

When the last item is confirmed the modal closes automatically and advances to Step 3 — no extra button tap needed. The remaining scale reading (empty container) is never recorded; only the deltas matter.

Rules:

- **You do not choose what to remove** — the system tells you. Just follow the instructions.
- **No manual weight entry** — the scale reading is the only source of truth.
- **Meat must come out first** — this weight becomes the new Small min meat threshold on Apply.
- If you remove the wrong item by mistake, tap **Start over** to return to the item confirmation screen and restart.

> **Tip:** Remove each item cleanly and completely. Residue left in the container reduces the delta and under-records the item's weight, skewing the per-kg rates.

Step 3 — Review & Apply

After the build, the system runs the pricing algorithm and shows a single **editable pricing table**:

Column	Description
Item	Each ingredient captured in the build, with weight
Small ($/kg)	Per-kg rate for this item in the small container
Medium ($/kg)	Per-kg rate for the medium container — lower than Small
Large ($/kg)	Per-kg rate for the large container — lowest of the three
Base price row	Flat charge per size, seeded from the combo's defined base prices (editable)
Total row	Target price at reference fill per size (amber "at min fill" label)

How rates are derived:

The simulation capture IS the small reference fill. Per-kg rates are set so that at the captured weights, `Σ(weight × rate) = items budget` exactly:

1. `itemsBudget[small] = targetPrice − base[small]` (e.g. $2.00 − $1.00 = **$1.00**)
2. The $1.00 is distributed across items proportionally by (weight × pool buying price). Items whose share falls below $0.10 are floored to $0.10, and their reserved cost is excluded before the remainder is distributed to other items — ensuring the items total stays exactly $1.00.
3. Each item's rate = its budget share ÷ its captured weight.

For medium and large, the reference fill is scaled from the simulation using the min-meat-weight ratio:

- `rev[size] = targetPrice × (minWeight[size] / minWeight[small])`
- `itemsBudget[size] = rev[size] − base[size]`
- Rates are proportionally lower than small, so larger sizes are priced more attractively per kg.

> **Example:** target $2, bases $1/$1.50/$2, captured 0.454 kg, min weights 0.15/0.20/0.25 kg.
>
> - Small rates: budget $1.00 ÷ 0.454 kg proportional → e.g. Mazondo ≈ $2.00/kg
> - Medium rates: ≈ 87.7% of small rates (budget scales by 0.15/0.20)
> - Large rates: ≈ 79.8% of small rates (budget scales by 0.15/0.25)

When min meat weights are not yet set on the combo, the system falls back to the size multipliers (2×, 3×) for the ratio.

Editing the table:

- Click any cell to change it. When you manually edit the **Small** column, Medium and Large auto-update as `Small ÷ multiplier` unless those cells have already been independently changed.
- Overridden cells show an **amber border** — click **Reset to Calculated** to revert all cells to the algorithm's values.
- The **Target price (small)** field above the table is also editable — changing it reseeds the entire table.

Advanced options:

- Expand **Advanced: Show all 5 options** to see five different base-price / per-kg splits generated by the built-in algorithm (ignores the combo's defined base prices). Each option produces the same total at the simulation weight. Selecting one reseeds the table from that option.

- Option 1 = zero base (pure per-kg), Option 5 = highest base (lowest per-kg).

Going back to adjust the capture: If after reviewing the pricing table you decide the weights need changing, click ← **Modify capture** (top of the review step). The calibration modal reopens with all previously captured lines already in place — the scale baseline is restored to the total captured weight so that physically removing food from the container immediately shows a negative delta on the item you select. Adjust the weights, then click **Done — Review Pricing** → again.

Click **Apply Pricing & Save** to:

1. Save the calibration record (simulation lines, target, all 5 generated options).
2. Write the table's current prices directly to each combo item and the combo's base prices.
3. **Automatically update the combo's min meat weights** — the first meat item's captured weight becomes the new Small min meat weight; Medium and Large are extrapolated using the existing ratio between sizes. This replaces whatever was set manually before and keeps the pricing reference in sync with the actual calibration build.
4. Mark the calibration APPLIED and switch to the Adjust tab.

Recalibrate from History

At the top of Step 1 (Set Target Price), the **Previous Calibrations** list shows up to 5 past runs. Click **Load & Review** on any row to jump straight to the Review table pre-loaded with that calibration's weights, target price, and pricing — without repeating the physical scale build. From there you can recalibrate with updated costs or adjust prices manually before applying.

Resetting AYLI Pricing

To go through the full wizard again from scratch (new weights, new target price):

1. Go to **AYLI Pricing** → **2. Calibrate**.
2. Change the **Target selling price** in Step 1 if needed (or keep it the same).
3. Click **Next** → **Build on Scale** → then **Start Calibration Build** to rebuild the portion on the scale with fresh weights.
4. Review and apply in Step 3.

Each run creates a **new calibration version** and immediately overwrites the live prices. The old calibration stays in history (up to 5 versions) and can be restored at any time via **Load & Review** (Step 1 history list) or the **Restore** button in the Adjust tab's Calibration History panel.

> **There is no "wipe to zero" button.** If you want to temporarily disable AYLI pricing, disable the combo from the AYLI Combos page instead.

Updating Pricing When a New Item Is Added

If you add a new pool item to a combo that already has an APPLIED calibration, the system automatically prompts you:

> *"[Item name] was added to [Combo]. Would you like to update pricing?"*

Click **Update Pricing** in the modal that appears:

1. Enter the typical portion weight for the new item (in kg).
2. The pricing table recalculates live showing updated rates for all items.
3. Edit any cells if needed, then click **Apply These Prices**.

The result is a new calibration record with the merged composition — the new item is priced, and the rest of the combo's rates adjust proportionally. Click **Skip for Now** to close without changing prices (the new item will have $0 rates until you run the wizard).

Calibration History & Restore

All calibration records (simulation lines, generated options, applied prices, target) are stored per combo and included in system backups. The **3. Adjust** tab's Calibration History panel shows previous versions with a **Restore** button — restoring a version re-applies its prices to the combo immediately.

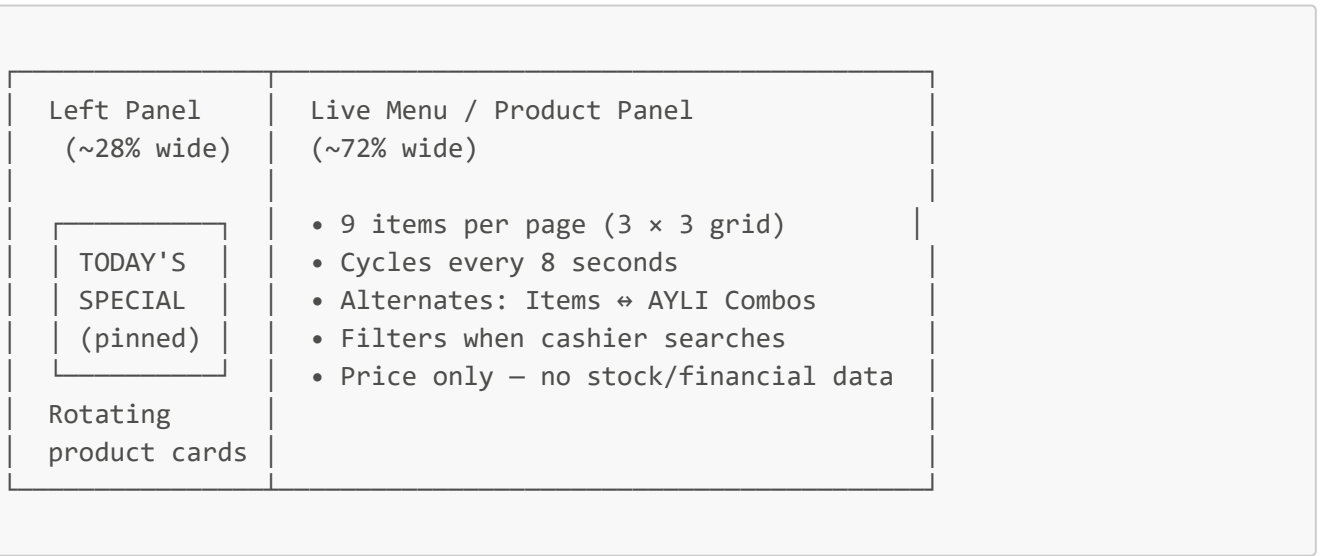
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55. Smart Customer Display — Dynamic Menu & Ads

> **Who reads this:** Restaurant, grocery, and clothing managers who want to understand or configure the customer-facing display screen.

Overview

When no sale is in progress, the customer display shows two panels side by side:



When a daily special is active, it is **always pinned at the top** of the left panel. Two rotating product cards fill the space below it. When no special is active, three rotating cards fill the full left panel.

When a sale is in progress (items in cart), the right panel switches to the live cart display. The left panel stays visible throughout.

Supported business types: Restaurant, Grocery, Clothing — each shows the items relevant to that business type.

What Each Business Type Shows

Business	Left panel (rotating ads)	Right panel (live grid)
Restaurant	Menu items + AYLI Combos sorted by sales	Menu items with sales history; alternates with AYLI Combos view
Grocery	Barcode inventory items + service products by sales	Same pool, paginated 9 per page
Clothing	Bale categories (sorted by new arrivals) + barcode inventory + quick-add products	Same pool, sorted by new arrivals then sales

---

Rotating Ads Panel

The left panel shows product cards sorted by display score:

```
Display score = (today's units × 3) + (yesterday × 2) + (day before × 1) +
(priority boost × 10)
```

- **Daily Special** (restaurant) — always pinned at the top of the left panel (not part of the rotation). Shows the product image, menu number, bullet list of what's included, add-on items with their images, special price with strikethrough original price, and savings amount. See Daily Special (Restaurant) for full details.
- **Featured** items sort to the top of the rotation
- **Hidden** items never appear (see Menu Availability to hide/show an item yourself)
- **Clothing** — categories with new bales added in the last 14 days score higher; items added in the last 14 days get +10 bonus
- Cards rotate every 6 seconds by default (configurable — see Global Display Settings)
- **How many cards show at once is configurable** (default 2) — fewer cards means each one, and its image, is bigger. Set via the "Rotating cards (left panel)" slider.
- All visible cards are **equal height** — layout is a CSS grid so no card can grow taller than its neighbours regardless of image size
- The item name shows on up to 2 lines before truncating, and any emoji prefix in the product's name (e.g. staff typing "🍛🐓 Rice & Chicken") is stripped for this display only — the underlying product name is unchanged everywhere else
- AYLI Combos appear alongside menu items listing their pool items (ingredients) and per-kg price; size base prices are shown at the bottom of the card
- **AYLI combos with no pool items configured are automatically hidden** from the customer display

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Live Menu Panel (Right Side)

The right panel shows a live grid of items, paginated:

- **Column and row count are both configurable** (default 2 columns × 4 rows — see Global Display Settings); together they set exactly how many items show per page. Fewer columns means each card is wider; fewer rows means each card is taller — either way the item's image gets more room.
- Pages cycle automatically every 8 seconds
- **Restaurant:** only items with sales history are shown
- **Grocery / Clothing:** all in-stock items shown, sorted by sales score
- Alternates between regular items and AYLI Combos (restaurant) or stays on items (grocery/clothing)
- Advertising note badges appear on cards when set (see below)
- Product images shown when available — advertising image takes priority over the product's own image
- Item names show on up to 2 lines and have any emoji prefix stripped, same as the left panel
- Dot indicators in the header show current page / total pages

---

Advertising Notes

Staff can attach a short promotional note (up to 80 characters) to any item. Notes appear as a coloured badge on the product card:

Badge	Trigger	Colour
🔥 BOGO ...	Note contains "BOGO"	Amber
🏷️ 20% OFF	Note contains "%"	Green
⭐ TODAY'S SPECIAL	Note contains "special"	Gold
💬 Custom note	Any other text	Indigo/blue

Examples: `BOGO — Buy One Get One Free`, `20% OFF today only`, `New Arrival`

Product Images vs Advertising Images

Each item on the display can show two separate images:

| Image | Where it comes from | How to change | |-------|---------------------|-----------|| | **Product image** | Product / inventory record | Via inventory or product management | | **Advertising image** | Display settings (per-item) | Via the Product Display Settings panel |

The **advertising image takes priority** on the customer display. If no advertising image is set, the product's own image is used. If neither is set (clothing only), a **representative photo for the item's category** is shown, sourced from the shared category reference pool (see Business Image Gallery & Category Reference Pool) — this catches most items, since the vast majority of imported categories never had a real emoji assigned. Only when none of the above exist does the category emoji show.

The advertising image is completely separate — uploading or removing it does not affect the product record.

This same priority order (advertising image → product image → category reference photo → category emoji) is what the thumbnails show on the management screens too — Item Priority, Product Display Settings, Menu Availability, and Product Availability all show whichever image is actually going to appear on the customer display, not just a generic placeholder.

Setting the advertising image from the pool (clothing only): on both Item Priority and Product Display Settings, a 📁 **Pool** link sits next to the Upload option whenever the item is a real product (not a bale category). Click it to browse a category-filtered picker instead of uploading a new file — it defaults to the item's own category but lets you switch to any category via the dropdown at the top. Picking an image sets it by reference immediately, same as Upload.

Search Sync

When the cashier types in the POS search box, the customer display filters the live panel in real time. When the search is cleared, the full menu/product list returns automatically.

Permissions

Customer Display access uses two separate permissions:

Permission	What it allows	Default
`canViewCustomerDisplay`	View the Customer Display page (read-only — no editing)	Owner, Manager, Employee, Restaurant-associate, Grocery-associate, Salesperson
`canManageCustomerDisplay`	Upload/delete ads, edit product display settings, change global settings	Owner, Manager

Sidebar link — the 📺 **Customer Display** link (or, for restaurant and clothing, both 📺 **Customer Display Ads** and ⚙️ **Display Settings**) is visible to anyone who has `canViewCustomerDisplay` or `canManageCustomerDisplay`.

View-only mode — users with only `canViewCustomerDisplay` see the page but the **Upload New Ad** button is hidden and ad edit/delete actions are unavailable. They can still open a **Preview Display** window to see what's currently showing.

Managers and owners have full management access by default. Grant `canManageCustomerDisplay` individually if another role needs editing rights.

Menu Availability — Quickly Hide/Show an Item

Who this is for: Anyone with `canViewCustomerDisplay` — this deliberately includes **salespeople**, not just managers/admins, since it's the kind of thing a cashier needs to do mid-shift without waiting for a manager.

Where: Restaurant sidebar → 🚫 **Menu Availability**.

Run out of something? This screen lists every menu item and AYLI combo that currently has a menu number assigned (i.e. is configured to appear on the customer display), with a one-click toggle:

- **Hide Now** — the item disappears from the customer display immediately. Its menu number, pricing, and images are all left exactly as they are.

- **Show Again** — brings it right back once it's available again.

This is intentionally a **minimal, single-purpose screen** — it has no pricing checks, no image upload, and no menu-number editing. For anything beyond hiding/showing an already-configured item, use **Menu Numbers** (assigning numbers, pricing, images) — that page requires `canManageMenu` and isn't meant for quick shift-to-shift use.

> Hidden items are excluded only from the actual customer-facing display — they still show up (marked accordingly) in Menu Numbers and Display Settings' Item Priority list, so a manager can always find and review anything a salesperson has hidden.

Product Availability — Grocery & Clothing

Who this is for: Same idea as Menu Availability above, for grocery and clothing — anyone with `canViewCustomerDisplay`, salespeople included.

Where: Grocery sidebar → 🚫 **Product Availability**, or Clothing sidebar → 🚫 **Product Availability**.

Grocery and clothing have no menu-number concept, so there's no "configured subset" to gate the list by — every in-stock, priced product (or, for clothing, bale category) is already eligible for the display. This screen shows the top ~40 items by current display relevance plus any already-hidden items so they're never lost from view, and a search box to jump straight to anything else by name or category:

- **Hide Now** — the item disappears from the customer display immediately. Nothing else about it changes.
- **Show Again** — brings it right back.

For users with `canManageInventory` (or admin), each product's name is also a link straight to its inventory edit screen — useful when you notice a price, image, or stock issue while reviewing display availability and want to fix it without a separate trip to Inventory. Users without that permission just see the plain name.

Same as Menu Availability, this is a quick single-purpose toggle only — it doesn't touch pricing, images, or how an item scores for display priority. Hidden items still show (marked accordingly) in the combined Customer Display management page, so a manager can always review what's been hidden.

Management — Where to Find It

Restaurant and Clothing each have **two separate** Customer Display destinations in the sidebar — don't confuse them. Grocery currently has one combined page:

Business	Navigation	What it's for
Restaurant	Sidebar → 📺 **Customer Display Ads**	"Product Display Settings" — per-item advertising note/image, priority, hide, with search and paging
Restaurant	Sidebar → ⚙️ **Display Settings**	Standalone page: global settings (rotation speed, panel columns/rows, etc.) plus a searchable, all-items "Item Priority" list
Clothing	Sidebar → 📺 **Customer Display Ads**	Same "Product Display Settings" screen as restaurant, scoped to clothing products/bale categories

Business	Navigation	What it's for
Clothing	Sidebar → ⚙️ **Display Settings**	Same standalone Global Settings + Item Priority page as restaurant
Grocery	Sidebar → 📺 **Customer Display**	Ads and global settings live together on one combined page (no separate Item Priority list yet)
Grocery	Sidebar → 🚫 **Product Availability**	Quick hide/show toggle for salespeople — see above
Clothing	Sidebar → 🚫 **Product Availability**	Quick hide/show toggle for salespeople — see above

> **If your uploaded ads never seem to show on the customer screen:** check **Display Settings** (or, on grocery, the Global Settings section of the combined page) — when "Smart display enabled" is turned on, the screen shows the rotating product/menu panels instead of your uploaded ad slideshow. Turn it off if you want the classic ad slideshow to play.

> **Clothing note:** the same global settings (rotation speed, panel/grid layout) can currently be reached two ways — the embedded settings panel on the combined **Customer Display Ads** page, and the standalone **Display Settings** page. Both edit the exact same underlying settings, so changing one shows up in the other immediately; use whichever is more convenient.

The standalone **Display Settings** page (restaurant and clothing) has two sections:

1. **Global Settings** — rotation speed, max items, enable/disable the smart display, panel/grid layout — sticky at the top of the page so it stays visible while you scroll the item list
2. **Item Priority** — a searchable list (search box sits in its own sticky header, right beside Global Settings) to configure every item's priority, advertising image, and promo note. Changes to any item apply instantly — no page reload, so your scroll position and search stay put — and reach the live customer display immediately rather than waiting for its periodic refresh.

Adding Items to the Customer Display

Items appear on the customer display automatically **when they have a menu number assigned**. If any item has a menu number, only numbered items are shown (items without a number are excluded).

To add a new item to the display:

1. Go to **Restaurant** → **Manage** → **Menu Numbers**
2. Find the item (menu item or AYLI combo) — a thumbnail of the item's own photo (or the combo's advertising image) shows next to it if one is set
3. Assign a menu number (e.g. `8`, `9`, `10a`) — click the **Assign** button with the number field left blank to auto-fill the next available number instead of typing one yourself
4. The item now appears in **Display Settings** → **Item Priority**

If pricing isn't set up yet: the system won't let you assign a number to an item with no price (or $0.00) — for a menu item that means an unset base price; for an AYLI combo it means any size or pool item still showing $0.00/kg. You'll see a ⚠ next to the item and a banner explaining what to fix (in Menu Management for items,

AYLI Pricing for combos) before you can proceed. This stops an unpriced item from ever showing $0.00 on the customer-facing screen.

Freeing a number: if a numbered item's pricing later becomes invalid (e.g. a calibration reset), a red **Free** button appears next to it in both the item list and the Assigned Numbers panel — click it to release the number for reuse without needing to fix the pricing first.

> **No two items can share a number.** The server rejects a duplicate on save, and the Menu Numbers page also checks instantly against the list already on screen before it even asks the server — so you'll see the conflict immediately rather than after a save attempt.

Setting the primary image from this screen: select an item, then click **Upload Image** (or **Replace Image** if one is already set) under its photo in the edit panel and pick a file. For a menu item this sets the product's actual primary photo — the same one Menu Management shows. An AYLI combo has no photo field of its own, so this sets its advertising image instead (the same one Display Settings' Item Priority list can also set). Either way, the new photo shows immediately, on this screen and on the customer display.

Scrolling and reassigning: the list keeps your scroll position and never reorders itself after you assign, remove, or free a number — only the row you touched updates in place, so you can work down a long list without losing your spot.

Adding an Advertising Image (per item)

Each item in the Item Priority list shows a display image that **defaults to the item's own catalog/primary photo** (the same one set from Menu Numbers or Menu Management) whenever one exists — you don't need to upload anything separately just to get a photo showing. Uploading here only matters when you want a **different, dedicated promotional photo** instead of the catalog one:

1. Go to **Restaurant → Display Settings**
2. Find the item in the **Item Priority** list
3. If it's currently showing the catalog photo, click 📷 **Use a different ad photo** (or 📷 **Add ad image** if it has no photo at all) under that item
4. Pick an image file from your device — it uploads and saves immediately as a dedicated ad photo, replacing the catalog photo on the display. Clothing products can instead click 🖼 **Pool** to pick an existing image from the category reference pool — no upload needed
5. A thumbnail appears confirming the image is set

Click **Remove (use catalog photo instead)** to drop the dedicated ad photo and fall back to the catalog photo again (or **Remove image** if there's no catalog photo to fall back to).

Whichever image is showing (catalog or dedicated ad photo) appears as a large photo on both the left rotating panel and the right menu grid.

Requires `canManageCustomerDisplay` — like the rest of the Item Priority panel except ⭐ **Special** (see below), this is read-only for users with only `canViewCustomerDisplay`.

Item Priority Panel

The **Item Priority** panel lists every numbered item the display can show. Each row is fully inline — no separate edit modal needed. Changes apply immediately when you interact with a control.

Control	Description
Score bar	Visual display score (T = today, Y = yesterday, D = day before)
Boost	Number field (0–100); each point adds 10 to the display score. Tab away to save. Requires `canManageCustomerDisplay`.
Display image	Defaults to the item's own catalog photo when one exists; 📷 **Use a different ad photo** / 📷 **Add ad image** overrides it with a dedicated promo photo, or 🎲 **Pool** (clothing products only) picks an existing image from the category reference pool instead of uploading a new file. Requires `canManageCustomerDisplay`.
Ad note field	Type a short promo text (up to 80 chars). Tab away or click elsewhere to save. Determines the badge colour automatically (see Advertising Notes section). Requires `canManageCustomerDisplay`.
⭐ **Special**	Set (or remove) this item as today's actual special — the same special the Today's Special system resolves, not a cosmetic flag. Setting one replaces whatever was set before; if nothing is set for a day, there is no special that day. Only shown for regular menu items — AYLI combos can't be a Today's Special. Requires `canOverrideDailySpecial` — salespeople have this by default, so this is a quick shift-to-shift action, not a configuration change.
★ **Feature**	Toggle featured — sorts item to the front of the rotation. Requires `canManageCustomerDisplay`.
🚫 **Hide**	Toggle hidden — removes item from the display entirely. Requires `canManageCustomerDisplay` here (salespeople should use the dedicated Menu Availability screen instead, which is scoped to just this one toggle).

Users with only `canViewCustomerDisplay` see every row but can only use ⭐ **Special** — every other control is disabled. All changes save immediately (no Save button needed per item), and the customer display now picks them up right away rather than waiting for its periodic refresh.

Global Display Settings

Where: Restaurant or Clothing sidebar → ⚙️ **Display Settings**

Permission required: `canManageCustomerDisplay`. Users with only `canViewCustomerDisplay` see this page in read-only mode — toggles and sliders are disabled and the **Save Settings** button is hidden.

Setting	Description
Smart display enabled	Toggle the entire smart product display on/off
Split layout	Enable/disable the ads panel
Rotation speed	How long each card shows (3–30 seconds)

Setting	Description
Max items in rotation	How many items appear in the ads rotation
Today's Special show frequency	0% = never show the special card; 100% = always show it. Default 25% means the special card replaces the normal rotation roughly once every four ticks. The special is always pinned at the top of the left panel regardless of this setting when it is > 0.
Rotating cards (left panel)	How many cards show at once on the left panel (1–3, default 2). Fewer cards means each one — and its image — is bigger.
Menu grid columns (right panel)	How many columns the right live menu grid uses (1–3, default 2). Fewer columns means each item card is wider.
Menu grid rows (right panel)	How many rows the right live menu grid shows per page (1–5, default 4) — combined with columns this sets exactly how many items appear per page (rows × columns). Fewer rows means each item card is taller, so its image is bigger too.

All of these settings apply to the live customer display immediately on **Save Settings** — no manual refresh needed on the display screen.

Grocery has the same settings embedded on its combined **Customer Display** page. Clothing has them in both places — embedded on its combined page and on this standalone **Display Settings** page (see Management — Where to Find It).

Daily Special (Restaurant)

Where: Restaurant sidebar → ⭐ **Today's Special**

The Today's Special system lets you promote an existing menu item at a reduced price for a specific day. It integrates with the POS, customer display, and receipt.

How it works

- A **special** is an existing salable menu item — no new product is created.
- The special has its own **override price** that replaces the base price on the day it runs.
- **Free WiFi is always included** — every special automatically adds a free WiFi token to the order.
- **Add-on items** (e.g. a free drink) can be attached. They appear as line items in the cart at full price with a matching credit that zeroes them out.
- The special can be **scheduled weekly** and **overridden on the day** without affecting the schedule.

Setting up a Special

1. Go to **Restaurant** → ⭐ **Today's Special** → **Library tab**.
2. Click **+ New Special**.
3. Fill in the form:

Field	Description
Menu Item	Search or type to find the product. Shows menu number, name, and regular price.
Special Price	The reduced price for today. A comparison (Regular → Special, save $X) appears automatically.
Display Image	Shows the product's own menu image as a preview. Optionally upload a custom image to override it. Click ↩ **Use menu product image instead** to revert to the default.
Additional Items (Free)	Attach one or more existing products to give free with every sale of this special (e.g. a free drink). Each add-on shows a credit amount.
Free WiFi Included	Always enabled — all specials include a free WiFi token.
Display Bullets	Short text lines shown on the customer display card (e.g. "Grilled Chicken", "Free Coke"). "Free WiFi included 🌐 " is auto-appended.

4. Click **Save Special**. The special is added to your library and can be assigned to days.

> Specials can be edited at any time — price, add-ons, bullets, and image can all be changed. Changes take effect immediately on the next POS poll (within 5 minutes).

Weekly Schedule

1. Go to the **Weekly Schedule tab**.
2. For each day of the week, select a special from the dropdown (or leave it as "— No special —").
3. Each row shows the special's name, special price, and savings amount.
4. Changes save immediately per row.

Overriding Today's Special

The **Today tab** shows what is running right now. From here (with `canOverrideDailySpecial` permission):

Action	What it does
Disable for today	Turns off the special for the rest of today. The weekly schedule is unaffected.
Switch to different special	Swaps today's special to another library item without changing the schedule.
Revert to scheduled	Removes today's override and goes back to whatever the weekly schedule says.

If no special is scheduled for today, you can pick one from the library using the dropdown.

Add-on Items (Free)

When the cashier adds a special to the cart, each configured add-on automatically appears:

```
⭐ Rice & Beef Stew (Today's Special)   $3.00
+  🥟 Russian & Chips                   $1.00
   ↳ Special Credit: Russian & Chips   -$1.00
+  🧃 Pet Coke                          $0.80
   ↳ Special Credit: Pet Coke          -$0.80
──────────────────────────────────────────────
   Total                               $3.00
```

- The add-on is shown at its **full regular price** so the customer can see its value.
- A matching **credit line** immediately cancels the charge.
- The net effect is zero — the customer only pays the special price.
- If the cashier removes the special from the cart, its add-ons and credits are removed automatically.

POS — Quick Add Banner

A **pinned amber banner** sits above the menu grid whenever a special is active. It shows the menu number, product name, special price, and a **+ Add** button. Tapping the banner adds the special (with add-ons and free WiFi) to the cart without having to find the card in the grid.

The special's product card in the menu grid also shows a "⭐ TODAY'S SPECIAL" badge with amber styling and the special price, for reference.

Cart, Credits & Receipt

The receipt (preview and printed) shows:

```
  [3] Rice & Beef Stew (Today's Special)   $3.00
      Regular price: $2.00
      Russian & Chips                       $1.00
      Special Credit: Russian & Chips      -$1.00
      Pet Coke                              $0.80
      Special Credit: Pet Coke             -$0.80
  WiFi Token — Free (Today's Special)       $0.00
──────────────────────────────────────────────────
  Total                                     $3.00
```

The credits section is clearly labelled so the customer can read what they received for free — this is intentional to encourage repeat purchases when the special is available again.

Free WiFi with Every Special

All today's specials automatically include a free WiFi token:

- The system first checks the pre-generated token pool.
- If the pool is empty, it generates a fresh token on the fly from the R710 device.
- If token generation fails for any reason, **the sale still completes** — the WiFi token failure never cancels an order.
- The token appears on the receipt at $0.00, labelled "WiFi Token — Free (Today's Special)".

Daily Special Permissions

Permission	What it allows	Default roles
`canManageDailySpecial`	Create/edit/delete specials in library; manage weekly schedule	Owner, Manager
`canOverrideDailySpecial`	Disable today's special, swap to another, or re-enable	Owner, Manager, Restaurant-associate, Salesperson

The ⭐ **Today's Special** sidebar link is visible to anyone with either permission.

Backup — Tables

Table	Contents	Added in
`as_you_like_it_combos`	AYLI combo definitions	MBM-231
`as_you_like_it_combo_sizes`	Size tiers per combo	MBM-231
`as_you_like_it_pool_items`	Shared ingredient library	MBM-231
`as_you_like_it_combo_items`	Pool items assigned to each combo	MBM-231
`display_product_configs`	Per-item display settings (note, images, boost)	MBM-232/233
`display_global_settings`	Per-business global display settings	MBM-232
`daily_specials`	Library of configured specials (product + special price + bullets + optional custom image)	MBM-237
`daily_special_add_ons`	Free add-on products attached to each special	MBM-237
`daily_special_schedules`	Weekly schedule (one special per day of the week)	MBM-237
`daily_special_day_overrides`	Per-date overrides — disable or swap today's special	MBM-237

New columns (not new tables):

- `barcode_inventory_items.imageId` — links to `images` table for the item's own display image
- `display_product_configs.advertisingNote` — short promo text shown as a badge
- `display_product_configs.advertisingImageId` — links to `images` table for the advertising-only image
- `business_products.menuNumber` — display number (e.g. `1`, `1a`) used to filter what appears on the customer display

- `as_you_like_it_combos.menuNumber` — same for AYLI combos; assigned via the Menu Numbers management page
- `display_global_settings.specialShowPercentage` — how often the special card appears in the left panel rotation (0–100%)

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56. Vehicle Repair & Service Business Type

> **Who reads this:** Admins setting up a vehicle repair/service shop, managers registering contractors and billing jobs, and contractors using their restricted portal.

Overview

The **Vehicle Repair & Service** business type (`vehicle_service`) is for garages, repair shops, and similar businesses that combine three things in one job: mechanical **labour** performed by outside **contractors** (not employees), **parts** sold from inventory, and a single **customer bill** at the end covering both.

It is a separate business type from **Vehicle Sales** — the existing "Vehicles" type is a car dealership (VIN tracking, no contractors or jobs). Don't confuse the two when creating a business.

Contractors are **not employees**. They hold no payroll contract, are paid per completed job at a pre-agreed rate, and log into a separate, restricted **Contractor Portal** that shows them only their own work — never pricing, payments, or receipts.

Setting Up the Business

Create the business as normal (**Admin** → **Businesses** → **New Business**) and choose **Vehicle Repair & Service** as the type. This automatically gives the business:

- The full parts/service category taxonomy (4 domains, 21 categories, ~170 individual services and parts — oil changes, brakes, tires, engine work, electrical, parts and accessories, cleaning/detailing, fleet and roadside services) — the same category picker used everywhere else in the app (POS, inventory) already understands this taxonomy.
- **Jobs** and **Contractors** links in the sidebar (desktop and mobile). A **Parts Requests** link also appears for anyone with the `canManageInventory` permission — see Parts Requests below. A **Labour Rates** link also appears for anyone with financial-data access — see Labour Costs & Contractor Pay below.

Managing Contractors

Navigate to **Contractors** in the sidebar (requires **Manage Employees** permission or system admin).

Registering a new contractor:

1. Click **+ Add Contractor**.
2. **Search first** — contractors are backed by the same shared person records used for payees and other individuals system-wide, so if this person already exists anywhere (e.g. already a contractor at another business), they'll turn up here. Click **Use This Person** to reuse their record instead of creating a duplicate. (A person can only be a contractor at one business at a time — trying to reuse someone already active elsewhere will say so.)

3. If nobody matches, click **register a new contractor** and enter their details — full name, phone, national ID (required), email and address (optional). If the national ID or phone turns out to already belong to someone (a search miss), you'll be offered their existing record instead of an error.
4. Click **Create Contractor**.

This creates the contractor's core record. Click into it (or the row) to **Manage** further:

Section	What it does
Status	Active / Retired / Disabled. Retired and disabled contractors are automatically excluded from every job-assignment picker — they cannot be given new work, but their history and past payouts are preserved.
Skills & Certifications	Free-text list — skill name plus an optional certification note (e.g. "ASE Certified"). Informational only; does not gate what they can be assigned.
Authorized Services & Fees	The specific services this contractor is qualified to perform, each with **their own agreed fee**. A contractor can hold many authorized services. Only services they're authorized for (and only while Active) appear when assigning them to a job task.
Contractor Portal Login	Creates, revokes, resets, and audits the contractor's own sign-in — see Contractor Portal Login Management below.
Monthly Payout	See Monthly Contractor Payments below.

Contractor Portal Login Management

This is a normal user account, but it is **not** given membership in the business the way an employee account would be — it can only ever reach the Contractor Portal, nothing else.

- **Create Login**: enter an email and, optionally, a password. Leave the password field blank to have the system generate a random temporary one instead — either way, both fields are right there on the form. An auto-generated password must be changed by the contractor the first time they actually sign in; a password you type in yourself is **not** forced to change.
- **Temporary password display**: if a password was auto-generated (at creation, or later via Reset Password), it's shown **once**, in an amber banner at the top of this section — copy it and share it with the contractor securely (it's never shown or retrievable again after you navigate away or click Dismiss). This banner stays visible regardless of whether the login is currently active or revoked.
- **Reset Password**: available any time a login exists, whether active or revoked — lets a manager set a specific new password, or leave it blank to generate a fresh temporary one (same behavior as creation). Useful when a contractor forgets their password or a temporary one needs replacing.
- **Revoke Access**: blocks sign-in to the Contractor Portal immediately (with an optional reason). Their profile, skills, authorized services, tasks, and payout history are completely untouched — this only stops them signing in. Fully reversible.
- **Reactivate**: restores a revoked login immediately.
- **View login history**: expands a list of every login event — created, revoked, reactivated, password reset — each showing who did it and when, and the reason if one was given.

Assigning Jobs & Tasks

Navigate to **Jobs** in the sidebar.

Creating a job:

1. Click **+ New Job**.
2. Search for an existing customer, or leave blank for a walk-in. If the search finds no match, a **+ New Customer** link appears right there in the modal — it opens the same quick-registration form used at the POS, so you never have to leave the job screen to register someone first.
    - Phone numbers uniquely identify a customer everywhere in the system — nobody has two records. If the person is already a customer at **another business** (e.g. they've eaten at the restaurant but never visited the shop before), the search finds them there too and shows them under "Not a customer here yet, but found elsewhere," tagged with which business they're from. Click **Use This Customer** to select their existing record — same customer number, same profile, same order history, wherever they're used. Trying to register them again with the same phone number (instead of selecting them) is blocked, with a prompt to use the existing record instead.
3. Enter vehicle details (make, model, plate, VIN — all optional but recommended). **Make** and **Model** suggest values already used at this business as you type — pick one or just type a new one; typing it here is enough for it to show up as a suggestion next time. **Model is attached to Make** — it stays disabled until a Make is chosen, and only shows models already seen for that specific make (so "Hilux" won't show up under "Isuzu"). Changing the Make clears whatever Model was selected.
4. Pick the **primary contractor** for the job — required. Search as you type; if they're not registered yet, a **+ New Contractor** option appears at the bottom of the results — fill in name, phone, and national ID right there and they're immediately selected, no need to leave the job screen. (A brand-new contractor isn't authorized for any services yet — set that up from the Contractors page before assigning them tasks.) This is the main contractor associated with the vehicle visit and is what prints on the job card; individual tasks can still be assigned to other contractors.
5. Click **Create Job** — you're taken straight to the job's detail page.

Job notes: shown just below the primary contractor on the job detail page — click it (or **+ Add job notes** if empty) at any time, on any job regardless of status, to edit and save. This is the same free-text field printed as "Job Notes" on the Job Card.

Adding tasks (assigning contractors): On the job detail page, use **Add Task**:

1. Pick a **category** first (e.g. "🛢️ Oil Change and Lubrication"), then the **service** within it (e.g. "🛢️ Standard oil change") — the service picker stays disabled until a category is chosen, and only shows services in that category. Both pickers show the emoji seeded for that category/service.
2. Pick the **contractor**. Contractors already authorized for that exact service appear first with their fee shown. Anyone else active at the business also appears, labeled "not authorized for this service yet" — picking one prompts for a fee to authorize them for this specific service on the spot, no trip to the Contractors page needed. If the contractor isn't registered at all yet, search finds them system-wide (like Primary Contractor on New Job) or a **+ New Contractor** option lets you register them right there — either way, you'll still set a fee to authorize them for the selected service before the task can be added. Retired or disabled contractors never appear.
3. **If you can see financial data** (see Labour Costs below): the service's configured labour rate shows as the default customer charge, with an optional field to override it for just this task. If the service has no rate configured yet, you'll be prompted to set one — it's saved as the new default for that service going

forward. If you can't see financial data, this step is skipped entirely and the task uses whatever rate is already configured.
4. Optionally add a short work note.
5. Optionally attach **Known Parts** — if you already know what part the job needs (e.g. an oil filter for an oil change), click 📦 **Browse Parts to Attach** to open a photo grid of real stocked inventory (search and category filter both narrow it further, neither is required) and add one with a quantity. The part's stock is deducted immediately, the same way parts are deducted when added from Bill Job. This is separate from a contractor requesting parts mid-job — use Known Parts when staff already knows what's needed up front.
6. Click **Add Task**.

A job can have any number of tasks, and different tasks on the same job can go to different contractors — e.g. one contractor for an oil change, another for a brake job, on the same vehicle visit.

Phone and national ID formatting: anywhere a contractor is registered (New Job, Add Task, or the Contractors page), phone and national ID use the same standard input widgets as the rest of the app — a country-code selector defaulting to Zimbabwe for phone, and a format template defaulting to the Zimbabwe National ID pattern, with validation against the selected format. Phone numbers are shown formatted (e.g. "+263 77 123 4567") everywhere they're displayed on-screen; the printed Job Card shows the local format (e.g. "078 486 9759"), matching how receipts show phone numbers.

Task status: Assigned → In Progress → Completed. Staff/managers can update task status directly here; contractors update their own tasks from their portal (see below). A completed task cannot be removed from a job. The first time a task moves to In Progress, its start time is recorded; once completed, staff with financial-data access see the actual time taken alongside the task — this is for reference only and never changes the price. Once the **job itself** is Billed or Cancelled, every task on it is locked — status can no longer be changed and tasks can no longer be removed, from either the job detail page or the Contractor Portal, since the invoice (and any contractor pay) has already been generated from exactly that set of tasks. This matches the job-level lock below — see Rework Jobs for how to handle follow-up work on an already-billed job.

Job status: Open → In Progress → Completed → Billed, plus Cancelled at any point. The status buttons on the job detail page enforce this sequence — they aren't just labels:

- **In Progress** happens automatically — the moment any task on the job is marked In Progress (by staff here, or by the contractor from their own portal), the job itself advances to In Progress too. No manual click needed, and it never fires early — a job with no tasks yet, or with all tasks still Assigned, stays Open.
- **Completed** is disabled until every task on the job is itself Completed.
- **Billed** never appears as a clickable button at all — it's set automatically by **Bill This Job** once an invoice is actually generated, never by hand. The job still shows a "Billed" badge once that happens.

This prevents a job from ever showing Completed or Billed without the underlying work — or invoice — actually existing, and keeps the job's own status honest without staff having to remember to update it by hand.

Labour Costs & Contractor Pay (two separate numbers)

The **customer labour charge** (what the customer is billed for a service) and the **contractor's pay rate** (what the contractor earns for doing it) are configured completely independently — a shop can charge a customer

$35 for a brake inspection while paying the contractor $20 for it, and neither number affects the other.

- **Labour Rates** (sidebar, under vehicle-service — requires financial-data access) is the central screen for the customer-facing side: every service, grouped by category with its emoji, shows its current default rate or "Not set." Click any rate to edit it inline.
- **Contractor Payment Settings** — the Contractors page's existing "Authorized Services & Fees" section — is entirely separate and controls what each individual contractor earns per service. Contractors never see this configuration, only their own portal, which never displays rate figures either.
- On the job detail page, staff with financial-data access see each task's labour charge and contractor pay as two distinct figures, plus a **Total Estimated Cost** for the whole job (labour + parts) above Add Task. Everyone else sees the job's tasks and status with no dollar amounts anywhere. "Bill This Job" is only available to staff who can see this financial data, since billing is itself a breakdown of these figures.
- The printed Job Card never shows any of this — pricing has never appeared on it, for anyone.

Searching and Filtering Jobs

The Jobs list has a search bar at the top (the same style used on Receipt History) plus date and contractor filters:

- **Search** matches the customer's name or phone, the vehicle's make/model/plate, either contractor's name, or the service performed — so typing "oil change" finds every job with that task on it, regardless of who did the work or which vehicle it was.
- **Date presets** (Today / Yesterday / Last 7 Days / This Month) or a custom **From/To** range filter by when the job was created.
- **Contractor** dropdown filters to jobs where that contractor is either the primary contractor or has a task on the job.
- All filters combine — e.g. search "oil change" + a specific contractor + this month shows only that contractor's oil changes this month.

The Job Card (Print)

Every job has a printable **job card** — a work document for the shop floor and the contractor, deliberately showing **no pricing anywhere**: just the job number, vehicle, customer, primary contractor, every task with its service and instructions, and signature lines.

- **Print Job Card** on the job detail page opens a print-preview modal in the same tab (no page reload) and records when it was first printed (shown as a "Printed" badge in the jobs list). Printing again after that shows as **Reprint Job Card**. Clicking **Print / Save PDF** inside the preview opens the browser's print dialog on just that document.
- Once every task on the job is marked Completed, a **Mark Job Card Returned** action becomes available — this records the moment the physical card comes back from the shop floor, separate from task completion itself, and is the cue that the job is ready to bill. The jobs list shows a "Returned" badge once this is done.

Parts Requests (Contractor to Inventory Department)

Contractors don't have inventory access or pricing visibility, so they can't look up exact part SKUs themselves. Instead:

1. **From the Contractor Portal**, on any of their in-progress tasks, a contractor clicks **Request Part**, describes what they need in plain text, and gives a quantity. This appears immediately in their own **My Parts Requests** list with a status badge.
2. **Inventory Department** (anyone with `canManageInventory`, or system admin) sees every pending request on the **Parts Requests** page (sidebar link). For each request they either:
   - **Issue** it — search and pick the actual product/variant in stock, confirm the quantity. This decrements stock **immediately** (the part physically leaves the shelf now, not at billing time) and attaches the part to the job.
   - **Reject** it — with a short reason, which the contractor sees on their own Parts Requests list.
3. **At Bill Job time**, any parts that were issued this way are already pre-filled into the bill at their recorded price — no re-searching, and stock is **not** decremented a second time. Parts added directly at billing (bypassing a request) still decrement stock as normal at that point.

The job detail page shows a **Parts** panel listing everything issued plus any pending or rejected requests, so staff always have visibility into what's been requested and fulfilled for a job.

Parts Inventory

A dedicated **Parts Inventory** page (sidebar link, next to Jobs and Customers) is where vehicle parts — the same parts jobs pull from above — get created, stocked, and searched. It's built on the app's normal product catalog, so every part here is also a normal, scannable, sellable inventory item; nothing about it is a separate system.

Categories are organized under two domains: 🧰 **Parts and Accessories Sales** (everything sellable — filters, fluids, engine parts, brakes, electrical, tires, body, interior, and more) and 🔧 **Workshop Inventory** (hand tools, workshop equipment, and consumables like gloves and shop towels — tracked for internal use, never sold to a customer).

Adding a part (**+ Add Part**, or 📷 **Scan** a barcode that isn't recognized yet — both reuse the exact same scanner and quick-registration flow every other business type already uses): fill in name, SKU, category, price, and optionally brand, supplier, storage location, condition, OEM/Aftermarket, and reorder level. **Vehicle Compatibility** rows let one part be tagged as fitting several vehicles (make, model, year range, engine, transmission) — a generic oil filter that fits five different cars only needs five compatibility rows, not five separate inventory items.

Duplicate check: before creating a part, the system looks for close matches (same category plus a similar name, brand, or vehicle) and shows them instead of creating a new item blind — pick 👁️ **View existing** to check it, or a manager/admin can click 🆕 **Create new anyway** to proceed regardless.

Searching and filtering covers name, SKU, barcode, vehicle make/model/year, domain, category, condition, OEM/Aftermarket, and stock status (In Stock / Low Stock / Out of Stock). Each row shows a small photo thumbnail when the part has one (a wrench icon otherwise).

Part photos: from a part's detail page, click **Upload Image** (or **Replace Image**) next to its photo — pick a file, or copy an image (e.g. from a supplier's website) and paste it (Ctrl+V) straight into the dialog. 🗑️ **Remove Image** clears it and falls back to the category icon. 📋 **Copy Image to Clipboard** copies the current photo so you can paste it elsewhere (another app, an email, another part's dialog). Requires the same stock-management permission as adjusting stock.

Stock actions, from a part's detail page (financial-tier permissions apply — see below):

- ➕ **Receive Stock** — record new stock coming in, with cost and a reference (PO number, invoice, etc.)
- ↩️ **Process Return** — a customer bringing a part back (stock goes up) or a return to the supplier (stock goes down)
- 🧰 **Internal Use** — a workshop consumable used day-to-day, not charged to anyone
- 🎚️ **Adjust Stock** — a manager-level correction (a miscount, found stock), always with a required reason
- 💥 **Write Off** — damaged, lost, or stolen stock, always with a required reason

Every one of these creates a permanent, timestamped movement record shown on the part's own **Stock Movement History** — quantities never change silently. A low-stock bell notification fires automatically the same way it already does for every other business type's inventory, the moment a write-off or adjustment pushes a part to or below its reorder level.

Permissions: Staff can receive stock and process returns as part of normal day-to-day work. Only Managers/Administrators can transfer stock between businesses, adjust quantities, write off stock, or change pricing — Technicians (contractors) can search available parts from their own portal (to know what's in stock before requesting one — see Parts Requests above) but never see cost or selling prices, and can't touch stock levels or pricing at all.

Reports (📊 **Reports**, from the Parts Inventory page): a **Stock Report** (current levels, low/out-of-stock counts, recent write-offs, by location) and a **Sales & Profit Report** (date-range filtered — quantity sold directly vs. used on a repair job, revenue, cost, gross profit and margin, best/worst sellers, and profit by vehicle make/model, sourced from the actual vehicle a part was used on). Both support CSV export and print/Save-as-PDF from the browser's own print dialog.

Pricing: Contractor Fee vs. Customer Price

Both amounts on a task are **snapshotted at the moment the task is created**, from two entirely separate configuration screens (see Labour Costs & Contractor Pay above) — changing either rate afterward never retroactively affects a job already in progress, only new tasks pick up the new rate:

- **Contractor's fee** — from that contractor's Authorized Services & Fees rate for the service (Contractors page).
- **Customer's price** — from the service's configured Labour Rate, or the fixed price you set for that specific task, if you set one. These two numbers are independent by design — they are not the same figure, and changing the shop's labour rate never affects what a contractor is paid, or vice versa.

The job detail page shows both, side by side, for anyone with financial-data access.

The Contractor Portal

Contractors sign in at the normal login screen with the credentials created for them. They land on a **completely separate, restricted screen** — no sidebar, no other business navigation, nothing outside their own task list.

From the portal a contractor can:

- See every **incomplete** task assigned to them (across all jobs).

- **Start Work** on a task (moves it to In Progress).
- **Mark Complete**, with a short text field to describe the work performed.

A contractor **cannot** see customer pricing, labour charges, payment information, invoices, receipts, or any charge breakdown anywhere in the portal — not just hidden in the UI, this data is never returned by the portal's API in the first place. Once a task is marked complete, the contractor can no longer edit or reopen it from the portal.

Billing a Job — Two Steps: Invoice, Then Payment

Billing and payment are deliberately **separate steps**, because in practice the customer is handed a printed invoice and walks it to a cashier — often a different person, sometimes much later — who actually takes the payment. Nothing about generating the invoice requires payment to happen in the same sitting, or by the same staff member.

Step 1 — Generate the invoice. Once **every task on a job is marked Completed**, a **Bill This Job** button appears on the job detail page (requires financial-data access; not available to contractors).

1. Click **Bill This Job**.
2. Labour lines are pre-filled from the completed tasks (each task's fixed price override if one was set, otherwise its configured labour rate — never the contractor's own fee, which is a separate figure).
3. Any parts already **Issued** through a parts request (see above) are shown read-only, pre-filled at their recorded price — nothing to search for, and stock isn't touched again here.
4. Browse and add any **additional parts** used that weren't formally requested — the same photo grid used by Known Parts (search/category optional, not required), with stock automatically checked and deducted on billing.
5. Add any **other charges** (shop supplies, disposal fees, etc.) as free-form line items.
6. **Discount** and **tax** are both adjustable here — tax pre-fills from the business's own tax settings (the same rate used at the POS) but can be changed or cleared for this invoice; discount is a plain dollar amount.
7. Click **Generate Invoice**.

This creates the order (visible in **Receipt History** like any other sale, with a full itemized breakdown) and marks the job **Billed** — but the order's payment status is **Pending**, and the business account is **not** credited yet. A **Print Invoice** button appears immediately after generating it, opening a print-ready copy of the invoice to hand to the customer.

Step 2 — Collect payment. Any authorised user (not necessarily whoever billed it) can now retrieve this job and take the payment:

- On the job detail page, a **Collect Payment** button appears whenever a job is Billed but still unpaid.
- On the Jobs list, the **Awaiting Payment** filter (next to the status pills) shows every such job across the business, each also tagged with a small "Awaiting Payment" badge — this is the queue a cashier works from.
- Collecting payment just needs the payment method — confirming it marks the order **Paid**, records who collected it and when, and **only then** credits the business account. The job is now ready for **Release Vehicle**.
- Right after payment, the same receipt preview used everywhere else in the app (POS, restaurant, grocery, clothing) opens automatically — pick a printer and print, or just close it. Printing is entirely

optional; the payment is already recorded either way, closing without printing has no effect on that.

Releasing the Vehicle

Billing produces the receipt, but handing the vehicle back is a separate, deliberate step. Once a job is **Billed** and its payment status is **Paid**, a **Release Vehicle** button appears on the job detail page. Clicking it records who released the vehicle and when — the job detail page then shows "Vehicle released" going forward. This can't be done before payment is confirmed, and can't be repeated once a vehicle has been released.

Rework Jobs

Once a job is billed, its status is locked — it can never be reopened or edited back to In Progress or Completed, even by an admin. If a vehicle comes back needing warranty-style follow-up work, create a **new** job instead:

1. On **New Job**, check **This is a rework job**.
2. Search for and select the **Original Job** this rework relates to.
3. Two checkboxes appear, both checked by default:
    - **Waive labor charges** — every task added to this job bills the customer **$0** for labour, regardless of any configured rate.
    - **Waive parts charges** — any parts added at billing (freshly picked or already issued) bill the customer **$0**. Stock is still deducted normally, and internal cost tracking is unaffected — only what the *customer* is charged changes.
4. Uncheck either box for a partial waiver (e.g. a genuinely new part still gets charged, but the redo labour is free).

A fully-waived rework job can be billed at a **$0 total** — this is the one case where the normal "total must be greater than zero" rule doesn't apply, since a free warranty visit is still worth invoicing and closing out properly (so **Release Vehicle** can still happen).

Contractor pay, separately: when adding a task to a rework job, a **Contractor Pay** field appears — independent of the customer-facing waivers above. If the same contractor who did the original work is doing the rework, it defaults to **$0** (they don't get paid twice for their own mistake) with a note explaining why; pick a different contractor and it defaults to their normal fee instead, since they didn't cause the issue. Either way, this is just a default — type any amount to override it, including a partial reduced rate instead of a full waiver.

The job detail page shows a **Rework of {vehicle}** link back to the original job, and the original job lists any rework jobs created from it, so the history stays traceable in both directions.

Bell Notifications

Two situations in the vehicle-service workflow raise a bell notification (top-right of every page) automatically, using the same notification system as the rest of the app:

- **Invoice awaiting payment** 🧾 — the moment a job is billed (Step 1 above), everyone with financial-data access in the business is notified that an invoice is sitting there ready for Step 2. Clicking the notification opens the job directly.
- **Job not started** ⏰ — if a job has been sitting **Open** for more than 24 hours with no task ever moved to In Progress, everyone who can manage contractor assignments is notified so someone can follow up.

This check runs automatically whenever the Jobs list is loaded (no separate schedule to configure), and won't repeat for the same job more than once a day.

Monthly Contractor Payments

From a contractor's detail screen (**Contractors → select contractor → Monthly Payout**):

1. Pick a period (defaults to the current calendar month).
2. Click **Preview** — shows every completed, billed, and paid job/task for that contractor in the period that hasn't already been paid out, with a running total. **Every job is listed with its own checkbox, checked by default** — uncheck any you don't want on this voucher (e.g. one is under dispute and should wait). Use **Select All / Select None** to speed that up. The running total updates live as you check/uncheck.
3. Optionally set a **Due Date** — leave it blank and it defaults to the end of the calendar month the period covers (the shop's normal "pay by end of month" policy); type a different date to override it for just this voucher.
4. Click **Generate Payout Voucher**.

This submits a payment request through the **same cashier-approval queue** used for every other expense-account payment in the system (Payee = the contractor, as a Person) — no separate approval process to learn. Only the jobs you actually checked are included and locked against being included in any future payout — anything you unchecked stays available to bundle into a later voucher, so re-running the same period (or overlapping periods) never double-pays a contractor.

Past Payouts (same screen) lists every voucher for this contractor, each showing:

- A **status badge** — Submitted (not yet picked up for review), Pending Approval (linked straight to the EOD batch review page — click it to jump there), Approved, Rejected, Voided, or, if a submitted voucher has passed its due date by more than 7 days, **"Nd Overdue"** in red.
- **Edit** and **Void**, shown only while the voucher is still Submitted (i.e. before a cashier has picked it up for EOD review — once that happens, changes go through the cashier rejecting it there instead, the same as any other expense-account payment):
  - **Edit** reopens the job checklist for that specific voucher — its current jobs come back pre-checked alongside anything newly eligible in the same period — check/uncheck and save to change what it covers, or update its due date.
  - **Void** cancels the voucher entirely (with an optional reason, kept for the record) — every job on it becomes available for a future payout again, and the linked payment is marked cancelled. This can't be undone; generate a new voucher afterward if needed.
- **Download Voucher** — a printable PDF payment voucher, the same format used for other expense-account payments.

> **Note:** Generating a payout requires the business to have an active expense account linked to it. Every newly created business is now set up with one automatically. If an older business predates this and payout generation says no active expense account exists, an admin can fix it — see Linking an Expense Account to a Business.

Contractor Payments Report

Contractors → 📊 **Payments Report** gives a business-wide, searchable view across every contractor — for tracking down disputes or simply seeing what's outstanding, without opening each contractor one at a time.

Three tabs:

- **Pending Submissions** — completed, billed-and-paid jobs that haven't been put on any payout voucher yet, per contractor, with how long ago each was completed.
- **Pending Payments** — every generated voucher still working its way through approval (Submitted or Pending Approval), with its due date and status.
- **Overdue** — anything from either of the above that's more than 7 days past its due date (jobs still unsubmitted past the end of the month they were done in, or vouchers still unpaid past their due date), red-highlighted.

Each tab has the same search-and-date-filter bar used throughout the app (search by contractor, vehicle, order number, or voucher number; filter by date preset or a custom range), summary tiles for count/total/overdue-count, and **CSV Export** / **Print / Save PDF** buttons.

Sales Reports and End-of-Day

Sales Reports in the sidebar opens a reports hub with four options: **Visual Analytics Dashboard**, **Sales Analytics Report**, **Today's End-of-Day Report**, and **Report History** — the same underlying reports every other business type uses (see Section 3 — Cash Office & End of Day for the full EOD walkthrough: rent transfer, auto-deposits, payroll contribution, manager cash count, save & lock). A few restaurant-only reports (Meal Program, Prep Inventory, Delivery Reports) aren't shown here since they don't apply to a repair shop.

How direct sales and job billing combine on one report: a vehicle service business makes money two ways — parts/WiFi sold directly at the POS, and labour/parts billed through a job (see Billing a Job above). Both land in the same sales figures automatically; there's nothing separate to reconcile.

One thing to know about EOD and two-step billing: because billing a job (Step 1, generating the invoice) and collecting payment (Step 2) can happen on completely different days, the sales/cash figures follow the **payment date**, not the billing date. A job billed today but paid three days from now doesn't count as today's sales — it counts on the day it's actually paid. This keeps the EOD cash count accurate (an unpaid invoice isn't cash yet), but it does mean a job's total won't appear anywhere in the daily figures until someone actually collects payment for it.

That's exactly what the next report is for.

Billed but Unpaid Jobs

Sales Reports → ⏳ Billed but Unpaid Jobs lists every invoiced job still waiting on payment — the counterpart to the EOD behavior above, so an outstanding invoice is always visible somewhere even though it doesn't show up as "sales" until it's paid.

- The same date-range toolbar used throughout the app's reports (Today, Yesterday, Last 7/30/90 Days, Custom Range, or a specific month) plus a free-text search across customer name, vehicle, plate, and order number.
- Each row shows the order number, billed date, customer, vehicle, amount, and **days outstanding** — turning amber at 3+ days and red at 7+ days so aging invoices stand out.
- **Find in Jobs** jumps to the Jobs list pre-searched for that customer/vehicle so you can open the job and collect payment from there.
- Summary tiles at the top show the outstanding count and total dollar amount across the current filter.

Service Customers

Customers in the sidebar (or the button next to "+ New Job" on the Jobs page) shows everyone who has had at least one job at this business — their vehicle(s), how many jobs, and when they last came in. Click **View Jobs** on any row to jump to their job history.

If a customer's record actually belongs to another business (e.g. they were first registered at the restaurant, and their record was reused here rather than duplicated), their name shows a small **also at [business]** badge — click it for a popup with their full picture: customer number, phone, how long they've been a customer, and their total orders/spend/loyalty points across every business, since it's genuinely one shared record.

+ New Customer searches first — across this business and every other business — before offering to register someone new. If a match turns up anywhere, use it instead of creating a new record; phone numbers are unique system-wide, so registering the same number twice is blocked with a prompt to use the existing customer instead. Only when nobody matches does it fall through to the registration form (the same one used at the POS everywhere else).

Permissions Reference

Action	Permission required
Manage contractors (create, skills, services, login)	`canManageEmployees` or system admin
Create/manage jobs and tasks, search jobs, view service customers	Business membership (any staff with access to the business) — task creation itself needs no financial permission, but setting/seeing any dollar amount on it does (see below)
View labour costs, contractor pay, and Total Estimated Cost on a job; configure Labour Rates; set a fixed price override or a new labour rate when adding a task	`canAccessFinancialData` or system admin
Bill a job (generate invoice)	`canAccessFinancialData` or system admin
Collect payment on a billed job	`canAccessFinancialData` or system admin — same requirement as billing, independent of who billed it
Release a vehicle	Business membership
Issue or reject a parts request	`canManageInventory` or system admin
Generate/view/edit/void contractor payouts, view Payments Report	`canAccessFinancialData`, `canCloseBooks`, or system admin
Contractor Portal access (including requesting parts)	The contractor's own login only — no business permission applies

Backup — Tables

Table	Contents
vehicle_service_contractors	Contractor profile, status, portal login link
vehicle_service_contractor_skills	Skills/certifications
vehicle_service_contractor_services	Authorized services + agreed fee per contractor
vehicle_service_jobs	Job header — vehicle, customer, status, primary contractor, job-card print/return timestamps, vehicle release timestamp, linked order once billed
vehicle_service_tasks	Individual tasks — service, assigned contractor, status, agreed fee (contractor pay), customer labour rate, customer price override, work-started/completed timestamps
vehicle_service_labour_rates	Default customer labour charge per business + service — the Labour Rates screen's config, entirely separate from contractor pay
vehicle_service_contractor_payouts	One row per generated payout voucher — period, total, due date (computed or overridden), void status
vehicle_service_contractor_payout_items	Which tasks were included in which payout (prevents double payment)
vehicle_service_parts_requests	A contractor's part request — description, quantity, status (Requested/Issued/Rejected), who reviewed it
vehicle_service_job_parts	Parts actually issued to a job (via a request or added directly at billing)

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57. Sale Salesperson Reassignment

> **Who reads this:** Managers and admins who need to correct which employee a completed sale is credited to.

Overview

A sale is sometimes recorded under the wrong salesperson — the terminal was left on the previous cashier's name, a new employee used a coworker's login before their own account was set up, or the reassignment at checkout was simply missed. This feature lets a manager correct that after the fact, for one sale or many, from **Receipt History** or a receipt's detail view.

This is an **attribution fix only**. It corrects who a sale is credited to for reporting purposes (Receipt History, the Salesperson Shortfall Report, and any future per-salesperson reporting). It does **not** change payroll — commission in this system is a flat monthly amount tied to an employee's contract, not calculated from individual sales, so reassigning a sale never changes anyone's pay.

Who Can Reassign

Available to system admins and anyone with **Can Close Books** or **Can Access Financial Data** permission on the business. Staff without one of these permissions do not see the Reassign controls at all.

Reassigning a Single Sale

From Receipt History:

1. Navigate to **Receipt History**.
2. Find the sale and click **Reassign** in its Actions column.

From a receipt's detail view:

1. Click a receipt to open its details.
2. Click **Reassign Salesperson** at the bottom of the modal, next to Cancel Order.

Either way, a modal opens:

1. Choose the correct employee from the **Reassign to** dropdown.
2. Enter a reason (required — this is recorded on the audit trail).
3. Click **Reassign**.

Reassigning Multiple Sales at Once

Receipt History supports bulk reassignment, including a mix of sales that currently belong to *different* salespeople — they all move to whichever employee you pick.

1. Use the checkboxes on the left of each row to select sales. The header checkbox selects everything currently loaded on the page.
2. If more sales match your current search/date filter than are loaded on the page, a **Select all N matching current filter** link appears once every loaded row is checked — click it to apply the reassignment to the entire filtered result set, not just what's on screen.
3. Click **Reassign Salesperson** in the blue action bar that appears above the table.
4. Pick the employee, enter a reason, and confirm.

After You Confirm

The result screen reports what happened to every sale in the selection:

Outcome	Meaning
Reassigned	Updated successfully
Already assigned to this employee	No-op — skipped, not counted as an error
Blocked	The sale's date already has a submitted or manager-approved End-of-Day report for its *current* salesperson — see below

> **Sales with no employee record can be reassigned too.** A sale rung up by someone without an Employees profile (e.g. a business owner or admin covering the till) is recorded under their name for tracking, not credited to any employee. The Employees table exists for commission tracking, not as a

> gate on who's allowed to sell — so these sales are still fully eligible to reassign onto a real employee, the same as any other sale.

Why a Sale Can Be Blocked

If a salesperson has already submitted (or a manager has already approved) their End-of-Day cash report for the day a sale falls on, that sale is locked from reassignment. Moving it afterward would silently change cash figures that have already been reconciled and signed off. If a sale genuinely needs to move despite this, contact an admin — this restriction is not exposed as a bypassable option in the UI, by design.

What Gets Recorded

Every successful reassignment (single or bulk) writes an entry to the manager override audit log — who made the change, which employee it moved from and to, how many sales were affected, and the reason given. This log cannot be edited or deleted from the UI, the same as order cancellation records (Section 37).

Seeing a Sale's Reassignment History

Once a sale has been reassigned, a small ↺ **Reassigned** badge appears next to the salesperson's name — in Receipt History and in the receipt's detail view. If a sale has been reassigned more than once, the badge shows the count (e.g. ↺ **Reassigned ×2**).

Hover over the badge (or tap it on a touchscreen) to open a popup showing the full history, most recent first:

- Who it moved **from** and **to** for that reassignment
- The reason given
- The date/time, and which manager made the change

If a sale has been reassigned multiple times, every reassignment is listed in the popup, not just the most recent one — so you can trace the sale's full attribution history from its original salesperson to today.

All tables and their referenced images are backed up automatically with every full backup.

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58. Sales Targets — Setup & POS Progress Tracking

Who can access setup and full details: System admins, business owners, and anyone individually granted the permission — see Permissions below.

Who sees the POS progress bar: Everyone with POS access to the business (cashiers, salespeople, managers) — the compact bar is motivational and doesn't reveal any cost information.

Where: Edit Business → 🎯 **Sales Target** section (setup); the progress widget appears automatically on the POS screen once enabled.

Sales Targets gives each business a monthly sales goal that's automatically calculated from what the business actually needs to cover — rent, payroll, loan repayments, and other recurring commitments — plus a safety buffer. Cashiers see a simple, encouraging progress bar at the till; managers and admins can drill into the full breakdown, compare periods, and adjust things as circumstances change.

How It Works

Three figures drive the feature:

Figure	Meaning
Minimum	The lowest monthly sales figure that covers the business's real obligations (rent + payroll + recurring commitments + loan repayments + other commitments + buffer). This is a hard floor — the approved target can never be set below it.
Recommended	The system's suggested target — the minimum, or a higher figure based on the business's recent sales history, whichever is greater. For a new business with little sales history yet, this is simply the minimum plus 15%, clearly labeled as an estimate.
Approved	The figure actually driving the POS progress bar. It starts out equal to the Recommended figure and keeps following it automatically as the business's numbers change — until an admin manually sets a different approved amount, at which point it becomes a deliberate, fixed decision that recalculations no longer touch.

Every night, the system recalculates the minimum and recommended figures for every business with tracking enabled, so they stay current with rent changes, staffing changes, and recent sales trends without anyone having to remember to update them.

Setting Up Sales Targets

1. Open **Edit Business** for the business (Admin → Businesses → Edit, or Business Settings).
2. Find the 🎯 **Sales Target** section and click **+ Enable Sales Target Tracking**.
3. In the modal, switch on **Enable Sales Target Tracking**. The system immediately calculates the Minimum, Recommended, and Approved figures for you.
4. Review the **Minimum target breakdown** — Rent, Payroll, Recurring commitments, Loan repayments, Other commitments, and Buffer, each shown as a line item.
5. Adjust the **Buffer** if needed — either a percentage of the other obligations (default 10%) or a fixed dollar amount. Click **Save Buffer**.
6. Click 🔄 **Recalculate now** any time you want the figures refreshed immediately rather than waiting for the nightly update.

Overriding Individual Breakdown Lines

Rent, Payroll, and Recurring commitments are normally calculated live from the business's actual configuration (rent account, active employee contracts, recurring auto-deposits) — so they're always accurate day to day. But sometimes you know a figure is about to change before the system does — for example, a salary increase that hasn't been entered as a new contract yet.

To manually raise one of these three lines:

1. Next to the line (e.g. 👥 **Payroll**), click **Override**.
2. Enter the new monthly figure and click **Save**.
3. The line is now marked with a small ✏️, shown in a different colour (amber) from the other lines, with the original system-computed figure displayed alongside it in grey with a strikethrough — so both numbers stay visible at a glance, not just while you're actively editing.

> **The override can only raise a line, never lower it below what the system currently computes.** If you try to save a value below the live-computed amount, it's rejected with an explanation — this guarantees the minimum target can never quietly understate what the business really needs to cover.

To remove an override and go back to the live-computed figure, click **Edit** on the line, then **Reset to system value**.

Current Cumulative Contribution

Under each of Rent, Payroll, and Recurring commitments, a small second line shows how much has actually been contributed toward that obligation **so far this month** — reusing the same real deposits already tracked elsewhere (the Rent Account's running balance, the Payroll Account's EOD contributions, and each recurring auto-deposit) rather than a separate figure to maintain:

- **Green** — on pace for the point we're at in the month.
- **Red** — behind pace for the point we're at in the month.
- **$0** is shown plainly (no colour) when nothing has been contributed yet, or for **Loan repayments** and **Other commitments** — those two are manually-entered figures with no day-to-day accrual to track, so they always read "$0 contributed this month" rather than showing a misleading "behind" warning.

This is a pace indicator, not a warning that something is wrong — a business that funds its rent account in a lump sum a week before it's due will show red for most of the month and then catch up, which is normal.

Loan Repayments & Other Commitments

Unlike Rent/Payroll/Recurring, loan repayments and other commitments have no other record in the system, so they're entered directly:

1. Under **Loan repayments & other commitments**, choose a category (**Loan repayment** or **Other**).
2. Enter a label (e.g. "Equipment loan", "Security contract") and a monthly $ amount.
3. Click **+ Add**.
4. To remove one, click the ✕ next to it.

Setting the Approved Monthly Target

Under **Set approved monthly target**, enter the figure you want driving the POS progress bar and click **Save**.

- **Below the Minimum:** rejected outright, with an explanation of why (it wouldn't cover the business's real obligations).
- **Between the Minimum and the Recommended:** accepted immediately, no explanation needed.
- **Above the Recommended:** accepted, but you must give a reason (e.g. "Planned marketing push this month") — this is recorded in the change history along with your name and the date.

Once you set an approved target that differs from the Recommended figure, it becomes a deliberate decision — future recalculations (nightly or on-demand) won't silently change it. If you later want it to go back to following the Recommended figure automatically, set it equal to the current Recommended amount.

The POS Progress Widget

Once tracking is enabled, a compact progress bar appears on the POS screen (below the salesperson selector) for every business type. It shows:

- **Status** — 🚀 Ahead, ✅ On Track, ⚠️ Watch, or 🔻 Behind (icon, label, and colour together, never colour alone)
- **Today's sales so far vs. today's target**, as a dollar figure and percentage
- **How much is left to reach today's target**

The widget updates automatically about once a minute and shows nothing at all if tracking isn't enabled for the business, or if it fails to load — it never gets in the way of ringing up a sale.

Today's target isn't simply the monthly target divided evenly by the days in the month — it's weighted by the business's actual historical sales pattern (e.g. a typically busy Saturday gets a higher daily target than a quiet Tuesday), so it stays realistic and motivating rather than arbitrary.

Viewing Full Details

For managers, business owners, and admins, the progress widget is clickable and opens a detailed view:

- **Today / This Week / This Month** progress side by side, each with actual vs. target and how much remains
- **Comparisons** — today vs. yesterday, this week vs. last week, this month vs. last month
- **Last 14 days** — a simple bar chart of daily achievement
- **Minimum target breakdown** — the same Rent/Payroll/Recurring/Loan/Other/Buffer lines from setup, each showing its current cumulative contribution this month (see Current Cumulative Contribution)
- **Recommendation assumptions** — the factors behind the Recommended figure (or a note that it's an early estimate for a new business)
- **Change history** — every enable/disable, override, and recalculation, with who made the change and when

Regular salespeople and cashiers see the compact bar only — the widget isn't clickable for them, so this detailed breakdown (which includes cost information like rent and payroll) stays manager-and-up only.

Permissions

Permission	What it grants	Default
Manage Sales Targets	Enable/disable tracking, edit the buffer/commitments/overrides, set the approved target, view the full breakdown and change history, click through to the detailed view	Business owners and system admins by default; can be granted individually to a specific manager
View Sales Target Progress	See the compact POS progress bar	Everyone with POS access to the business

New Businesses — Estimated Targets

A business needs at least 90 days of completed sales history before the system has enough data to calculate a realistic Recommended target from historical trends. Until then, the Recommended figure is simply the Minimum plus 15%, and the detailed view clearly labels it as **"Estimated — not enough sales history yet for a data-driven recommendation."** Once 90 days of history accumulate, the business automatically switches over to the full calculation on the next nightly update — no action needed.

59. Default Business & Workstation Login Behavior

> **Who reads this:** System admins setting up user accounts or shared workstations, and anyone who works across more than one business and wants to land on the right one automatically after logging in.

When you log in, the system has to decide which business to show you first. Four things can determine that, checked in order:

Priority Order

1. **Your account's default business** (if an admin has set one for you) — always wins, on any workstation.
2. **The workstation's own default business** (if one is pinned to this specific device) — applies to everyone who logs in on that workstation and has no personal default of their own.
3. **Your last accessed business** — whichever business you were last working in.
4. **The first business you have access to** — a last-resort fallback if none of the above apply.

This means an admin-assigned default follows *you* to any workstation, while a workstation default applies to whoever sits down at *that machine* — a shared till can stay pinned to one business regardless of who's logged in, unless that person has their own default set.

Setting a User's Default Business (Admin)

1. Go to **Admin** → **Users** (User Management).
2. Click **Edit** on the user.
3. Under **Basic Information**, find the **Default Business** dropdown — it lists every business the user is currently assigned to.
4. Choose a business, or select **"— No default (use last accessed) —"** to clear it and fall back to whatever they last worked in.
5. Click **Save Changes**.

Only system admins can see or change this field — it's a cross-business, account-level setting, not something a business manager can set for their own staff.

Workstation Default (Electron Kiosk Devices)

On the Electron desktop app, a **"Switch Business"** link on the app's home page lets an admin pin a specific business as this workstation's permanent default, protected by the app's admin PIN. This is meant for a device that's physically dedicated to one business (e.g. a till that should always open on the restaurant POS no matter who logs in) — it's a per-device setting, separate from any user's own default business.

If a workstation's behavior seems stuck on the wrong business regardless of which account logs in, check whether this device-level pin has been set, since it takes priority over "last accessed business" for anyone without a personal default.

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60. Promotional Sales — Grocery & Clothing

Grocery and clothing don't use Today's Special like restaurant does — instead, any number of products can independently go on sale for a scheduled window, at the same time.

Where: Grocery sidebar → 🏷️ **Promotional Sales**, or Clothing sidebar → 🏷️ **Promotional Sales**.

A promotion is either:

- **A new fixed price** — "$3.50 instead of $5.00" — for an individual product (a scanned inventory item or a quick-add product).
- **A percent off** — "20% off" — for an individual product, or for a whole **clothing bale category** (e.g. "20% off all Men's Jackets"). Category-level is percent-only, since a category holds many bales at different prices — there's no single "new price" that would make sense across all of them.

The discount applies automatically for the window you set (start date/time → end date/time), and reverts to the normal price on its own the moment the window ends — nothing to remember to undo. This is computed fresh every time a price is looked up (checkout, customer display), not a flag some background job has to remember to flip, so it can never keep discounting past its scheduled end even if something else on the server hiccups.

Only one promotion can be open on a given product at a time — if you try to schedule a new one while another is still active or upcoming on that item, it's rejected; pause or end the existing one first.

Creating a Promotion

1. Go to **Promotional Sales** and click **+ New Promotion**.
2. Search for the product (or, for clothing, a bale category) and select it.
3. Choose **Percent off** or **New fixed price** (fixed price isn't offered for a bale category).
4. Enter the discount value, and the start/end date and time.
5. Click **Create Promotion**.

The discount takes effect the moment the start time arrives — no further action needed. It shows up on both the POS (product card) and the customer display immediately once active.

Shortcut from the item itself: open any item's details in Grocery or Clothing Inventory and click 🏷️ **Put on Sale** — it opens Promotional Sales with that item already selected, skipping the search step. Just fill in the discount and schedule.

Already on sale? The inventory list flags any item with an open promotion with a 🏷️ **On Sale** (or **Sale Scheduled**, if it hasn't started yet) badge next to its name — hover it to see the discount, the sale price, and the start/end window. Opening that item's details shows the same information as a banner, and the **Put on Sale** button becomes 🏷️ **See Promos** instead (an item can only have one open promotion at a time), taking you straight to the list to pause, resume, or end it.

Pause, Resume, End

Each promotion in the list shows its live status — **Scheduled**, **Active**, **Paused**, or **Ended** — computed from right now, not stored.

Action	What it does
Pause / End (shown while Active)	Immediately stops the discount — the original price applies to all sales from that moment on. The promotion isn't deleted; it can be

Action	What it does
	resumed later.
Resume (shown while Paused, and its window hasn't passed yet)	Turns the discount back on, picking up wherever its original schedule left off.
Cancel (shown only while Scheduled — hasn't started yet)	Removes it entirely. Once a promotion has started, it can no longer be deleted outright — pause or end it instead, so there's a record of what ran.

A paused or ended promotion can always be found again in the list (nothing is hidden), so it's easy to check what was run and when.

Customer Display

A product currently on promotion is highlighted everywhere it appears:

- **Badge** — the product's card shows both the original price (struck through) and the new discounted price, in red, on both the rotating left panel and the live right-hand grid. A bale-category promotion (percent-only) shows a **"X% OFF"** badge instead, since there's no single before/after price to show for a whole category.
- **More often** — a promoted item appears in the left panel's rotation twice as often as a normal item.
- **Longer on screen** — while a promoted item is showing, it stays up 1.5× as long before the rotation advances to the next card.
- **POS card** — the product's tile on the grocery/clothing POS also shows the discounted price with the original struck through, so the cashier can see at a glance that an item is on sale.

None of this needs the admin screen to be open or anyone to be watching — it's driven by the same schedule the pricing itself uses.

Permissions

Permission	What it allows	Default
`canManagePromotions`	Create, pause, resume, cancel, and view promotional sales	Owner, Manager, Admin — **not** salesperson (pricing changes are more sensitive than the display-only toggles elsewhere in this guide)

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61. POS Quick-Edit Mode — Update Images & Adjust Prices

Authorized users can update a menu item's photo or price directly from the POS screen — no need to leave the register and go to a separate admin page.

Where: Two small buttons — 📷 **Update Images** and 💲 **Adjust Prices** — visible only to users with `canQuickEditPOSItems`. On Restaurant they sit in the category-tab grid, right after the 📶 **R710 WiFi** tab; on other POS screens they're in the header toolbar. On every POS they stay on screen (float) as you scroll through

the product list, and always show their text label — the same behavior everywhere, since staff often work across more than one business.

Turning a Mode On

- Tap **Update Images** to enter Image Upload Mode, or **Adjust Prices** to enter Price Adjustment Mode. The button you tapped turns solid and shows an "● Active" label so it's obvious which mode is on.
- The two modes are mutually exclusive — turning one on automatically turns the other off.
- Tap the active button again to return to Normal mode.
- While a mode is active, every product card gains a small round button in its bottom-left corner (bottom-right is already used for the cart-quantity badge on several POS cards): 📷 in Image mode, 💲 in Price mode. Everything else about the POS keeps working normally — tapping the rest of a card still adds it to the cart as usual; only the corner button opens the edit dialog.

Updating an Item's Image

1. Turn on **Update Images**.
2. Tap the 📷 button on the item's card.
3. The dialog shows the current image (or "No image"). From here you can either take a fresh photo and clean it up (below), do a plain quick upload, paste, or pick from your gallery.
4. The new photo appears on the card immediately — no page reload.

The dialog offers several ways in, top to bottom:

- 📋 **Copy Image to Clipboard** (only when the item already has a photo) — copies the current photo to your system clipboard so you can paste it (Ctrl+V) somewhere else: another app, an email, or another item's own image dialog. Works the same whether the original photo is a JPEG, PNG, or anything else — it's converted automatically so pasting works reliably wherever you paste it. **Ctrl+C** while this dialog is open does the same thing, so copy and paste are both available either as a button or a keyboard shortcut.
- 📷 **Take Photo / Upload (Crop & Edit)** on a phone or tablet, 📷 **Upload Photo (Crop & Edit)** on a desktop/laptop (no camera to offer there) — see Take Photo / Upload with Crop & Background Removal below. This is the recommended option for a clean, consistent product photo.
- **Upload Image** / **Replace Image** — a plain quick upload with no crop or background removal step. Pick a file and it's saved exactly as-is. Use this when the photo is already cropped and clean (e.g. an official product shot from a supplier).
- 📋 **Paste Image from Clipboard** — pulls an image already on your clipboard straight in, no need to save it to disk first. This is the button form of the Ctrl+V shortcut — use whichever is more convenient; both do exactly the same thing (or just press **Ctrl+V** anywhere in the dialog).
- 🖼 **Choose from Gallery** — attach a photo already stored in the business's Image Gallery / Reference Pool instead of uploading a new one — useful when several similar items (e.g. size/color variants) should share one photo.
- 🗑 **Remove Image** (only when the item already has a photo) — clears the photo entirely; the card falls back to showing its category emoji instead.

Take Photo / Upload with Crop & Background Removal

The camera/photo pipeline lets you go from a raw phone photo (or an uploaded file) to a clean, square, background-free product image without leaving the app or needing separate photo-editing software. It opens from the 📷 button described above, and from the same **Add Image** / **Change Image** button on an existing item's edit screen (Section 14).

1. **Choose a source.**
   - On a phone or tablet: 📷 **Take Photo** opens your device's own camera app directly (not an in-app camera preview), or ⬆️ **Upload From Device** to pick an existing photo from your gallery.
   - On a desktop/laptop, only ⬆️ **Upload From Device** is offered — there's no camera to take a photo with, so that option doesn't appear there.
2. **Crop.** Drag to reposition, use the **Zoom** and **Rotate** sliders to fine-tune, and leave **Square (1:1)** checked (recommended — every product tile in the app is square) or untick it to keep the photo's original proportions instead. **Reset** clears zoom/rotation/position back to the start. Tap **Next** when it looks right.
3. **Remove Background (optional).** The app automatically tries to remove the background, entirely on your device — nothing is uploaded anywhere for this step. The first time you do this in a session it can take several seconds while the AI model downloads; after that it's faster. Once it finishes, you'll see the original crop side by side with the background-removed version:
   - **Use This** — keep the background-removed version.
   - **Keep Original** — keep the plain cropped photo instead (background left in).
   - **Skip — use the cropped photo as-is** — available immediately while it's still processing, if you don't want to wait.
   - If background removal doesn't work on a particular photo (this can happen on slower devices, or if it takes too long), you'll see **Keep Cropped Original** instead — nothing is lost, you just continue with the plain cropped photo.
4. The finished photo is saved automatically — no separate "Save" step once you've made your choice in step 3.

Note: When creating a brand-new item that hasn't been saved yet, the image button only offers a plain **Upload from device** or **Choose from image pool** — the crop/background-removal pipeline isn't available until the item exists. Once the item is created, use **Change Image** to go back and clean up the photo with the full pipeline if you want to.

Adjusting an Item's Price

1. Turn on **Adjust Prices**.
2. Tap the 💲 button on the item's card.
3. The dialog shows the current price. Enter the new price and tap **Save Price** (must be greater than $0).
4. The new price takes effect immediately — the next sale of that item charges the new price.

Where This Works Today

Available on every POS: **Restaurant**, **Grocery**, **Clothing**, **Hardware**, and **Universal POS** (retail, services, consulting, construction, vehicles, and other similar business types).

For Clothing specifically: it's on the **Quick Add Products** tab only — **Bale Items don't get either button**, since bales have no image of their own and their pricing goes through the existing bale workflow, not this

feature. Clothing products are sold by variant (size/color), each with its own price, so **Adjust Prices** shows a small 💲 button on each variant's row rather than one price for the whole card — click the variant you want to change.

Every price change made this way — or through any other price-editing screen — is recorded (who, when, old value, new value) and reviewable on the Price Change Report.

The same dialog also opens from the **Business Image Gallery**'s linked-products list — click a product's name (shown in blue with a 🖍️ icon when you have `canQuickEditPOSItems`) to view or change its price without leaving the gallery. See Section 65.

Permissions

Permission	What it allows	Default
`canQuickEditPOSItems`	See and use the Update Images / Adjust Prices buttons on the POS	Owner, Manager, Admin — not salesperson

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62. POS Menu-Number Search & Receipt Credit Balance — Restaurant

Aligns the restaurant POS with the printed menu's numbering, and makes sure a customer's credit balance always shows up on the receipt when they have one.

Menu Number Badges

Every menu item and AYLI combo with a menu number assigned (via Menu Numbers) shows that number as a badge, top-right on its POS card — the same corner it's always shown in, now guaranteed to appear whenever a number is assigned, even on a card that's also discounted, out of stock, or sold by weight (those indicators moved to top-left so they no longer compete). Items without a number show no badge at all.

Undo a Card Tap

Tapping a card in the grid adds one of that item to the cart, and a blue count badge appears bottom-right on the card to show how many are in the cart. A small ✕ button sits right above that badge whenever the count is showing — tap it to undo: it clears the cart of that item entirely (not just one unit), without opening the cart panel. Handy for a mis-tap or a customer who changed their mind before checkout.

Searching by Menu Number

Typing a menu number into the POS search box behaves differently from typing a name:

- If what you've typed so far **looks like a menu number** (starts with a digit, made up only of digits with at most one trailing letter — e.g. "7", "12", "4a") the search switches to **number mode**: it looks for an exact match on that number only, never a partial or fuzzy match on the name.
    - Exactly one item has that number → it's shown by itself, large, with **+ Add to Cart** and **Cancel** buttons side by side.

    - No item has that number → **"No menu item found for №..."**, with a **Cancel** button below it, and the search box stays active so you can correct it.
    - **Cancel** clears the search box in either case — use it if the customer changes their mind before you tap Add to Cart.
- The moment what you've typed stops looking like a menu number (a space, a second letter, etc.), it falls back to the normal name search, unchanged.

Auto-reset: adding an item via the number-search result clears the search box automatically, ready for the next number. Adding an item any other way (clicking a card in the regular grid) leaves the search box exactly as it was — this reset is specific to the number-search flow.

Type anywhere: you don't need to scroll up and click the search box first — just start typing a menu number (or a name) while nothing else is focused, and after a brief pause it jumps into the search box on its own, cursor at the end, ready to keep typing. This is deliberately tuned to never interfere with actual barcode scanning: a real scan is a long, fast burst of characters, while this only ever kicks in for short input — anything long enough to plausibly be a barcode is left entirely alone for the scanner to handle.

Cart and Receipt

- A numbered item's cart line shows a small number badge next to its name.
- The printed receipt shows the same number next to the item name (e.g. `#7 Rice & Beef Stew`) — items with no number print exactly as before.
- The on-screen receipt preview matches what actually prints.

Customer Credit Balance on Receipt

If a customer is attached to the order and has a positive credit balance:

- **Credit was applied or change was saved to credit this transaction** — the receipt shows the full breakdown: opening balance, credit applied, change saved to credit, and remaining balance (unchanged from before).
- **Credit was untouched this transaction** (paid cash, card, EcoCash, etc., without applying credit) — the receipt now still prints a **"Credit balance: $X.XX"** line so the customer and business always see where their balance stands, not only on transactions where it was spent.

No credit line prints at all when no customer is attached to the order, or their balance is $0.00.

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63. Price Change Report

Every time a product's price changes — from the POS Quick-Edit **Adjust Prices** dialog, Menu Management, a Products/Inventory edit form, or Bulk Stock receiving — it's recorded to an audit trail, and can be reviewed on a dedicated report.

Reason for Price Change

Changing a price that already had a real value requires a reason — a short free-text explanation typed into the same dialog where the price is changed. **Setting an initial price** (the item had no price before, i.e. $0/none) never asks for one, since there's nothing yet to explain.

This applies everywhere a price can be changed:

- POS Quick-Edit **Adjust Prices** dialog
- The inventory item edit form (Grocery, Clothing, Hardware, Restaurant)
- The clothing admin price-update modal
- Bulk Stock receiving — a single optional reason applies to every price change in that batch (not required, since a large receiving batch must never be blocked by a missing reason)

Whoever makes the change also gets a notification sent to this business's managers/admins (and every system admin) — piggybacking on the same audit trail — so a price change never goes unnoticed by the people responsible for pricing decisions. The person who made the change doesn't notify themselves.

Where to Find It

Restaurant, Grocery, Clothing, and Hardware → sidebar → **Reports** → 💲 **Price Change Report** tile.

What's Recorded

For every price change:

Column	Shows
Date	When the change was made
Product	The item's name, the genuine reason typed in when the price was changed (in quotes), and "via POS Quick-Edit" / "via Bulk Stock Receiving" underneath if that's how it was changed. Rows from before this feature shipped show "no reason captured" instead. Hover the name for the same text as a tooltip.
Original Price	The price before the change (struck through)
New Price	The price after the change — red if it went up, green if it went down
Changed By	The name and email of the user who made the change

The change is captured by the server the moment the price update is saved — it isn't dependent on which screen made the edit, so nothing slips through unrecorded.

Using the Report

- **Search** by product name or by the name/email of whoever made the change.
- **Date range** — same date-range picker used throughout Reports, including an "All Time" option.
- Results are paginated, newest first.

Permissions

Permission	What it allows	Default
`canManageMenu`, `canManageInventory`, or `canAccessFinancialData` (any one)	View the Price Change Report for that business	Owner, Manager, Admin

64. POS Cart Badges — Decrement & Remove Without Opening the Cart

The small quantity badge that appears on a product card once it's in the cart carries two quick actions, so a mis-tap or a change of mind never requires scrolling down to the cart panel:

- **−** removes one unit of that item.
- ✕ clears that item from the cart completely, regardless of how many are in it.

Both act immediately and never open the cart panel.

Where this works:

- **Restaurant** — bottom-right of the card, above the count.
- **Grocery** (Desk Mode) — top-right of the card, next to the count. The **−** button doesn't appear on items sold by weight, since their "quantity" is a kg amount rather than a count that makes sense to reduce by one — use ✕ to remove those instead.
- **Clothing** — Quick Add Products and WiFi Tokens tabs, next to each variant's own **Add** button (clothing sells by variant, so each size/color tracks its own quantity and its own − / ✕).
- **Universal POS** (Vehicle Service, Construction, Vehicles, Consulting, Services, Retail, Other) — grid and list display modes, same corner placement as Restaurant/Grocery.

Hardware POS's product browser doesn't have this yet — its cart lives in a separate panel from the browsing grid, so the same shortcut isn't available there today; the cart panel's own quantity controls still work as before.

65. Business Image Gallery & Category Reference Pool

> **Who reads this:** Clothing, grocery, and hardware business owners/managers browsing or organizing their product images. Other business types may get this later.

Where: Sidebar → 🖼️ **Image Gallery** (visible to anyone with access to a clothing, grocery, or hardware business).

The Image Gallery has two tabs at the top, alongside a business picker (only your clothing/grocery/hardware businesses are listed):

Tab	What it shows
My Gallery	Every image this business actually owns or uses on one of its own products

Tab	What it shows
📁 **Pool**	The shared category reference pool — thousands of pre-imported category photos, browsable by category, not yet tied to any specific business until you attach one

The top toolbar (business picker, tabs, filters/search, image count) is **sticky** — it stays in view while you scroll the grid below it.

My Gallery Tab

Shows only images this business has actually used — starts small and grows as you attach images to products (from either tab).

Filters (all in the sticky toolbar): search by linked product name/SKU, inventory status (has inventory / not linked yet), stock status (in / low / out of stock), and a tag filter with autocomplete.

Each thumbnail shows:

- A count badge (top-right) — how many products use this image
- A stock-status chip (bottom-left) — In Stock / Low Stock / Out of Stock, based on the linked product(s)' current stock

Clicking a thumbnail opens the detail panel:

Action	What it does
Tags	Add or remove tags (autocomplete from this business's own tags **and** the shared vocabulary below); typing a name that doesn't exist yet creates it. Every tag shows its emoji next to its name.
Linked inventory items	Every product using this image — see Linked Products below
Set Primary	Makes this the product's main photo (shown on POS cards, receipts, etc.)
Remove	Un-links this image from that one product (doesn't delete the image itself)
Copy Image	Copies the image to your clipboard (paste it anywhere, e.g. while creating a new product)
Add this image to another product	Search by name, SKU, or **scan a barcode** — the search box is focused automatically so a physical scanner's input goes straight into it. Results are always limited to this business's own products.

📊 **Insights panel** (collapsible, above the grid): most-used images, images on high-turnover items (top sellers in the last 7 days), and images on low-stock/out-of-stock items — each thumbnail click-through to the detail panel above.

Reference Pool Tab

Browses the shared, business-agnostic category image pool — imported in bulk from a source catalog, plus anything added since via Bulk Upload. An image here isn't "yours" until you attach it to one of your own products.

- **Domain dropdown** — filter to one department (e.g. Women's, Bakery), or browse "All domains". Most pool images are tagged at this level only.
- **Category dropdown** — appears next to it once you've picked a domain, but only if at least one image in that domain has also been tagged to a specific category (see Bulk Upload below) — narrows further (e.g. within Women's, just "Blouses"). If it doesn't appear, no image in that domain has a category tag yet.
- Images already used by one of your own products are shown **first**, most-used first — so the images your business actually relies on surface at the top of the grid instead of being buried among thousands of untouched ones
- **Clicking a thumbnail** opens a small dialog: the image, Linked Products already using it (if any), and the same search-or-scan "add to a product" box described above
- Once attached, the thumbnail shows the same count badge as My Gallery — no need to switch tabs to confirm it worked
- If the same pool image is also used by **other businesses**, a second badge shows how many — groundwork for this feature eventually opening to more business types; it doesn't affect your own use of the image

⬆️ **Bulk Upload** — add multiple images to the pool at once. Requires `canManageInventory` — this writes into a pool shared by every business of this type, not just your own data, so it's gated stricter than browsing.

- **Category (optional)** is the primary field — search across every real category for the business type directly (e.g. "Blouses"), grouped under its parent department where one exists. Picking one **auto-fills the Domain** below it — no need to already know which department a category lives under.
- **Domain** stays available for a whole-department upload with no specific category. Changing it manually after picking a category clears the category (they must always match).
- 🔎 **Browse all categories** (link at the top of the dialog) opens the full category tree — including the clothing group headers like Tops/Bottoms — in a new tab, useful for seeing what exists before deciding what to upload.
- Once at least one image is tagged to a specific category, that category becomes filterable in the browse dropdown above for everyone — most existing pool images are still domain-only, so don't be surprised if the Category dropdown doesn't show up yet for a domain nobody has category-tagged.

Linked Products — Viewing, Selling & Editing Price

Both the My Gallery detail panel and the Reference Pool's attach dialog show the same list of "your products using this image" — name, SKU, price, and stock (e.g. *In Stock (12)*, *Low Stock (3)*, *Out of Stock (0)*):

- 🛒 **Add to Cart** — for a product with a single variant, this adds it straight into your **floating cart** (the shopping-cart icon in the top header) without leaving the gallery. The cart pops open and stays open — it won't auto-close as you keep browsing — until you dismiss it yourself (✕, clicking the icon again, clicking elsewhere, or checking out). Products with more than one variant (e.g. multiple sizes) instead jump to that product in its own business's POS so you can pick the variant, the same cross-business navigation the barcode scanner uses elsewhere.

    - Disabled (greyed out) when the price is $0 or stock is 0 — hover it to see why.
- **Click the product's name** (shown in blue with a 🖍️, only if you have `canQuickEditPOSItems`) to open the same price dialog used by POS Quick-Edit Mode — view or change the price without leaving the gallery. Saving it updates the price shown here immediately, **and** if that product is already sitting in your floating cart, that cart line's price updates too.

Tag Vocabulary, Product Tags & Tag Search

Tags started as an image-organizing tool (above) and now cover three more things: a large built-in vocabulary, tagging products directly (not just images), and search.

Built-in vocabulary — every clothing business automatically has access to a shared set of ~317 ready-made tags (fabric, pattern, color, fit, length, neckline, sleeve style, closures, occasion, season, audience, style/vibe, sustainability, and a handful of internal/operational tags), each with its own emoji, grouped the same way they're organized in this list (Fabric / Material, Pattern / Print, Occasion / Use Case, etc.). These are **system tags** — shared across every clothing business, not owned by yours specifically, so they show a small 🔒 in the Tag Management screen and can't be renamed, merged, or deleted from your own business (only created custom tags can be). You can still use every one of them freely on your own images and products.

🏷️ **Manage Tags** (button next to the tag filter on the My Gallery tab) opens a screen to:

- Browse the full vocabulary, grouped and searchable, or your own business's custom tags (a "Your Tags" section at the end)
- **+ New Tag** — create your own custom tag with a name and an emoji (uses the same emoji picker as everywhere else in the app — search by description or paste one directly); leave the emoji blank and it defaults to 🏷️
- **Rename / Merge / Delete** — only available on your own custom tags. Merge folds one tag into another (e.g. a duplicate you created by accident) and re-tags everything that had the old one.

Tagging a product directly — when creating a new product (**Clothing** → **Products** → **New Product**) or editing an existing one, a **Tags** field lets you search and pick from the full vocabulary (or type a new one) — the same picker, showing emoji + name, with your current picks as removable chips. On the create screen, picks are applied right after the product is saved; on the edit screen, each pick/removal takes effect immediately, the same way Set Primary/Remove already work elsewhere in the gallery.

Tag search — the product search used everywhere in the app (POS quick-add, this business's own inventory search, the Image Gallery's "add to a product" box, vehicle-service parts requests) now also matches tags. Searching "linen" or "clearance" finds every product tagged that way, on top of the existing name/SKU/barcode matching.

Permissions

Permission	What it allows
Active membership in a clothing business	Browse My Gallery and the Reference Pool, tag images/products, attach/remove product links, add linked products to cart, create custom tags

Permission	What it allows
`canQuickEditPOSItems`	Click a linked product's name to view/change its price from the gallery
`canManageInventory`	Bulk-upload new images into the shared Reference Pool
System admin	Rename, merge, or delete a shared **system** tag (not available from a business's own Tag Management screen)

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66. Pricing, Cost, Value & Performance Intelligence Reports

Who can access: Admins, users with Manage Inventory permission, or Financial Data access. All four reports are scoped to the single business currently selected in the business switcher — they never combine data across businesses, even under an umbrella "All" selection.

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → the four report links below, or from any business type's Reports page (Grocery, Clothing, Hardware, Restaurant, Retail).

These reports work across **both** of the app's inventory systems (the barcode/scan-based items used by Bulk Stock Panel and Stock Take, and the catalog items used by menu/service-style products) — a product entered either way is included in every report below.

A hub page ties them together: Sidebar → Inventory → any of the report links takes you into that report directly, but the **Reports** breadcrumb at the top of every one of them leads to `/inventory/reports` — a single page listing all five, so you can jump between them without going back through the sidebar each time.

Common to every report on this page:

- **Product thumbnail + edit link** — each row shows the item's photo (or a "No image" placeholder) next to its name. For users with Manage Inventory permission (or admin), the name is a link straight to that item's edit screen; other users just see the plain name.
- **Search** — every report has a search box (by name/SKU/barcode) with pagination and an adjustable page size beneath it. Search debounces briefly as you type.
- **Export CSV** — downloads the currently filtered/sorted rows as a spreadsheet.
- **Print / Save as PDF** — opens the browser's print dialog with a clean, filter-free layout; choose "Save as PDF" there for a PDF copy.

Pricing & Value Exceptions

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → ⚠️ Pricing & Value Exceptions

Lists every product with a pricing, cost, or value problem worth investigating. A product can appear with more than one issue at once.

What it detects:

- No selling price, or a selling price of $0 — flagged differently depending on how the item was created: menu/service-style items are simply **hidden from the POS** until priced, while barcode/scan-based items stay **visible and sellable at $0** if never priced. The report's POS Status column tells you which applies.
- No cost price, or both cost and selling price missing.

- Selling price below cost price (a loss on every sale), or exactly equal to cost (zero profit).
- Margin below your configured minimum (10% by default).
- A price that looks like a decimal-entry error (e.g. 10× or 100× what it should be, based on cost).
- A selling price far outside the average for its category (needs at least 5 similarly-priced products in the same category to compare against — shown as "insufficient peer data" otherwise).
- A cost or selling price that changed sharply (more than 30% by default) since the last time it was recorded. Price-change history only starts from when this feature shipped — items whose price hasn't changed since then show no "previous price" yet.
- **Margin above your configured maximum** (90% by default) — the mirror image of the low-margin check; not necessarily wrong, just worth a second look (could be a cost-side decimal error, or a legitimately premium item).
- **Possible bulk cost error** — the classic mistake this flag catches: a case/box of stock gets bought and its *whole-case* cost gets entered as if it were the cost of *one unit*. Example: a case of 24 drinks bought for $6.70 total entered as costing $6.70 each, against a $0.50 selling price — the report would otherwise show a huge loss on every sale that isn't real. See "Fixing a Bulk Cost Error" just below.

Filters: date range (affects "qty sold"/"last sold" only — the exceptions themselves reflect current data), severity, POS status, profitability status, and text search.

Reviewing an exception: click the status pill next to any exception badge to mark it Reviewed, Corrected, Approved, Ignored, or Follow-up, with an optional note. **Approving a below-cost sale** requires Manage Inventory permission (or admin) and a written reason — the same safeguard pattern used elsewhere in the app for sensitive approvals.

Fixing a Bulk Cost Error

When a row is flagged with ⚠ **Possible bulk cost error**, click **Fix** next to the Cost figure to open a small correction modal — the underlying report page stays open behind it, so your search/filters/scroll position are never lost.

- **The only thing you can ever change here is Units per Pack / Case Quantity.** Cost figures in this modal are always read-only — that split is deliberate:
  - **Anyone who can view this report** (Financial Data access, Manage Inventory, or admin) can correct the pack quantity. It's treated as a safe, non-financial correction — it never touches recorded sales.
  - **If you also have Manage Inventory permission (or admin)** and no bulk cost is on file yet for this item, confirming the pack quantity *also* infers the case cost from the item's current (suspected-wrong) cost price and fully corrects the unit cost, margin, and this exception in one step.
  - **If you don't have Manage Inventory permission**, the same action only records the pack size — the cost price is left exactly as it was. A banner in the modal explains this plainly, and the row keeps showing the raw pack-cost math (e.g. "$6.70 ÷ 24 = $0.28/unit") as a hint even before anyone finalizes it, so the original case cost is never lost from view.
- After confirming, the row stays visible with a green "just fixed, was $X.XX" line under Cost, Margin, and Potential P/L — so you can immediately judge whether the fix looks right, and click **Fix** again right away if you spot a mistake. A full page reload is what actually re-checks whether the row still qualifies as an exception at all.

- **Open Full Item Editor** (visible only with Manage Inventory permission) is always available from this modal for anything beyond a pack-size fix — for example when the cost price itself also needs correcting, not just the pack quantity.

Inventory Value

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → 💰 Inventory Value

Shows what your stock is worth, at cost and at selling price, split three ways:

- **Recently Stocked** — quantity/value received within the selected date range (based on stock-receiving history; items received before that history started fall under Existing even if actually received recently).
- **Existing** — everything else already on hand.
- **Combined** — the two added together (should match total quantity on hand).

Items with no cost price are labeled **unvalued** and excluded from the cost-value totals (shown as a separate count so they aren't mistaken for zero-value stock). Items that are hidden from or sellable-at-$0 in the POS are flagged in the Status column, and any item selling below cost shows its potential loss on the remaining stock.

Product Performance

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → 📈 Product Performance

The full drill-down version of the Fast & Slow Moving Stock report (§27) — same underlying data, plus revenue, cost of goods sold, gross profit, margin %, transaction count, and days since last sale. Filter by profitable / loss-making / no sales / unreliable pricing, and sort by any of the money columns.

> **Accuracy note:** cost of goods sold always uses today's cost price, not the cost at the time each historical sale happened — if a product's cost has changed recently, treat its margin figures for older sales as an approximation.

Poor-Performing Stock

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → 📉 Poor-Performing Stock

Surfaces the stock most likely tying up capital for no return: no or low sales, negative/zero margin, below-cost pricing, excess stock relative to how fast it sells, long since last sold, old stock, or missing/suspicious pricing. Each row shows every reason it was flagged and a suggested action (set a price, run a promotion, reduce future purchases, consider clearance, or discontinue).

Minimum-Stock Recommendation

Where: Sidebar/Notifications → Reorder Report (`/admin/reports/reorder`) → tick **"Show all products (Minimum-Stock Recommendation view)"**

By default this page only lists products already low on stock (see §27's Reorder Suggestions). Ticking this checkbox switches it to show **every** product with two extra columns:

- **Recommended Min** — a suggested minimum stock level based on average daily sales, supplier lead time (when on file — mostly only available for menu/catalog-style products, not barcode/scan-based

ones), and a safety buffer. Hover the number for the exact basis used; a ⚠ means there's too little sales history to trust the figure.
- **Min Stock Status** — Below Min / At Min / Above Min, comparing current stock to the recommendation.

This is decision support only — click **min N** in the Stock column (as before) to manually set the actual minimum stock level for any product.

Stocking & Related Expenses

Where: Sidebar → Inventory → 🚚 Stocking & Related Expenses

Answers "what did a restocking run actually cost, all in" — not just the goods, but the transport, tolls, meals, and other expenses that went with it.

Pick a date range and the report shows three tables:

- **By Product** — every item received in the period, total quantity, and total cost (pulled from real per-receipt stock history, not just today's snapshot, so this stays accurate even after prices have since changed).
- **Stocking Events** — the same data as a day-by-day log, so you can see exactly what was received on a given date.
- **Related Expenses** — every other expense-account payment in the same window, with a category filter (there's no single "Transport/Tolls/Meals" category system-wide, so pick the ones that apply, e.g. Transportation) so you can see what else was spent alongside the stocking itself.

Summary cards at the top total items stocked, stocking cost, related expenses (respecting the category filter), and a combined grand total. Each table has its own **Export CSV** button.

> **Expenses are correlated by date range, not a hard link** — the report doesn't know which specific expense belongs to which specific stocking trip, only that they happened in the same window. Use the category filter and your own judgement to narrow down to the ones that are actually stocking-related.

67. Bulk/Case Cost Entry — Bulk Stocking & Stock Take

Where: Bulk Stocking and Stock Take (the same screen, two modes) — wherever you enter or receive stock quantities.

This closes the same "bulk cost error" gap described in §66 at the point where it actually happens: receiving stock. If you buy a case of 24 drinks for $6.70 total, typing $6.70 straight into the Cost field would silently record it as $6.70 *per drink* — this feature gives you an explicit way to say "that number is for the whole case," so the system works out the real per-unit cost itself instead of guessing.

Two ways to enter a case cost, either one works:

- **The 📦 button next to any row's Cost field** — click it to open a small popover: enter the case/pack cost and how many units it contains, and it shows the computed per-unit cost live (e.g. "$6.70 ÷ 24 = $0.28/unit") before you apply it.
- **The pricing calculator** (opens when you focus a row's Sell Price field) — has a "Qty per box" field right in it. Enter it and every suggested price, the landed cost, and the margin math shown all use the corrected per-unit cost immediately. Leaving it at 0 keeps the calculator working exactly as it always

has. The correction (and the case-cost info on the row) is only saved once you actually pick a price from the calculator — not while you're still typing the quantity.
- Either way, once a row has a recorded case cost, it shows a small **"24×$6.70/case"** caption under the Cost field, and margin/price warnings appear right there if the price you're choosing would land outside the policy range (the same 10%–90% band §66 checks).

Existing stock is flagged automatically. When Stock Take loads your current inventory (or you resume a saved draft), any item that already has a recorded case cost shows that same "N×$X.XX/case" caption right away — so you can see at a glance which items are already tracked as bulk purchases before you touch anything.

> **Not the same as Bulk-Stock Conversion (§50):** this feature only *corrects a cost figure* — it never touches stock quantity, and can be freely re-edited at any time. If the item was actually received as sellable packets (e.g. a pack of 5 that should become 5 separate units in stock, not just 1 with a corrected cost), you want Bulk-Stock Conversion instead — a one-way conversion that recalculates quantity, cost, *and* price together.

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68. Clothing POS — Return & Exchange

Where: Clothing Advanced POS → **Sale / Return / Exchange** tabs at the top of the register.

Both workflows look up the customer's **original sale**, so you're always refunding/exchanging real, specific items that were actually sold — not a free-text guess.

Processing a Return

1. Switch to the **Return** tab.
2. **Search for the original sale** — by order number, receipt number, or customer name (the order number is printed on every receipt, e.g. `CLO-20260927-0001`).
3. **Pick the order** from the results — its real line items load (product, quantity sold, unit price).
4. **Check the item(s)** being returned and adjust the quantity if only some of what was bought is coming back (capped at what was actually sold).
5. **Select a return reason**.
6. Click **Get Manager Approval & Process Return** — a manager must approve every return, at any amount, by entering their own manager code (or badge scan) on the approval screen that opens. This is a real check against actual manager accounts, not a shared PIN.
7. Once approved, the return is processed immediately: the customer's payment is refunded, the returned stock goes back into inventory, and the original sale is updated to reflect the return.

> **Outside the 2-day window?** A notice appears if the original sale is more than 2 days old, as a reminder of store policy — it does not block anything by itself, since every return already requires manager approval regardless of age. The manager approving it is exercising that discretion.

Processing an Exchange

An exchange is a return (for the old item) combined with a new sale (for the replacement item), settled as a single net payment.

1. Switch to the **Exchange** tab.

2. Search for and select the original order, then check the item(s) being exchanged away — exactly like a Return.
3. Click **Get Manager Approval** and have a manager approve it.
4. Once approved, add the **replacement item(s)** to the cart using the normal product grid/search — this works exactly like a regular sale.
5. The cart total automatically shows the exchange credit applied (the value of the returned item(s), subtracted like a coupon) — so **you only ever charge or refund the customer the net difference**, not the full price of the new item.
6. Click **Process Exchange** and complete payment as normal. Once the new sale succeeds, the return side is processed automatically in the background.

Notes

- Return/Exchange only work against the POS's current **Target Business** — if the sale you're looking up belongs to a different business, switch to that business first.
- Stock is correctly returned to inventory regardless of how the original item was sold (a regular product, a clothing bale, a custom bulk item, or a scanned inventory item).
- If, in an exchange, the new sale succeeds but the return side fails for some reason (e.g. a connection error), you'll see a message telling you to process the return separately from the Orders page — the completed sale is never lost or silently rolled back.

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69. POS Sales Comparison Report — Today vs Yesterday vs 2 Days Ago

Where: Grocery, Hardware, and Clothing POS → the **Today's Sales** panel.

Beyond the usual daily summary, you can open a full report comparing today's trading against the last two days, directly from the same panel — no need to leave the POS screen.

- **Click the Total Sales amount** to open a detailed **single-day report** for today — summary totals, an hourly sales chart, payment method breakdown, top categories, and top salespeople.
- **Click the Orders count** to jump straight to the **Superimposition** view — a line chart overlaying today, yesterday, and 2 days ago by hour (in different colours, with a legend), so you can see at a glance how the shape of today's trading compares to recent days.
- Inside the report, four buttons — **Today**, **Yesterday**, **2 Days Ago**, 📊 **Superimposition** — switch between the single-day report for any of the three days and the overlay chart. A day with no data yet (e.g. a brand-new business) shows its button greyed out.
- The Superimposition chart can toggle between **Sales ($)** and **Orders** as the plotted metric.

> This report draws on data already loaded for the Today's Sales panel's own "vs yesterday" comparisons, so opening it doesn't trigger extra loading for Today/Yesterday/2 Days Ago — only the Superimposition's underlying chart data is computed on open.

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70. Linked Profile — Name & Photo Shared Between Your Login and Employee Record

If your system login (user account) is linked to an Employee record, your **name and profile photo are kept in sync** between the two — update either one and the other updates automatically, so you (and everyone who

sees your name/photo — Team Chat, the people picker, Admin user lists) never see two different versions of who you are.

Where you can edit your name/photo:

- **Your own profile** — click your avatar → **Profile Settings** — update your name and upload a photo there if you're not an employee, or want to change it from this side.
- **Employee record edit page** (HR/managers) — the same name + photo fields appear at the top of the Edit Employee form.
- **Admin** → **Users** → **Edit User** (system admins) — the same fields appear in the Basic Information section.

Whichever one you edit, if that account is linked to an employee record, the change is pushed to the other side immediately — there's nothing extra to do to keep them matching.

> If you're **not** linked to an employee record (e.g. a system admin with no HR record), your name and photo are entirely your own — editing them only affects your login, since there's no employee record to sync with.

Linking an Existing User to an Employee Record

If someone already has both a login and an employee record, but they were never connected (so a photo set on one side never showed up on the other), a system admin can link them from **Admin** → **Users**:

1. Open the ⋮ menu on the user's row and choose **Link Existing Employee** (only offered while the user isn't already linked — once linked, this entry stays in the menu but shows disabled as **"Linked to EMP000XXX"**, so the linked state is visible at a glance).
2. Search for and select the matching employee, then confirm.
3. The employee's name and photo immediately become the shared values for both records (the employee record is treated as the source of truth if the two had different names/photos beforehand).

The same linking can also be started from the employee's own page (**System Account** card → **Link Existing User**).